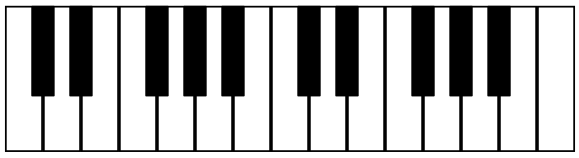
Read at Sight

A graded sight-reading course for piano

Volume 3 - Two Voices



Middle C

The left hand gets its own music: broken chords, Alberti basses and real second voices, in 6/8 time and in keys with up to two sharps or flats.

Exercises generated to graded rules; pieces are original or public domain.

How to use this book

What is new in Volume 3

In Volumes 1 and 2 the left hand mostly held long notes while the right hand played the tune. Now both hands have something to say. The left hand plays broken chords and Alberti basses, then a melody of its own, and the right hand starts to play two notes at once. You will also meet 6/8 time, the keys of D major and B-flat major, and sharps and flats that are not in the key signature. Start this book when you can read Volume 2 music, with shifts, dotted rhythms and dynamics, in C, G and F major and their relative minors.

The five rules

1. Never stop: keep the beat going, even after a wrong note. 2. Count out loud and use a metronome at the speed shown. 3. Keep your eyes on the music, not your hands. 4. Read the shape: up, down, or the same, and by how much. 5. Play each exercise once, tick its box, and move on. Come back only after a few weeks.

Before every exercise: 10 seconds

Check the clef and time signature. Find the first note and its finger number. Scan for the highest and lowest note, and for any bar that repeats an earlier one. Then count one bar in and play.

How each unit is laid out

A unit opens with what is new, a keyboard picture of the hand position, and reading tips. Then come Parts A, B and C, which grow slightly harder. Pieces come next, and the unit ends with a checkpoint that tells you when to move on.

A daily routine (15-20 minutes)

Warm up by playing the five notes of the hand position up and down, saying their names (2 minutes). Read 6-10 new exercises, one pass each (10 minutes). Play one piece, aiming for steady and musical (5 minutes).

Contents

Each unit adds exactly one new idea to everything before it.

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Triads; the left hand plays I, IV and V7 one note at a time

Unit 2 The Alberti Bass 20
Broken chords in eighth notes: low, high, middle, high

Unit 3 Six-Eight Time 38
6/8: two beats in a bar, each beat split into three eighths

Unit 4 D Major 54
Two sharps (F-sharp and C-sharp); D major and its chords

Unit 5 B-flat Major 70
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Right-hand thirds and sixths: reading two notes together

Unit 8 Two Independent Voices 118
A left-hand melody against the right hand: contrary and parallel motion

Unit 9 Imitation 131
Simple counterpoint: one hand answers the other with the same tune

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Everything in Volume 3 together

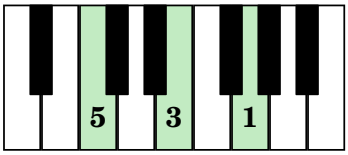
Unit 1

Broken Chords

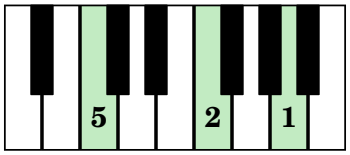
New: Triads; the left hand plays I, IV and V7 one note at a time

Until now the left hand mostly held one long note while the right hand played the tune. In this unit the left hand plays chords, one note at a time. A chord played one note after another is called a broken chord. Broken chords fill out the music and keep it moving, and they are easy to read once you know their shapes.
Each key uses three chord shapes. Learn them on the keyboard below before you start: in every exercise the left hand plays only these notes.

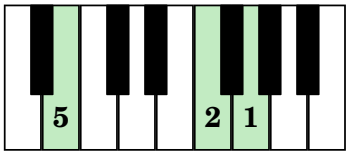
C major: left-hand chord shapes



I = C

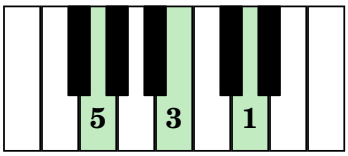


IV = F

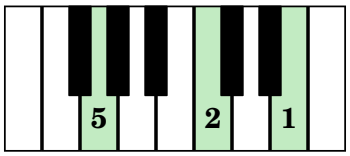


V7 = G7

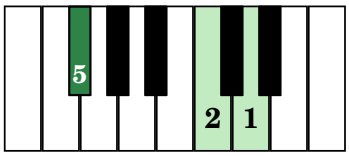
G major: left-hand chord shapes



I = G

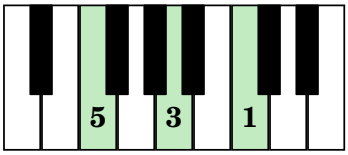


IV = C

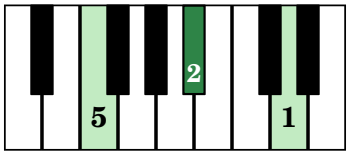


V7 = D7

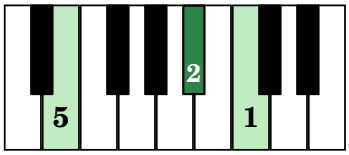
F major: left-hand chord shapes



I = F

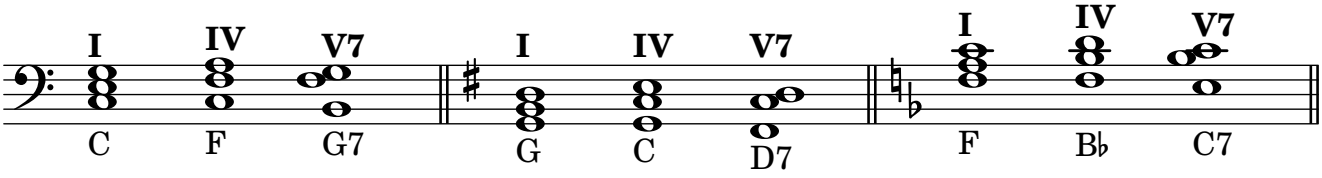


IV = B♭



V7 = C7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

Triad

Three notes stacked in thirds: a note, the note a third above it, and the note a third above that. On the staff a triad sits on three lines in a row or in three spaces in a row: C E G, F A C, G B D.

I, IV and V7

Chords are named by the scale note they are built on: I on the first note of the key (C in C major), IV on the fourth (F) and V on the fifth (G). V7 adds a fourth note, a seventh above the bottom note (G B D F). The three chords together can play under most simple tunes.

Shapes that stay close

The hand does not jump to each new chord. It keeps finger 5 near the tonic and changes shape: I is C E G (fingers 5 3 1), IV is C F A (5 2 1) and V7 is B F G (5 2 1), which is G7 without its D. Finger 5 moves down one key for V7.

Broken-chord patterns

In 4/4 the left hand plays bottom, middle, top, middle in quarter notes. In 3/4 it plays bottom, middle, top. The last bar holds the tonic.

Finger numbers in the bass

A finger number under a bass note marks a new chord shape. Change the shape of your hand there, not before.

Reading tips

1. Read the left hand in shapes, not note by note: three lines or three spaces in a row is I; a wider shape is IV or V7.

2. In your 10-second scan, follow the left hand's finger numbers and name each chord: I, IV or V7.

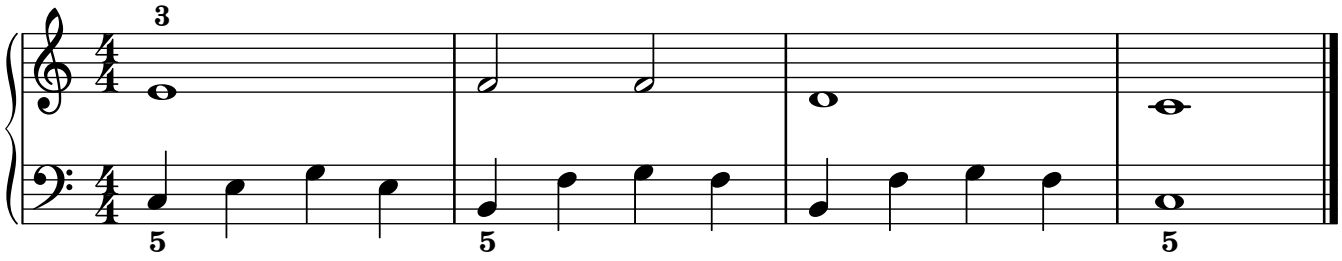
3. The first note of each bar in the right hand belongs to that bar's chord, so the hands always fit together on beat 1.

4. Keep the left hand soft and even. The tune is in the right hand.
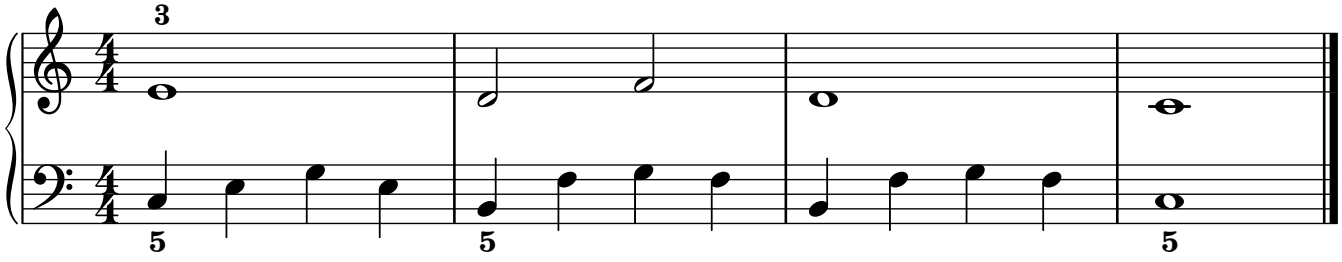
Part A: Two chords under long notes ♩ = 60

C major. The right hand plays half and whole notes; the left hand plays I and V7. Metronome 60.

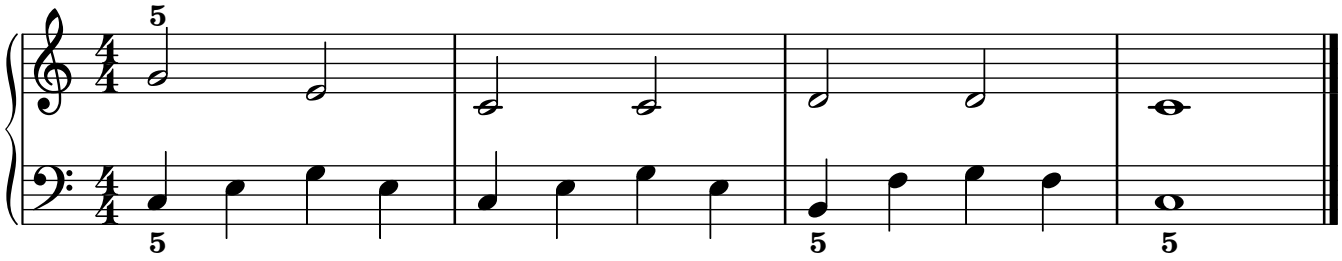
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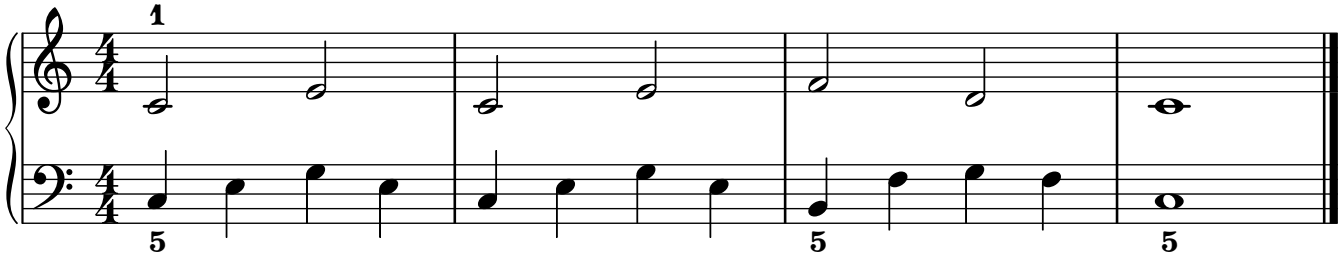
☐ **1.2**



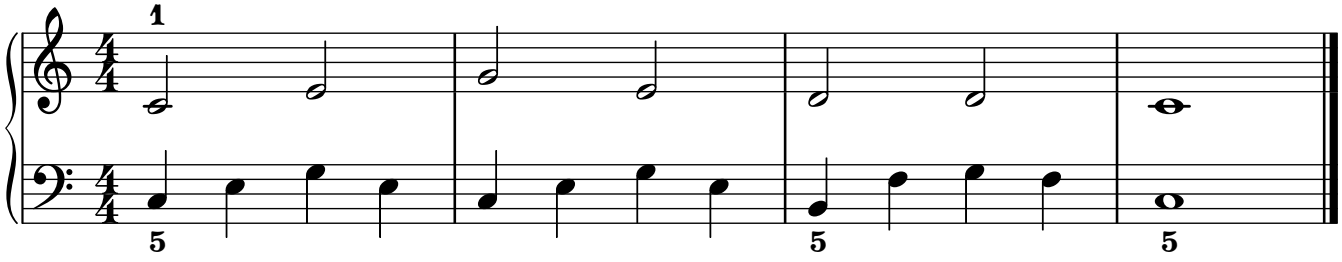
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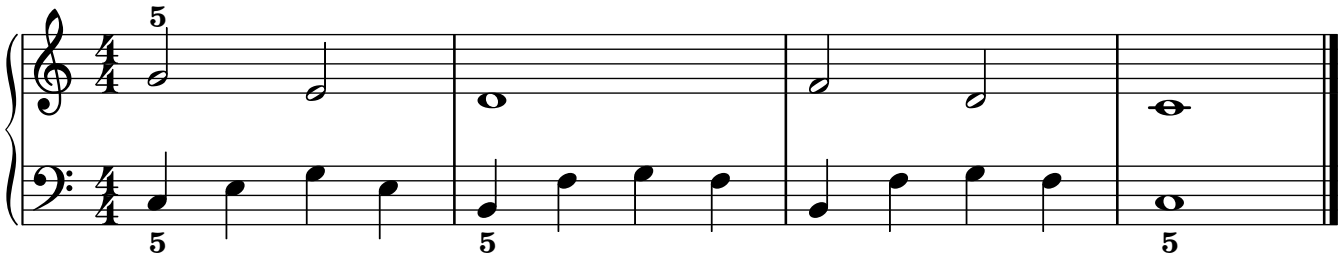
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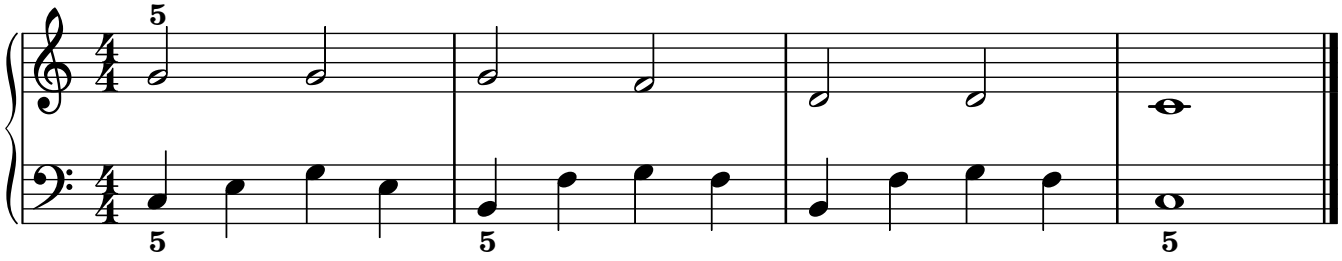
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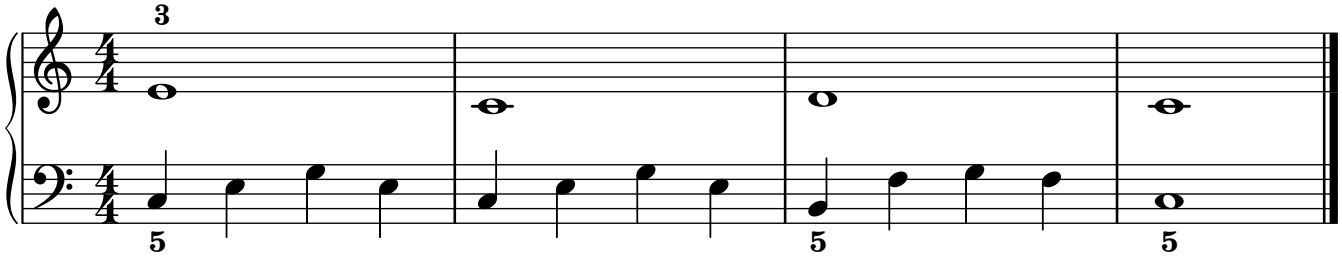
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☐ **1.7**
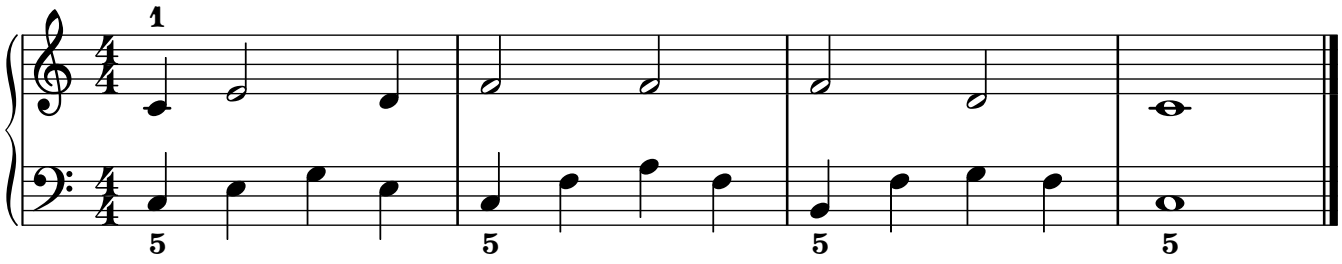


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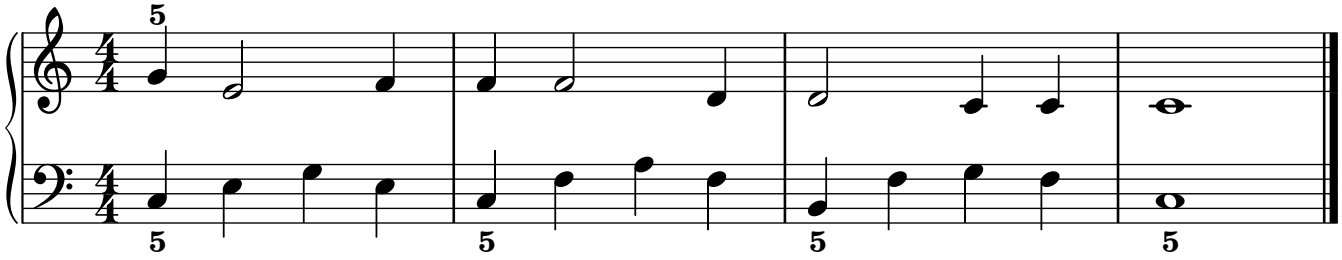
Part B: Adding the IV chord ♩ = 60

C major with all three chords. Every exercise goes I, IV, V7 and back to I.

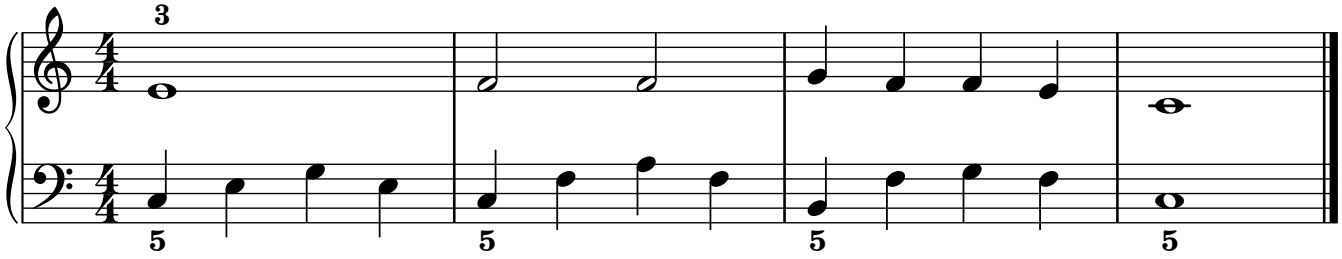
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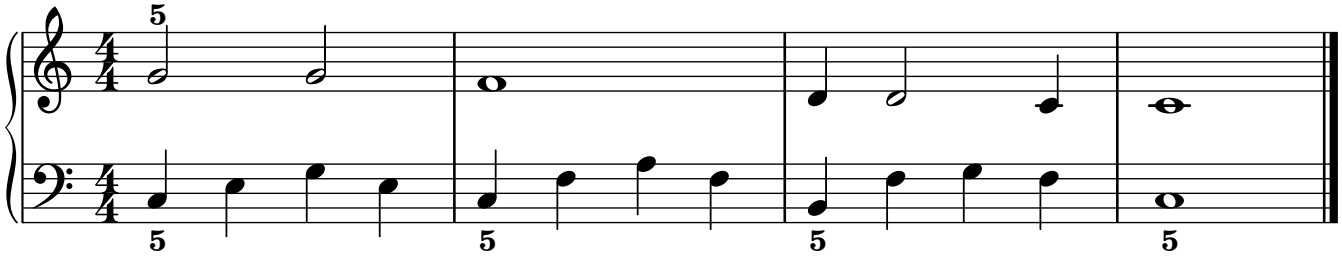
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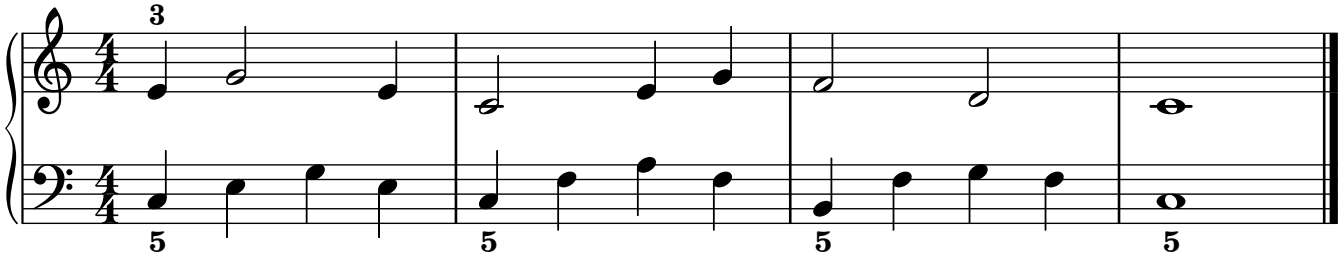
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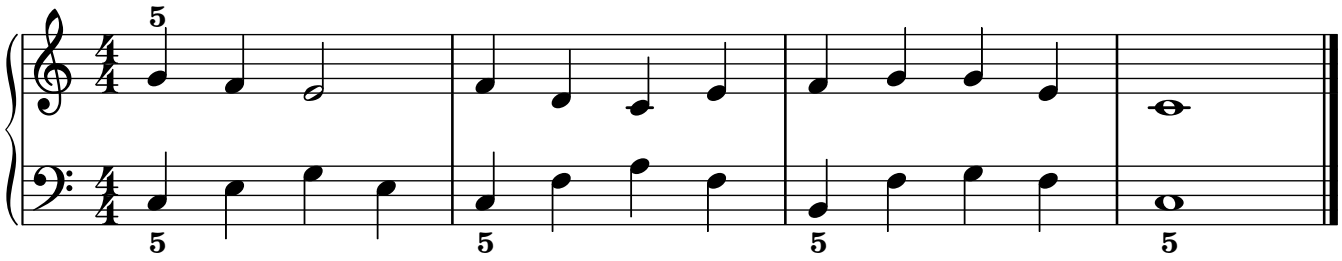
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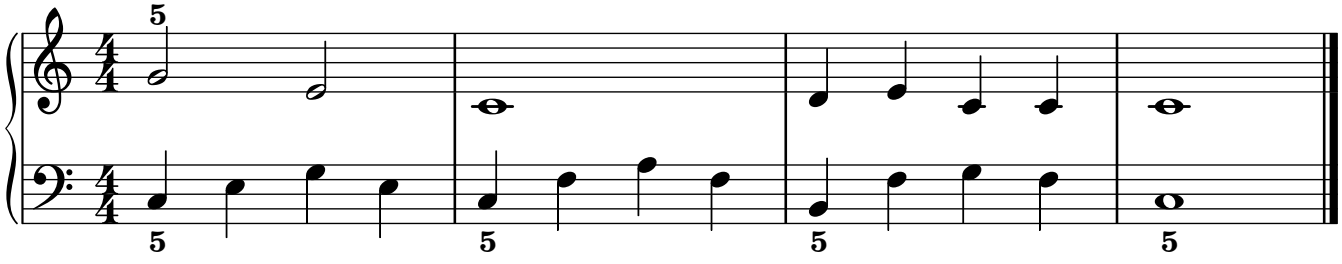
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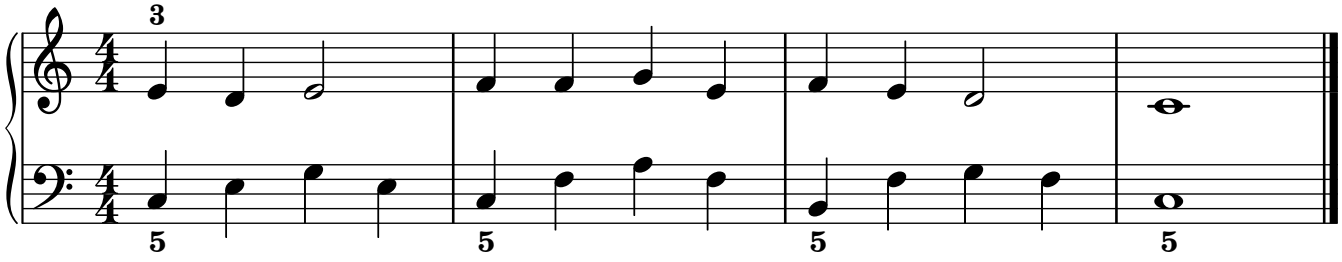
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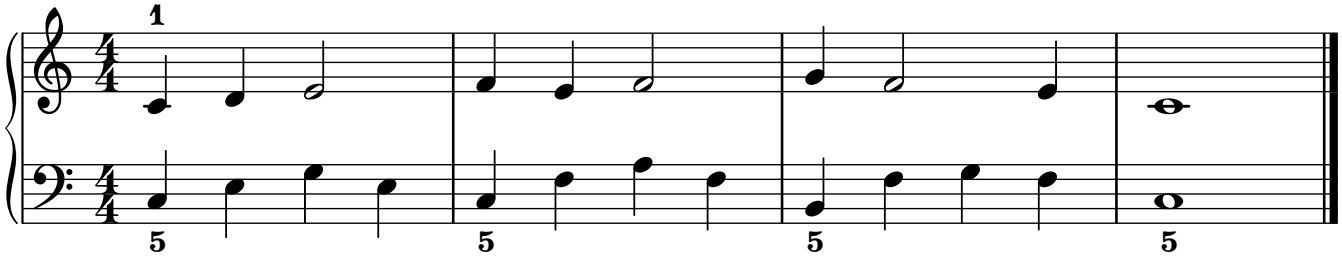
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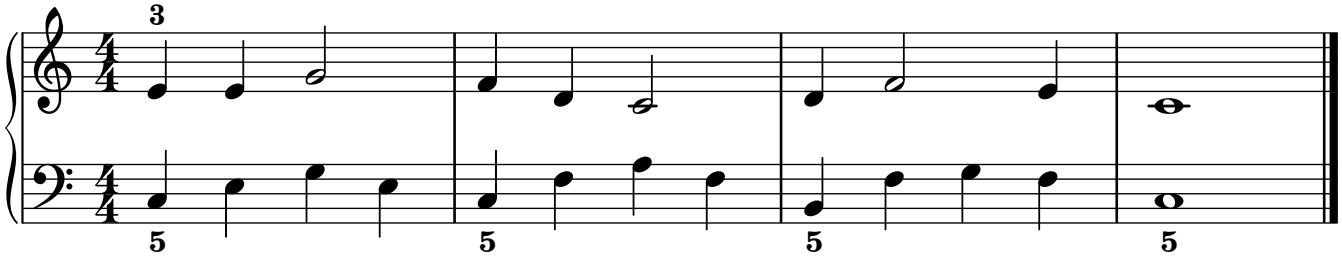
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☐ **1.17**



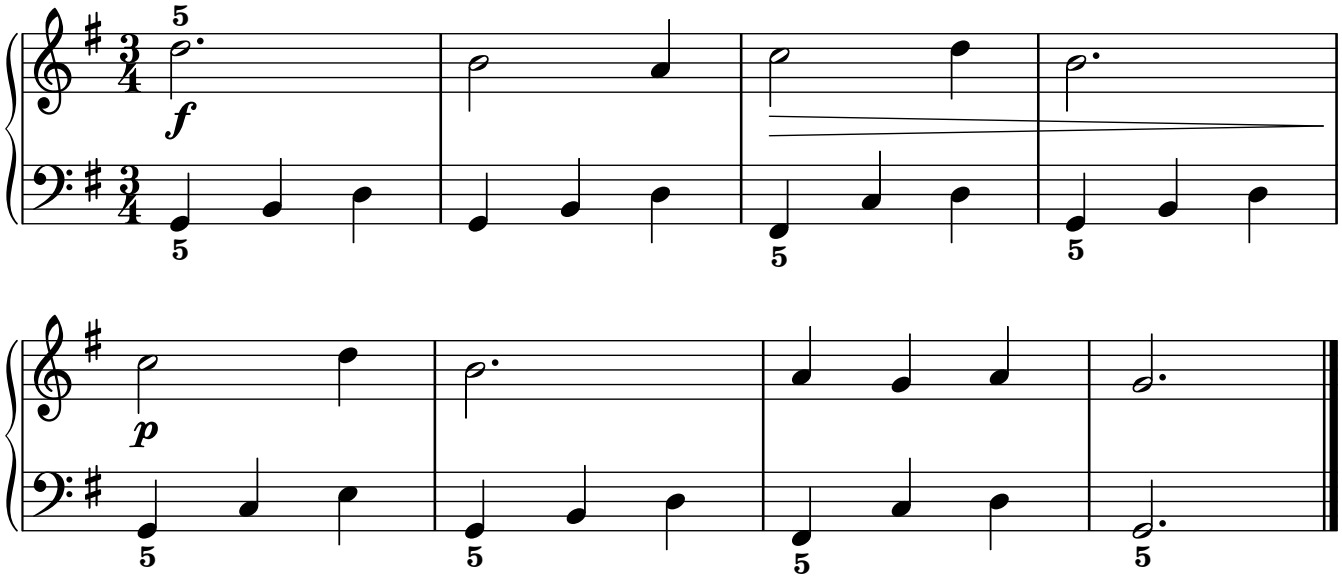
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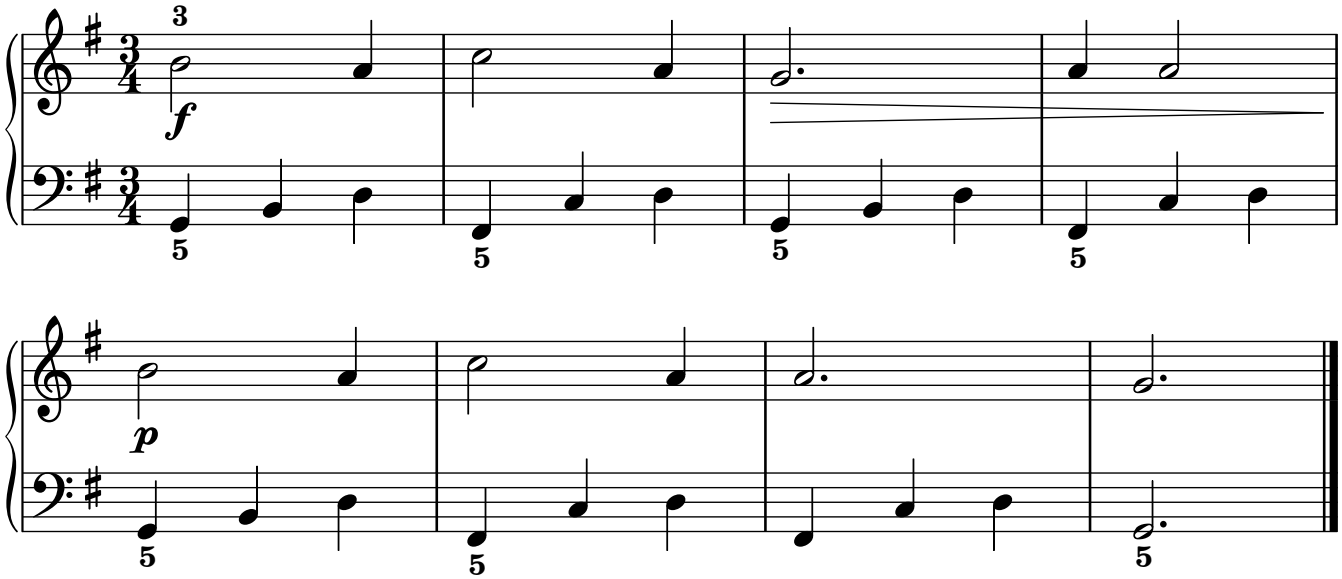


Part C: Waltz bass in G major ♩ = 72

G major waltzes: the left hand plays bottom, middle, top. F-sharp is the bottom note of the V7 shape.
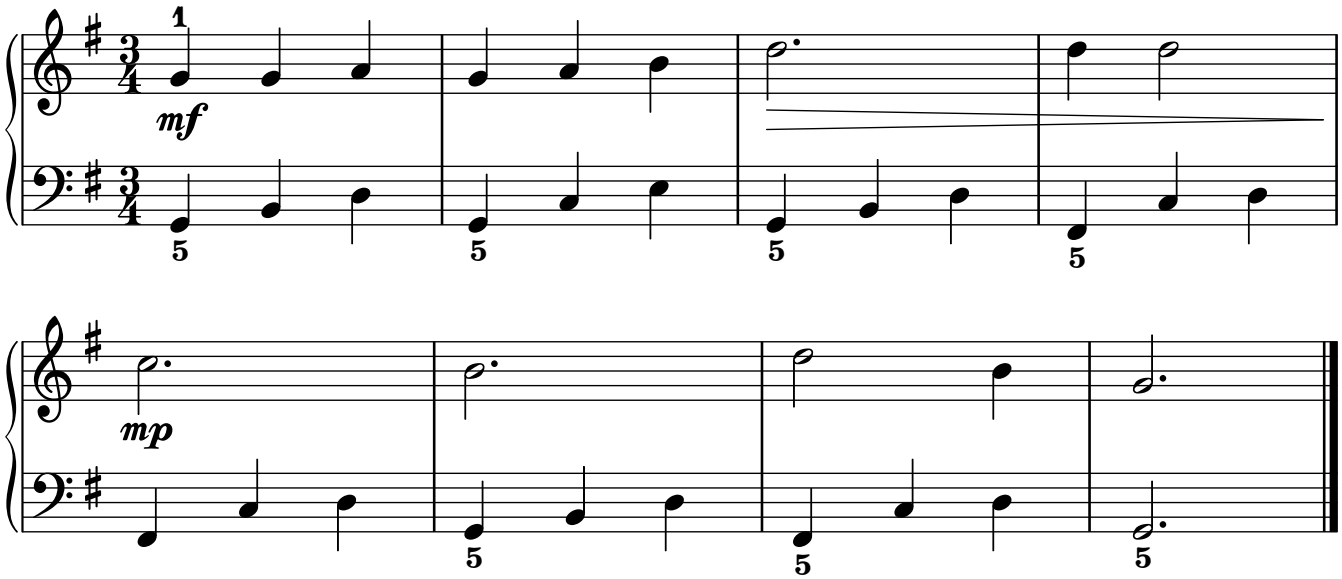
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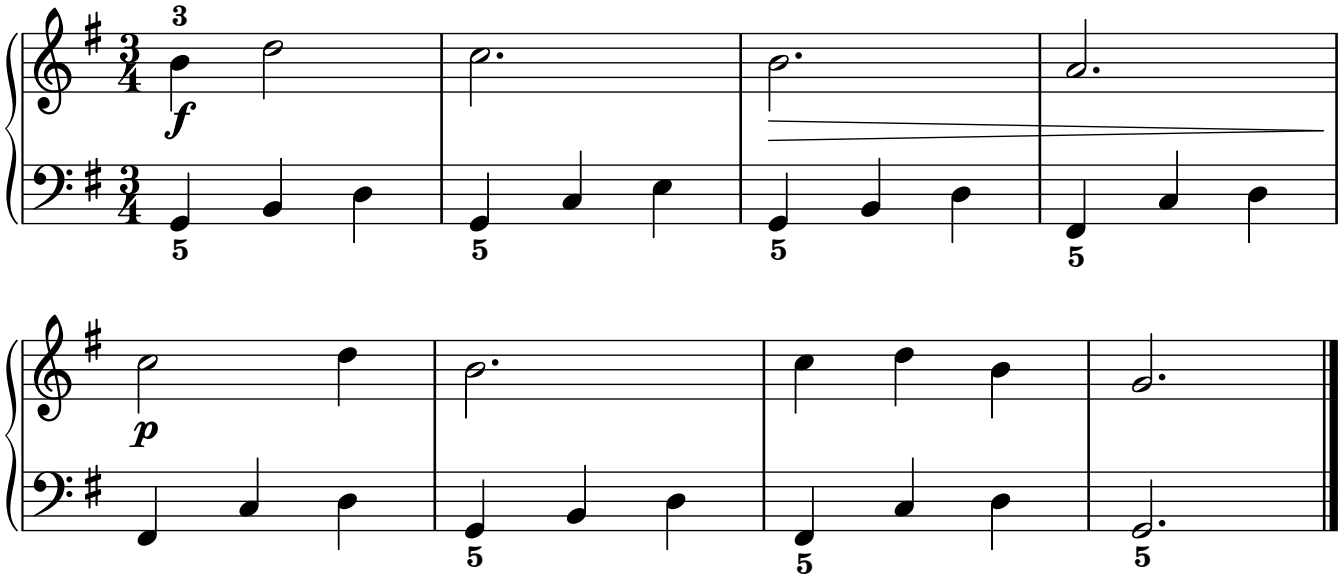
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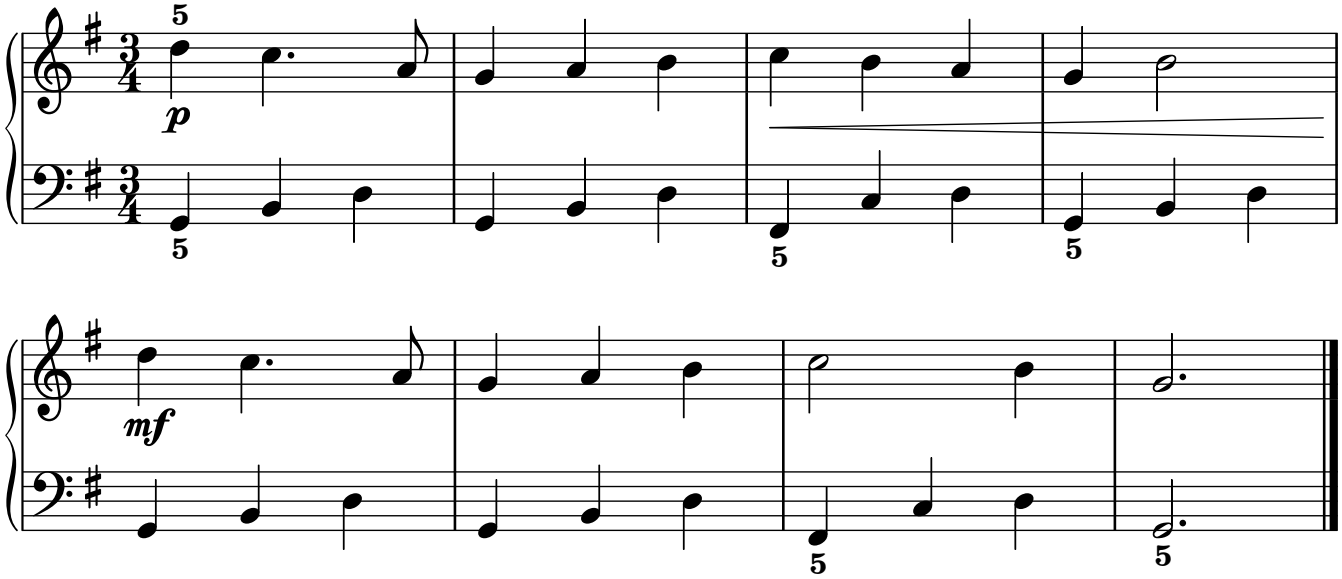


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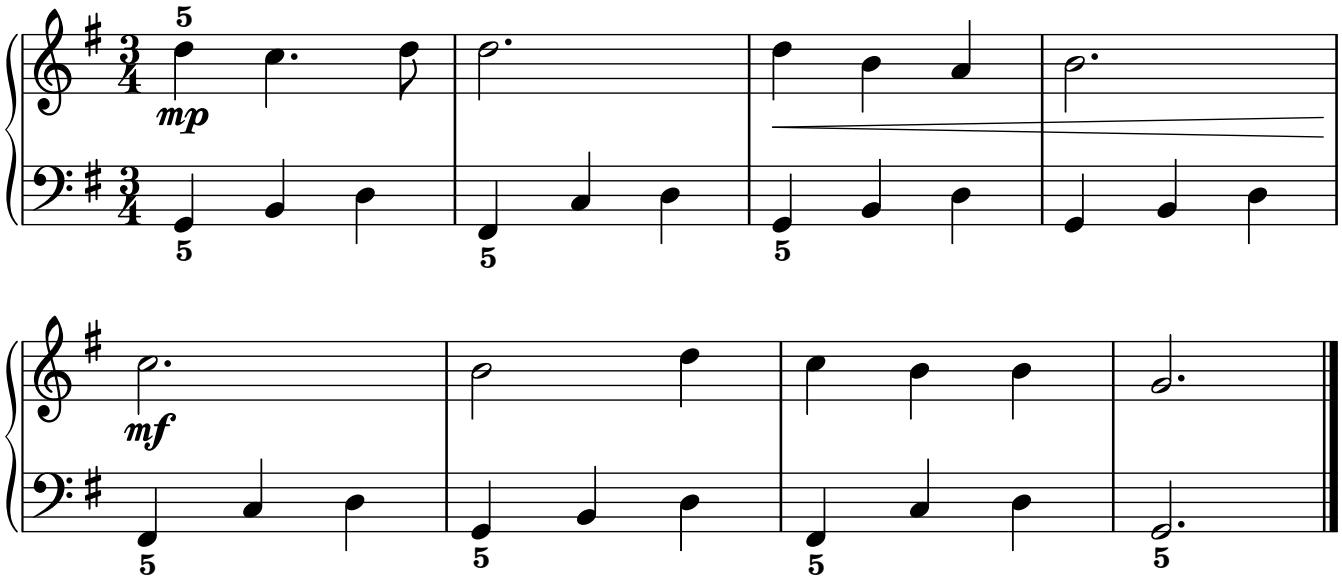
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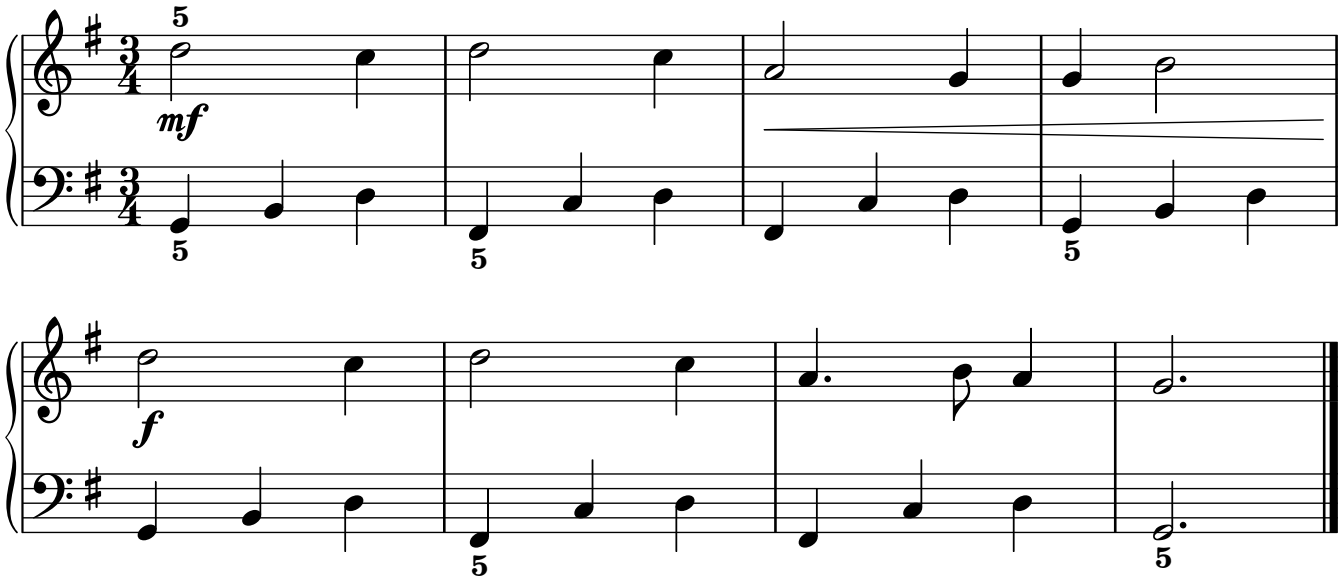
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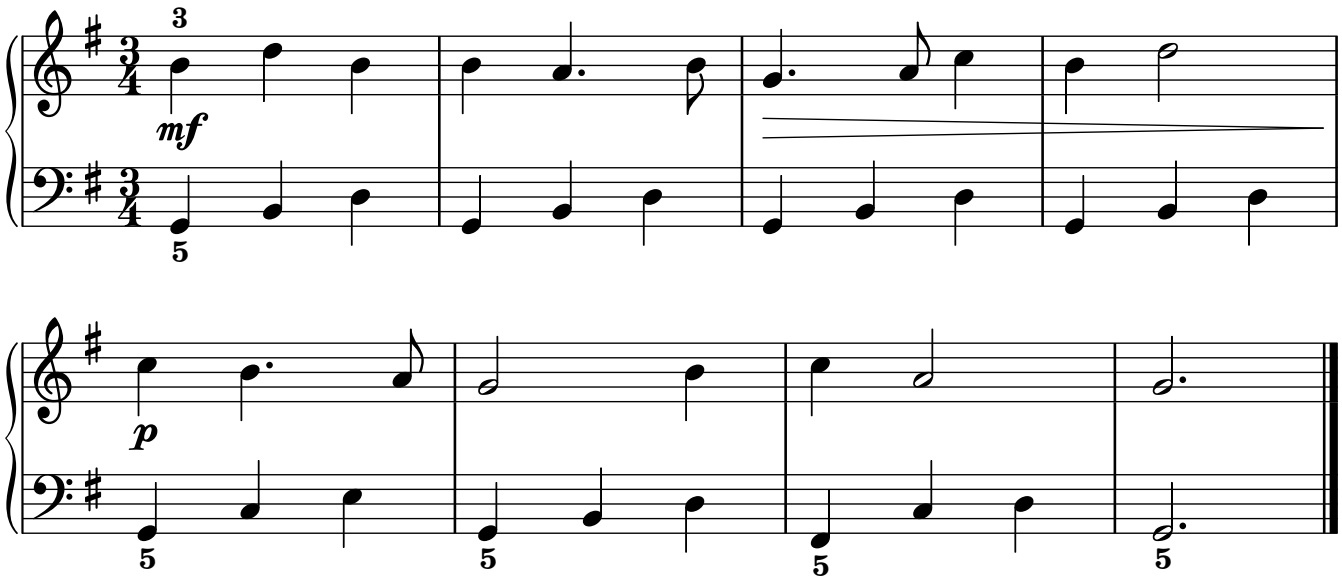
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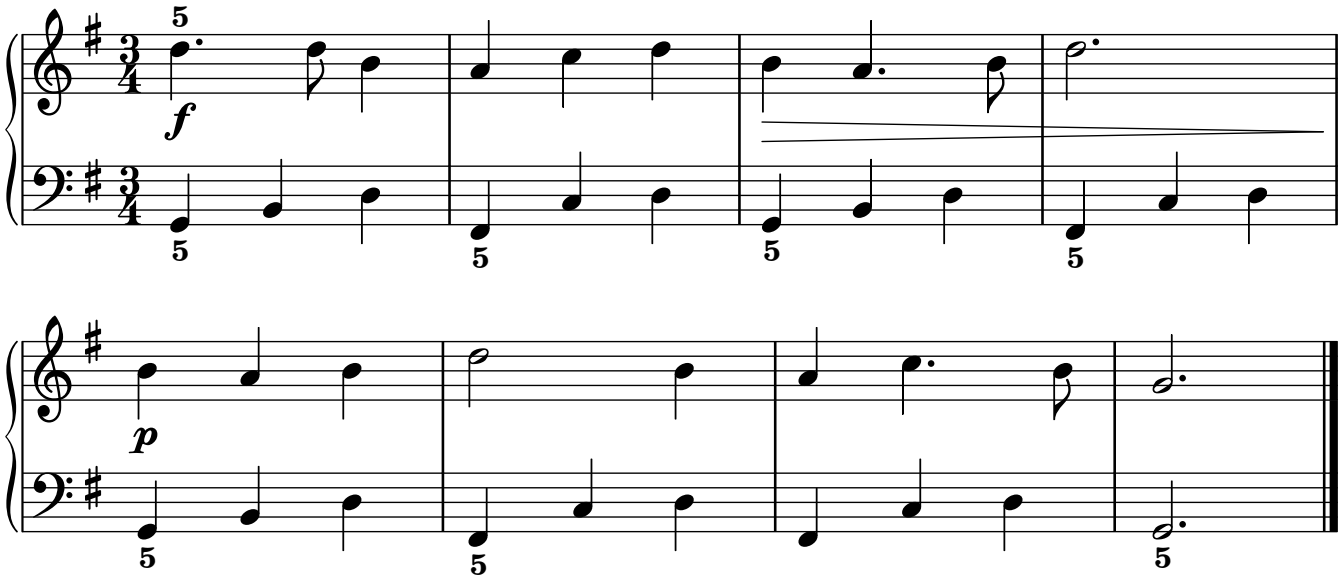


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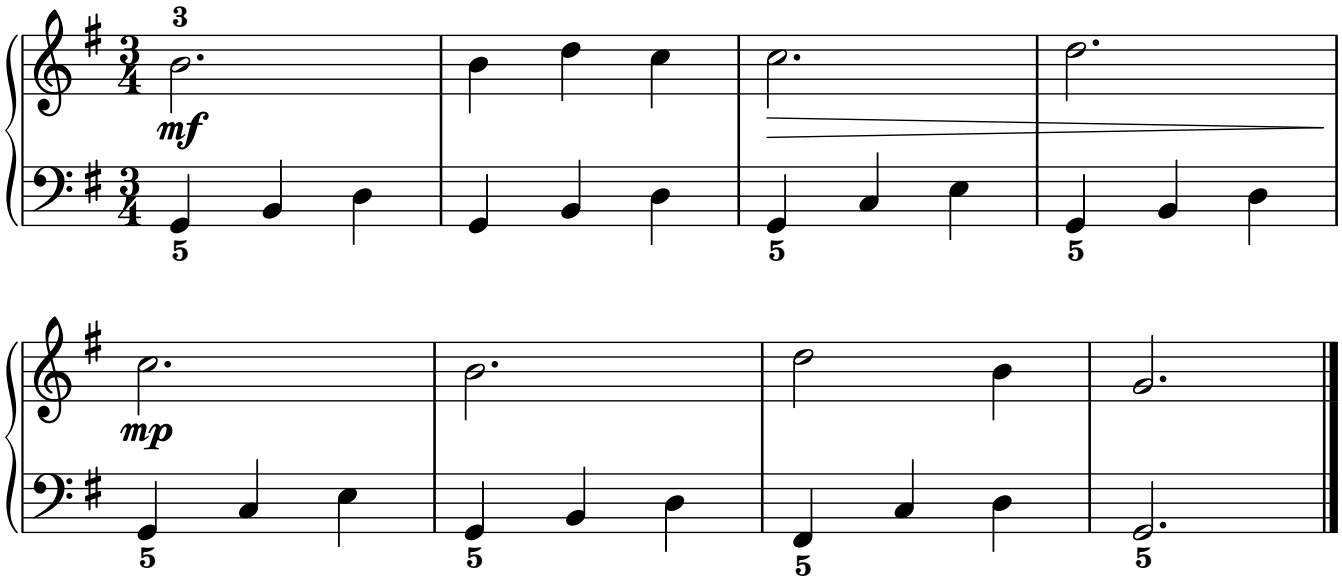
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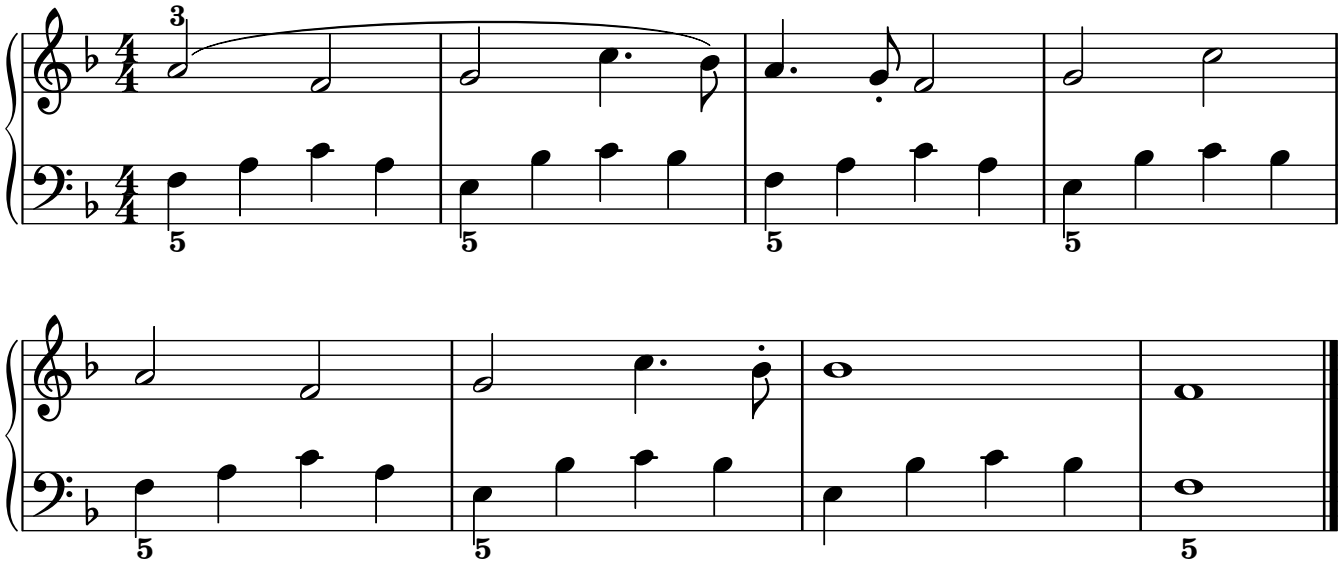
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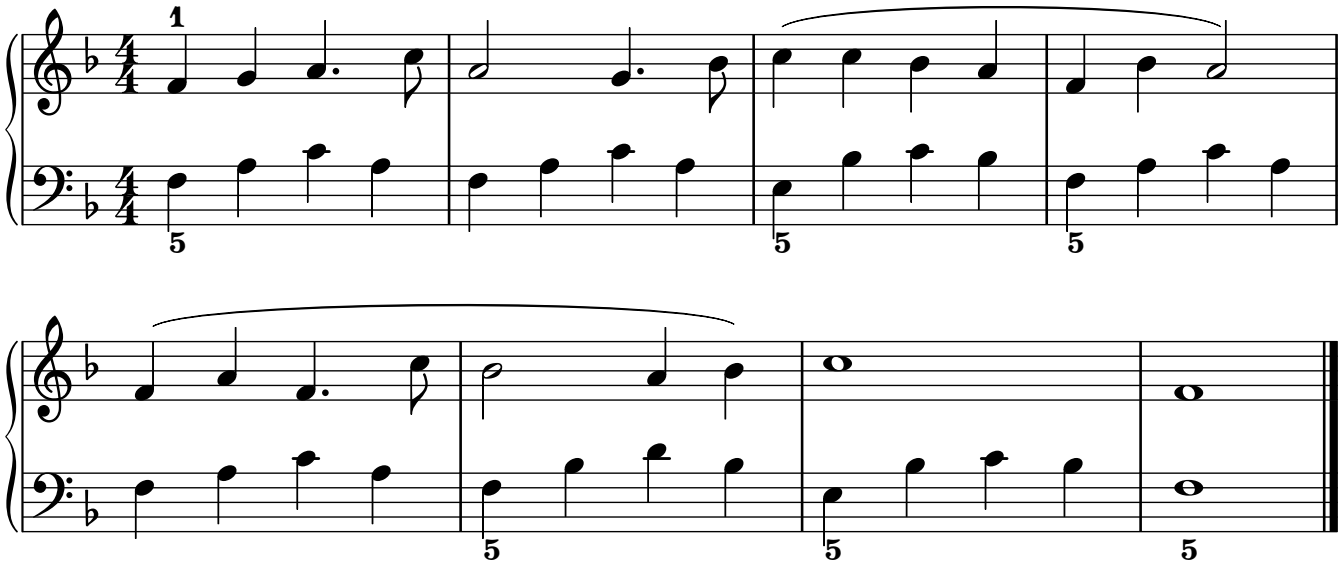


Part D: Eight bars in F major ♩ = 66

F major in eight bars. B-flat is the middle note of IV and V7. Watch the slurs and staccato dots.

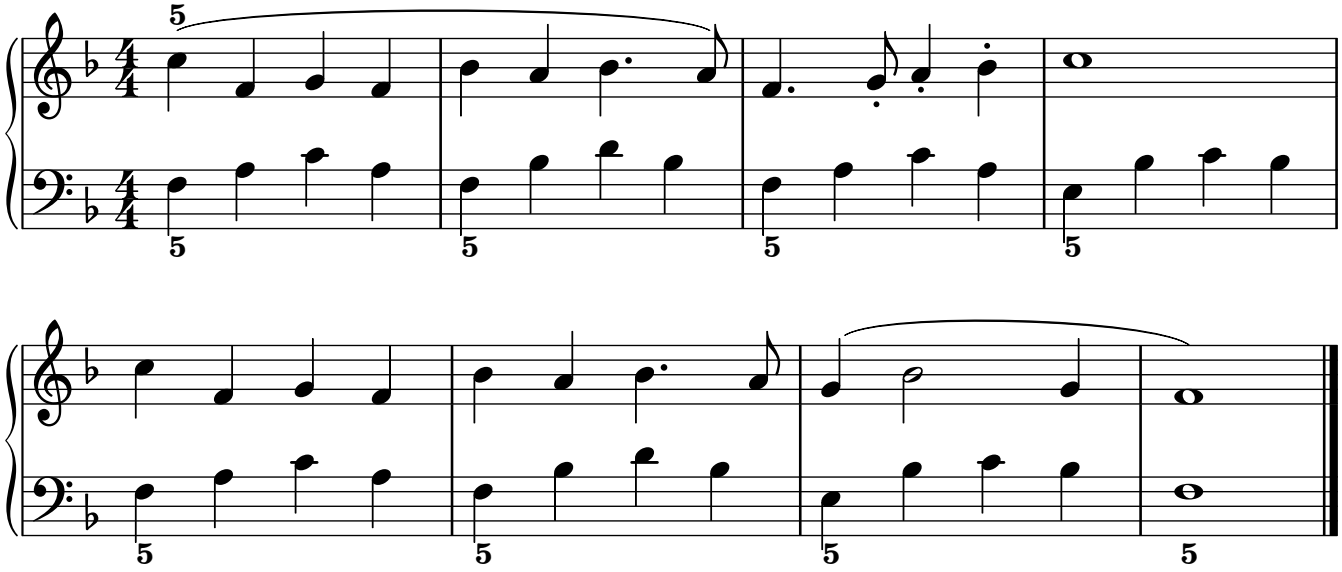
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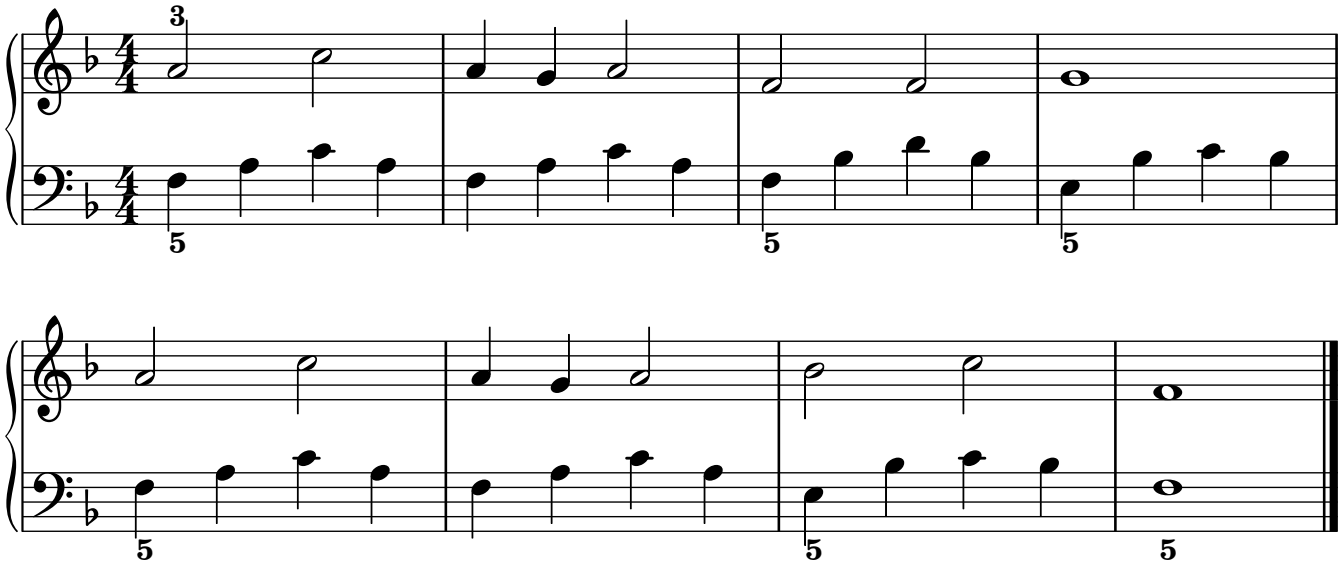
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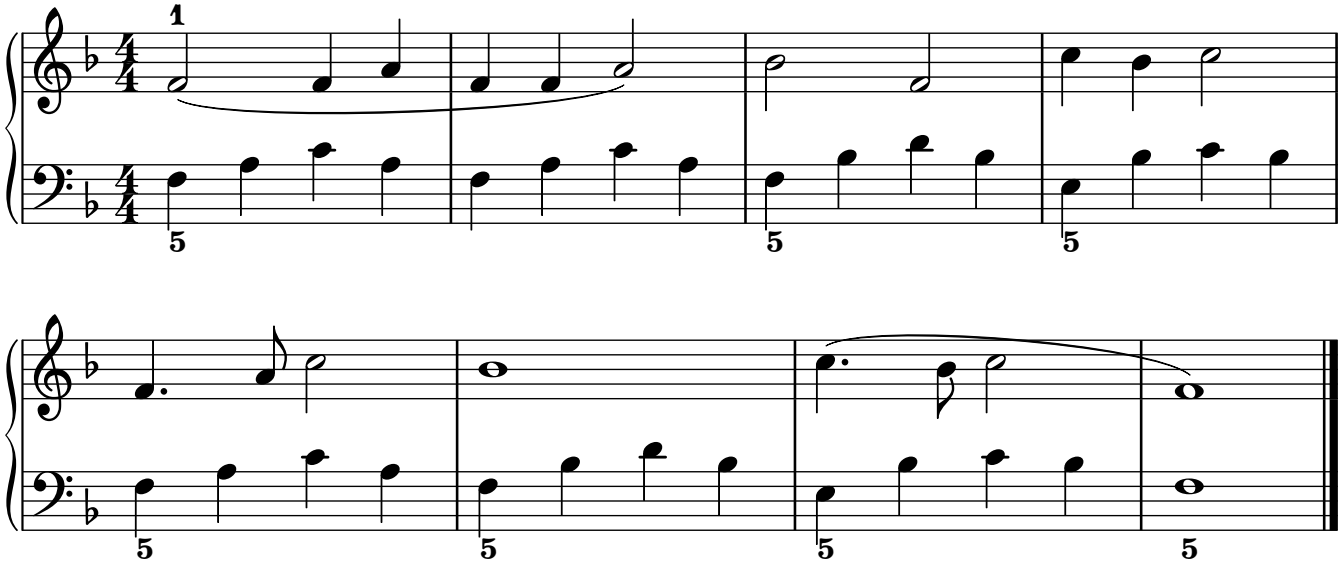
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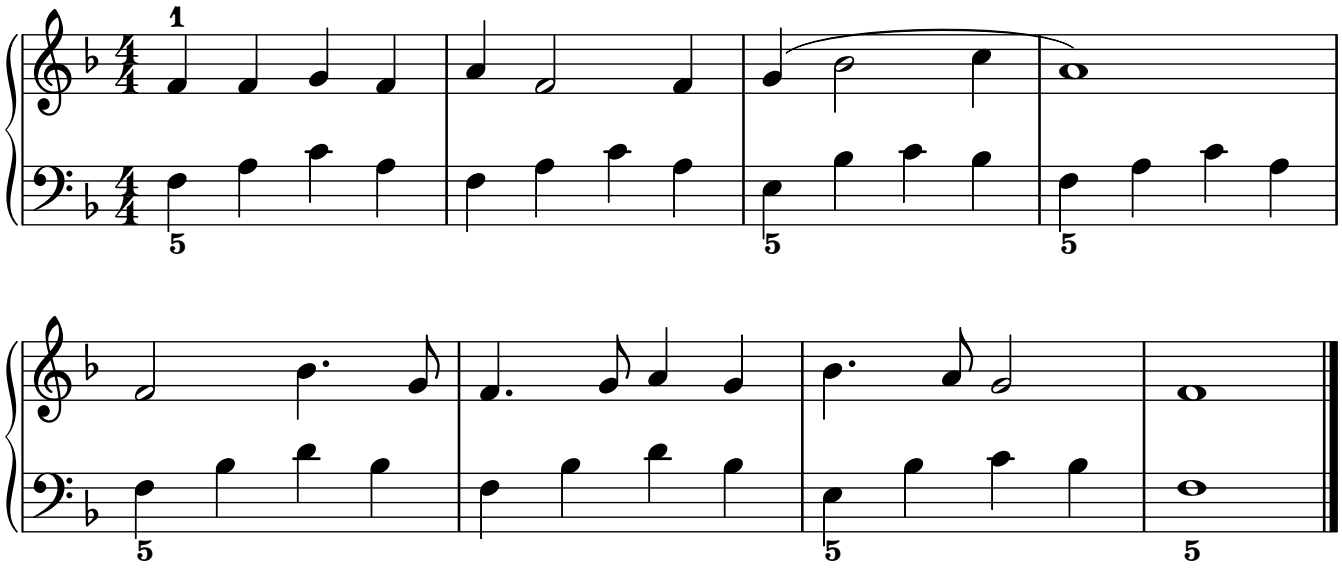
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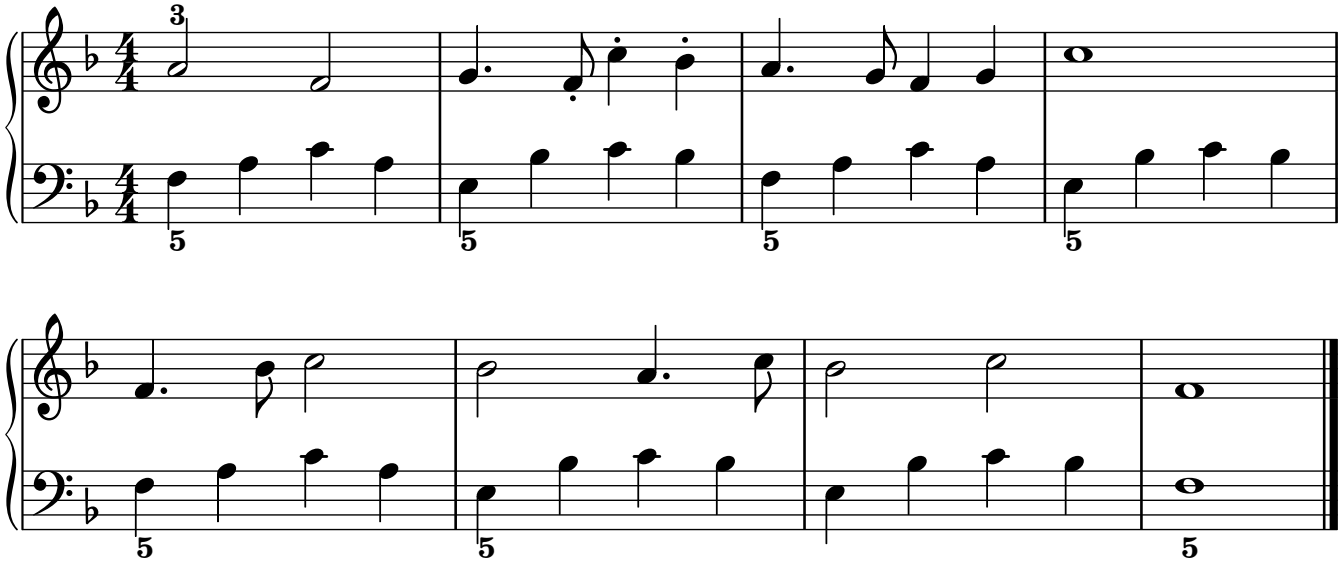
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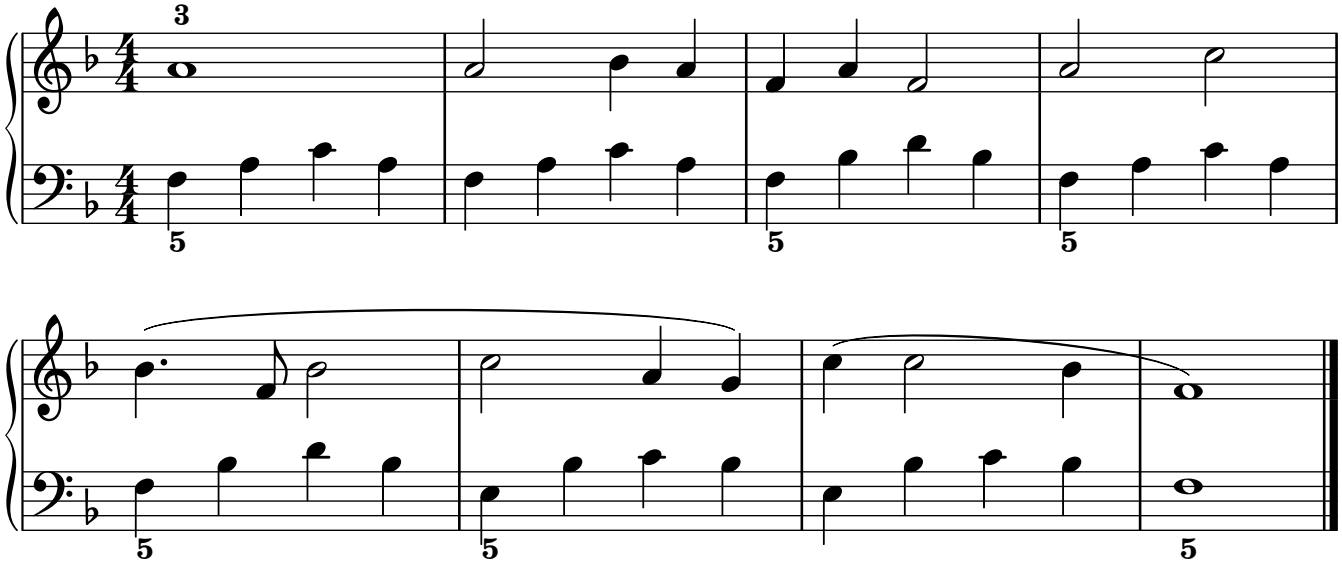
☐ **1.34**



☐ **1.35**



☐ **1.36**



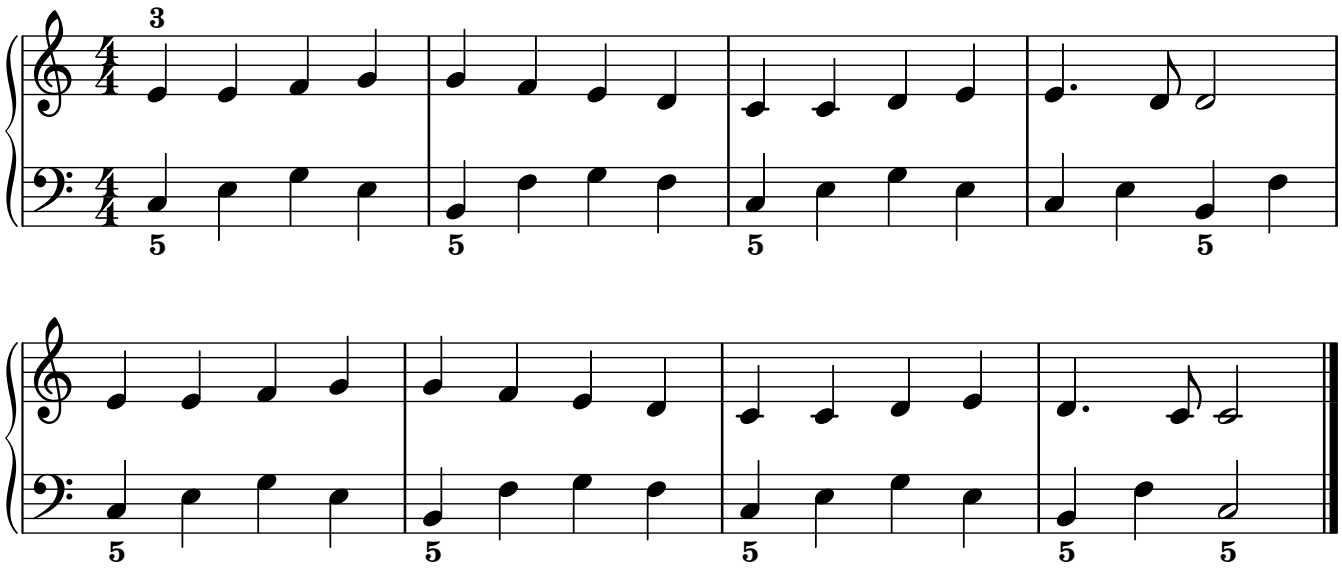
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Ode to Joy ♩ = 76

Ludwig van Beethoven, theme from Symphony No. 9 - simplified
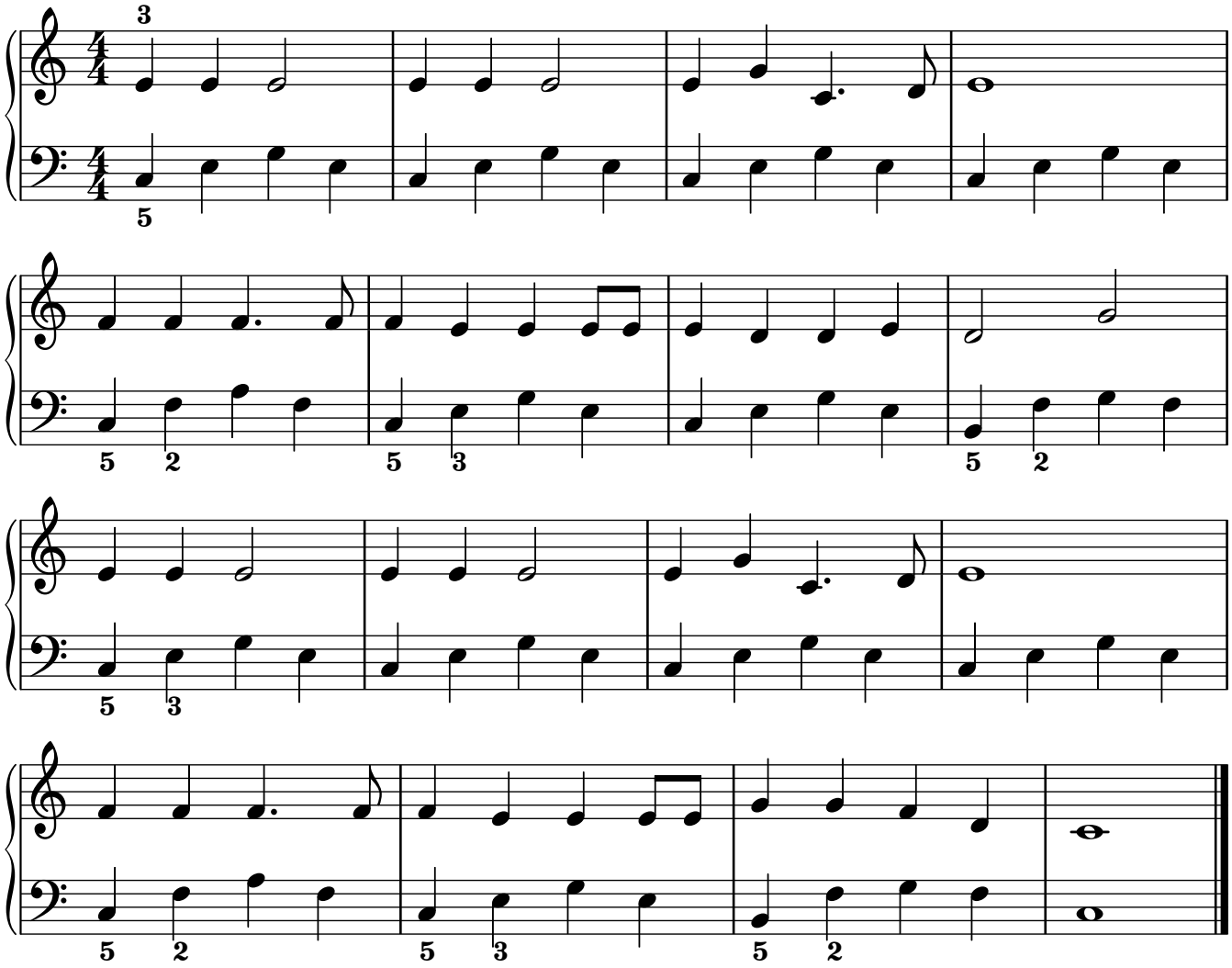
Two chords only, I and V7. In bar 4 the chord changes halfway through the bar, and in bar 8 the left hand settles on C for the last two beats.



Jingle Bells ♩ = 92

James Lord Pierpont (1857), chorus - simplified

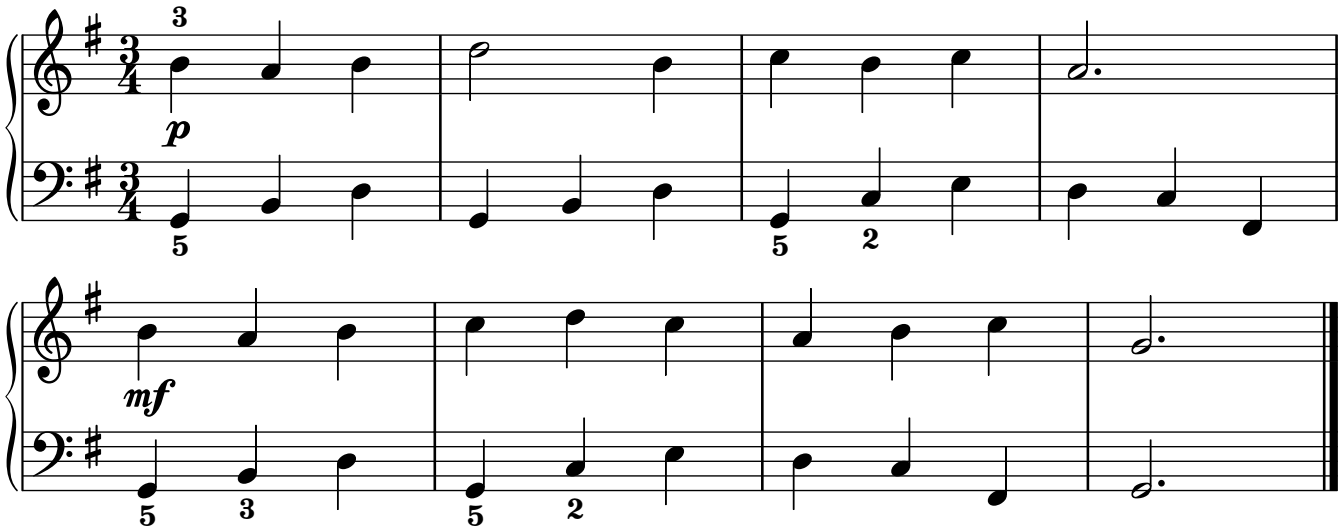
The chorus of a famous winter song, with all three chords. Find the IV shape (C F A) in bars 5 and 13 and the V7 shape (B F G) in bars 8 and 15 before you start.



Little Waltz in G ♩ = 96

Original

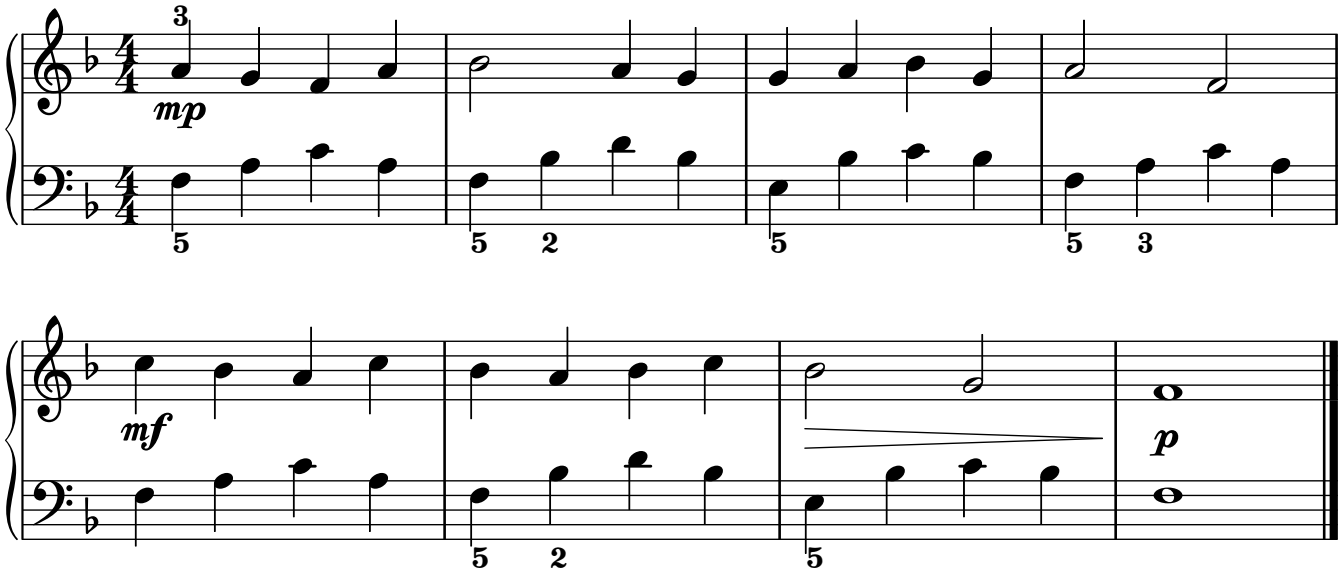
A waltz with the bass going bottom, middle, top. In bars 4 and 7 the V7 shape is played from the top down (D C F-sharp), so the hand moves only a short way.



Evening Song ♩ = 72

Original

F major, with B-flat in the right hand and in the IV and V7 shapes. The left hand's top note in IV is D above middle C, on a ledger line.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 2?

- Play five new Part C or D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Name the chord in every bar (I, IV or V7) from the left-hand shape alone.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 2.

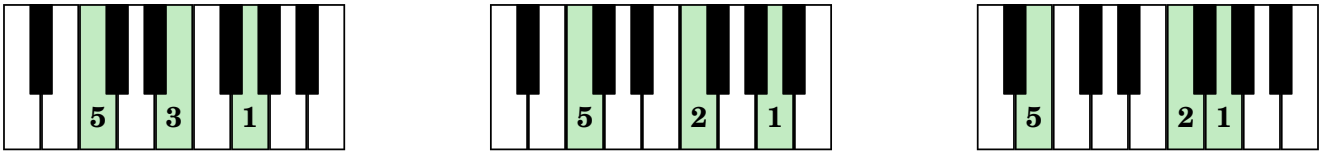
Unit 2

The Alberti Bass

New: Broken chords in eighth notes: low, high, middle, high

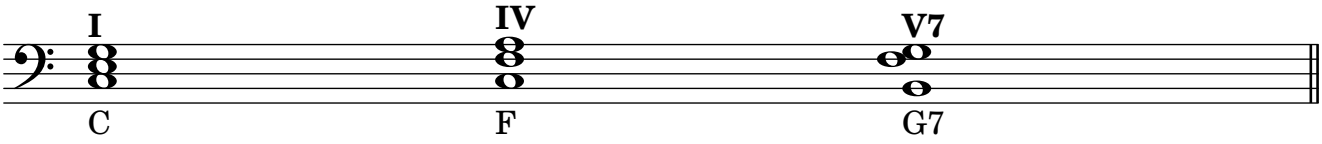
The Alberti bass is a broken chord in eighth notes: bottom, top, middle, top, over and over. It is named after Domenico Alberti, an Italian composer of the early 1700s, and you will hear it in countless pieces by Haydn, Mozart and Clementi. It keeps the music moving gently while the right hand sings above it. The chord shapes are the same as in Unit 1; only the order of the notes is new.

C major: left-hand chord shapes



I = C **IV** = F **V7** = G7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

Bottom, top, middle, top

In C major the I chord becomes C G E G, C G E G. The thumb plays every second note, so the pattern rocks between finger 5, the thumb, finger 3 and the thumb.

IV and V7

IV becomes C A F A (fingers 5 1 2 1) and V7 becomes B G F G (5 1 2 1). The thumb stays on top; only fingers 5 and 2 or 3 change.

Eighths against quarters

The left hand plays two notes for every right-hand quarter note. Count 1-and-2-and: the right hand plays on the numbers only.

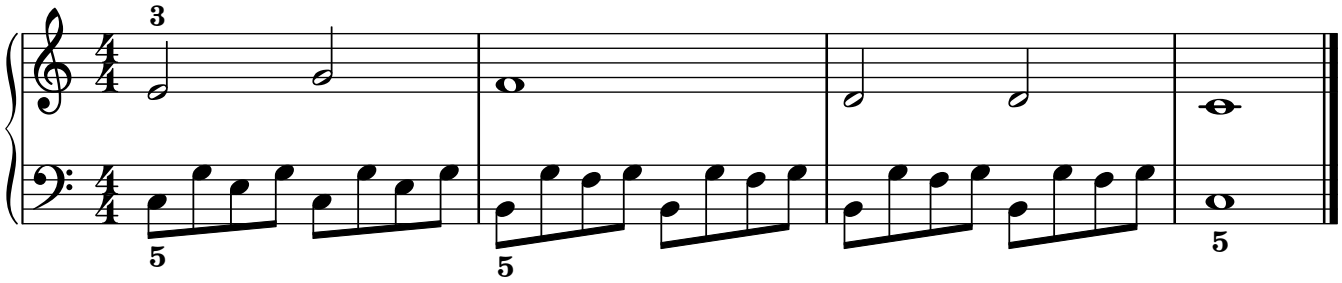
Reading tips

1. Before you start, find each new chord shape: a finger number under the bass marks it.
2. Keep the thumb light. The bottom note of each group carries the harmony; the thumb notes are softer.
3. Read the first four eighths of a bar as one shape; the rest of the bar repeats it, so your eyes can go back to the right hand.

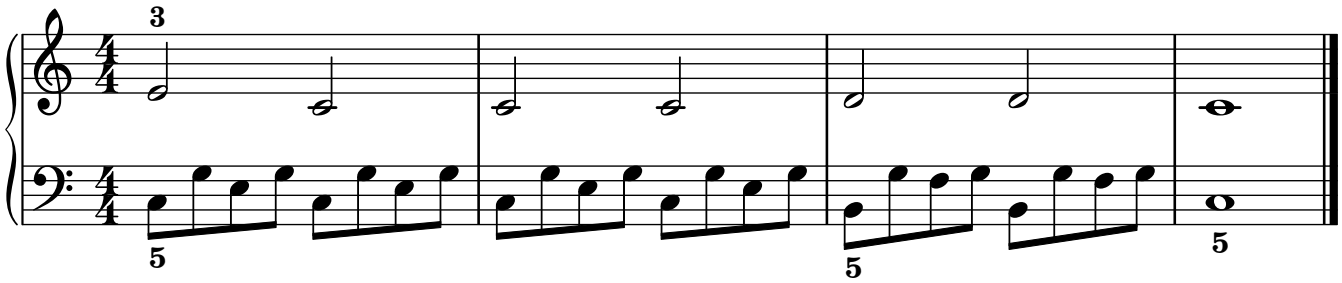
Part A: Alberti bass under long notes ♩ = 56

C major. The right hand plays half and whole notes over an Alberti bass on I and V7. Metronome 56.

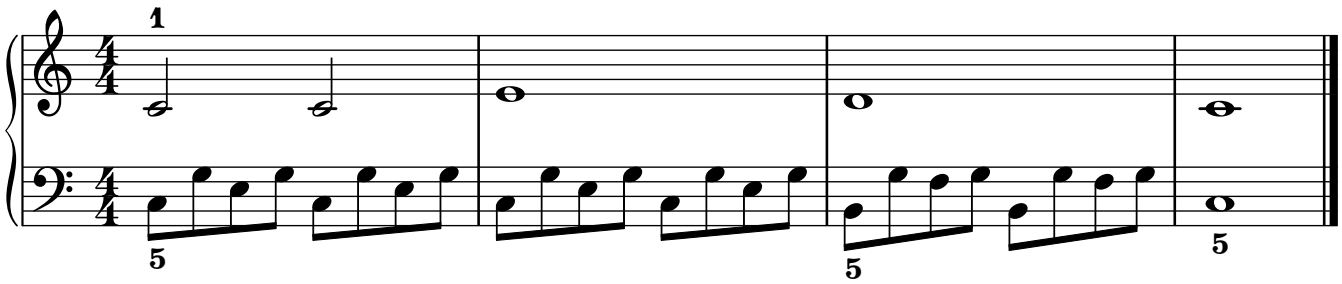
☐ **2.1**



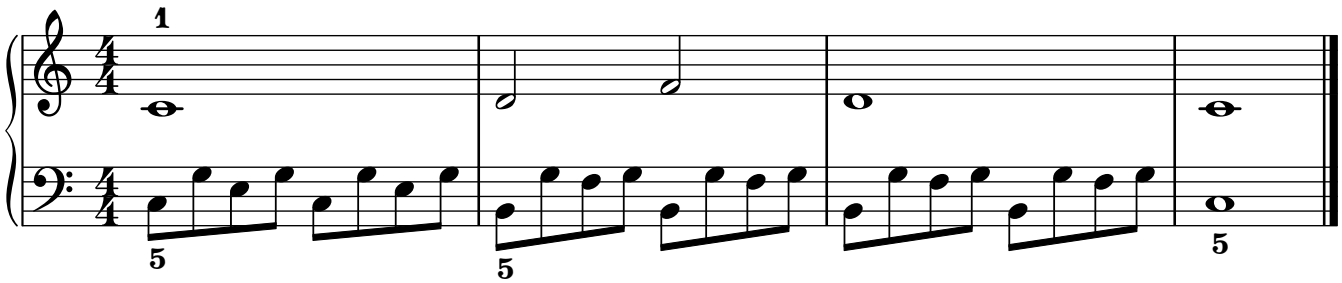
☐ **2.2**



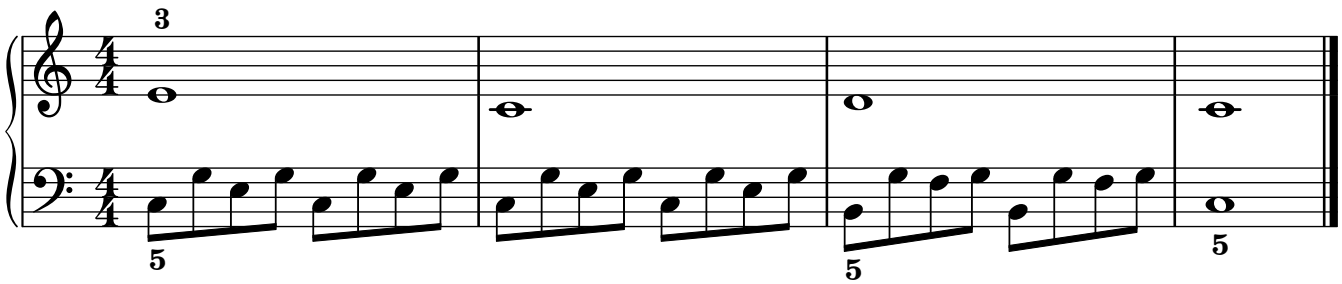
☐ **2.3**
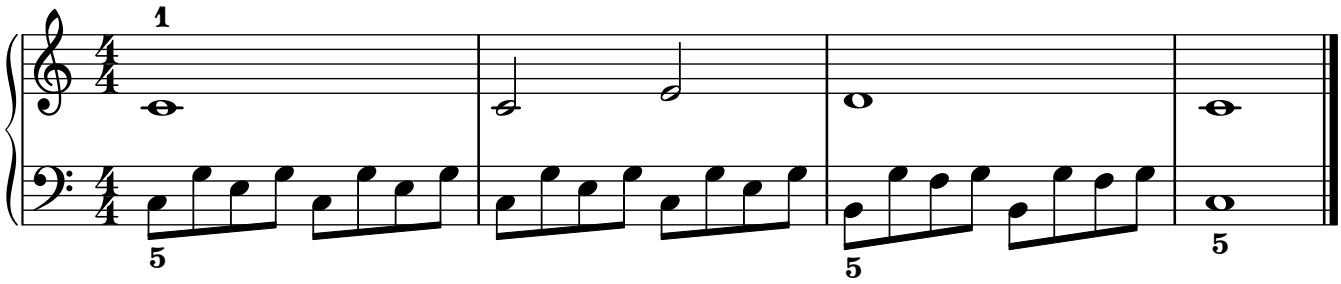


☐ **2.4**
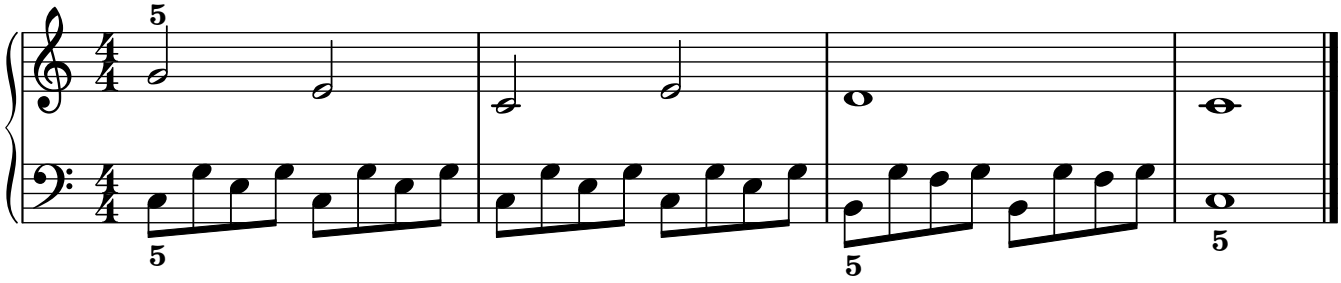


☐ **2.5**



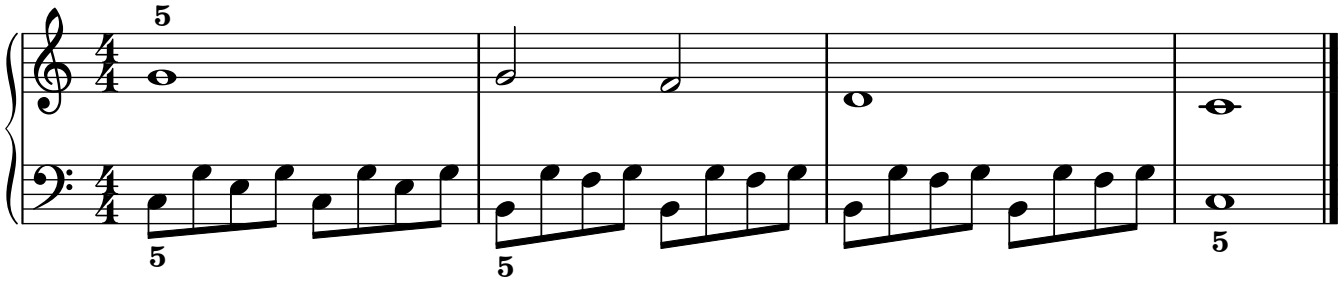
☐ **2.6**



☐ **2.7**
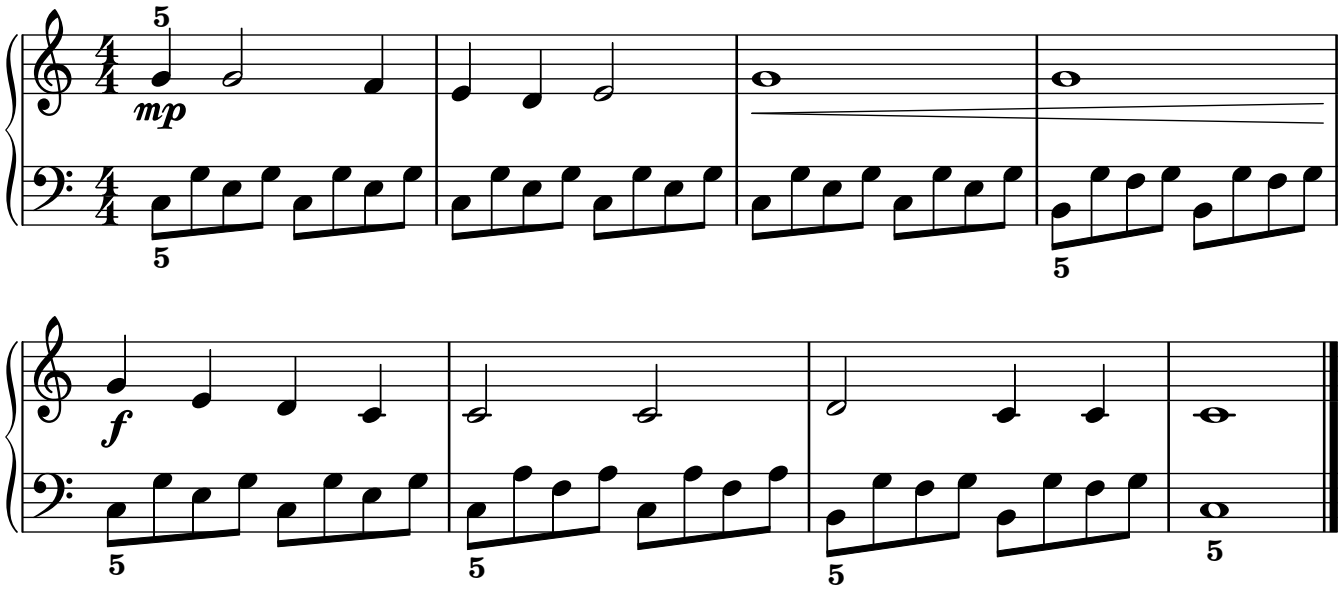


☐ **2.8**



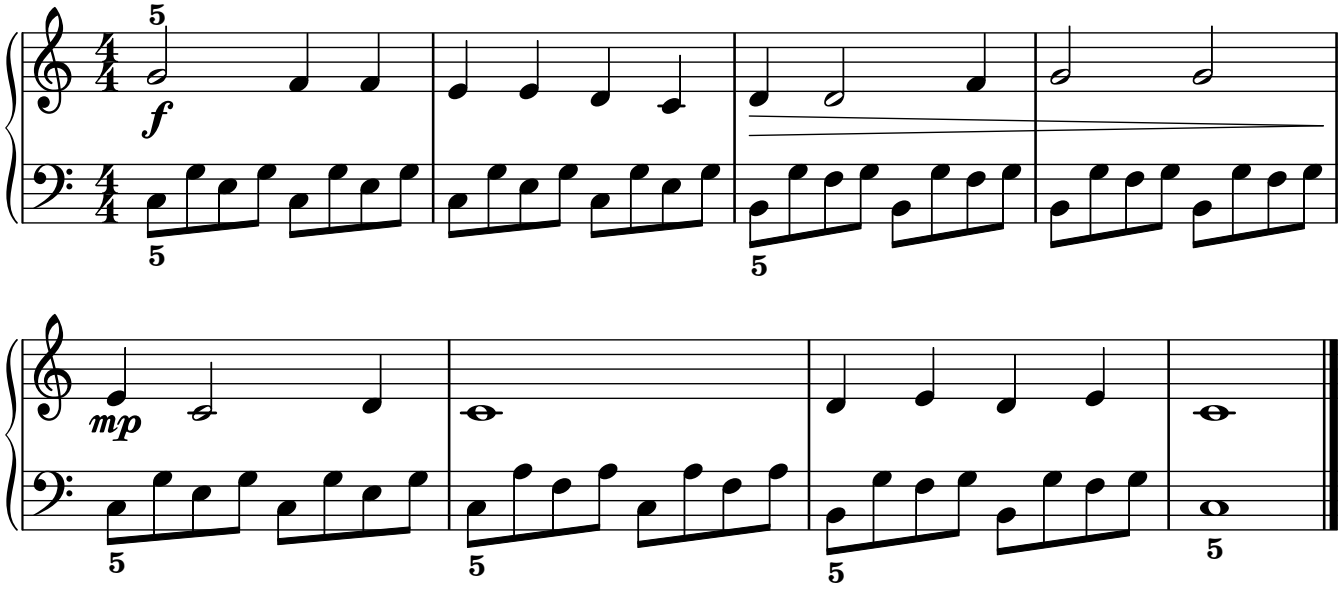
Part B: I, IV and V7 in C major ♩ = 60

Eight bars in C major with I, IV and V7, and dynamics.
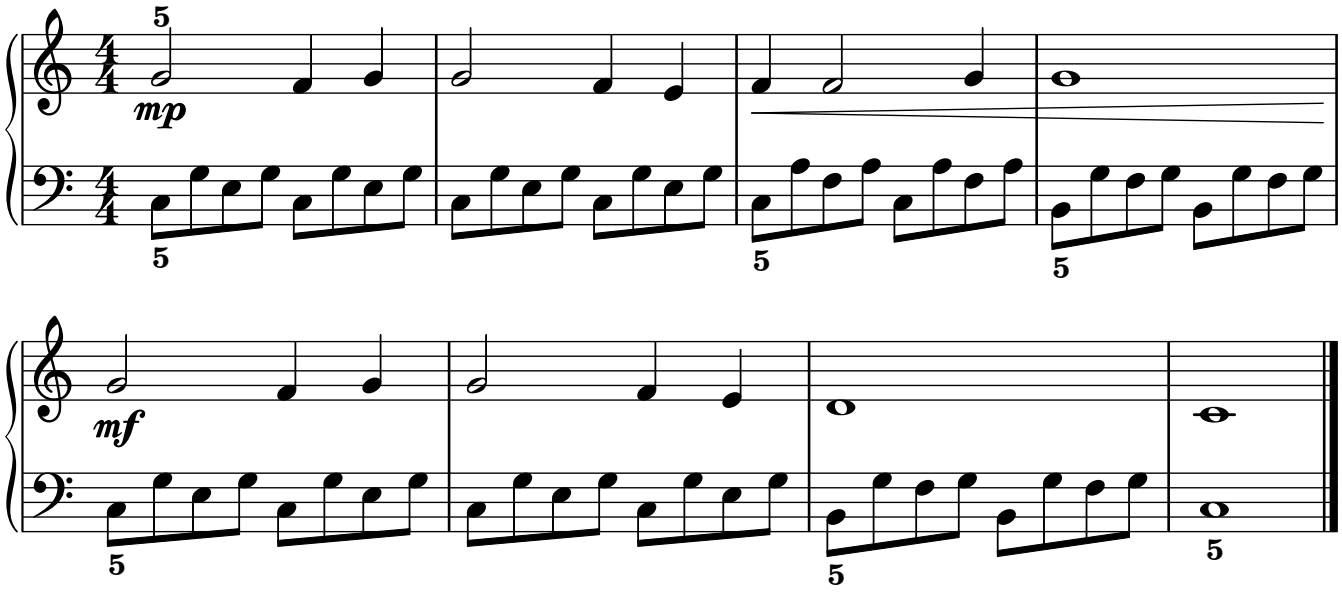
☐ **2.9**



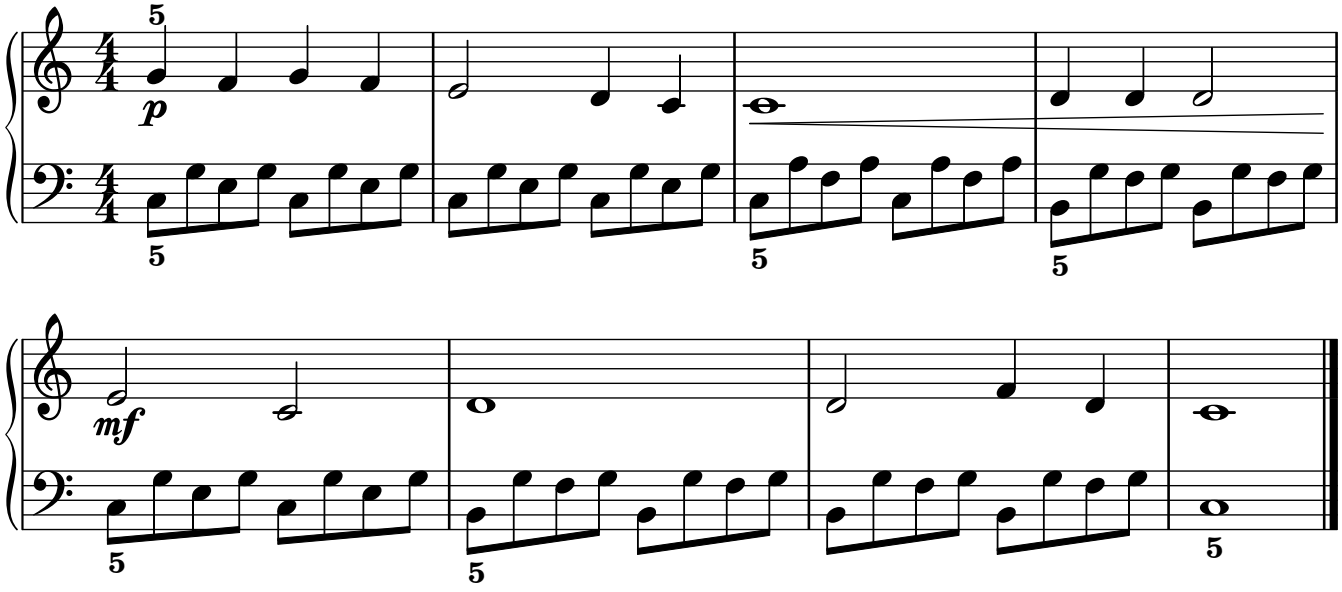
☐ **2.10**
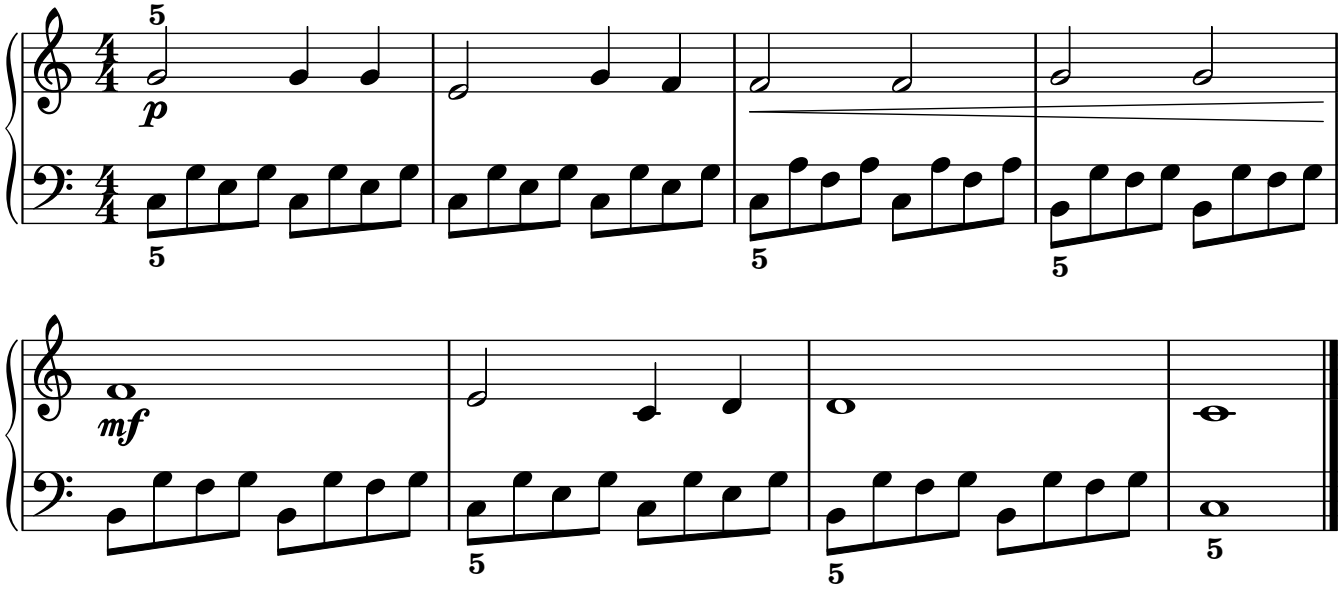


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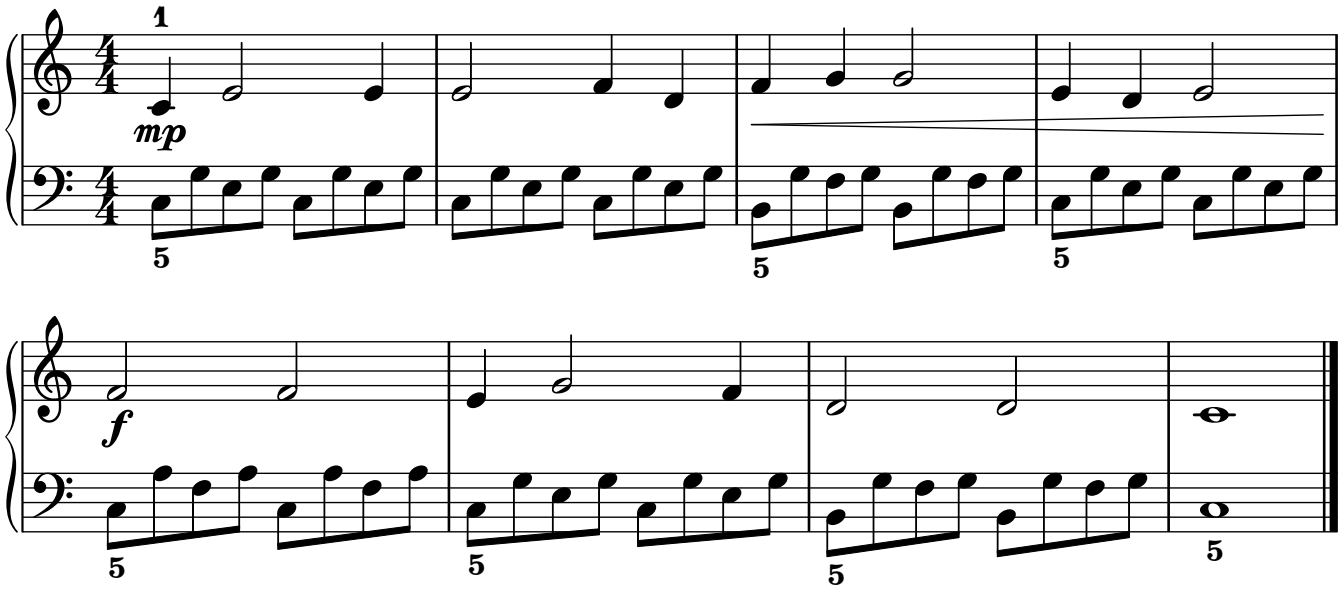


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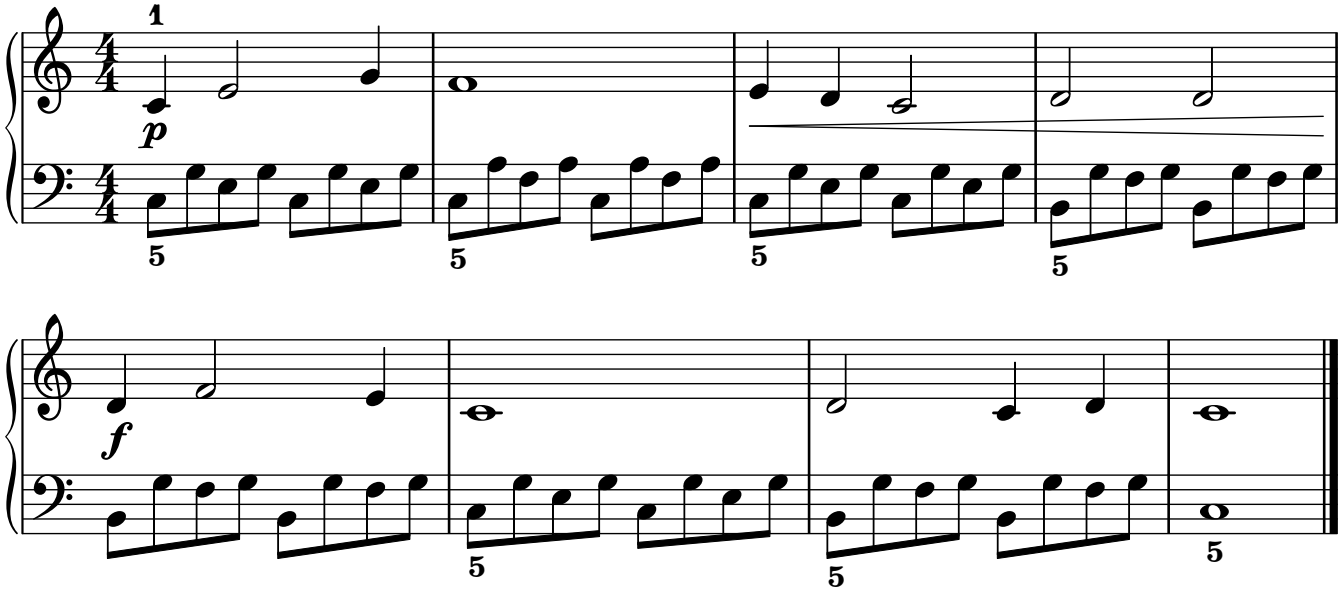


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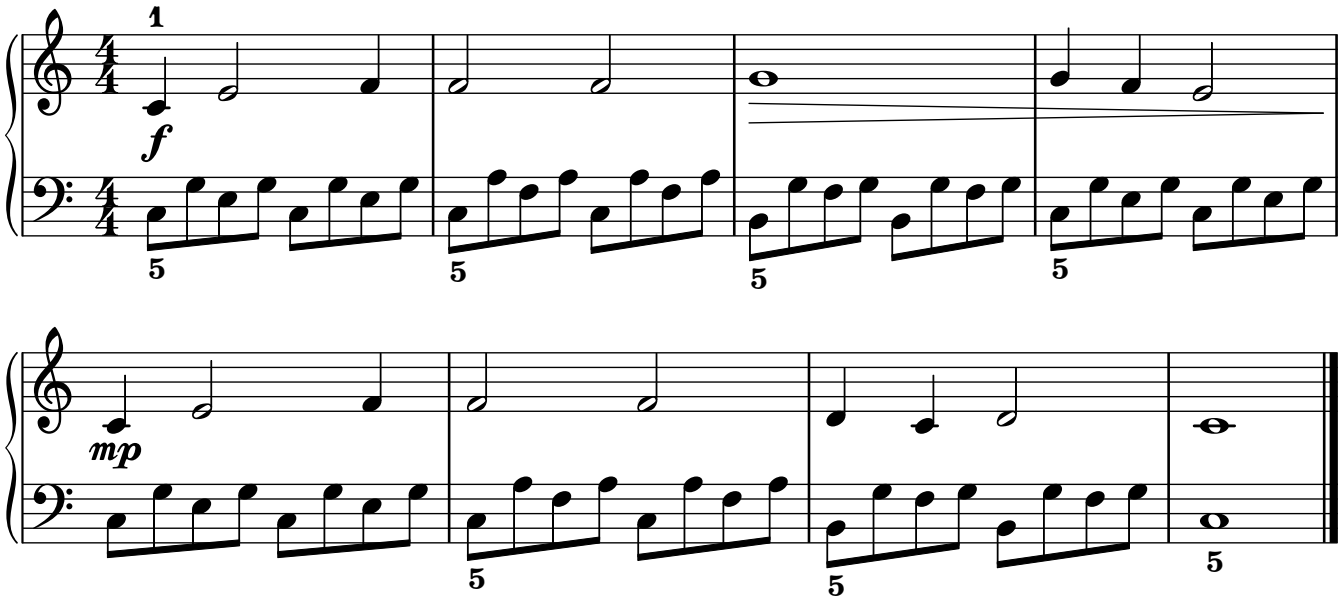


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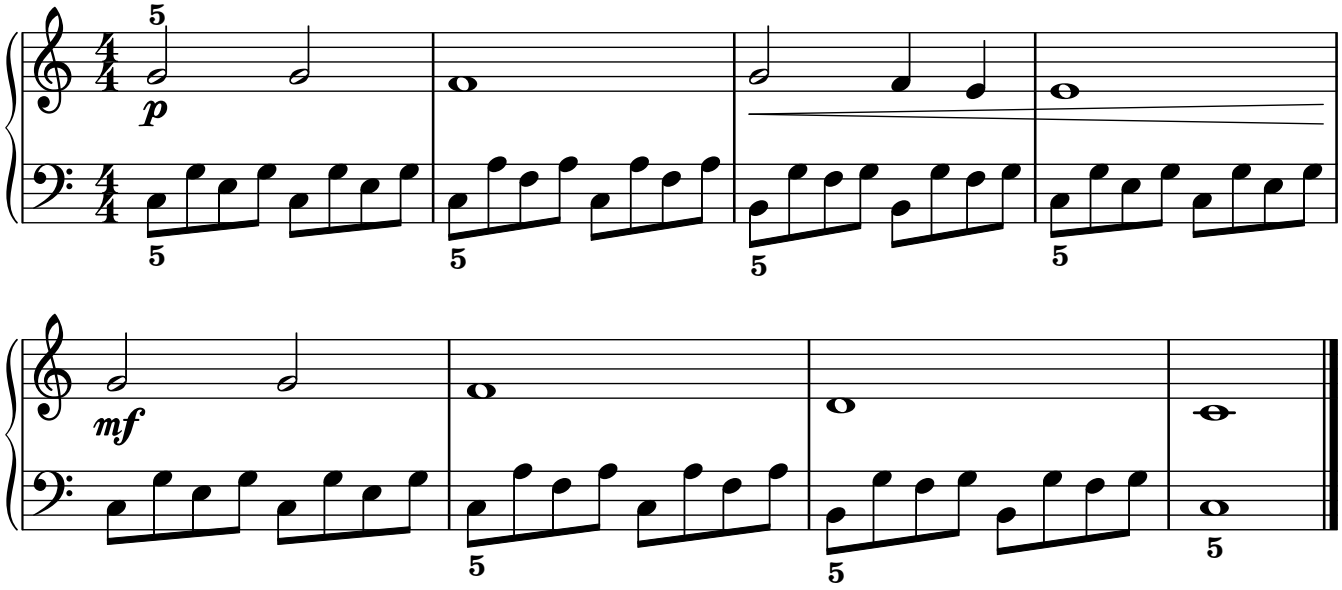


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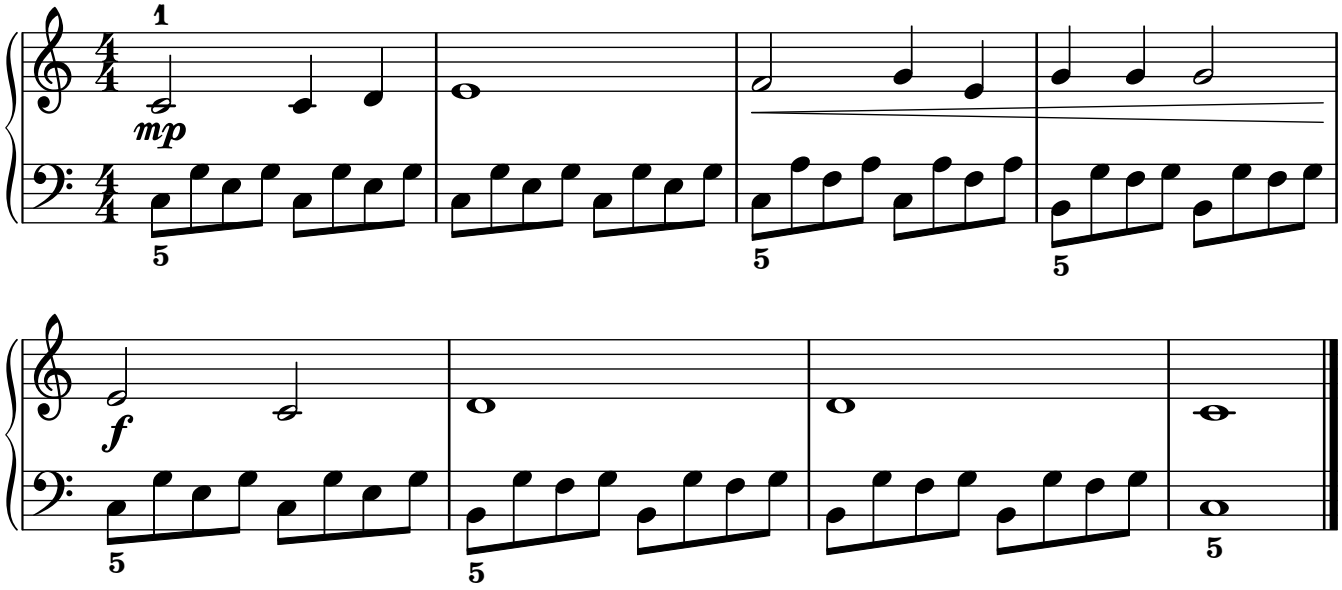
2.16



2.17



2.18

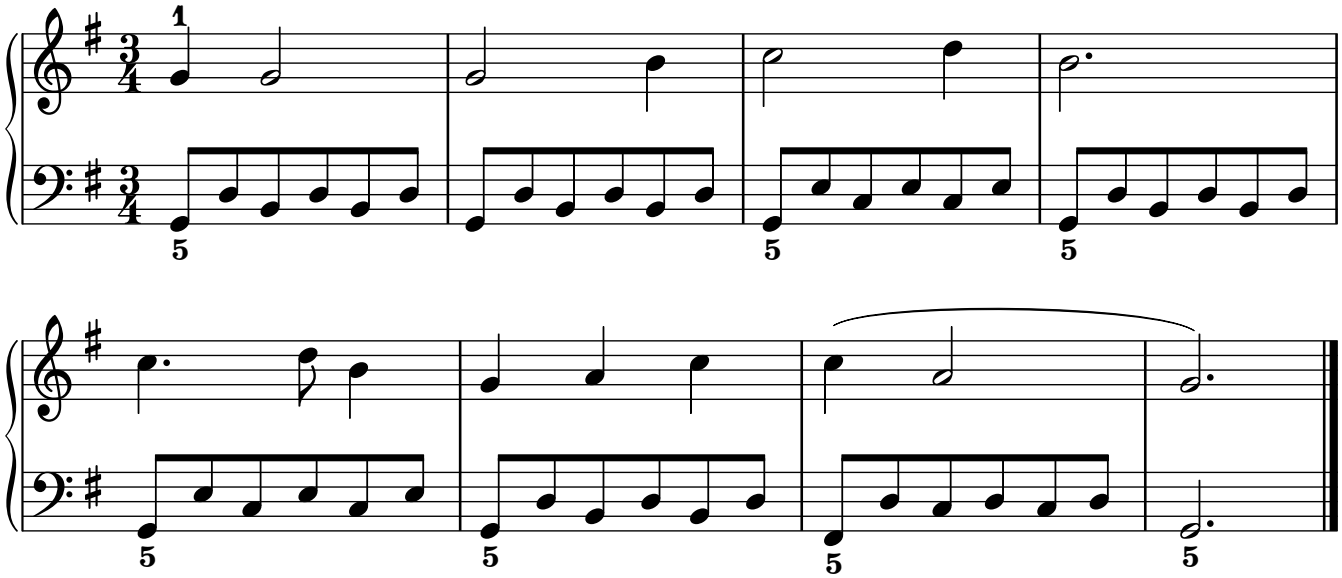


Part C: Alberti bass in 3/4

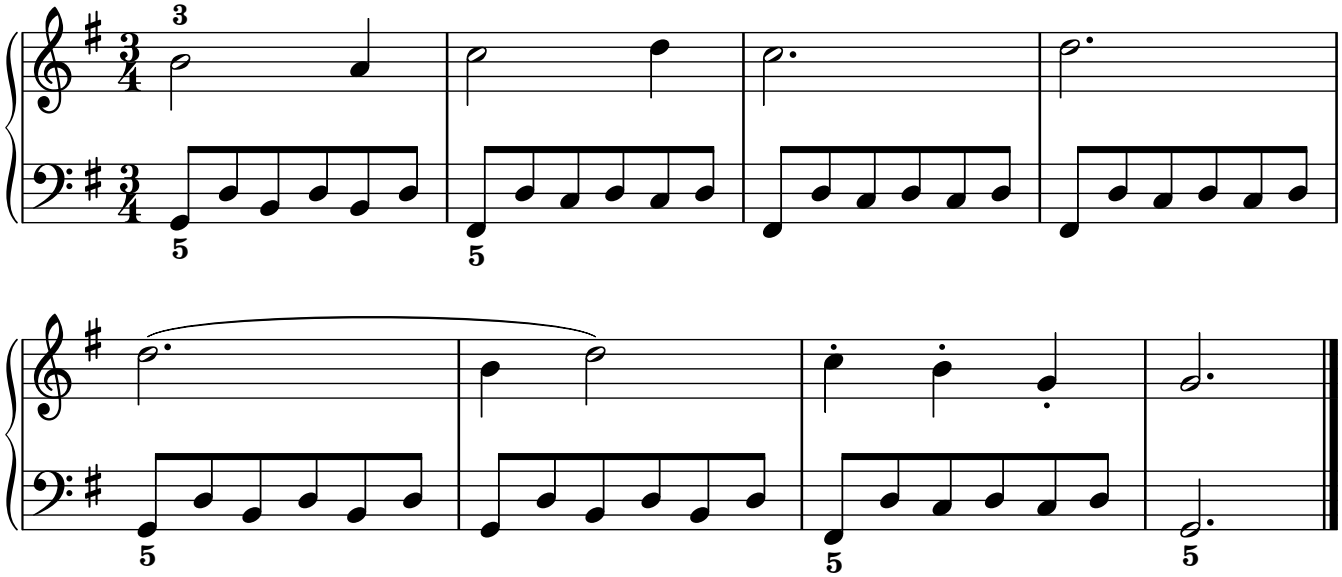
♩ = 66

G major in 3/4: the bass plays bottom, top, middle, top, middle, top - six eighths in a bar.

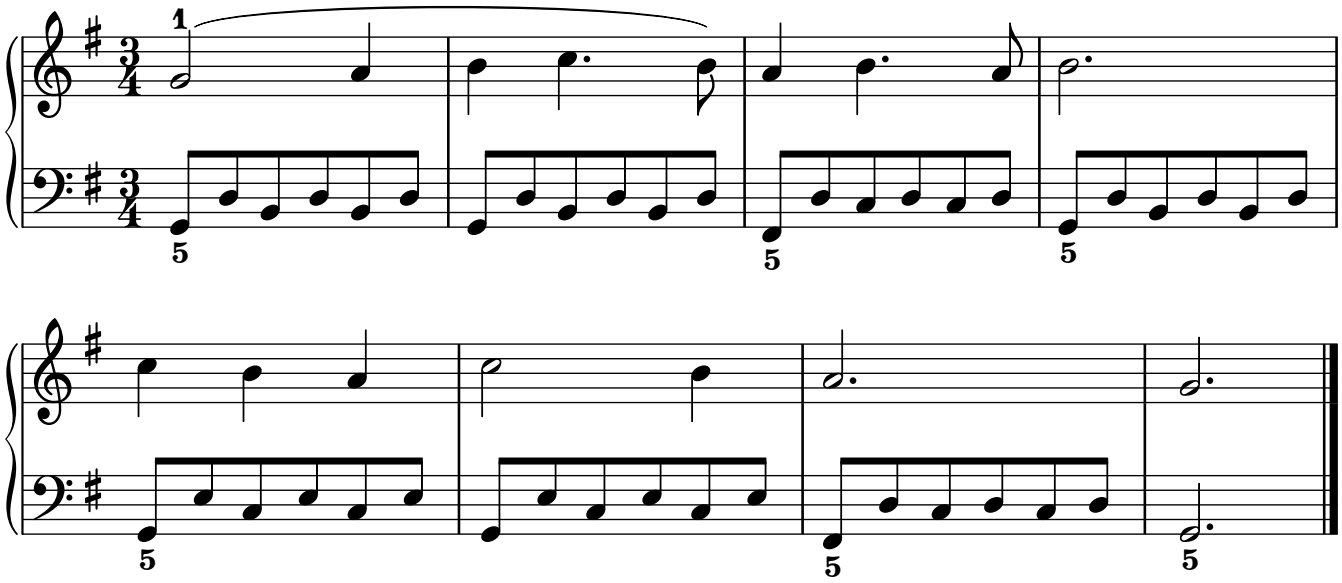
☐ **2.19**
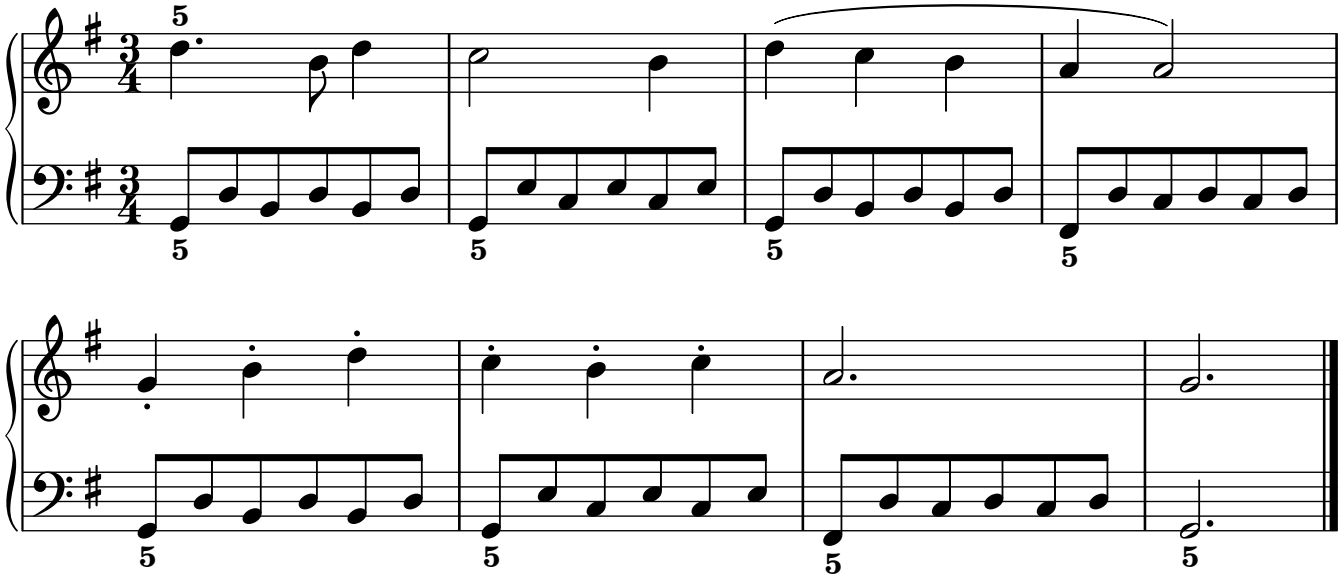


☐ **2.20**



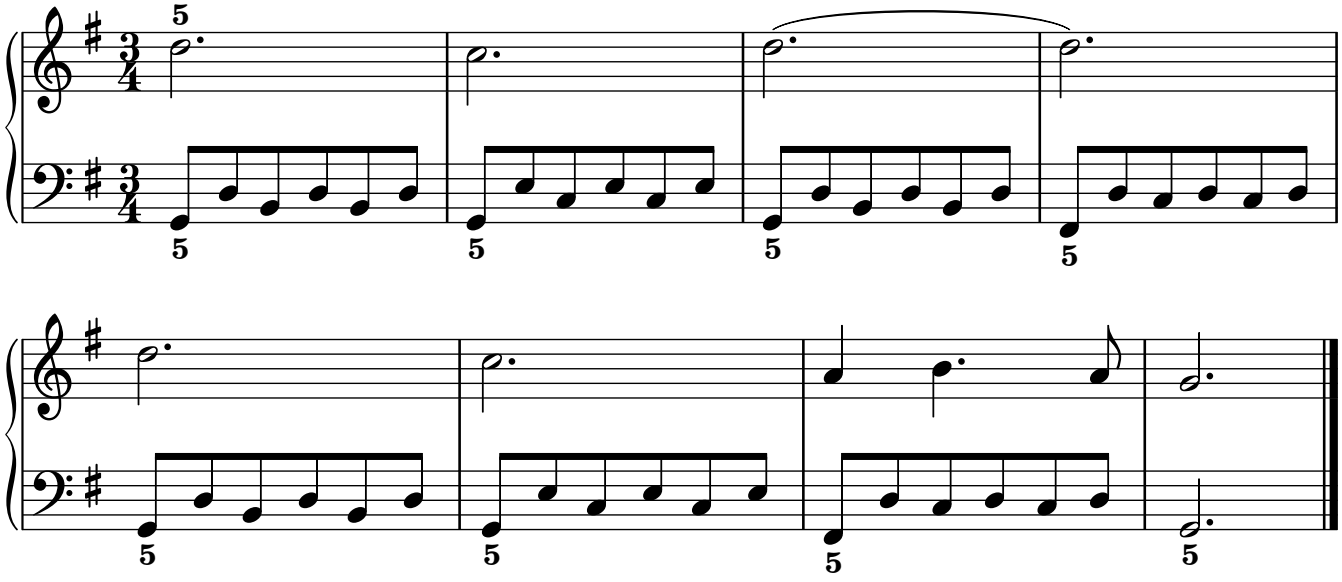
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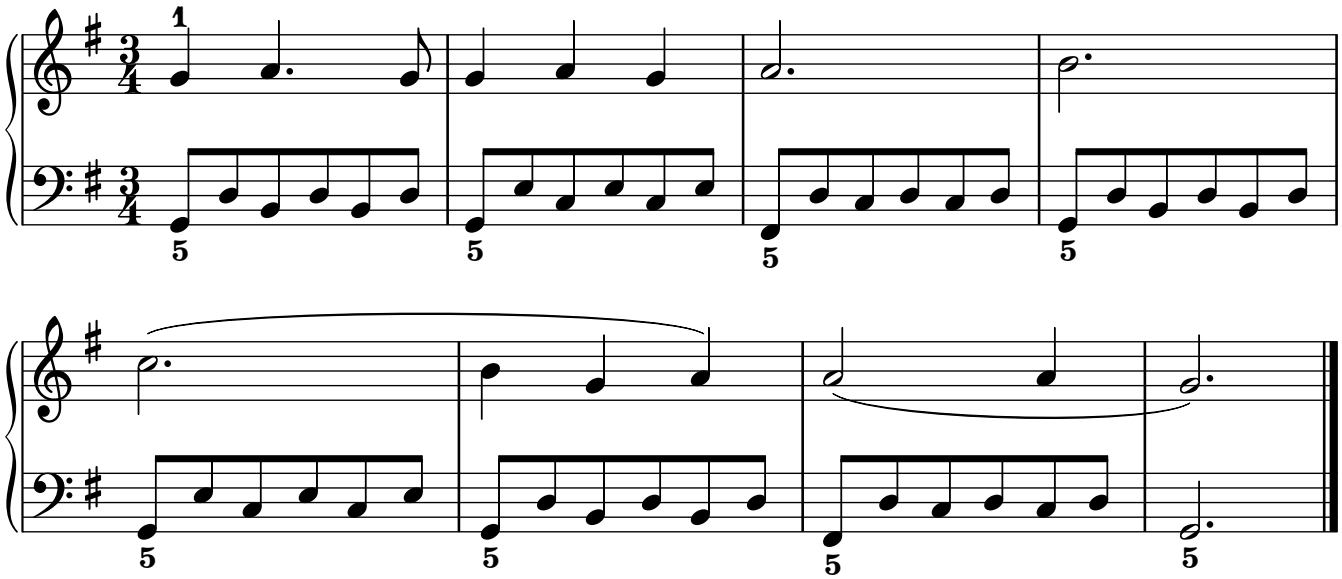
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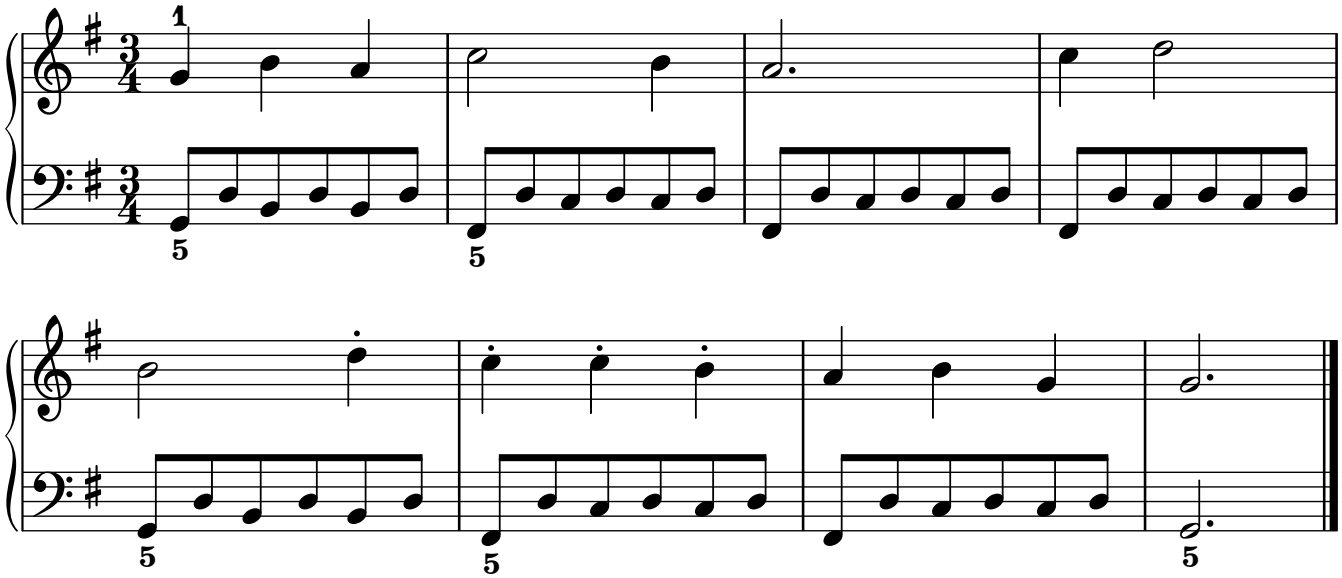
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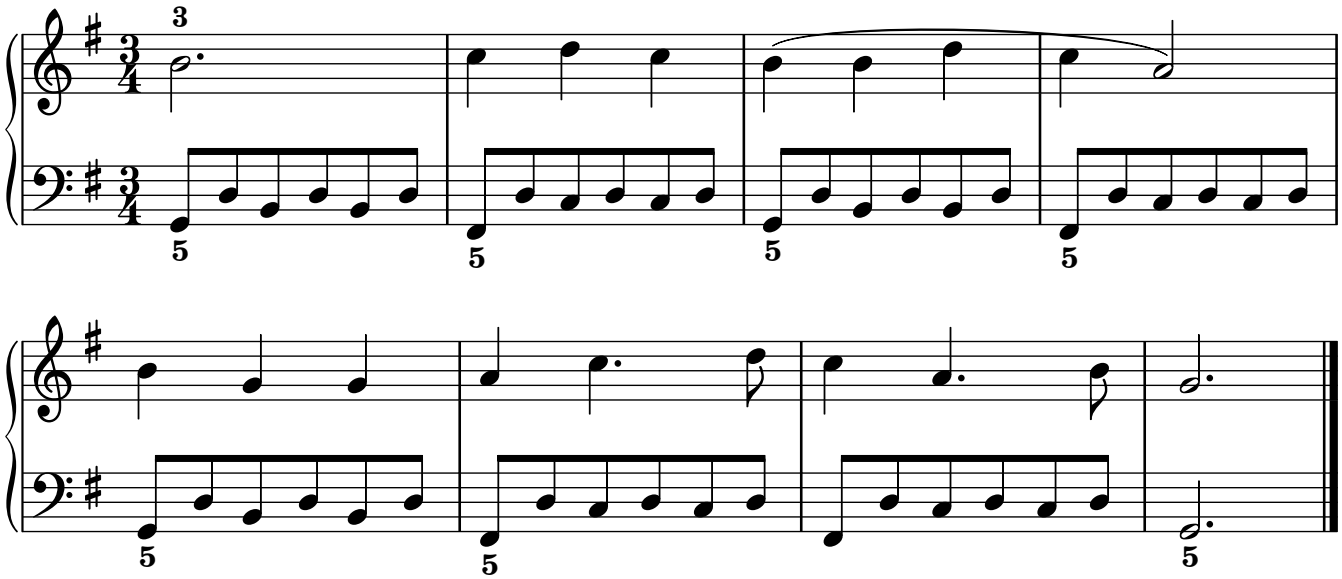
2.24



2.25



2.26

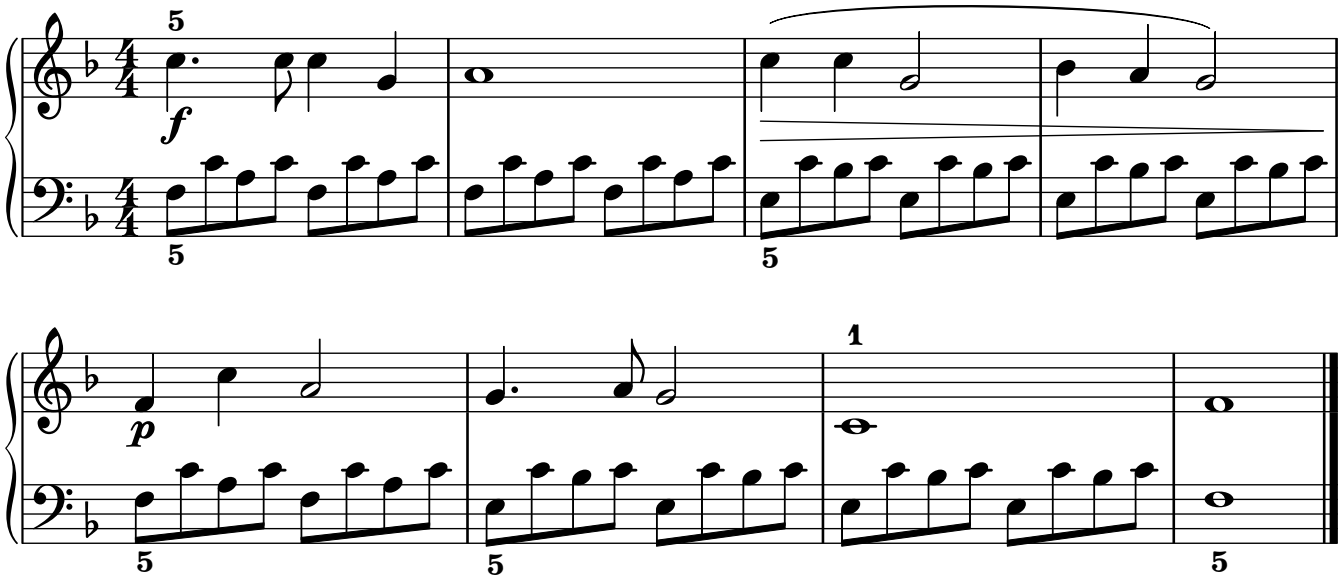


Part D: F major, the right hand on the move

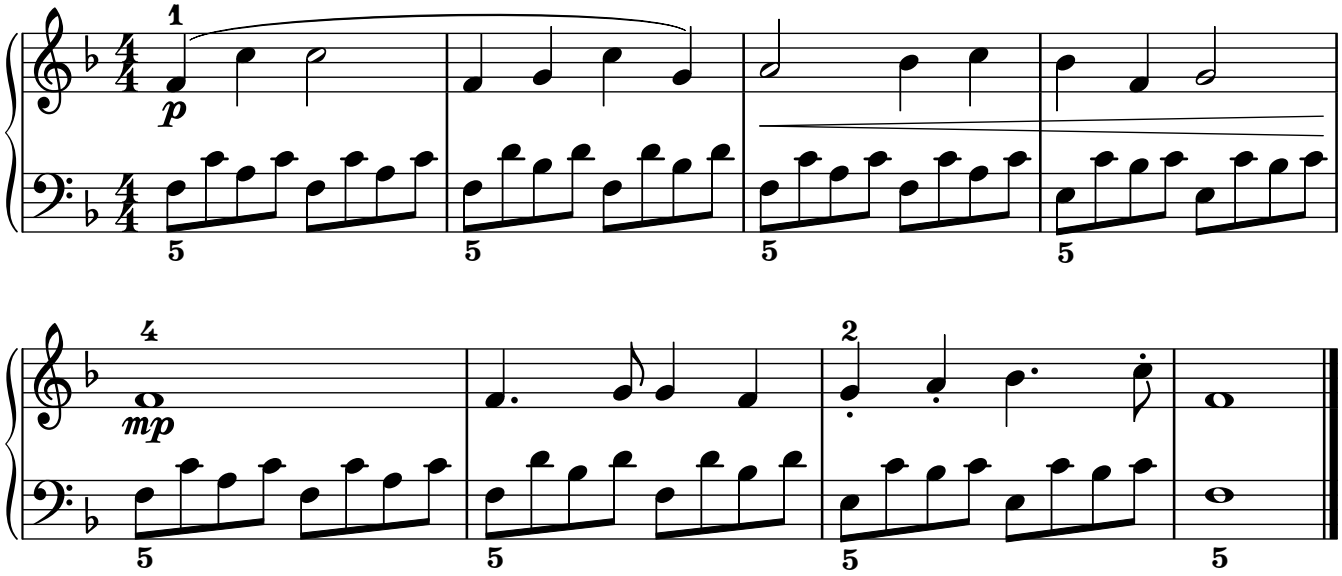
♩ = 60

F major. The right hand moves between F position and C position; watch for its finger numbers.

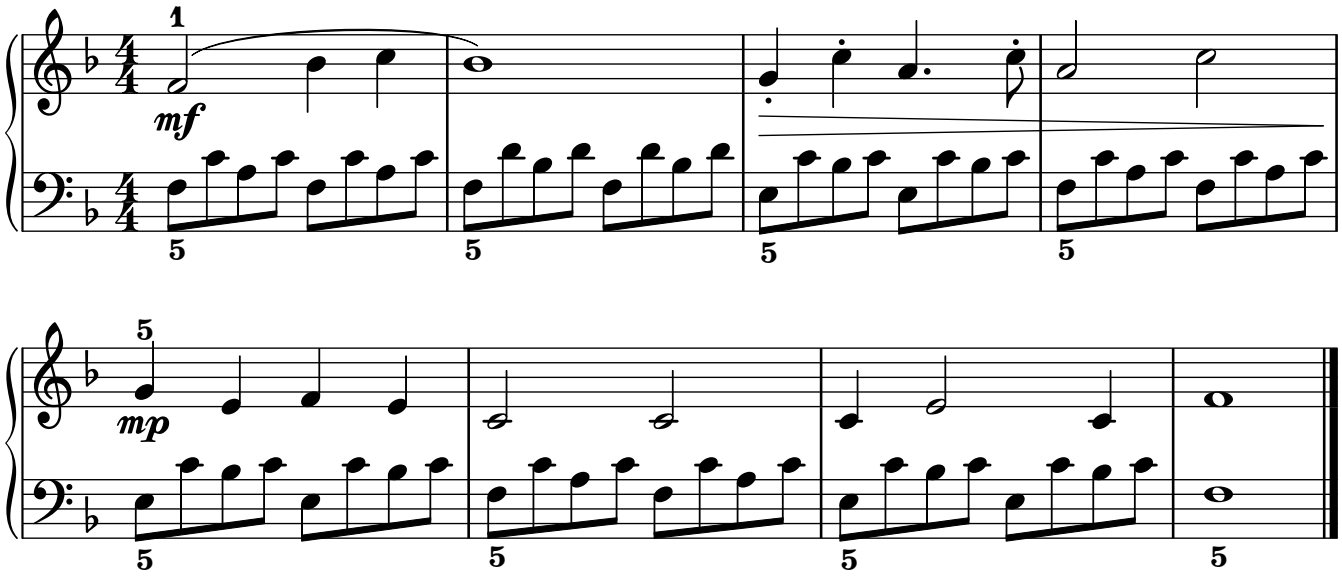
☐ **2.27**
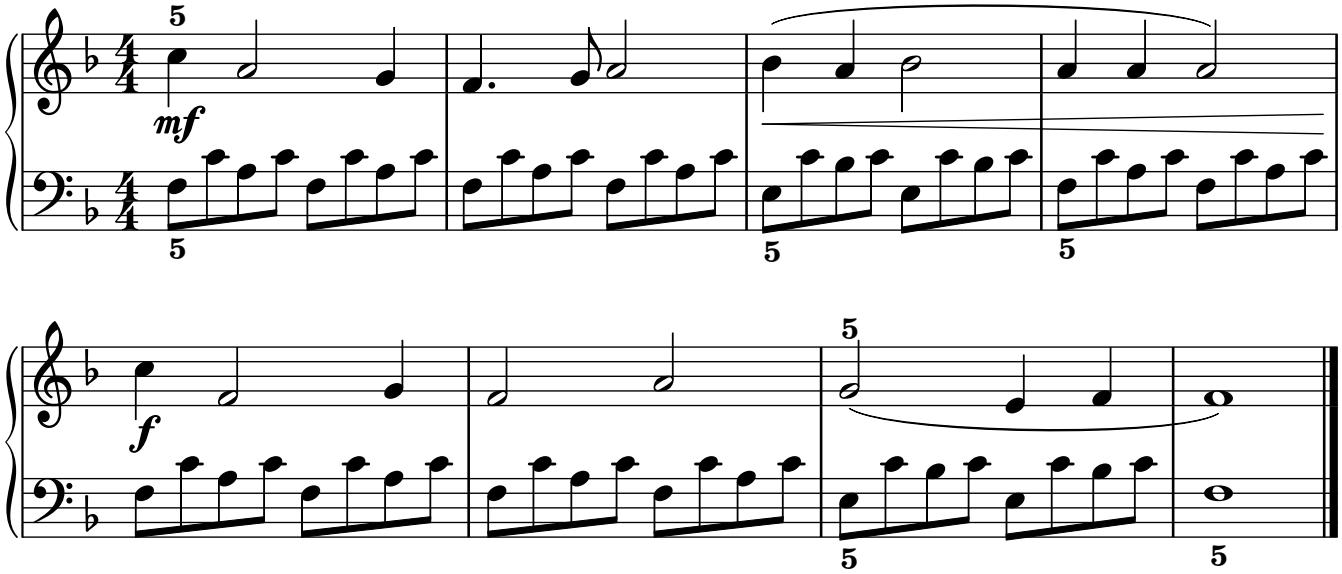


☐ **2.28**



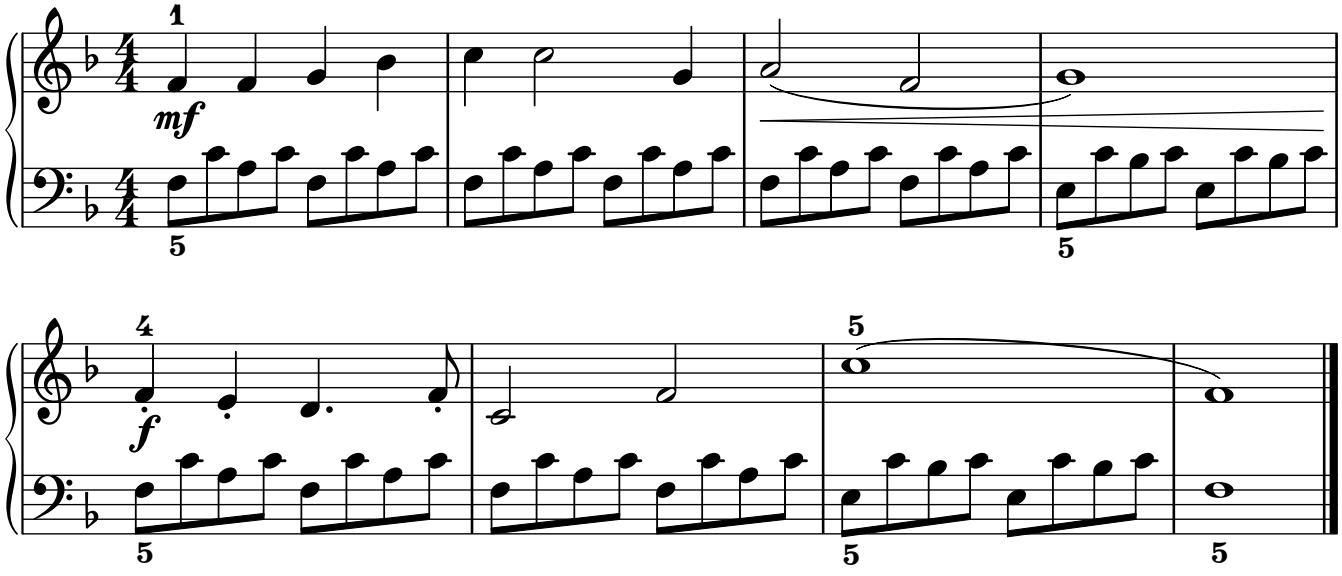
2.29
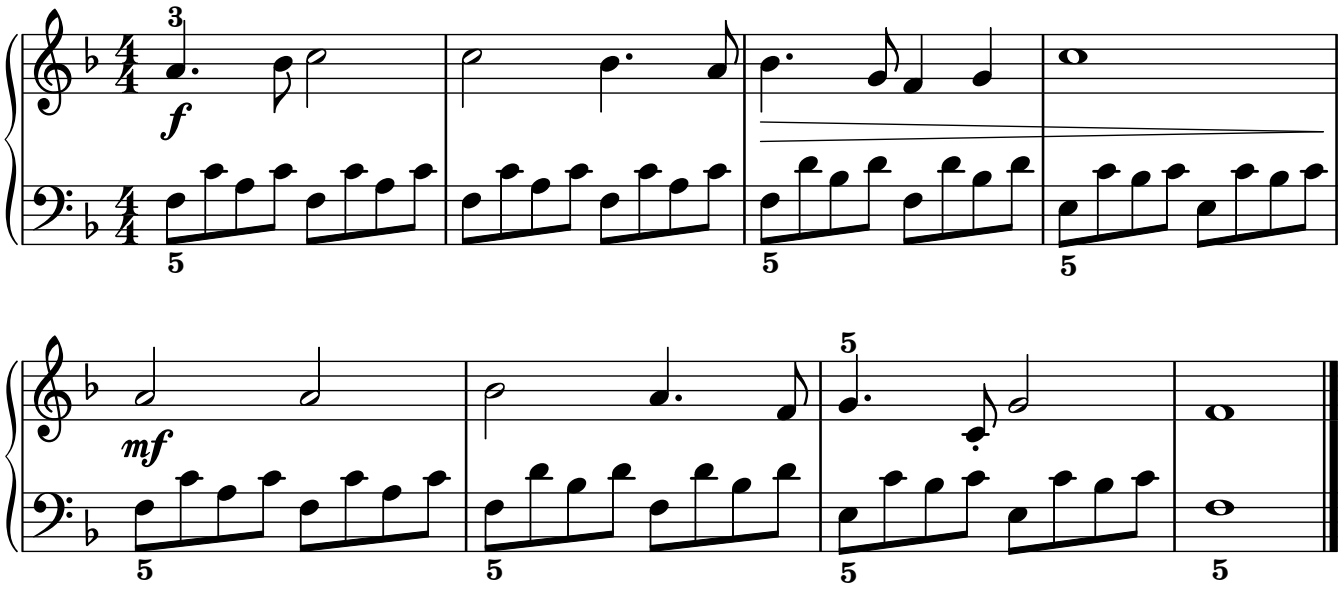


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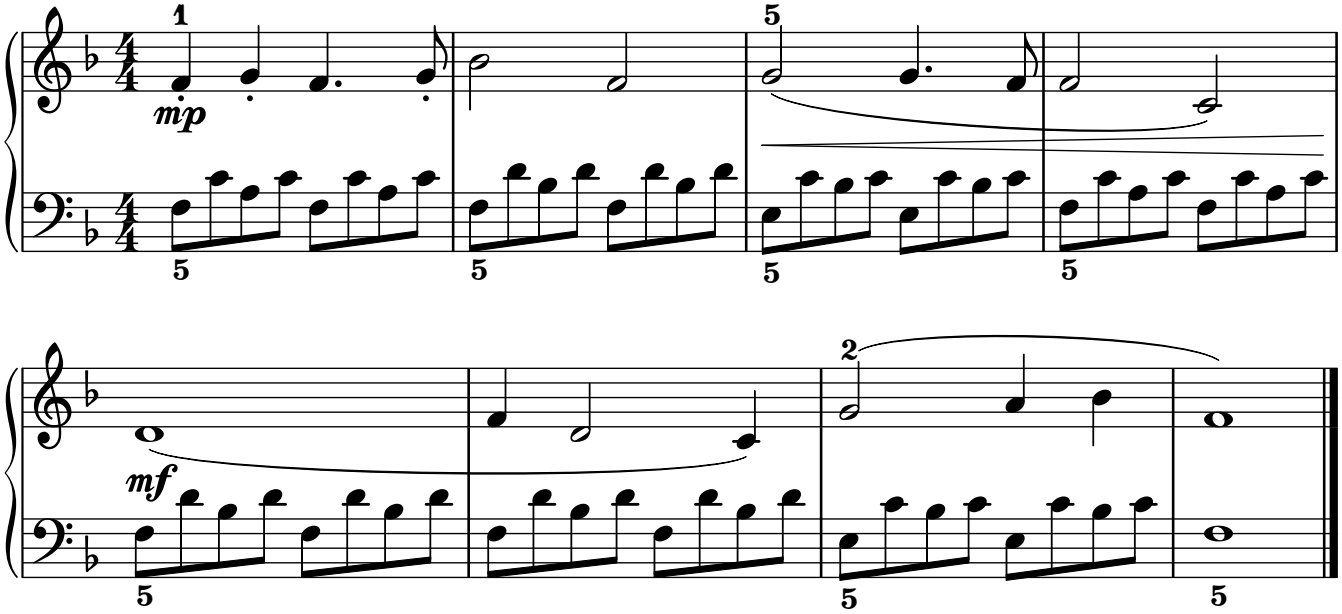
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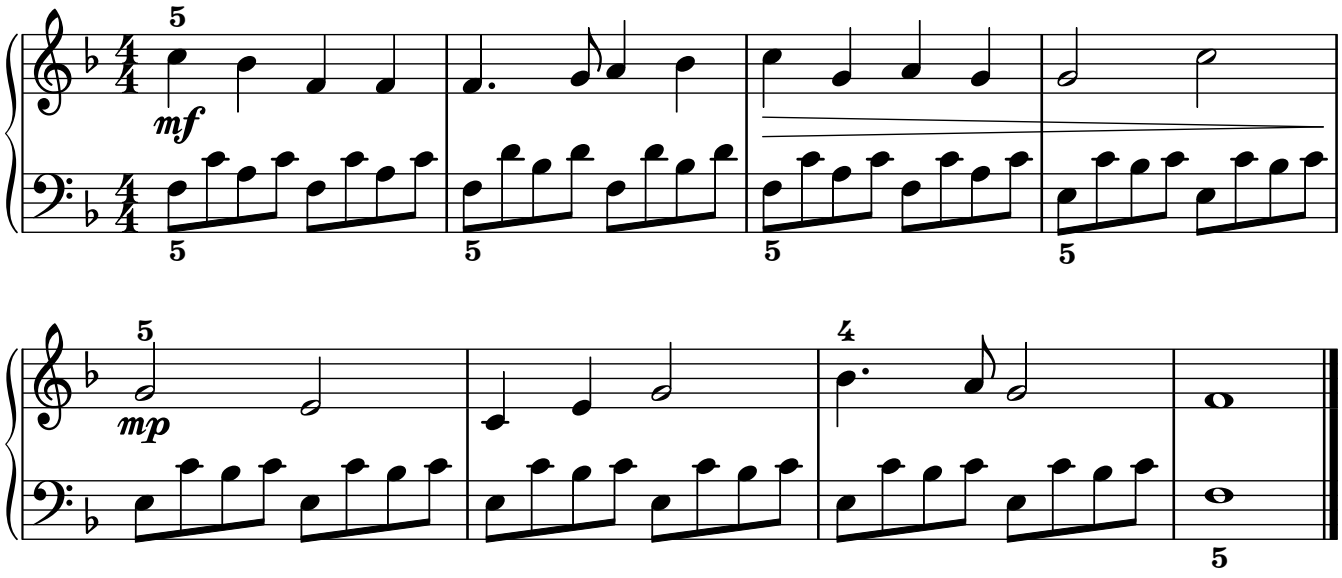
2.32



2.33



2.34
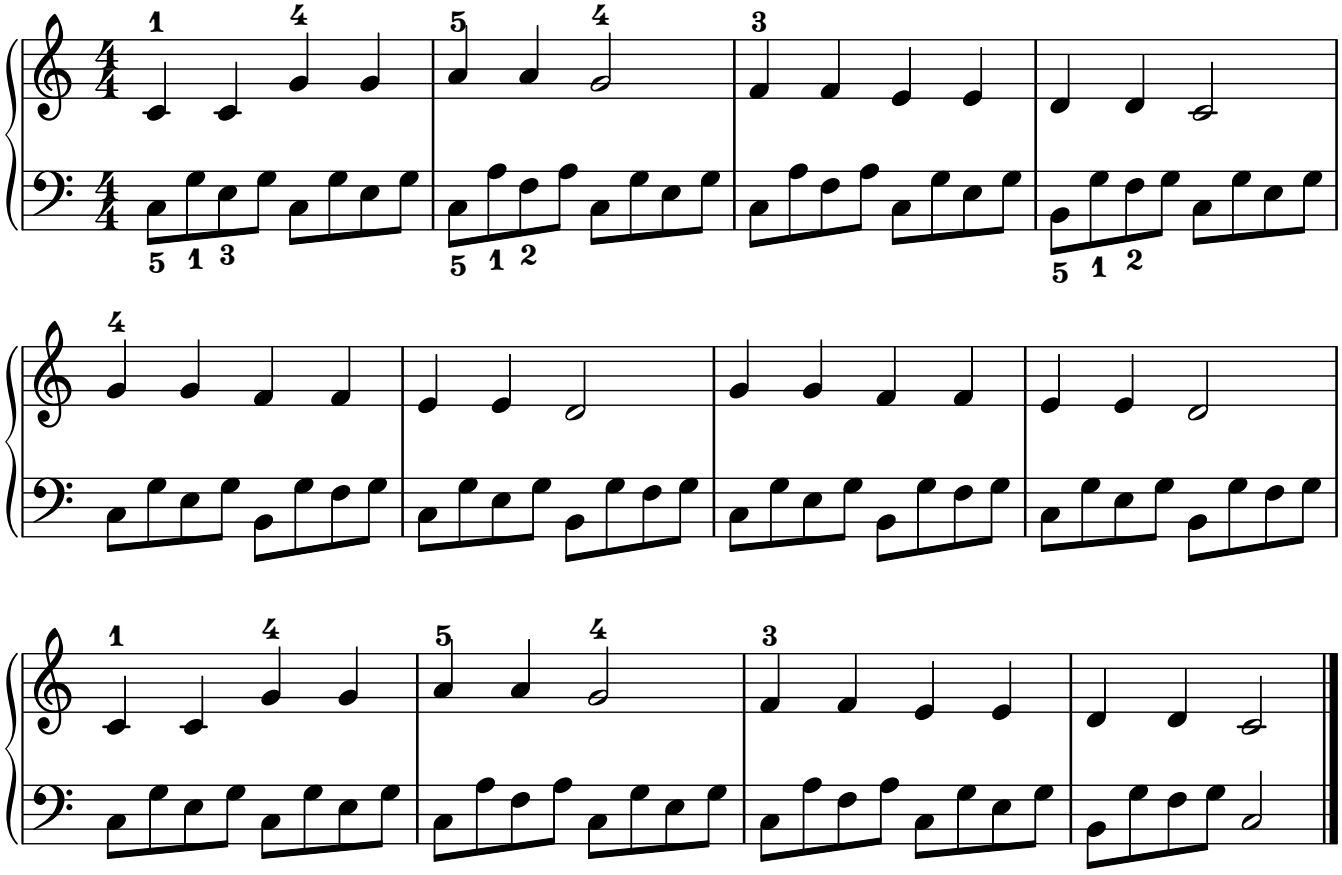


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star ♩ = 76

French folk tune 'Ah! vous dirai-je, maman' (18th century) - simplified

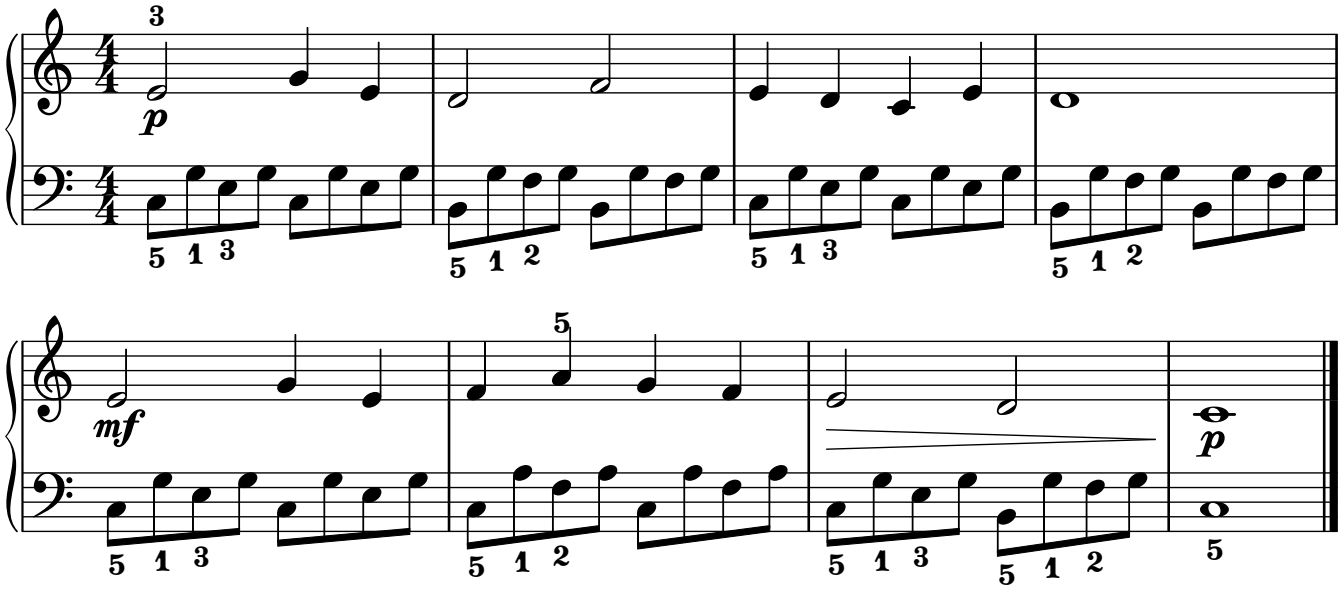
Mozart wrote twelve variations on this tune. Here the chord changes halfway through most bars, so each half bar has its own group of four eighths. The right hand stretches finger 5 up to A.



Little Sonata Theme ♩ = 72

Original

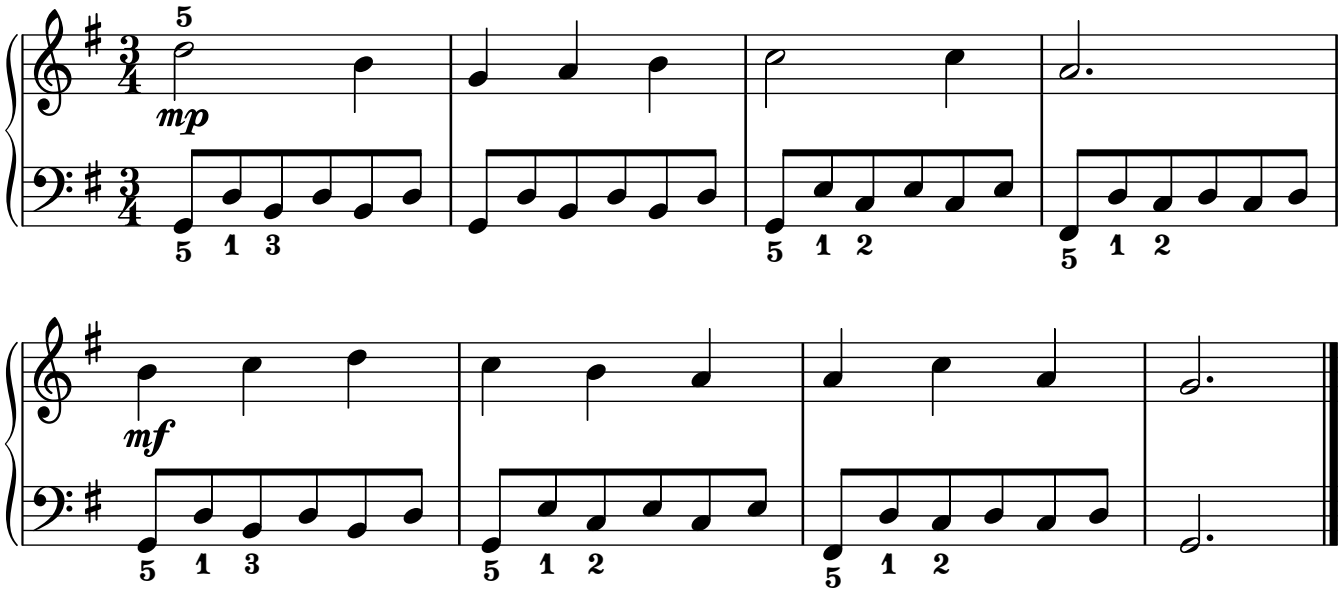
A tune in the style of a classical sonata. In bar 6 the right hand stretches finger 5 to A, and in bar 7 the chord changes halfway through the bar.



Alberti Waltz ♩ = 84

Original

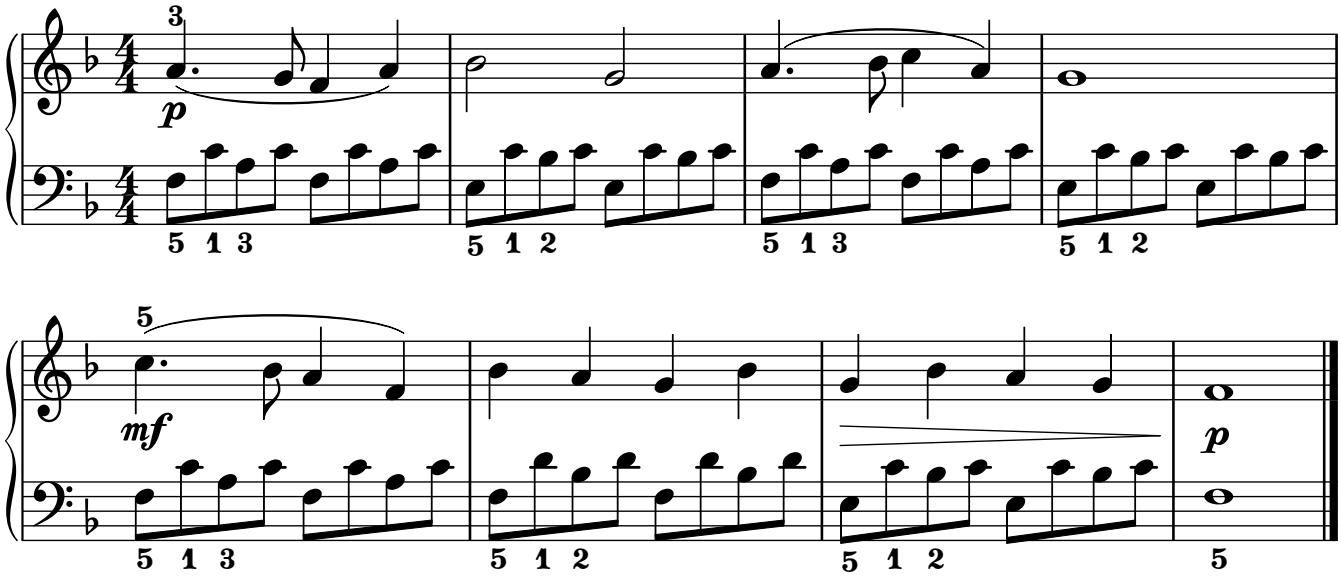
In 3/4 the Alberti pattern has six eighths: bottom, top, middle, top, middle, top. F-sharp is the bottom note of the V7 shape in bars 4 and 7.



Sunrise in F ♩ = 66

Original

Dotted rhythms over an Alberti bass in F major. B-flat is in both hands; in bar 6 the IV shape reaches up to D above middle C.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 3?

- Play five new Part B or D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- The Alberti bass stays even and softer than the tune.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 3.

Unit 3

Six-Eight Time

New: 6/8: two beats in a bar, each beat split into three eighths

In 6/8 time a bar holds six eighth notes, grouped in two sets of three: ONE two three FOUR five six. At a slow speed you can count all six. At a normal speed you feel only two beats in a bar, and each beat splits into three. That gives 6/8 its rocking, swinging feel, like a boat song or a lullaby.

What is new

6/8

The bottom 8 means the eighth note is the counting unit, and the top 6 means six of them in a bar. Eighths are beamed in threes, so you can see the two beats.

The beat is a dotted quarter

One beat in 6/8 lasts three eighths: a dotted quarter note. A dotted half note fills the whole bar. The metronome marks in this unit count dotted quarters.

Long-short

A quarter note followed by an eighth (counted 1-2 3) is the typical 6/8 rhythm: long, short, long, short. Do not let it turn into an even pair.

Two new bass patterns

Lilting: bottom (quarter), top (eighth), middle (quarter), top (eighth). Rolling: six eighths, bottom, middle, top, middle, top, middle.

Reading tips

1. Count six slowly first, then switch to two beats: ONE-and-a TWO-and-a.

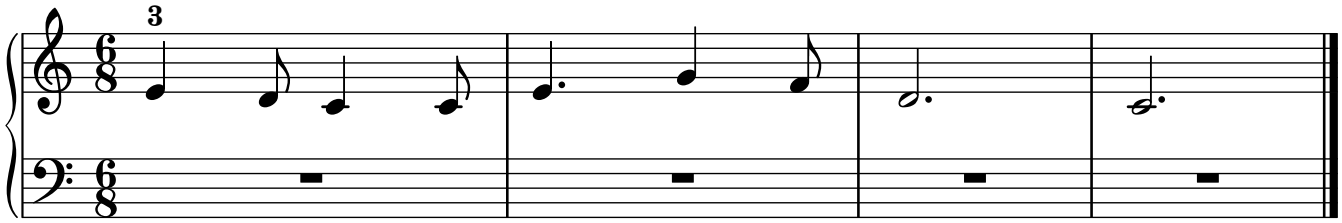
2. Find the dotted quarters and dotted halves before you start: they show where the beats are.

3. Feel the long-short swing in the left hand, and let the right hand ride on it.

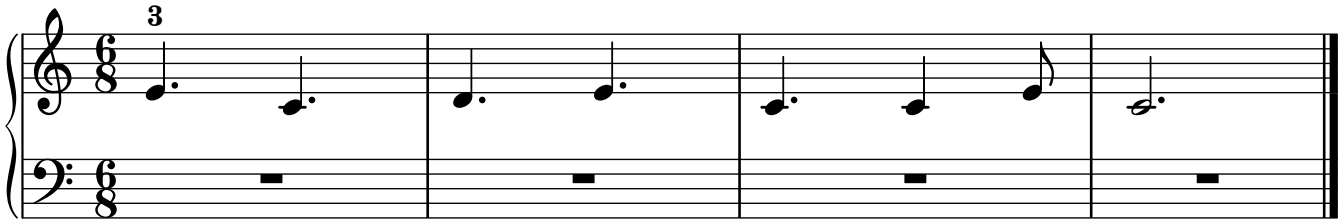
Part A: Two beats in a bar ♩. = 50

Right hand in C position. Count six eighths at first; the metronome gives one click per dotted quarter.

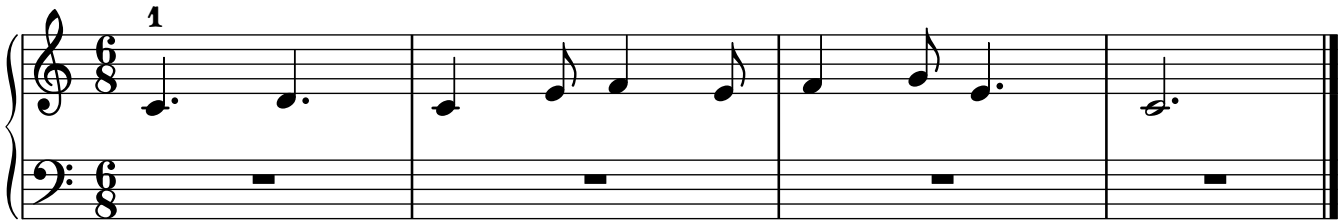
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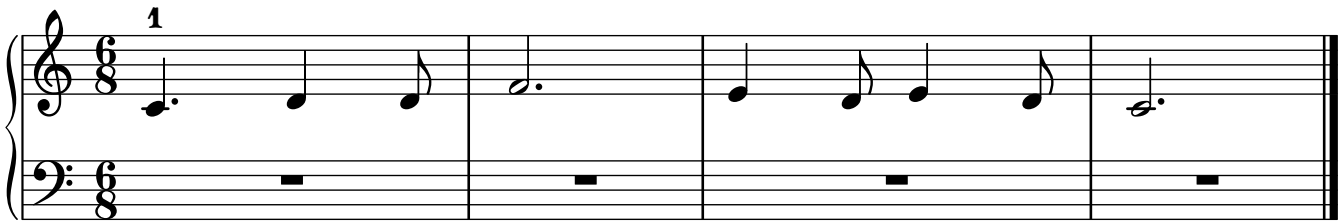
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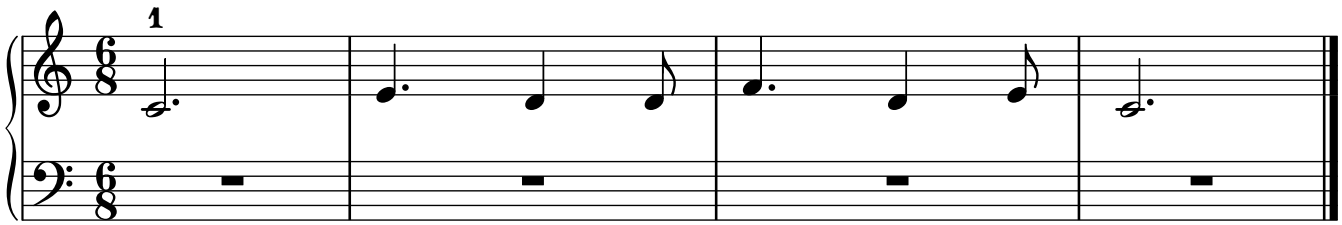


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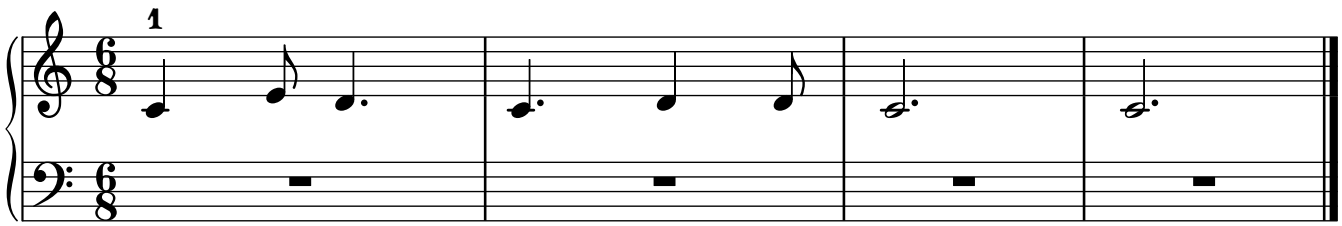
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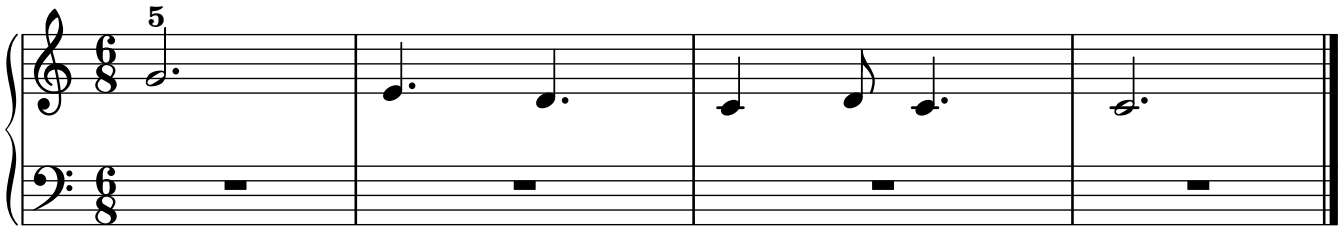
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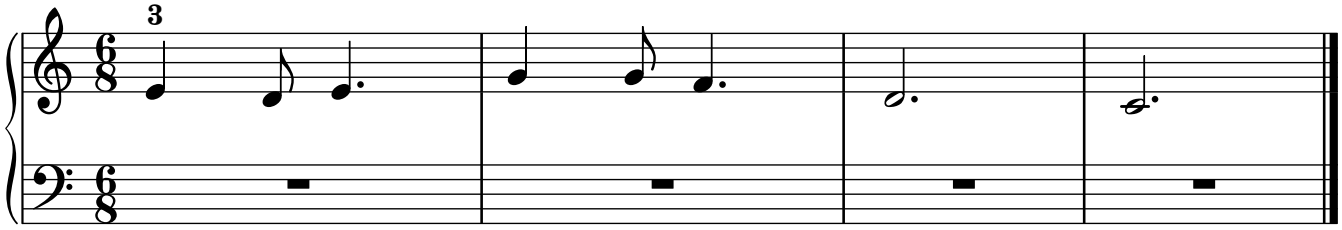
☐ **3.6**



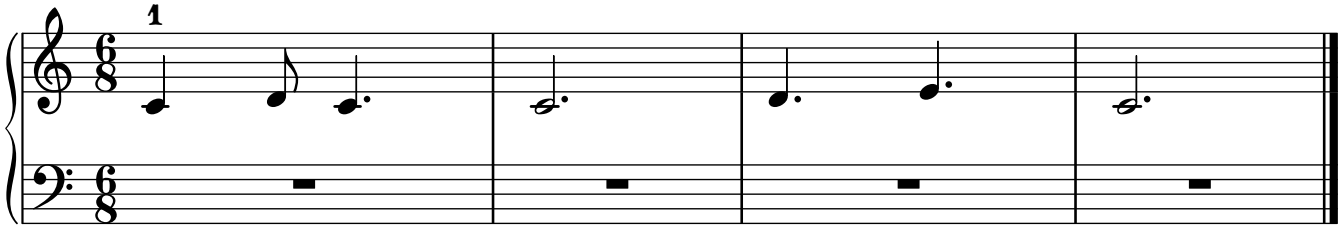
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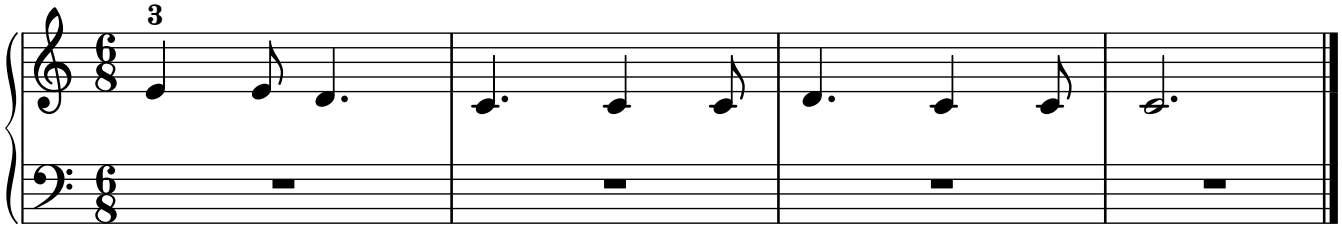
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3.9



3.10
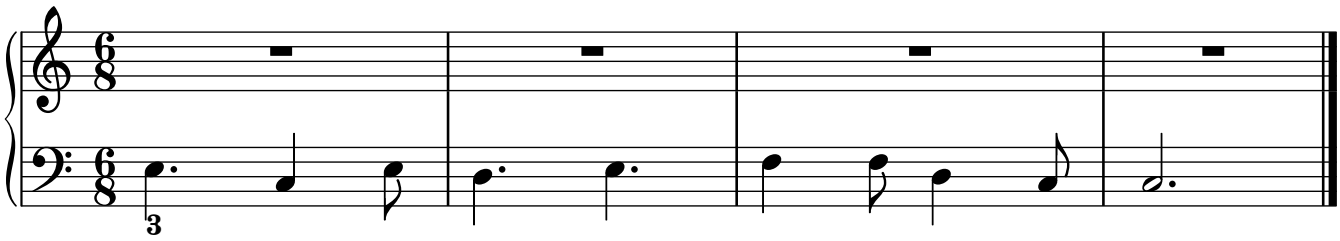


Part B: 6/8 in the left hand

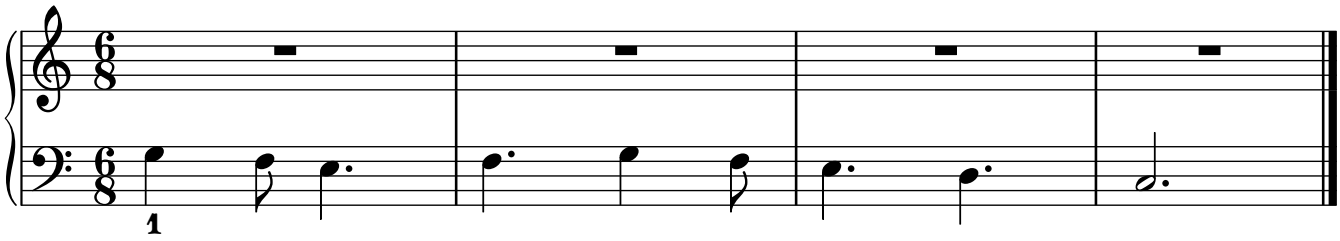
♩. = 50

Left hand in C position, in 6/8.

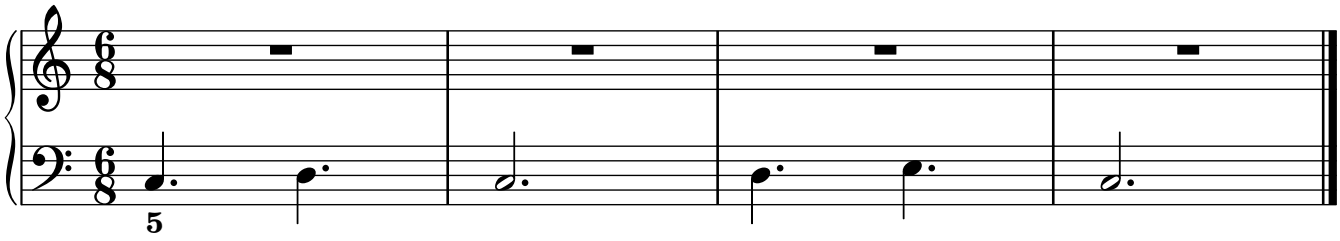
☐ **3.11**



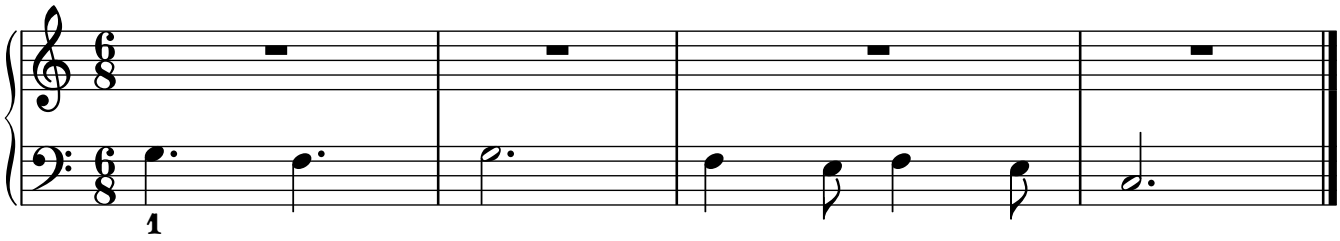
☐ **3.12**



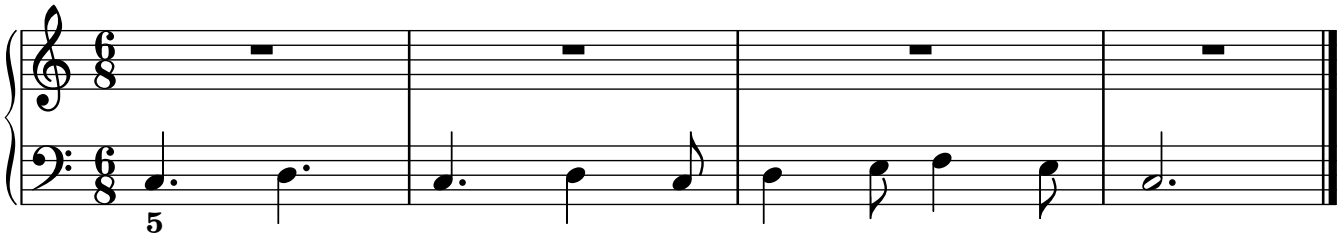
☐ **3.13**



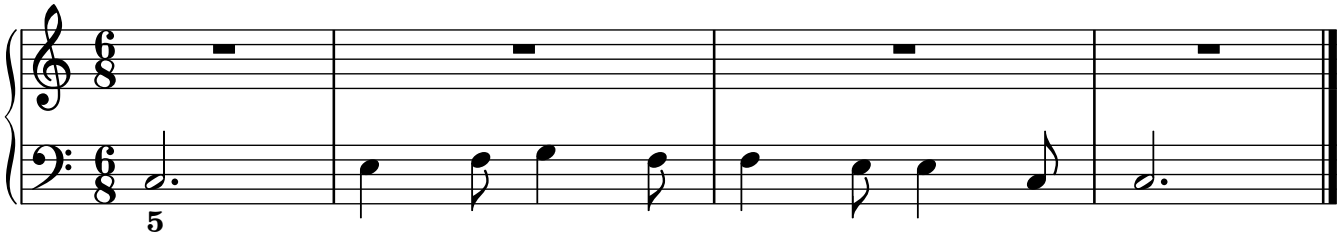
☐ **3.14**



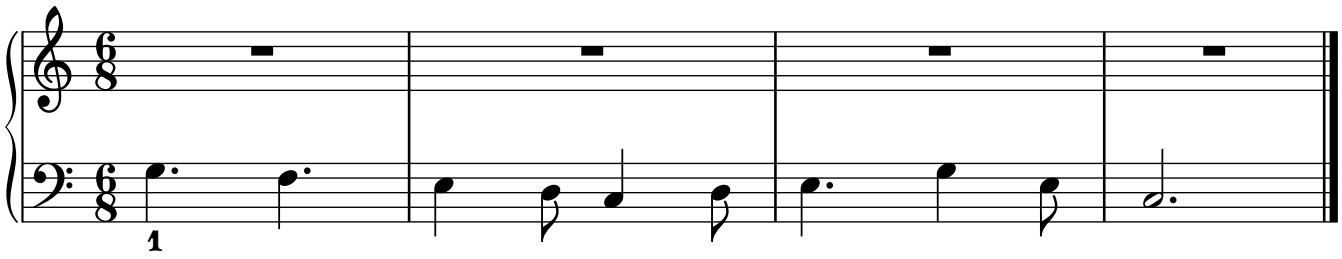
☐ **3.15**



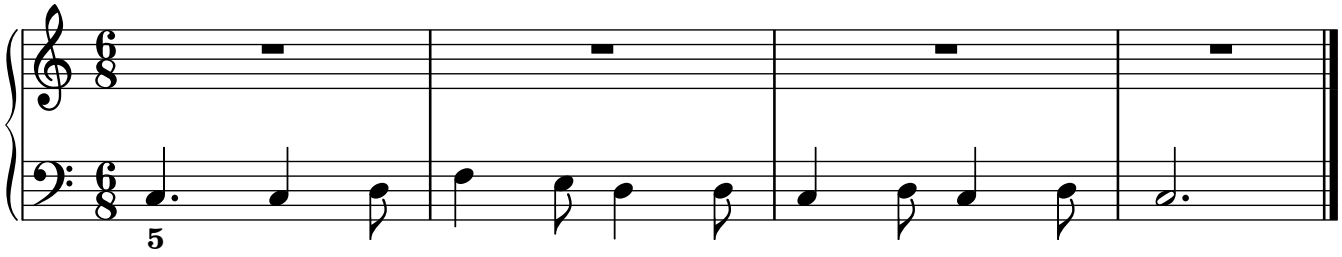
☐ **3.16**



3.17
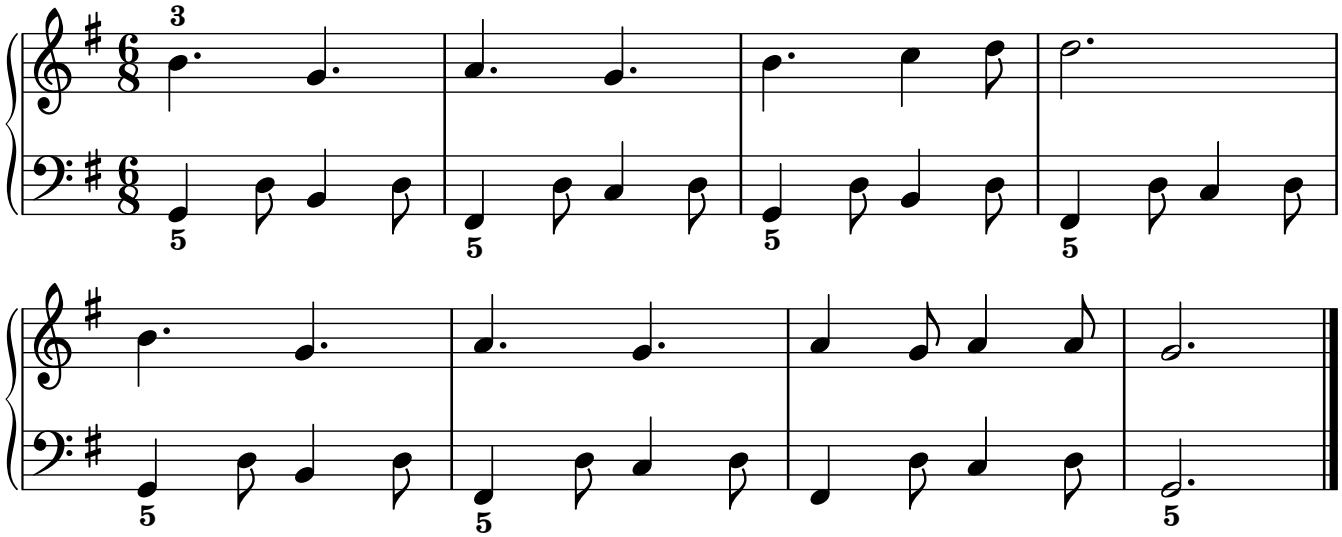


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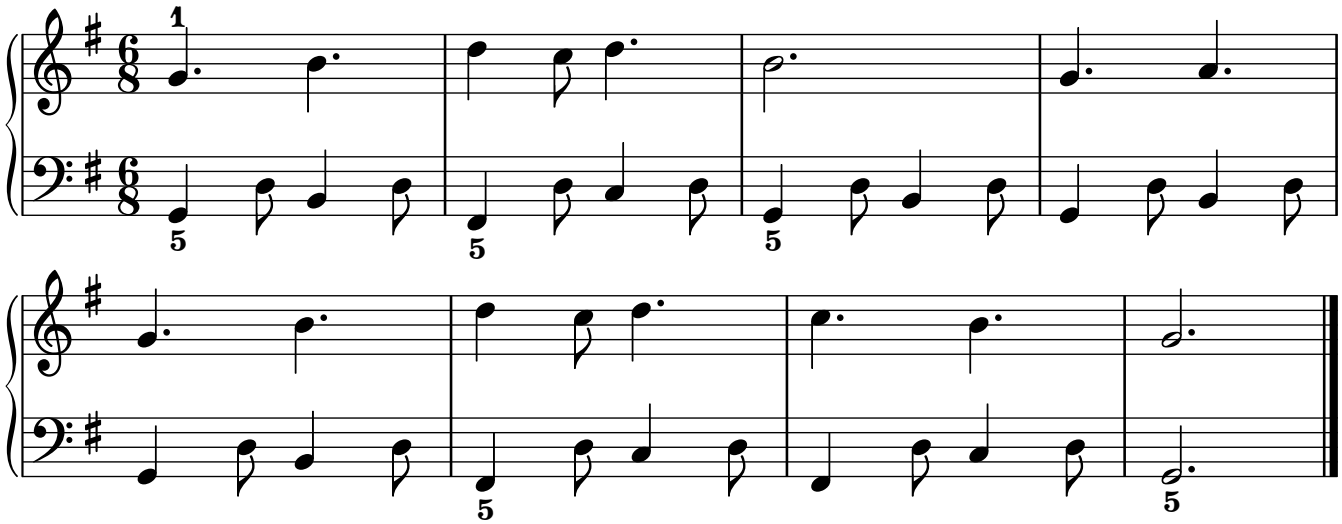


Part C: A lilting bass in G major ♩. = 50

G major, hands together. The left hand plays the lilting pattern: long, short, long, short.
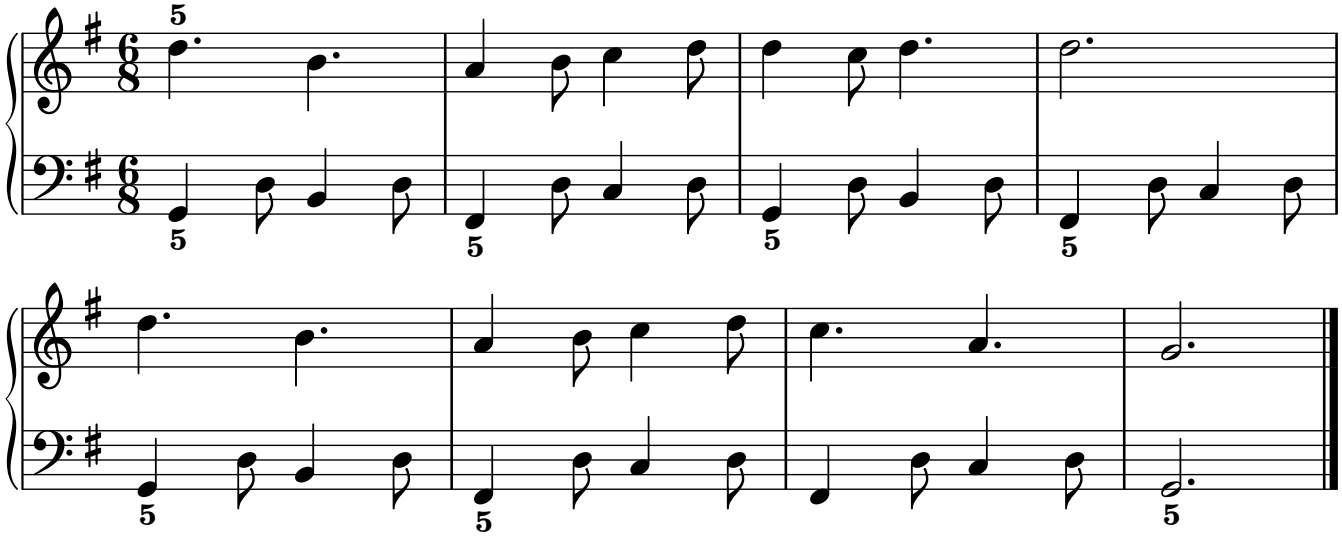
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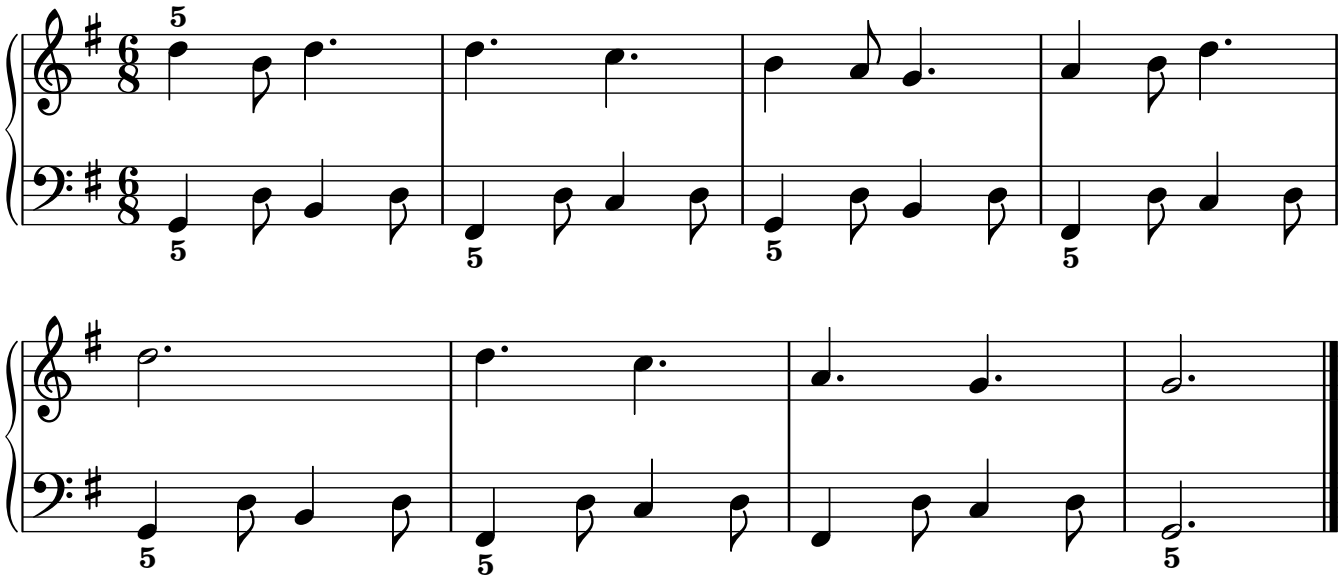


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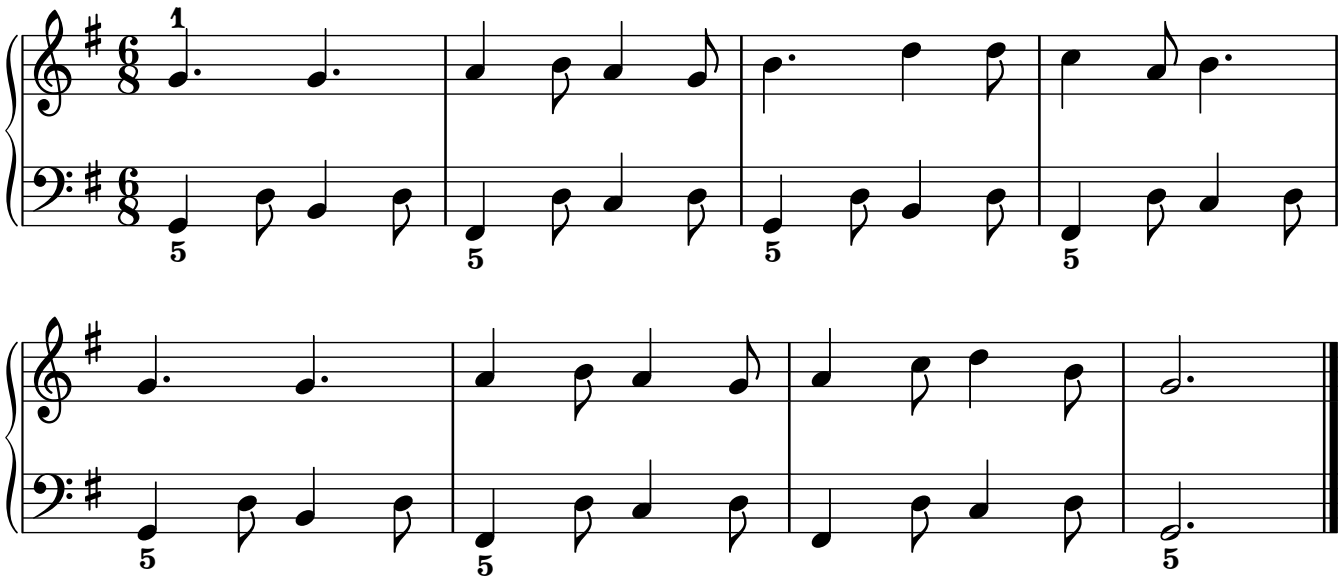


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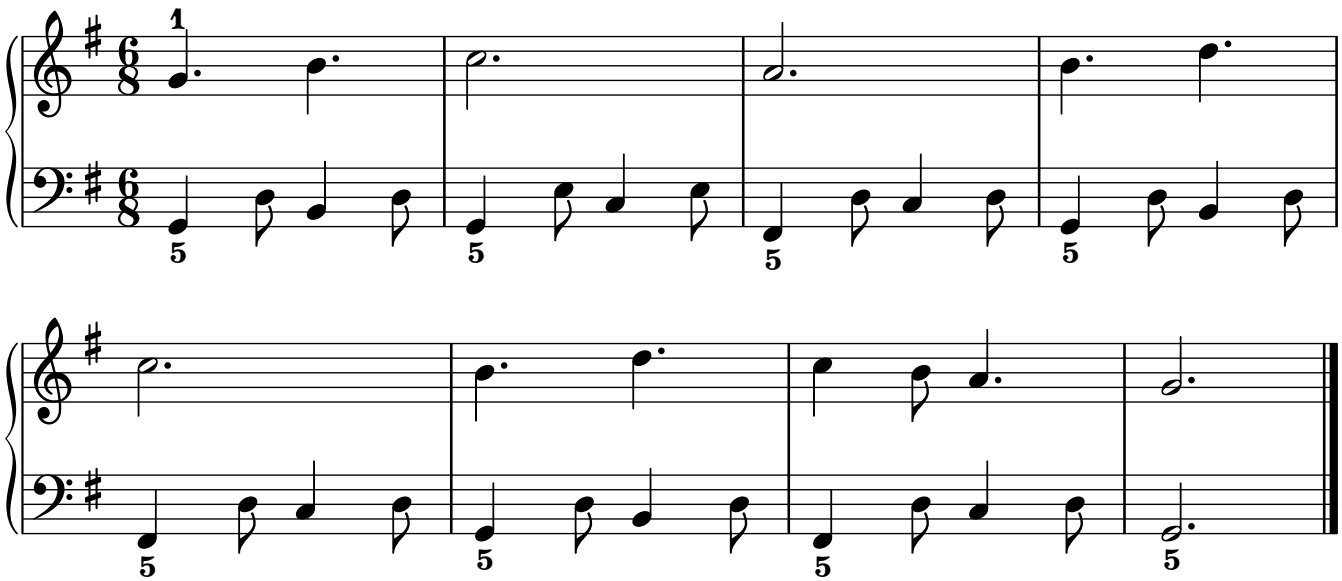


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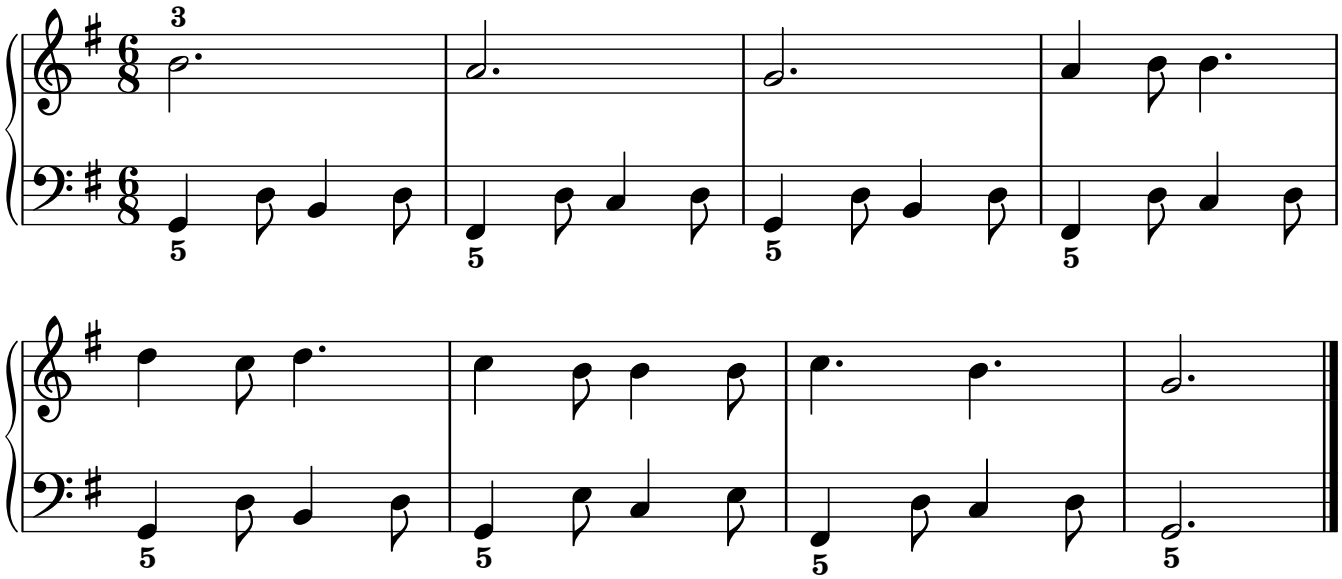


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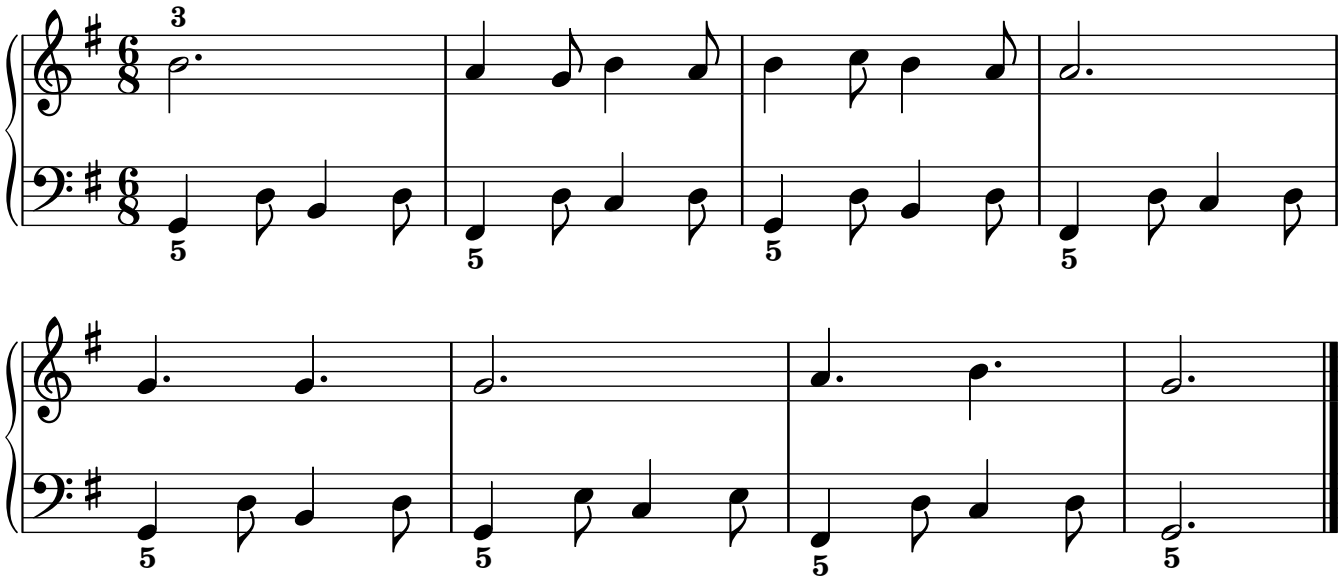


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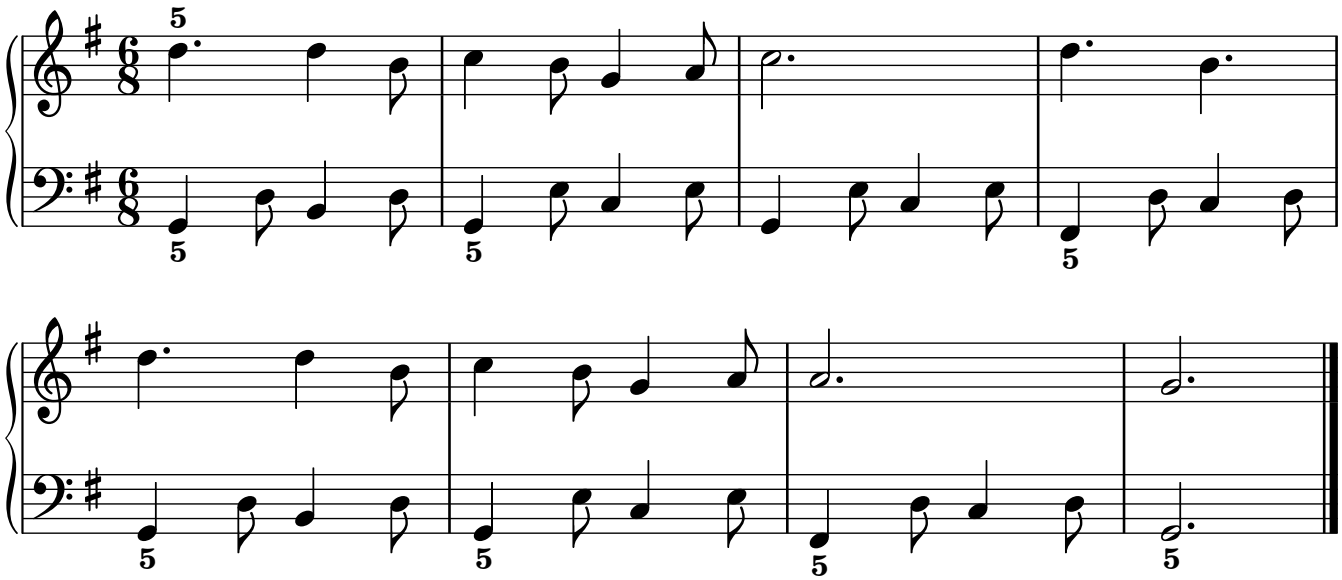
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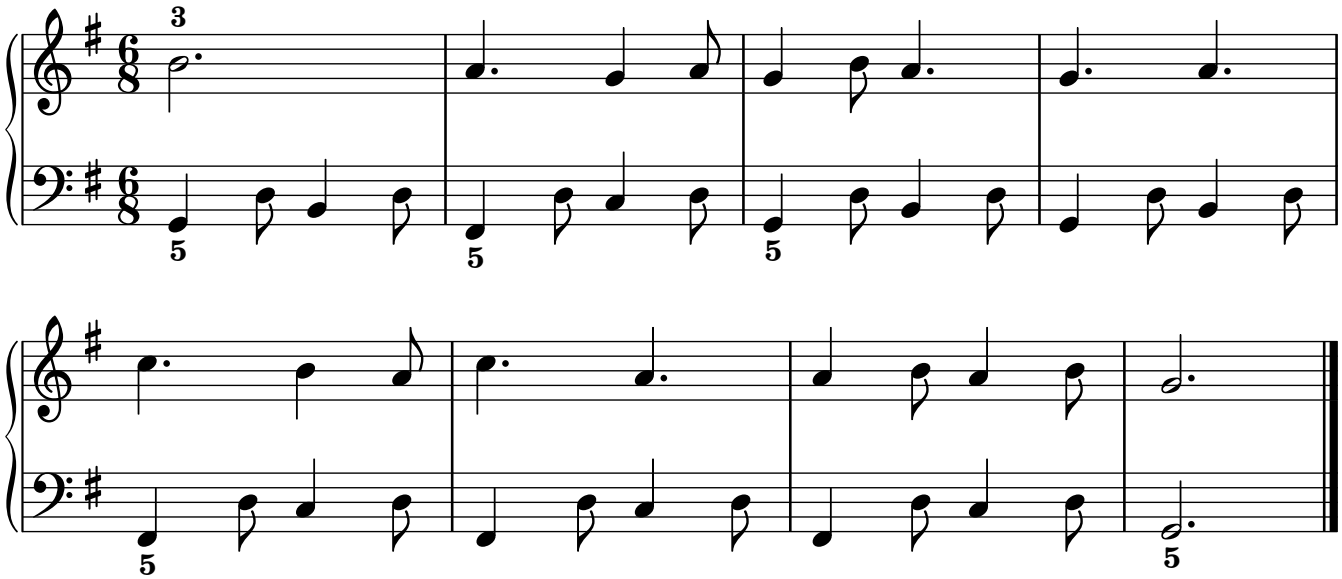


3.26



3.27



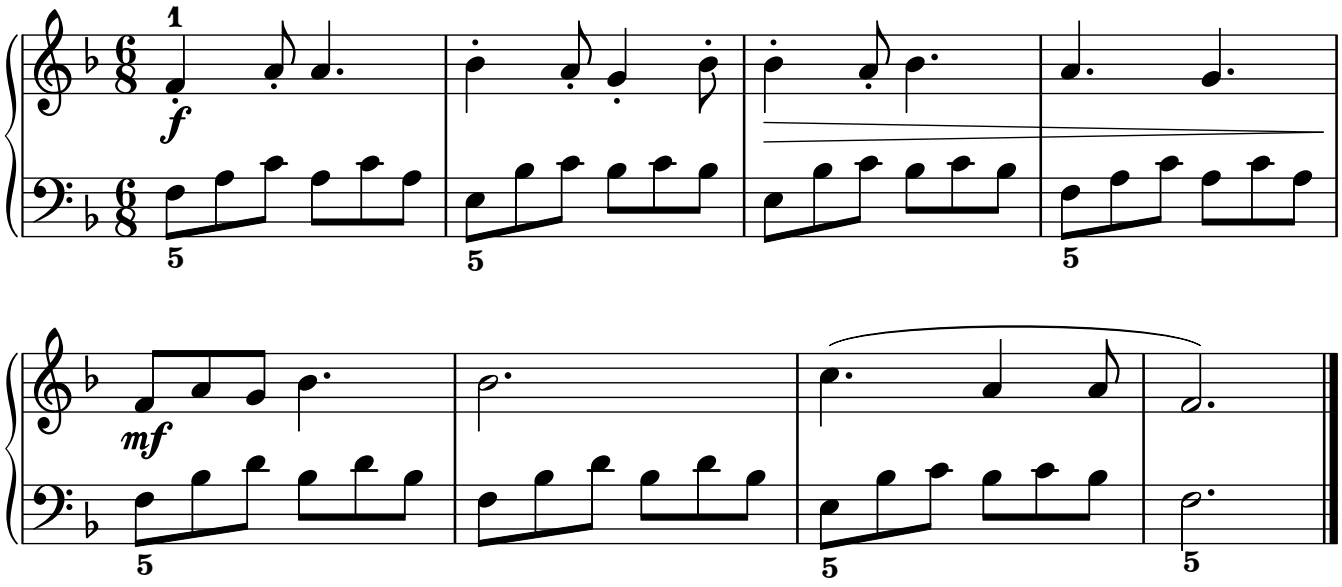
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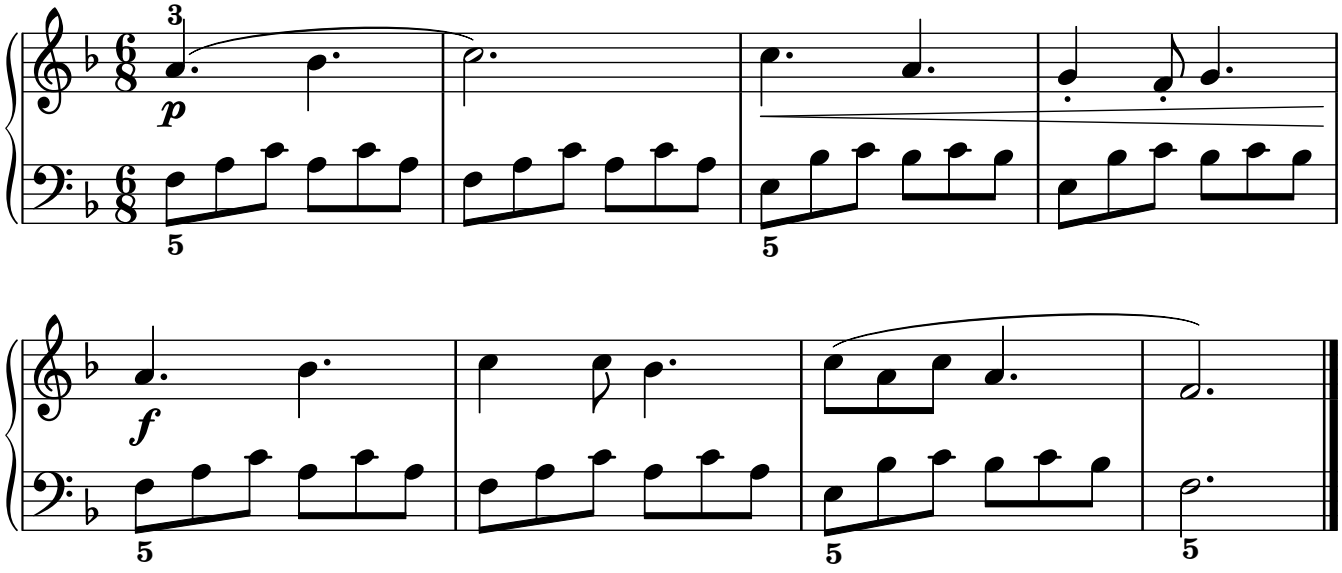
Part D: Rolling eighths in F major ♩. = 46

F major with the rolling pattern: six even eighths in the left hand.

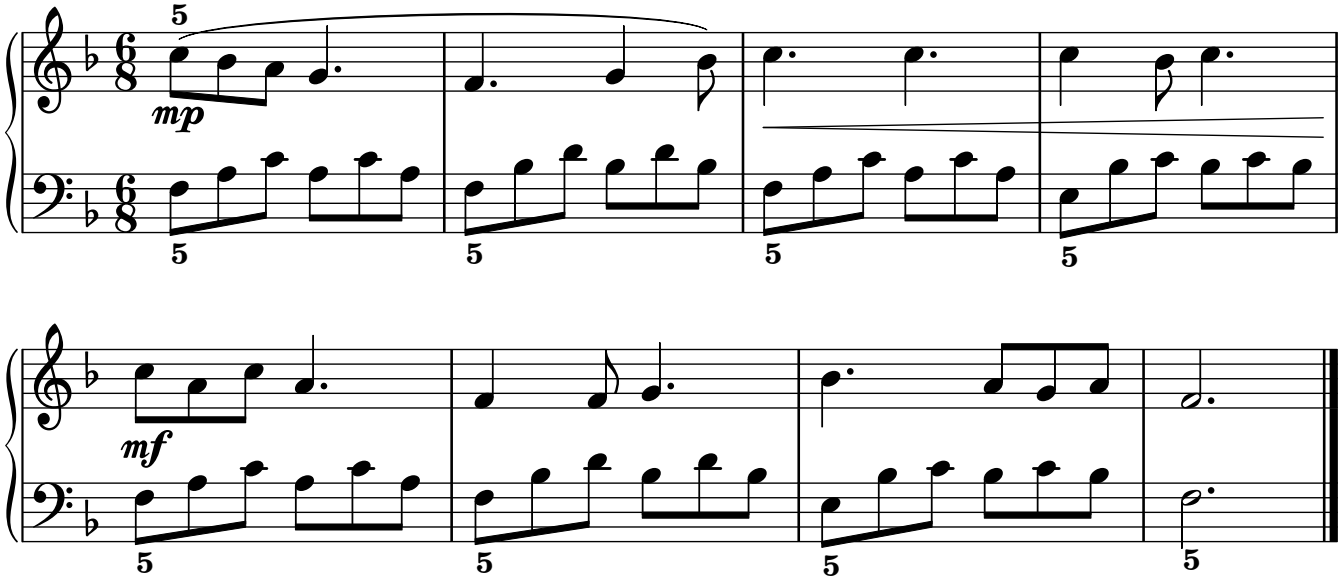
☐ **3.29**
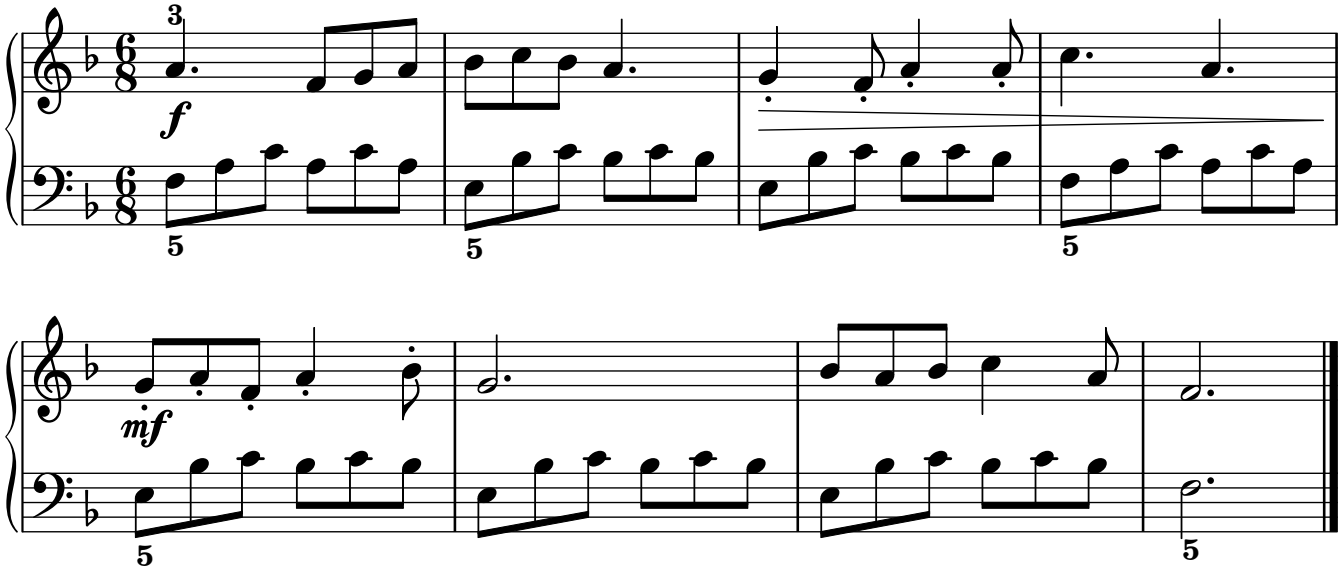


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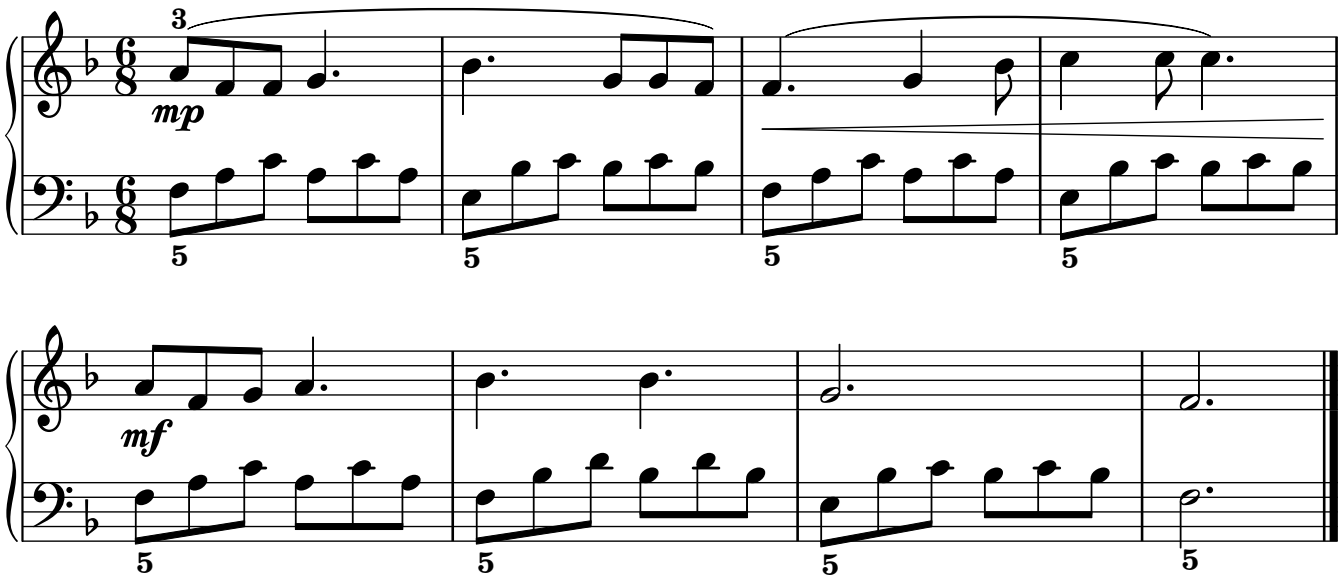


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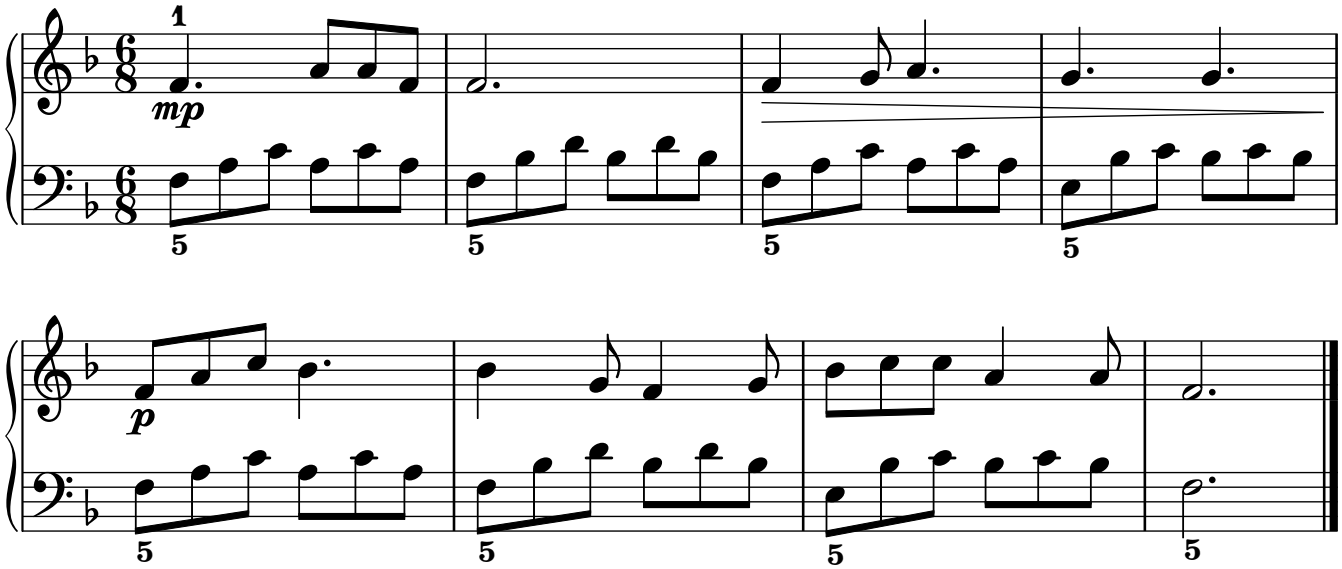


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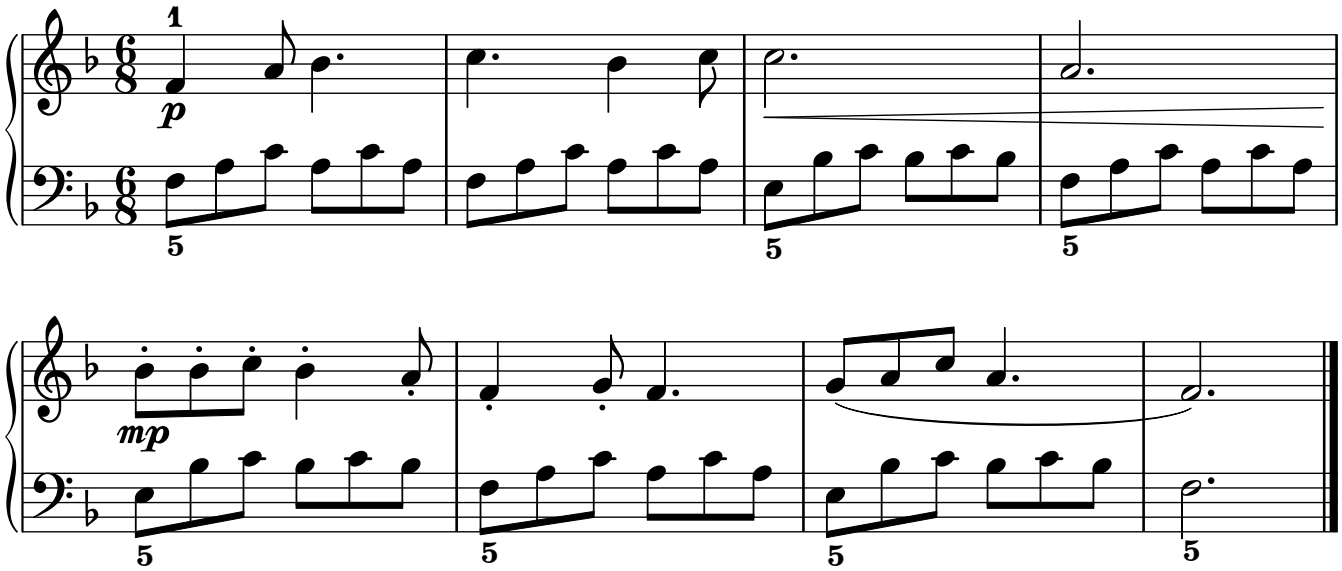


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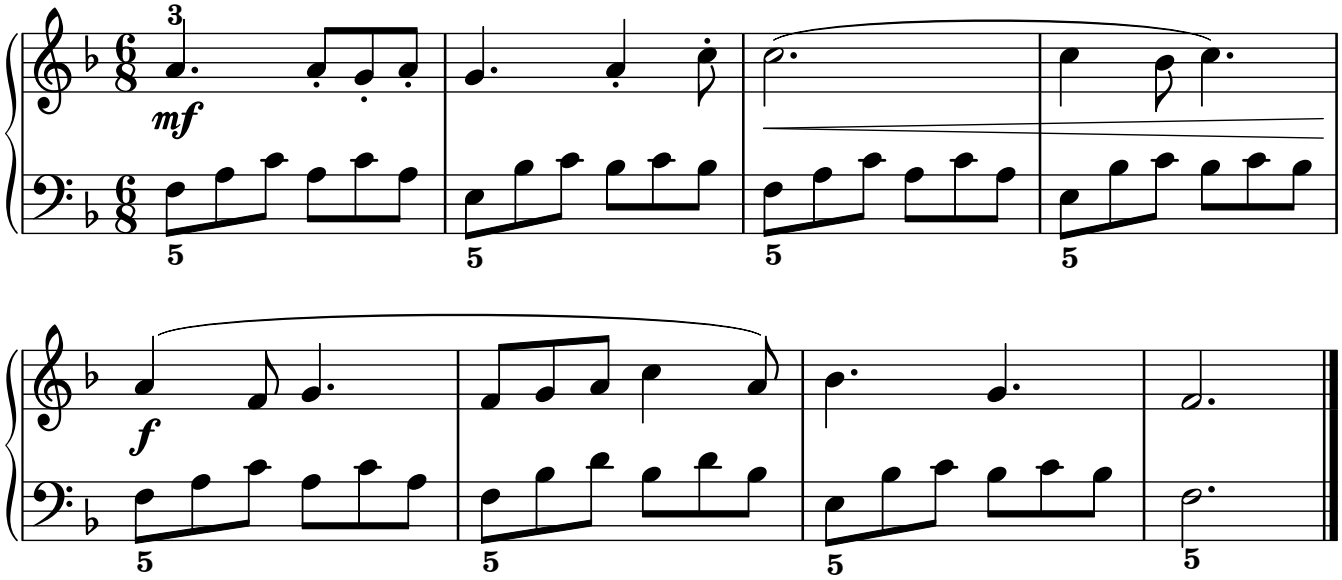


3.34



3.35



3.36



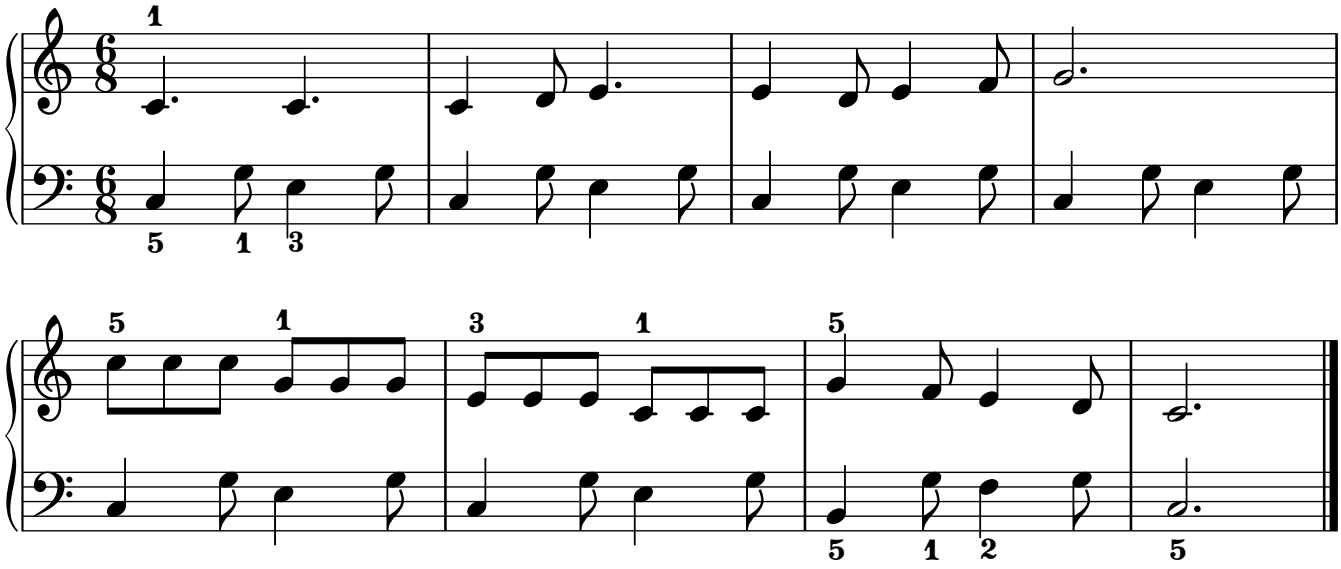
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Row, Row, Row Your Boat ♩. = 56

Traditional song (published 1852)
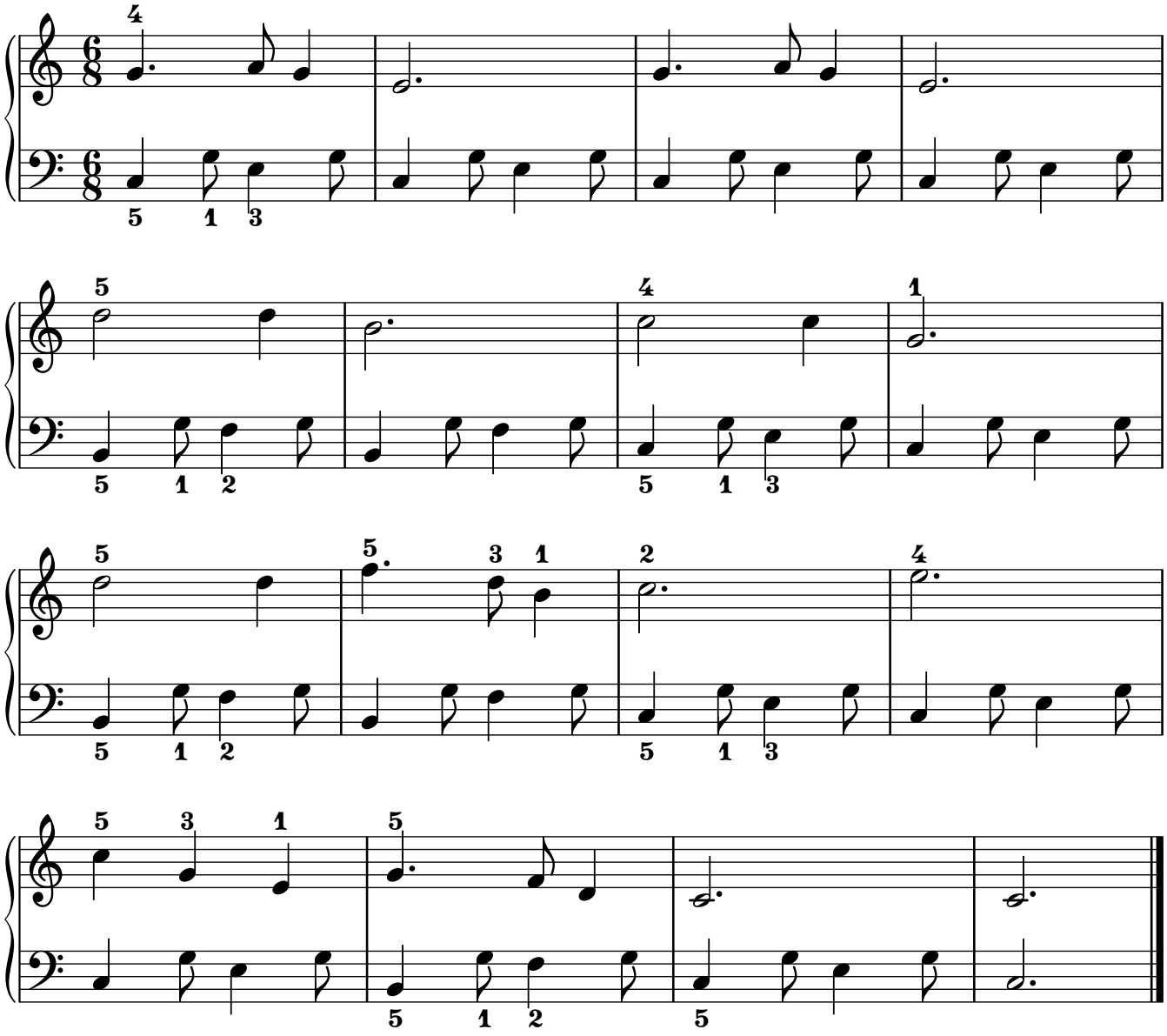
The best-known 6/8 song. In bar 5 the right hand moves up so finger 5 takes high C; in bar 6 it moves back to C position. The left hand lilts on I until the V7 in bar 7. It is also a round: two players can start two bars apart.



Silent Night ♩. = 44

Franz Xaver Gruber (1818) - shortened and simplified

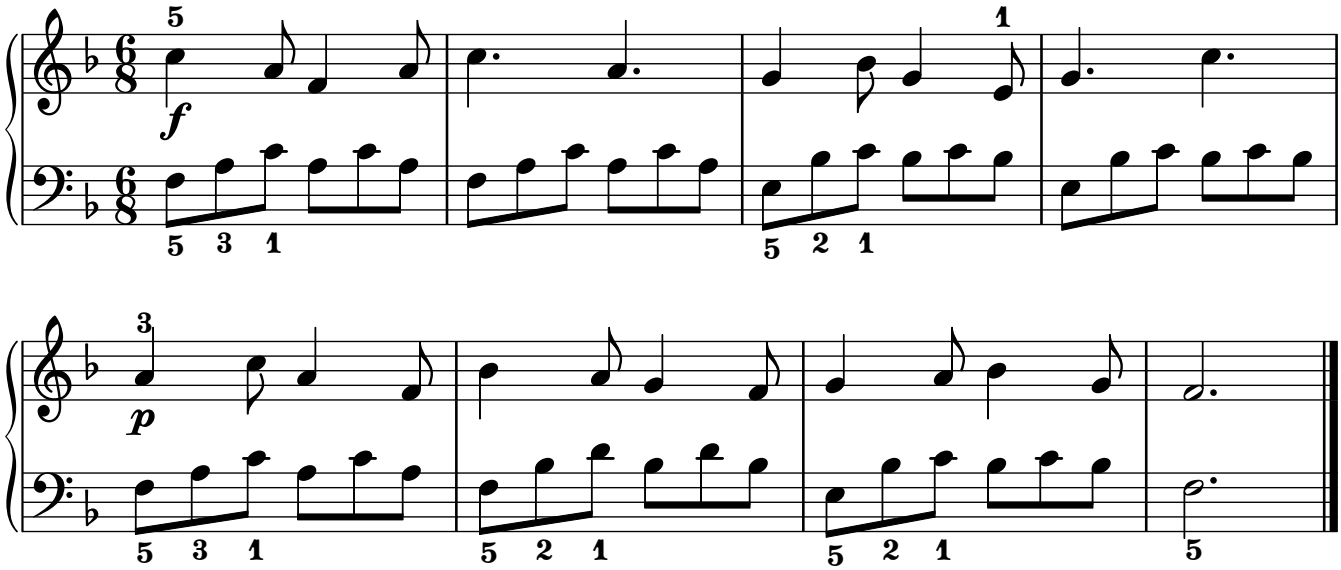
The first eight bars and the last eight bars of the carol. The tune climbs through three hand positions; the finger numbers show each move. The left hand lilts on I and V7.



Hunting Horns ♩. = 52

Original

Loud horn calls, then a soft echo. The left hand plays rolling eighths; in bars 3 and 4 the V7 shape has B-flat in the middle. In bar 3 the right hand stretches finger 1 down to E.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 4?

- Play five new Part C or D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- You can feel two beats in each bar, and the long-short rhythm swings rather than sounding even.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 4.

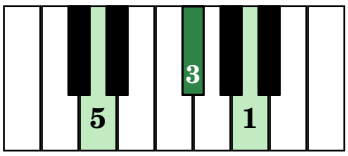
Unit 4

D Major

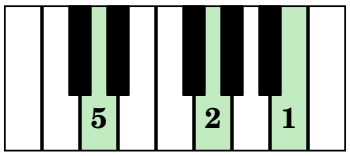
New: Two sharps (F-sharp and C-sharp); D major and its chords

D major has two sharps: F-sharp and C-sharp. You met D position in Volume 1, when only F was sharp. Now the key signature shows both sharps, so every F and every C in the piece is played on a black key.

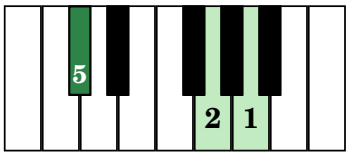
D major: left-hand chord shapes



I = D

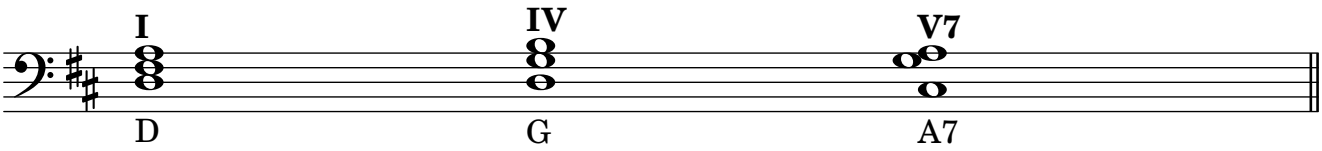


IV = G



V7 = A7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

Two sharps

The key signature of D major has a sharp on the F line and in the C space. The scale is D E F-sharp G A B C-sharp D.

Where C-sharp comes from

In the right hand, C-sharp is the note just below D: stretch the thumb down to it from D position, or play it with finger 3 in A position (A B C-sharp D E).

Chord shapes in D

I is D F-sharp A (5 3 1), IV is D G B (5 2 1) and V7 is C-sharp G A (5 2 1). The V7 shape puts finger 5 on a black key.

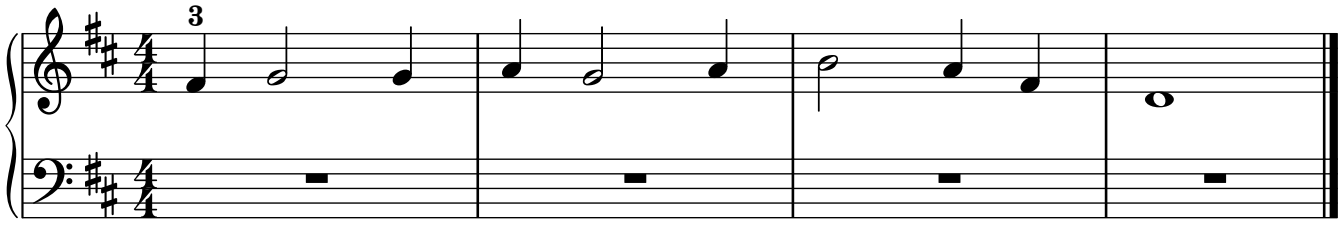
Reading tips

1. Before you play, name the two sharps aloud, and put the fingers that will play them over the black keys.
2. Read C-sharp in the left hand as 'the key below D': it is the bottom note of every V7 shape.
3. If you play a white key by mistake, keep going, and check the key signature at the next line.

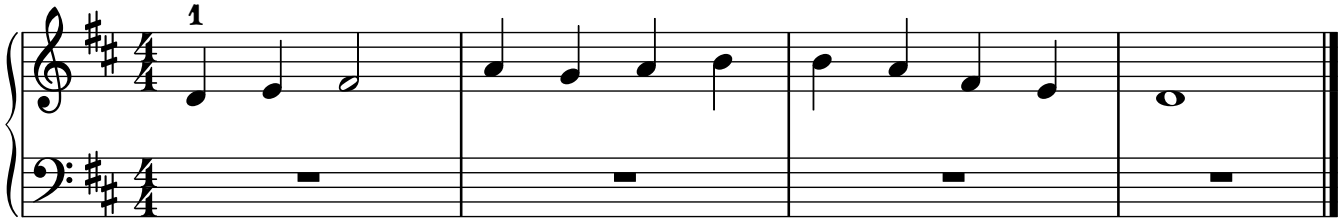
Part A: Right hand in D major ♩= 60

Right hand in D major. The thumb stretches down to C-sharp and finger 5 up to B. Metronome 60.

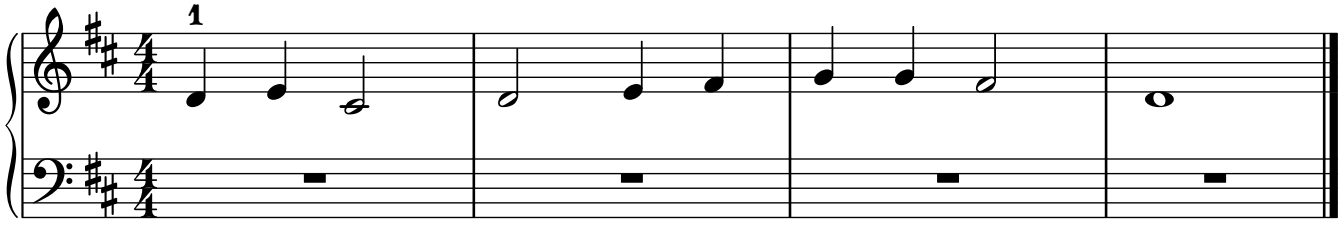
☐ **4.1**



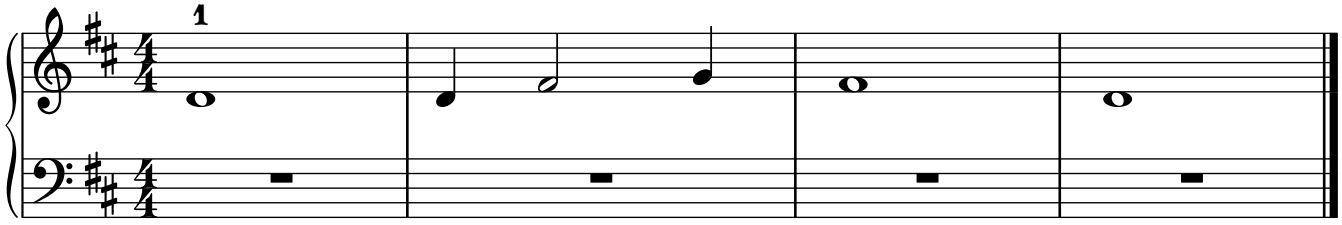
☐ **4.2**



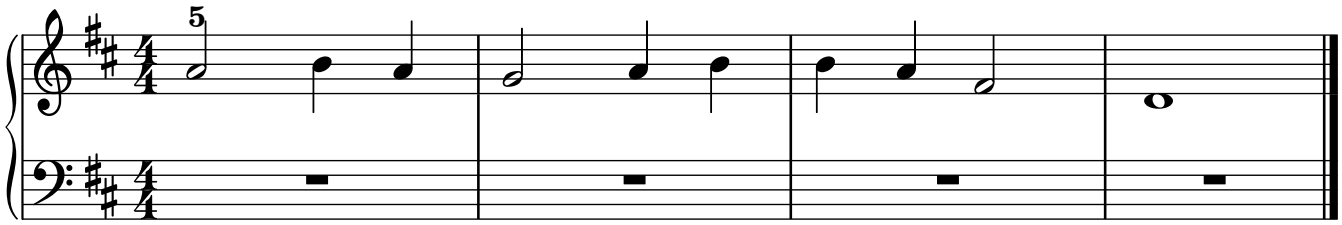
☐ **4.3**



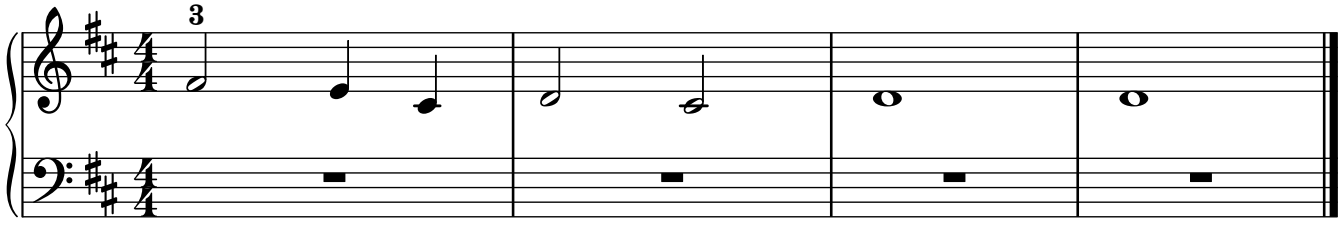
☐ **4.4**



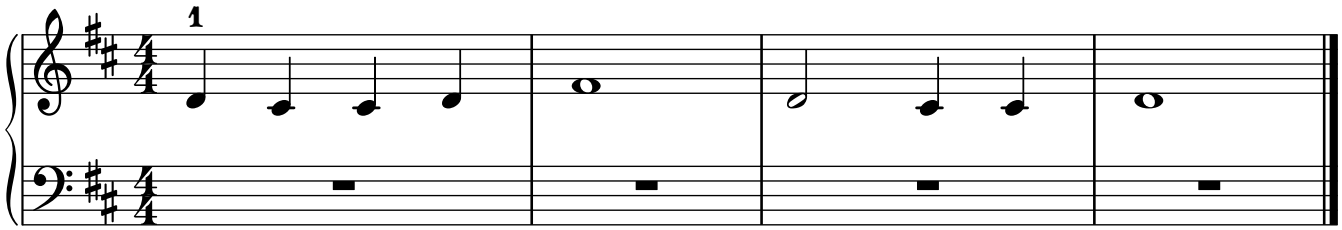
☐ **4.5**



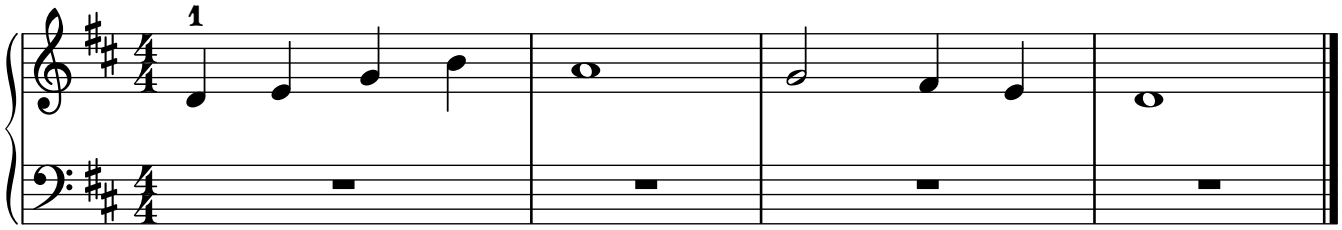
☐ **4.6**



☐ **4.7**
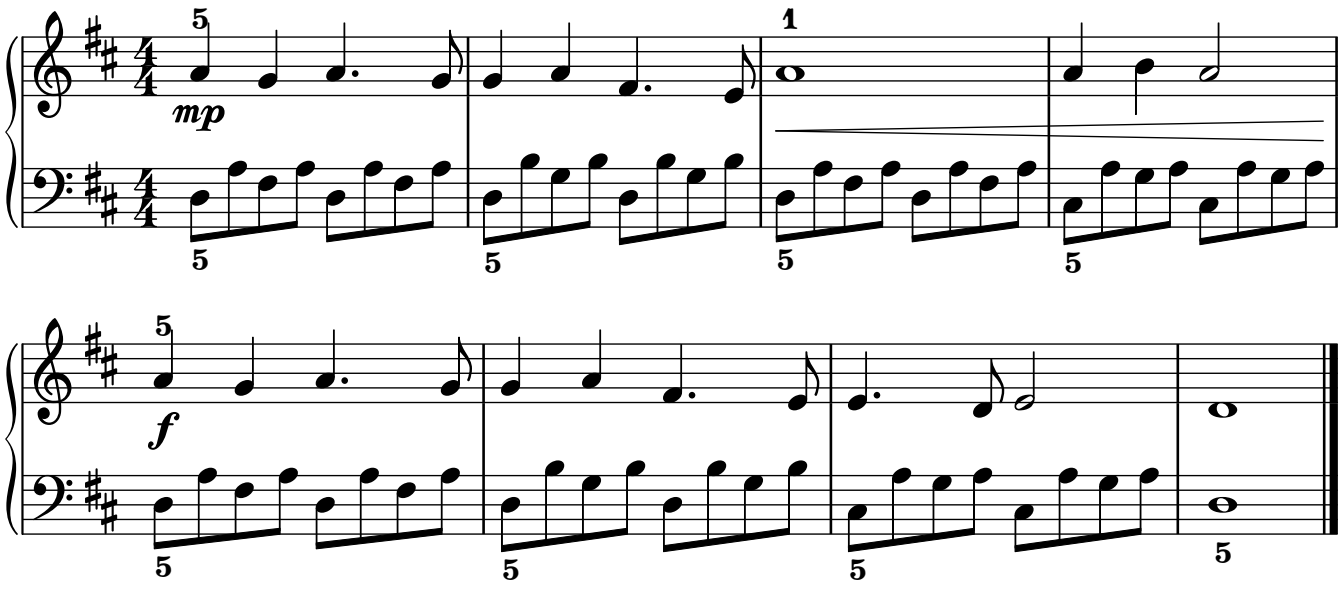


☐ **4.8**
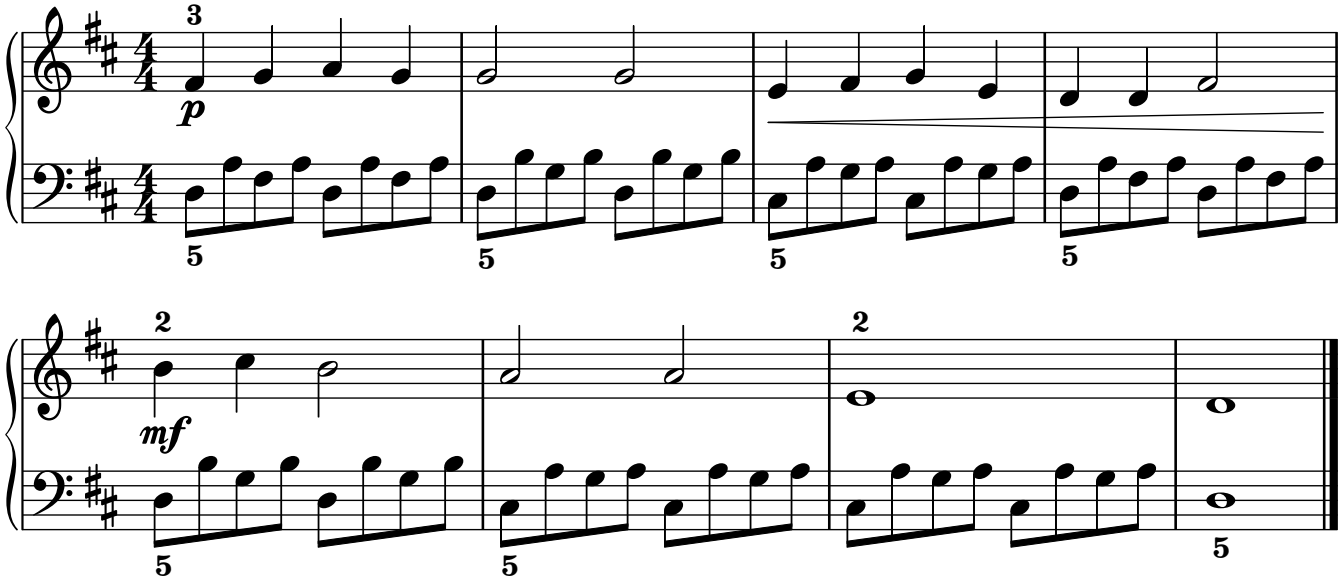


Part B: D major with an Alberti bass ♩ = 60

Alberti bass in D major. The right hand moves between D position and A position.
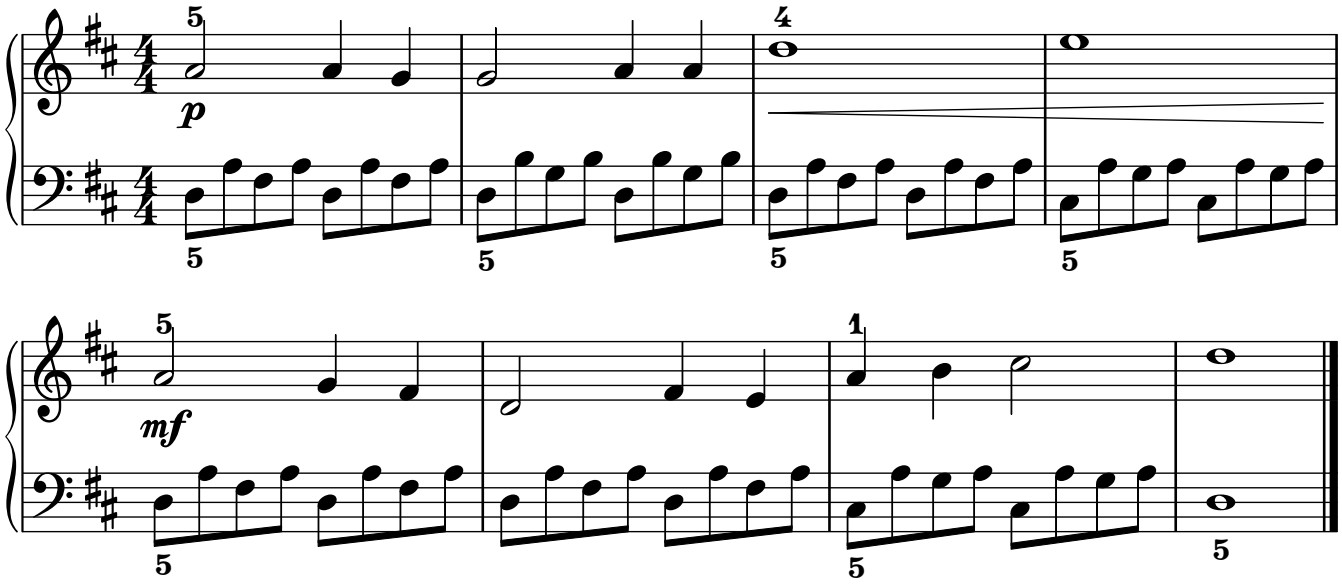
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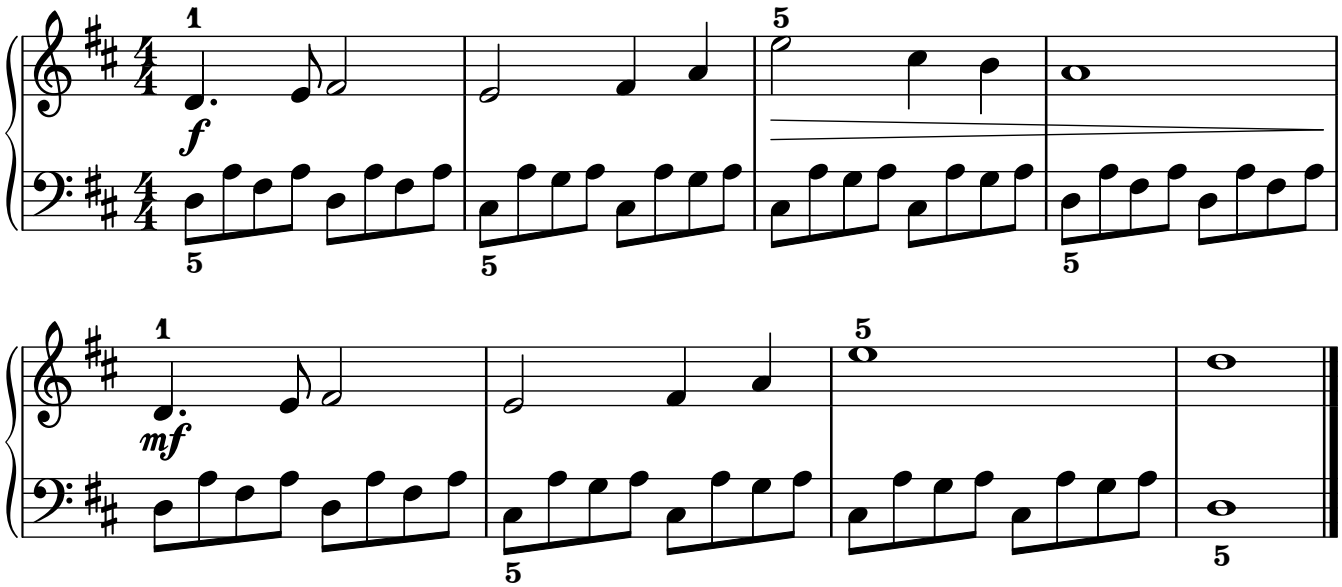


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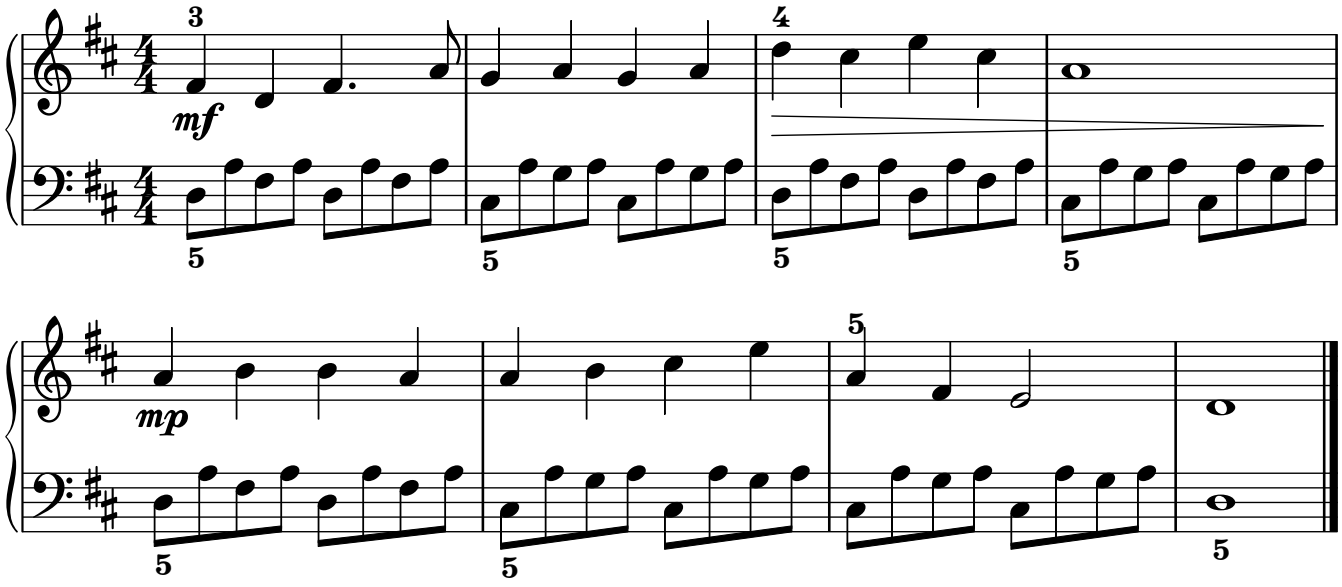


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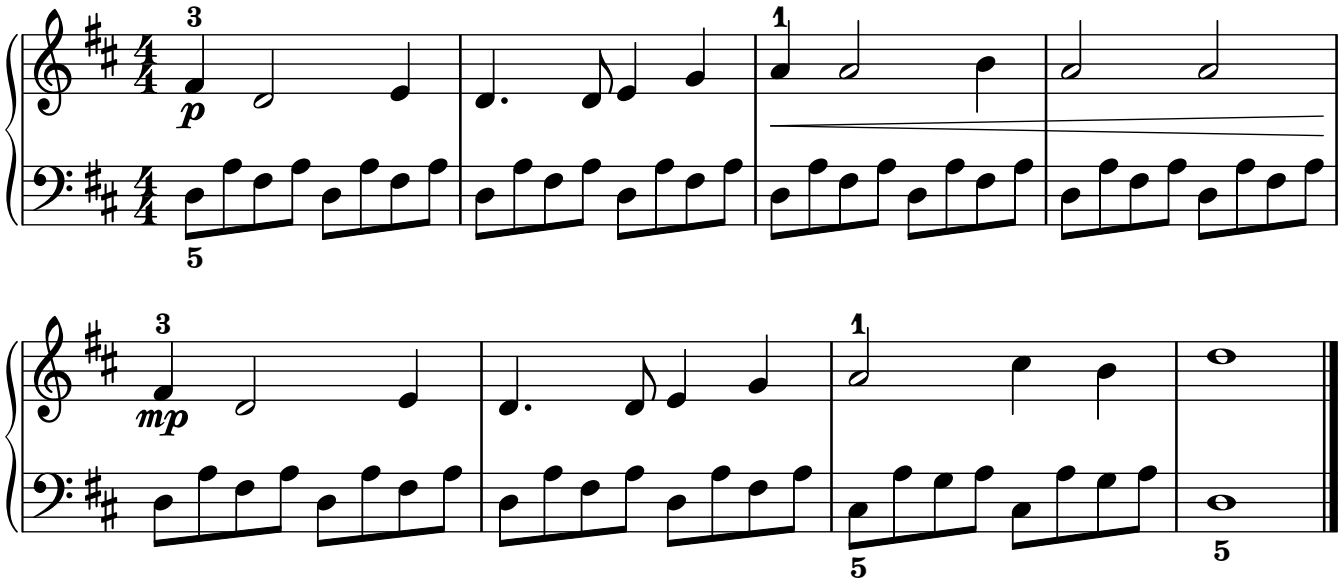
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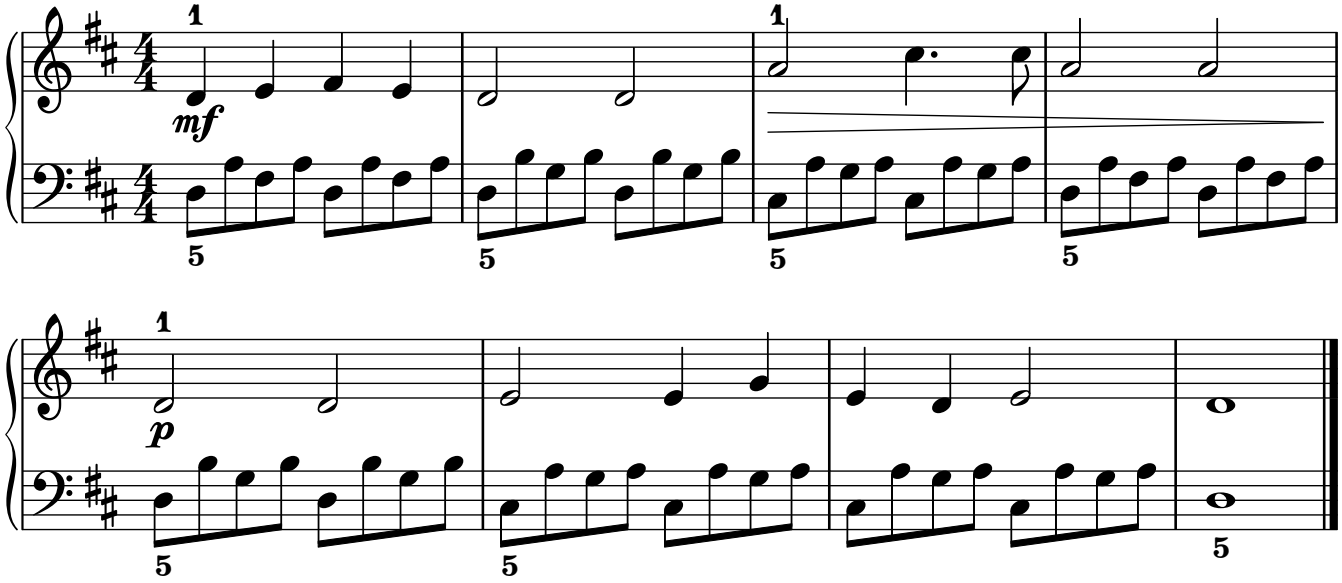


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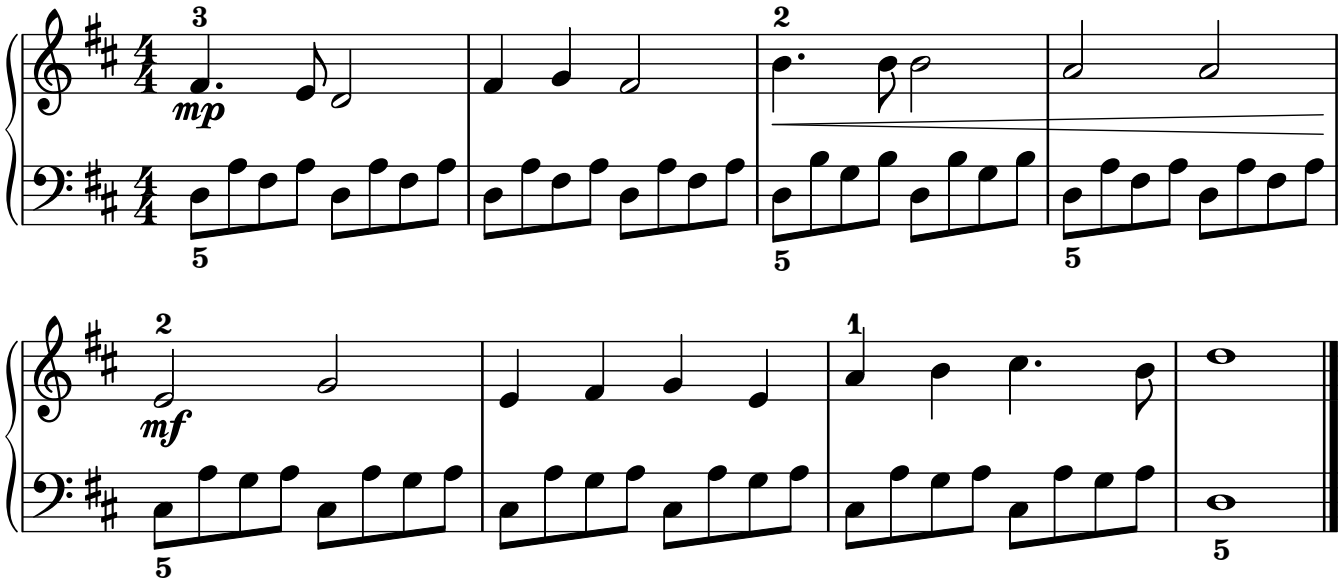


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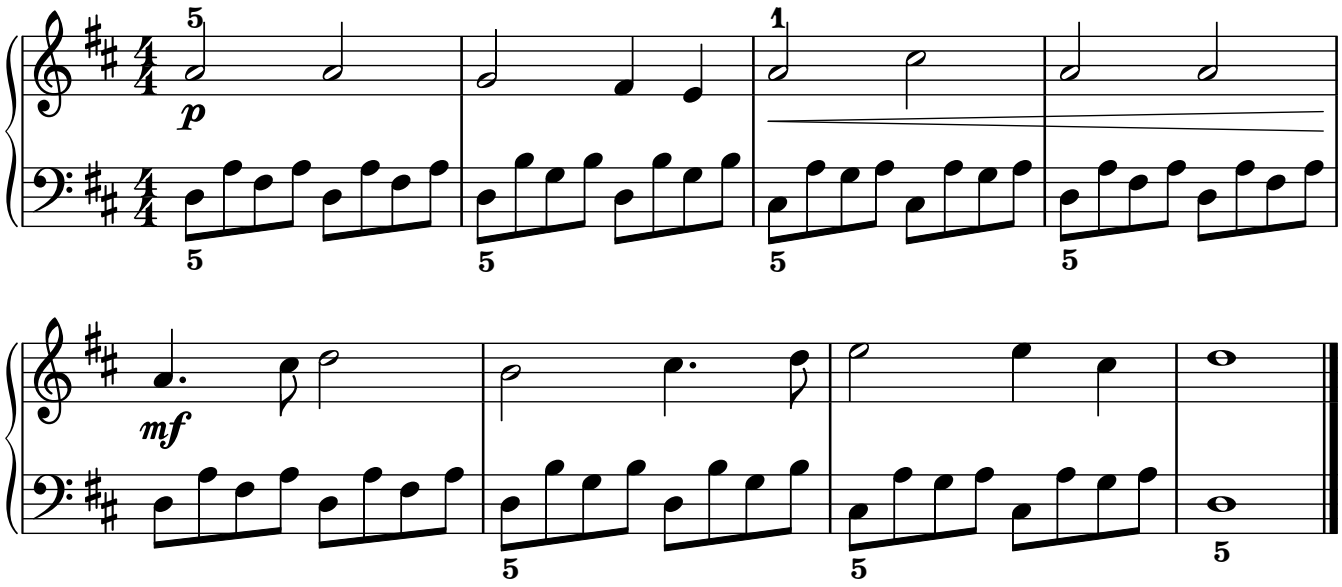


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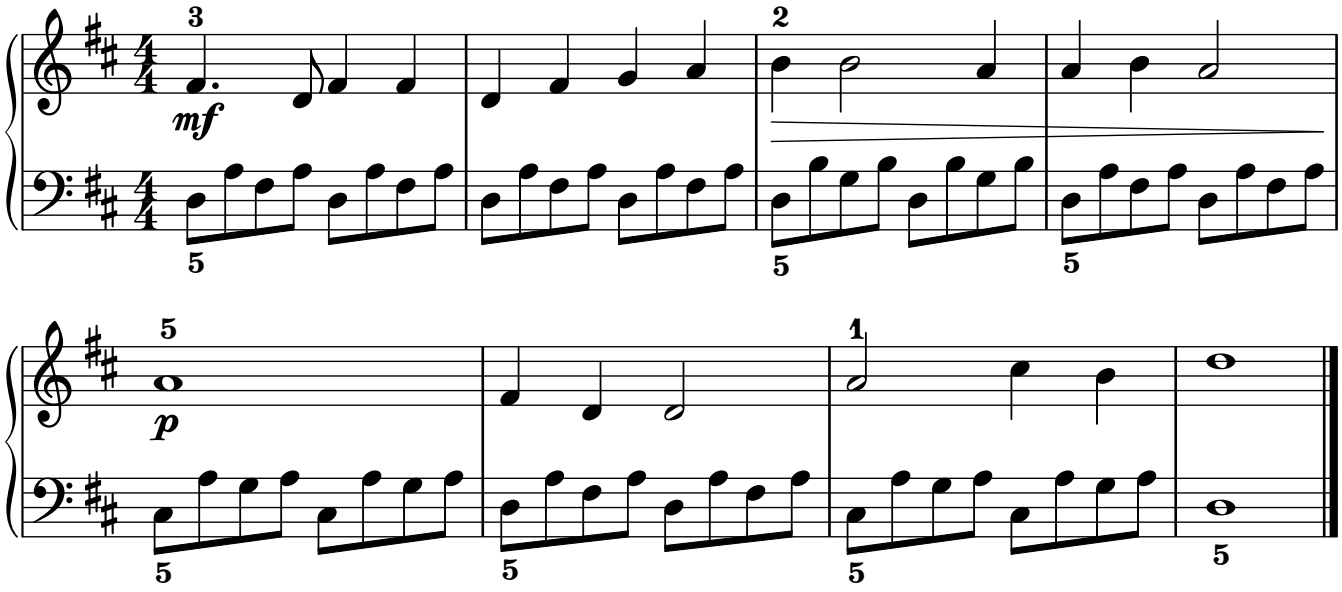


4.16



4.17



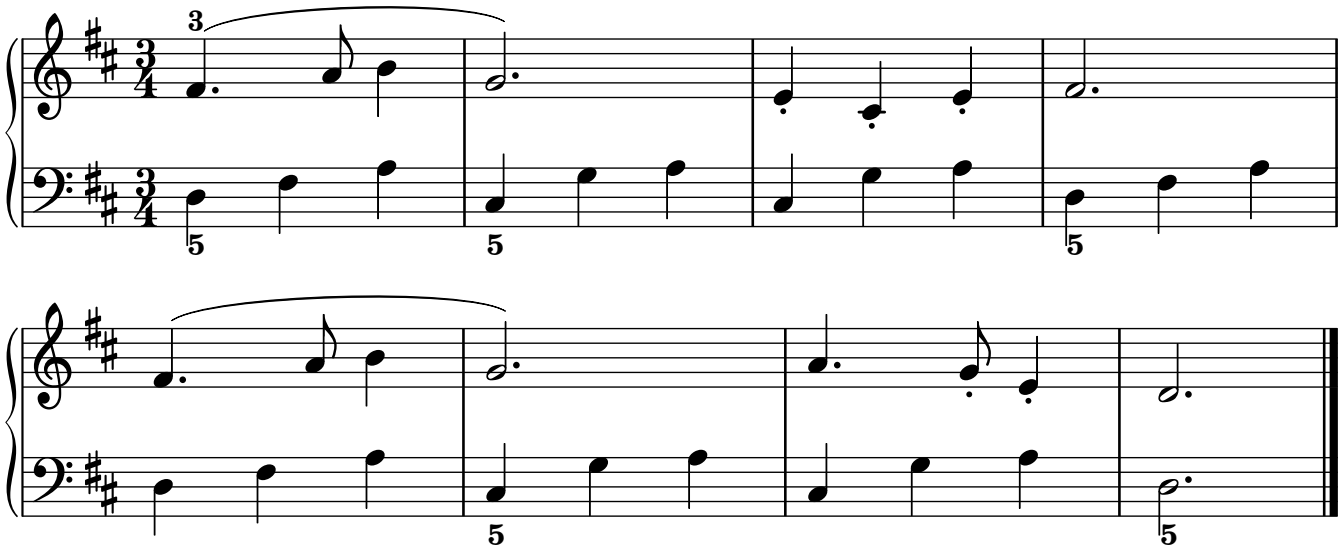
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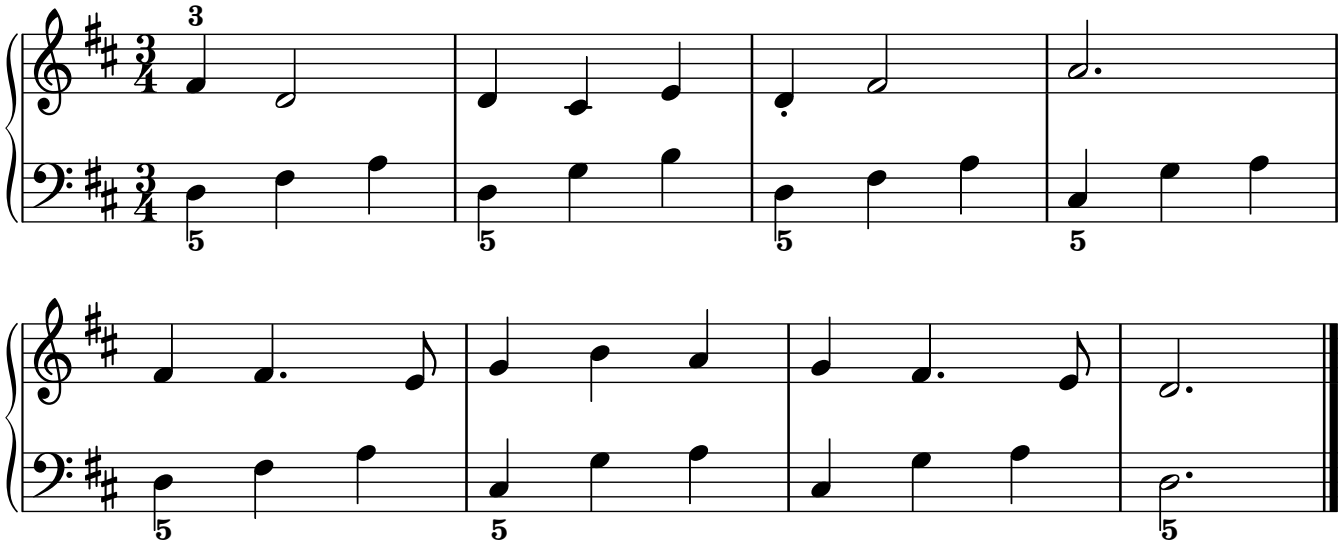
Part C: A waltz in D major ♩ = 72

A waltz in D major, with the broken-chord bass from Unit 1.
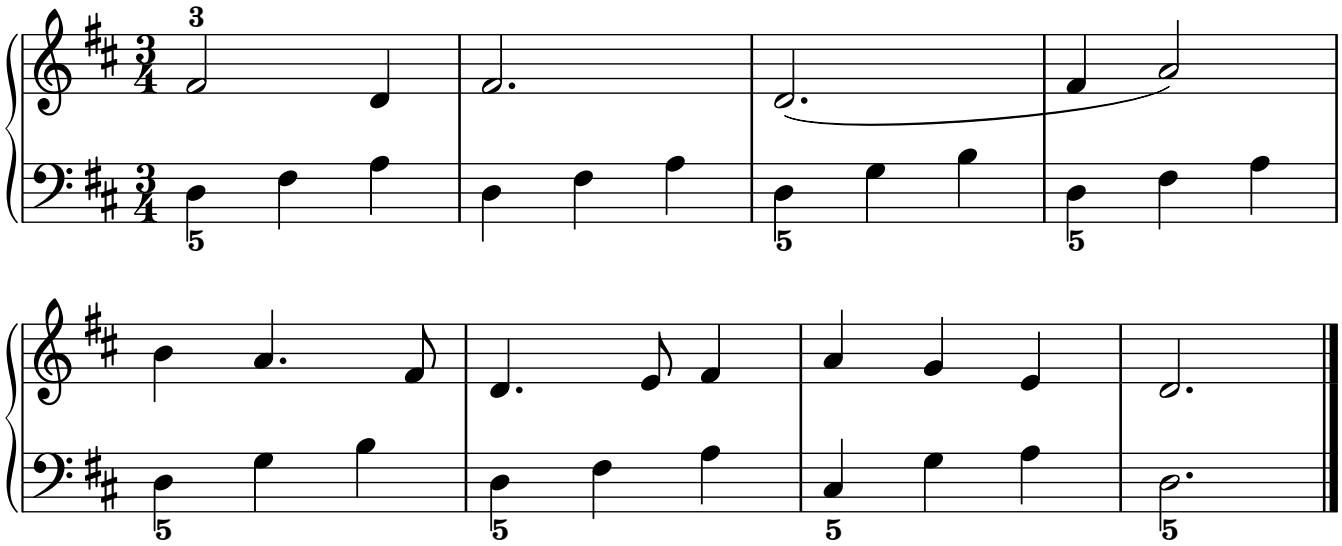
☐ **4.19**



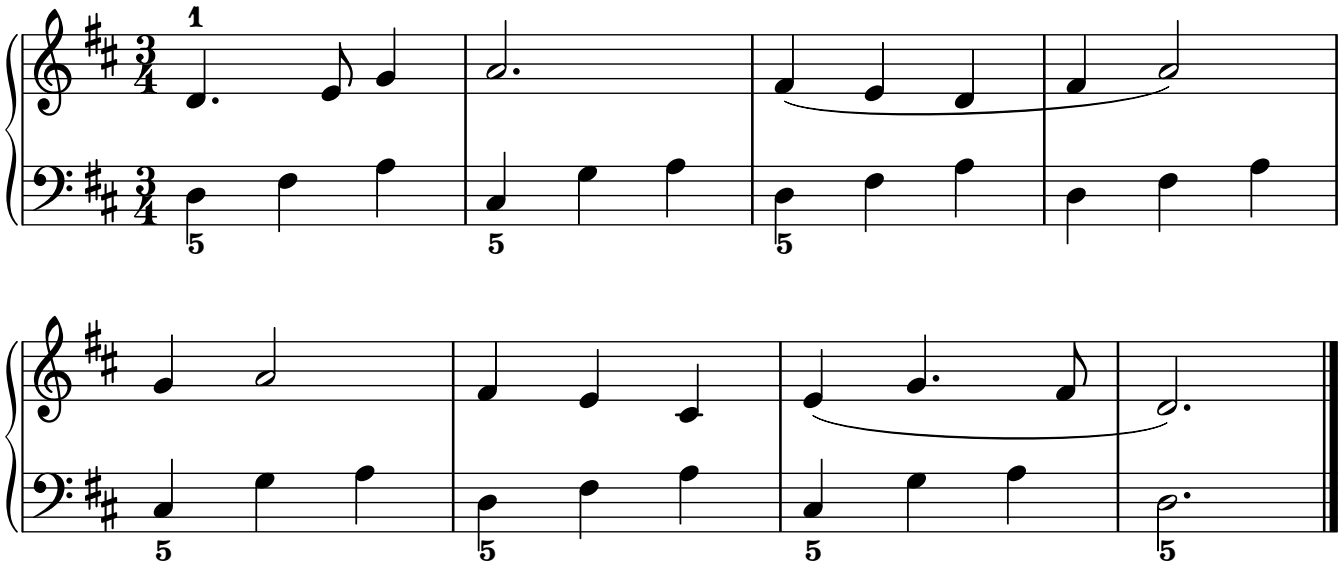
☐ **4.20**



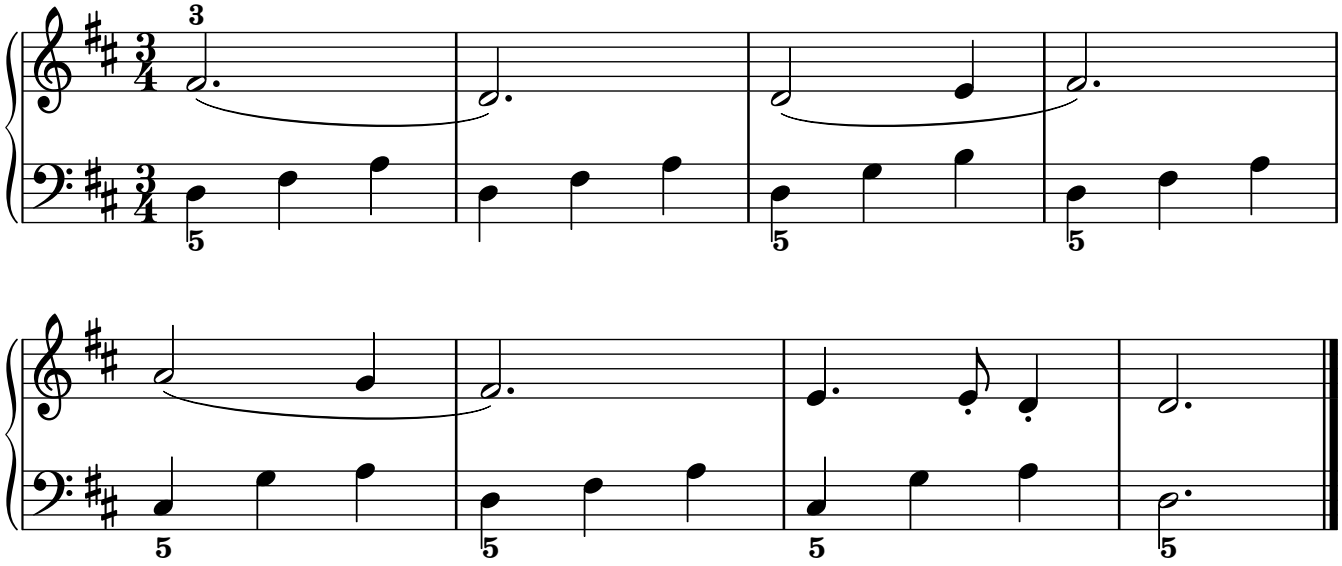
☐ **4.21**



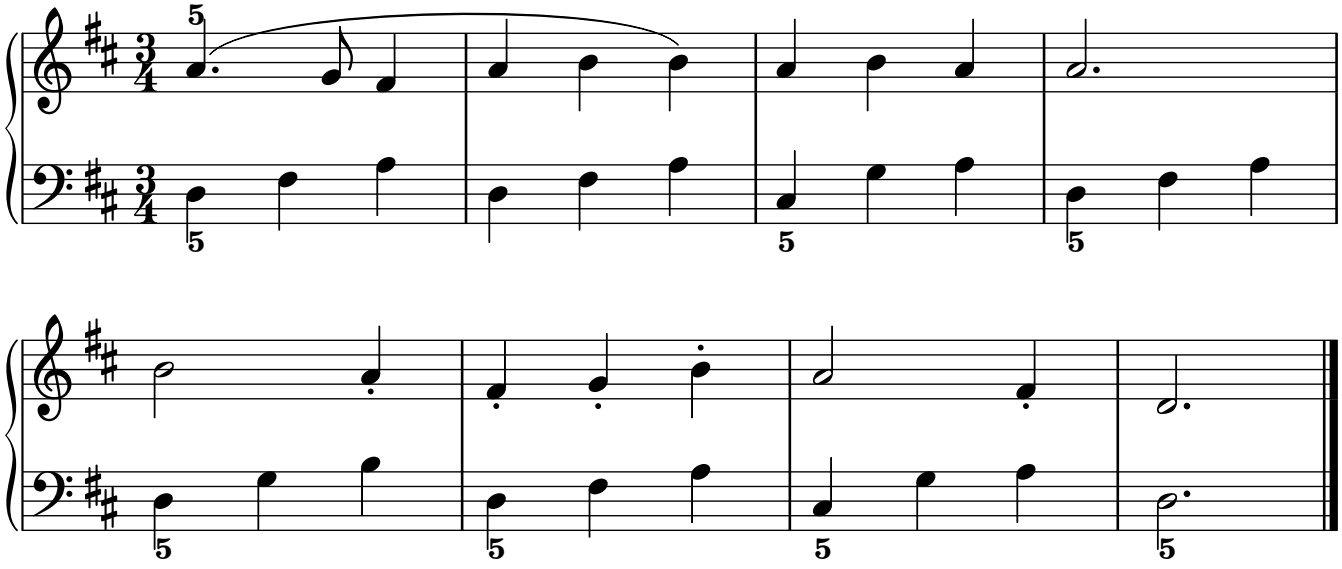
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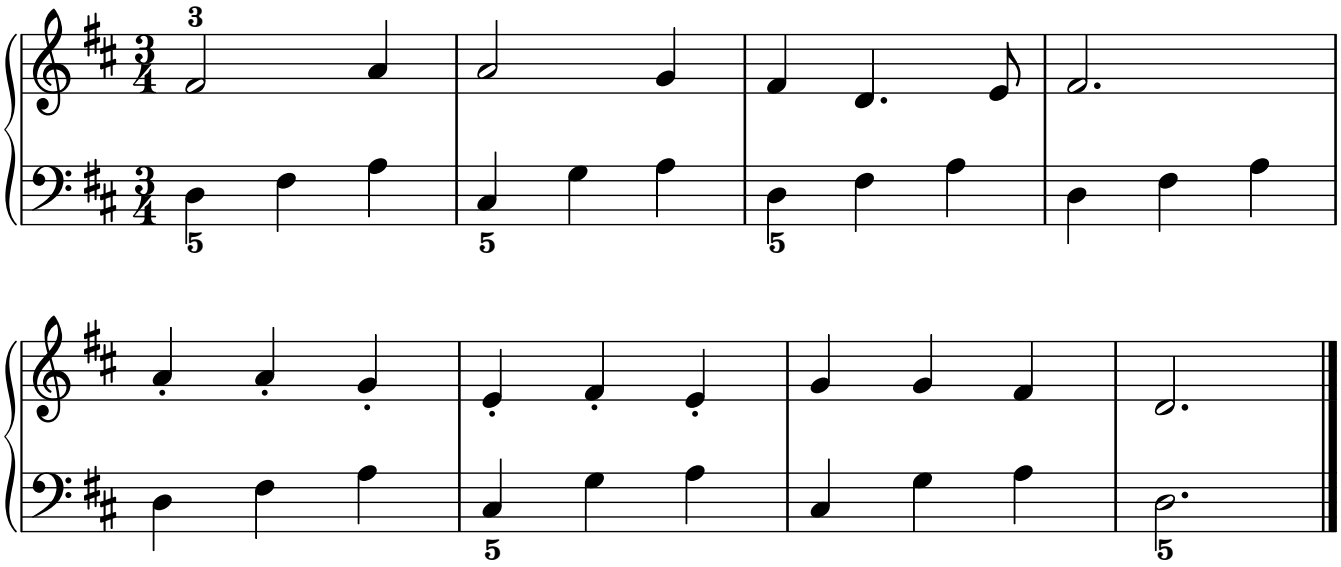
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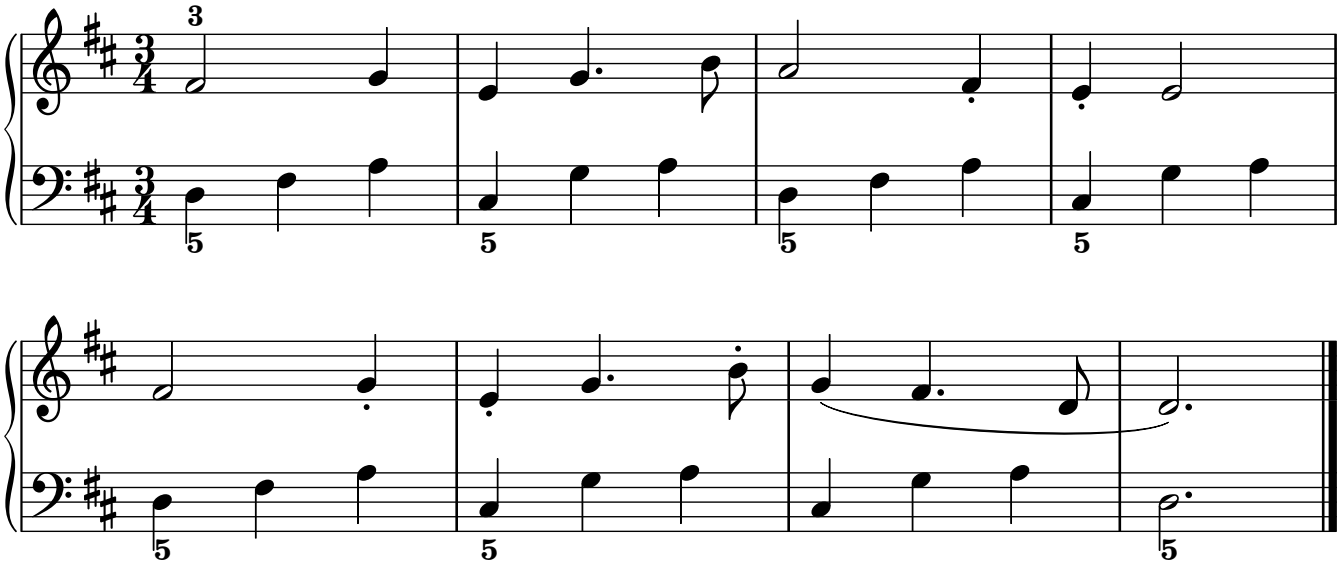
4.24



4.25



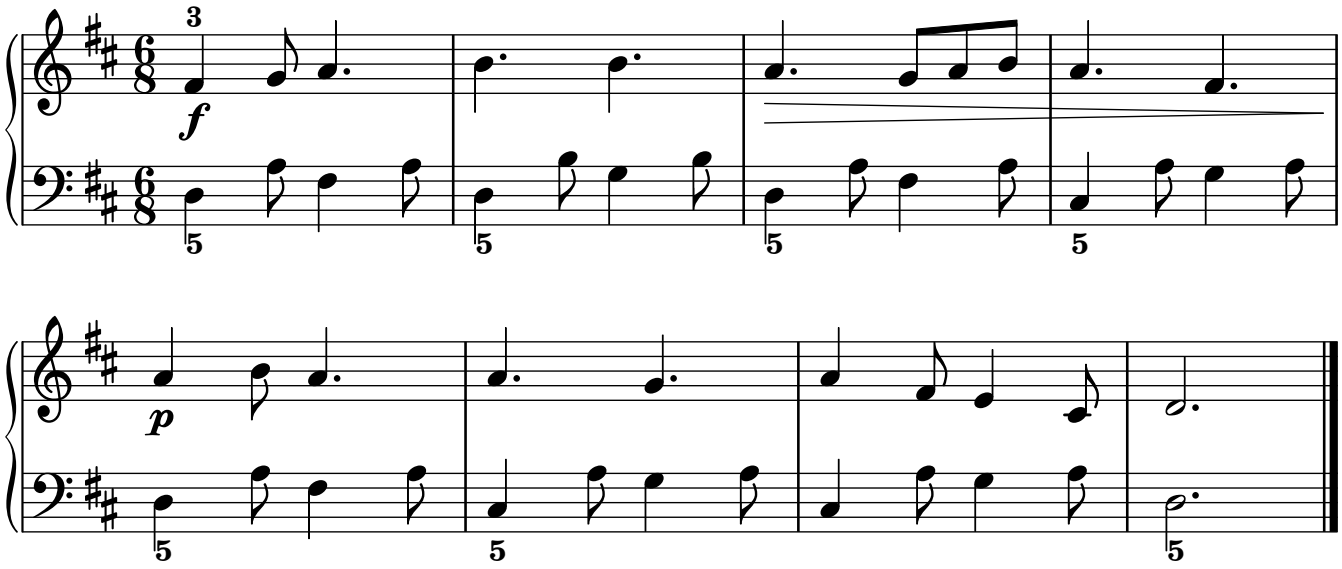
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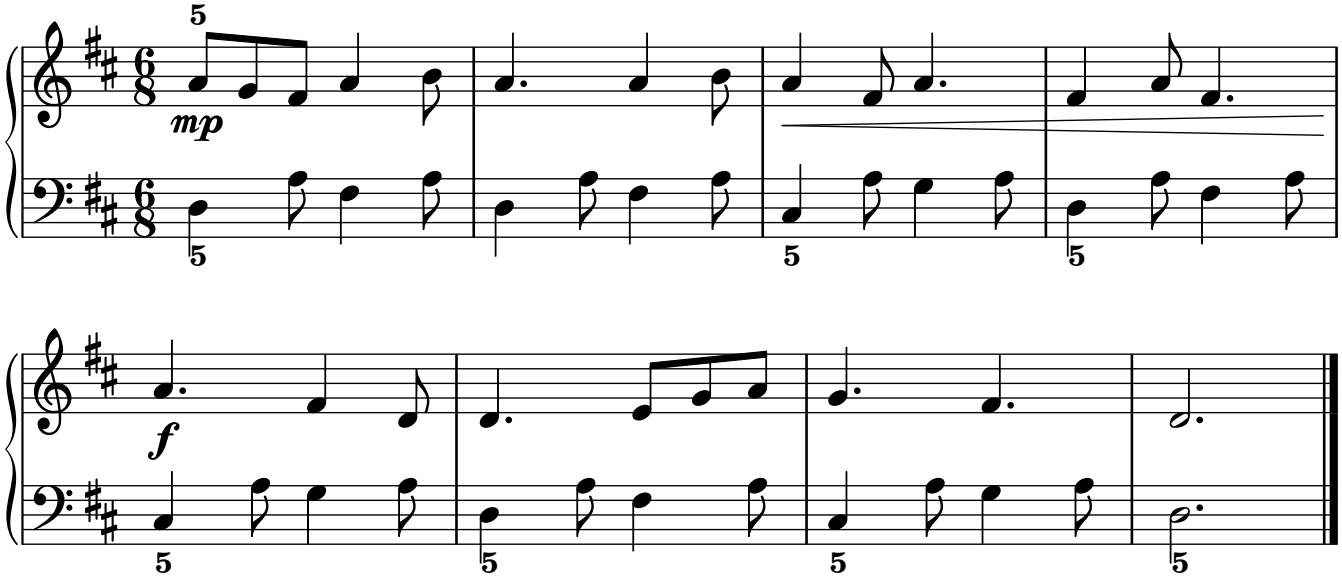


Part D: D major in 6/8 ♩. = 50

D major in 6/8, with the lilting bass from Unit 3.
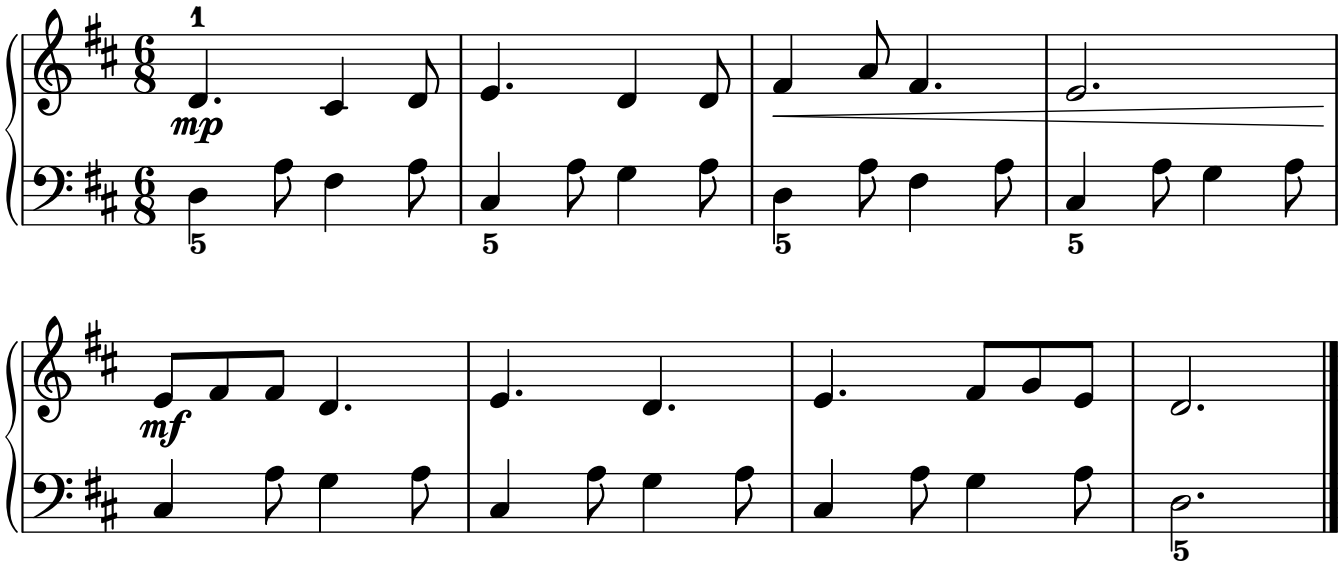
☐ **4.27**



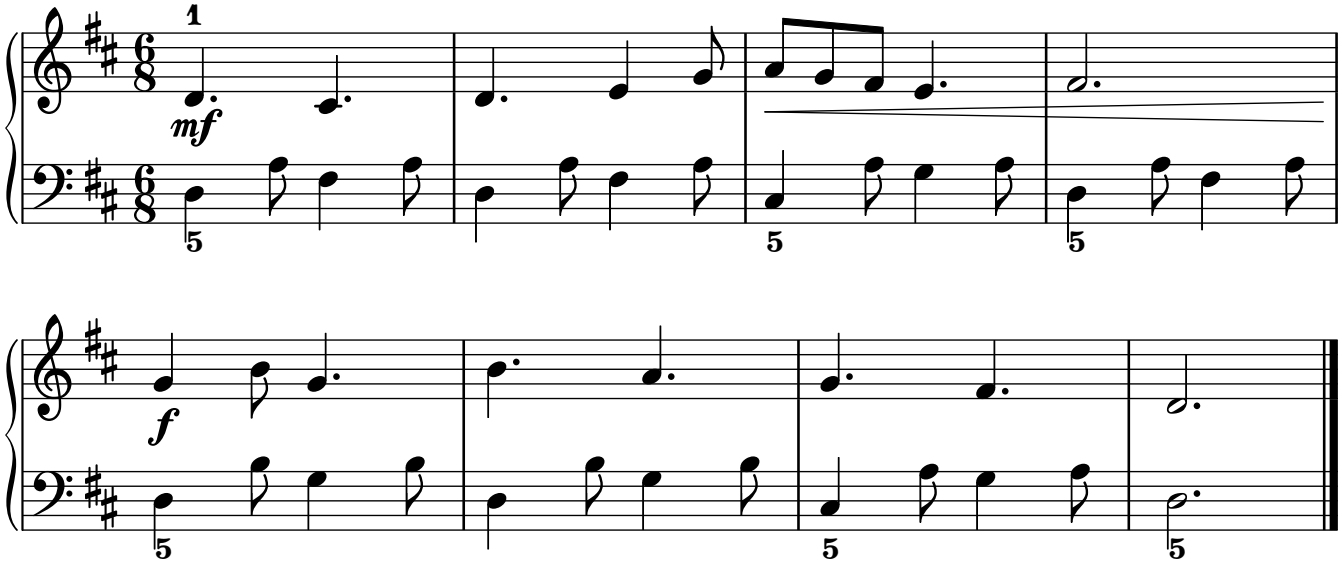
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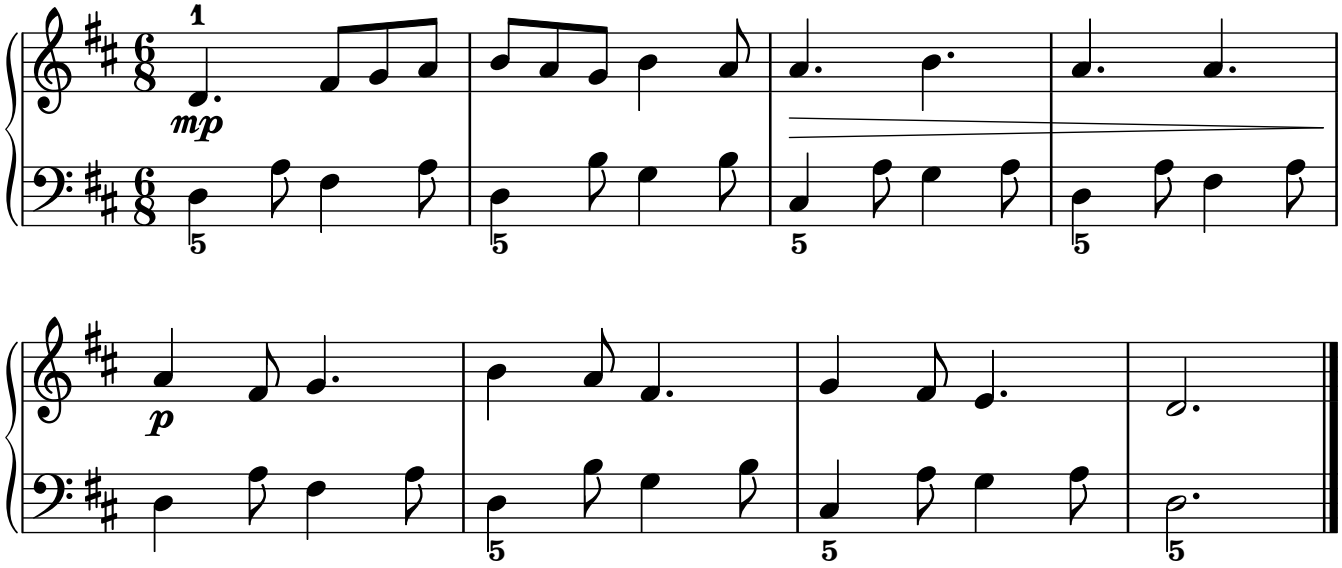


4.29



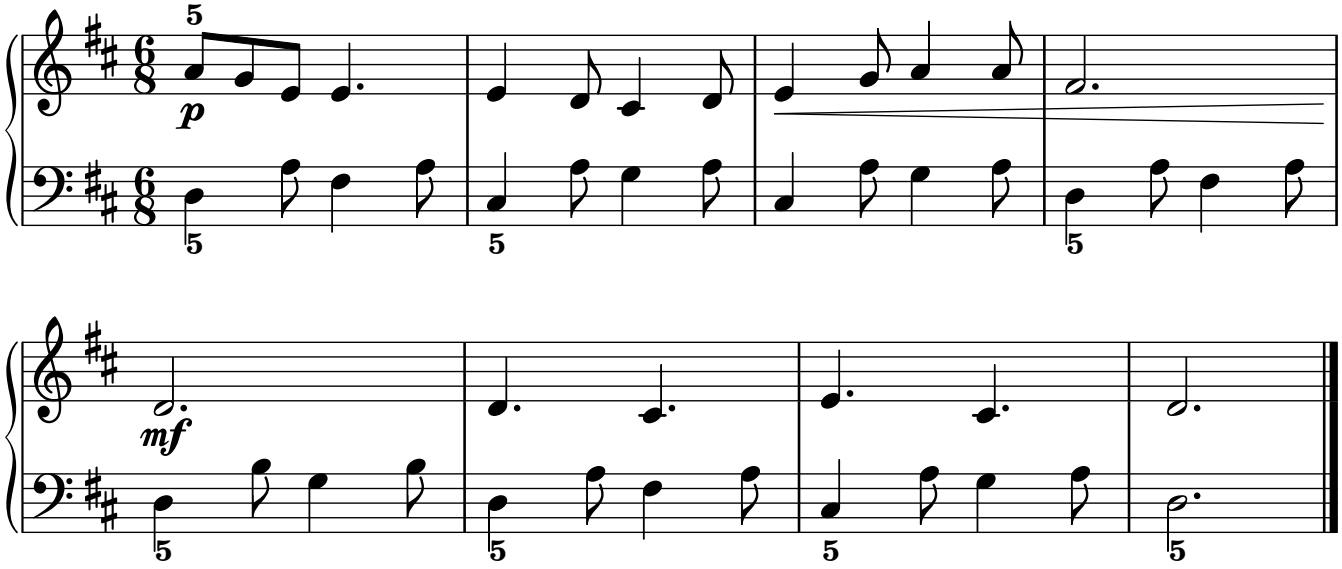
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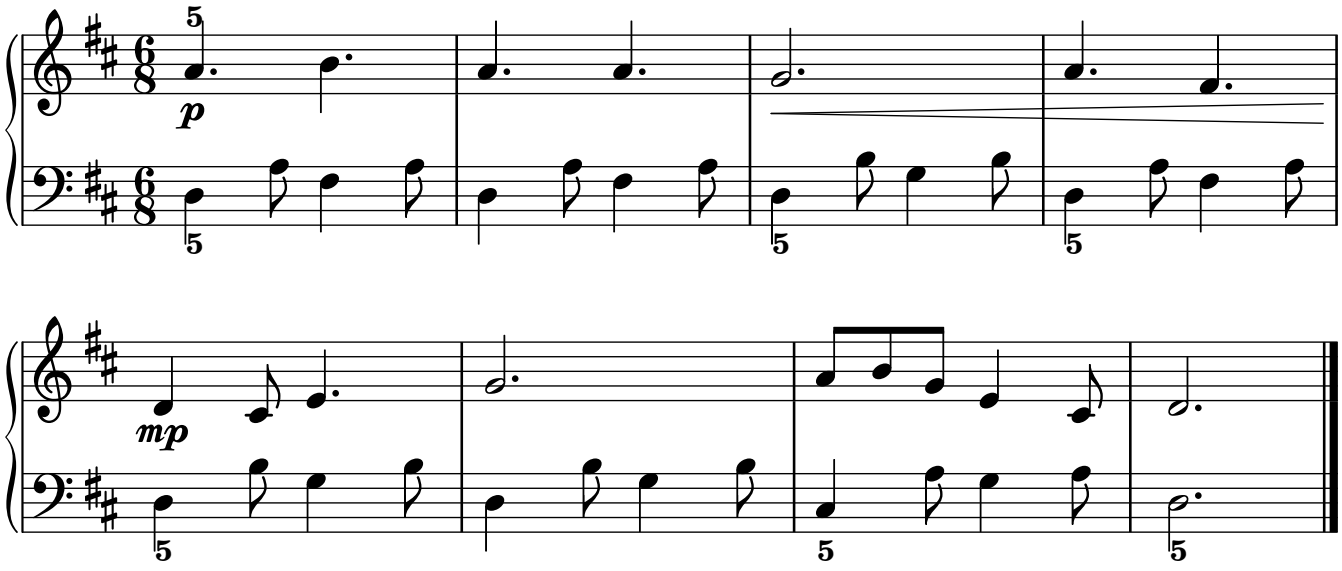


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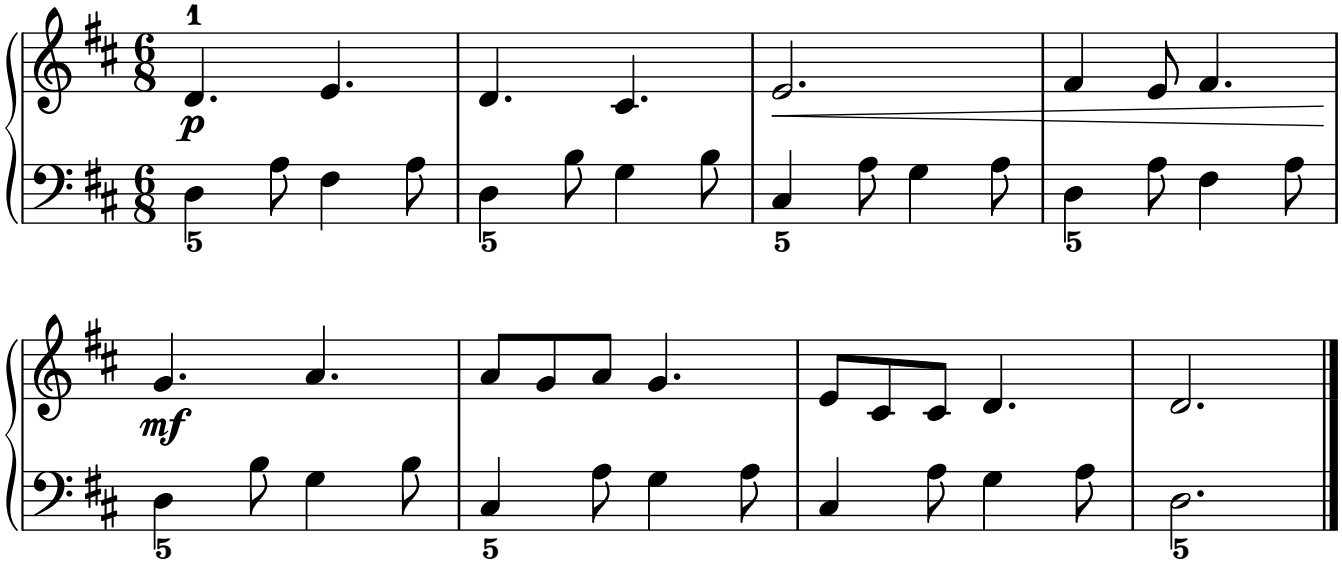


4.32



4.33



4.34
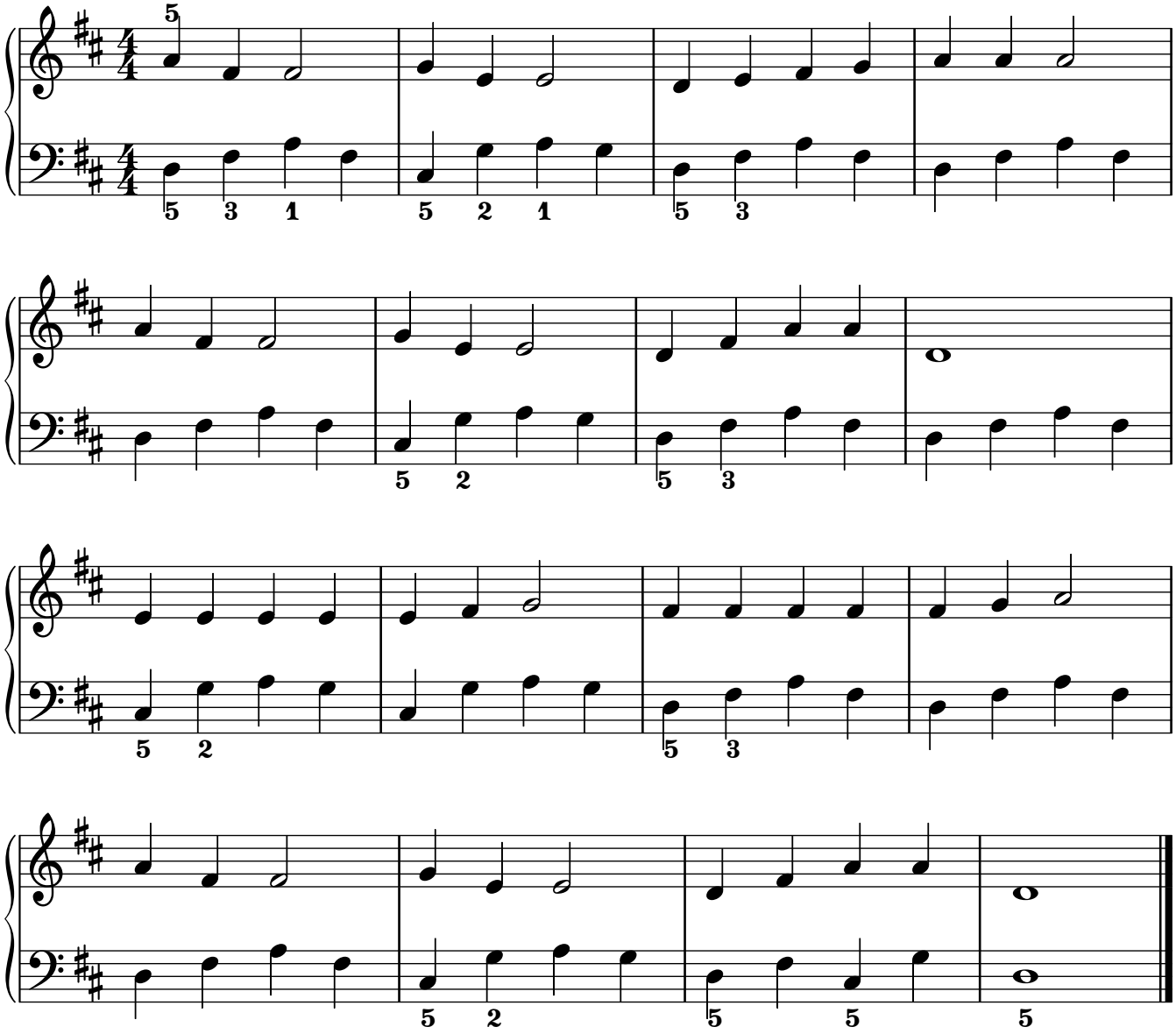


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Lightly Row ♩= 88

Traditional German folk song ('Hänschen klein')

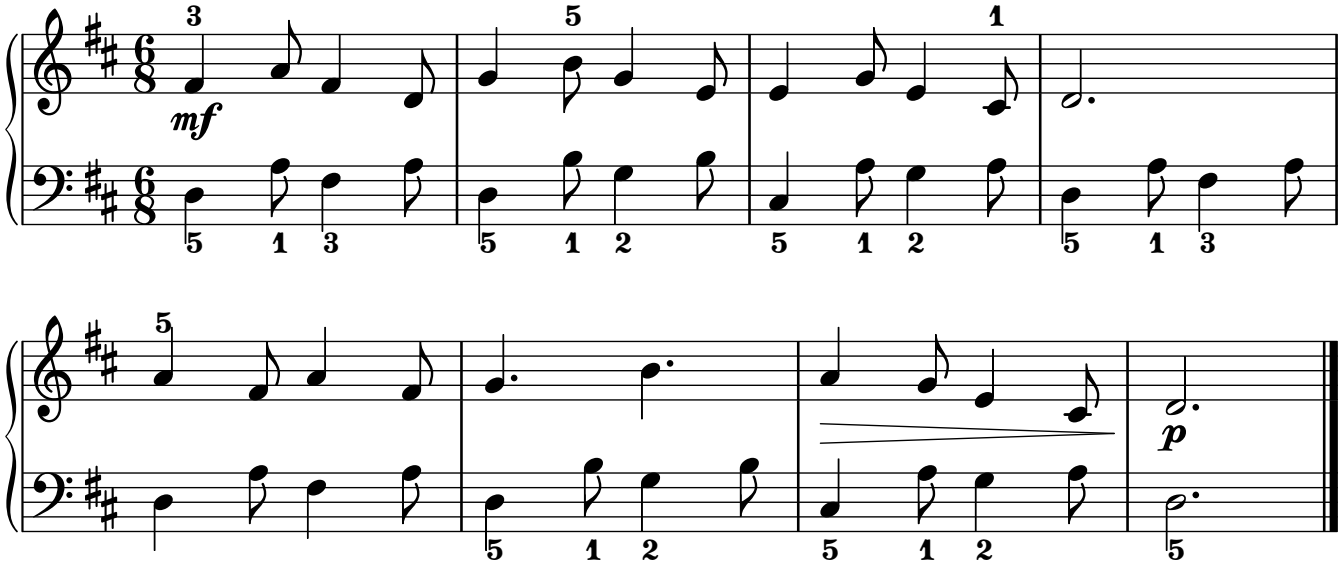
A folk song in D major. The right hand stays in D position all the way through. In bar 15 the left hand changes from I to V7 halfway through the bar.



Country Dance in D ♩. = 60

Original
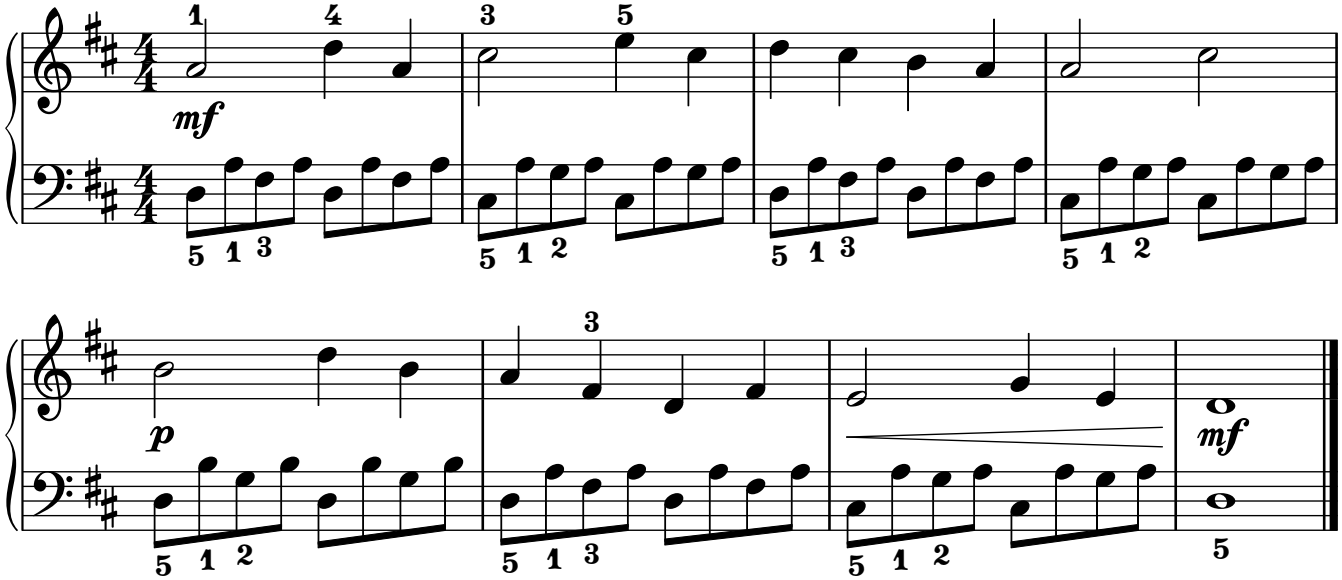
A 6/8 dance with the lilting bass. In bars 3 and 7 the right-hand thumb stretches down to C-sharp, which leads up to D.



Bells in D ♩ = 72

Original

The right hand starts in A position, where finger 3 plays C-sharp, and moves down to D position in bar 6. The left hand plays an Alberti bass.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 5?

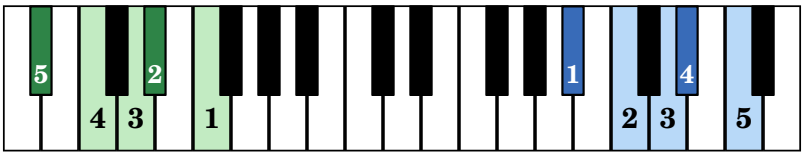
- Play five new Part B or D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every F and C is sharp, in both hands, without stopping to think.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 5.

Unit 5

B-flat Major

New: Two flats (B-flat and E-flat); B-flat major and its chords

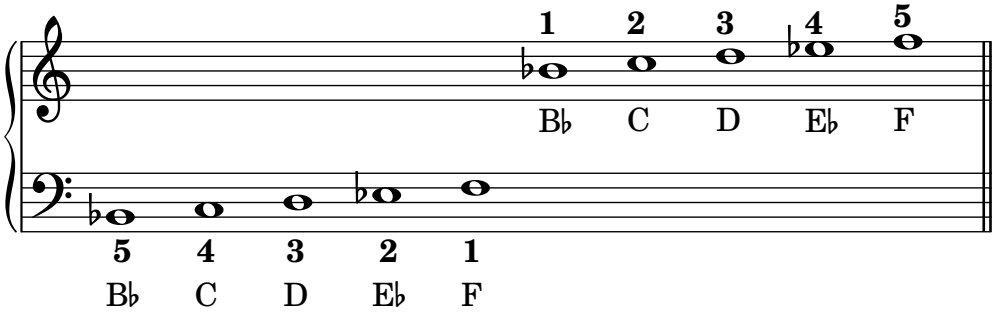
B-flat major has two flats: B-flat and E-flat. Its home note is a black key, so both hands start with the thumb or finger 5 on B-flat. It feels strange for a day or two, and then very comfortable, because the hand sits a little further into the keys.



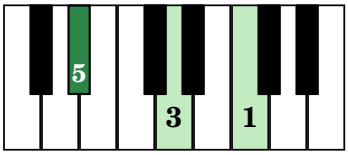
Middle C

Left hand B-flat position and Right hand B-flat position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

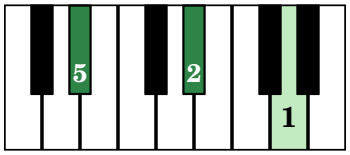
Your notes



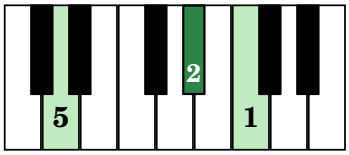
B-flat major: left-hand chord shapes



I = B♭



IV = E♭



V7 = F7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

Two flats

The key signature has a flat on the B line and in the E space. The scale is B-flat C D E-flat F G A B-flat.

B-flat position

Right hand: B-flat (1) C (2) D (3) E-flat (4) F (5). Left hand: B-flat (5) C (4) D (3) E-flat (2) F (1). Two of the five keys are black.

Chord shapes in B-flat

I is B-flat D F (5 3 1), IV is B-flat E-flat G (5 2 1) and V7 is A E-flat F (5 2 1).

Reading tips

1. Put the thumb (right hand) or finger 5 (left hand) on B-flat before you start, and check where E-flat is.

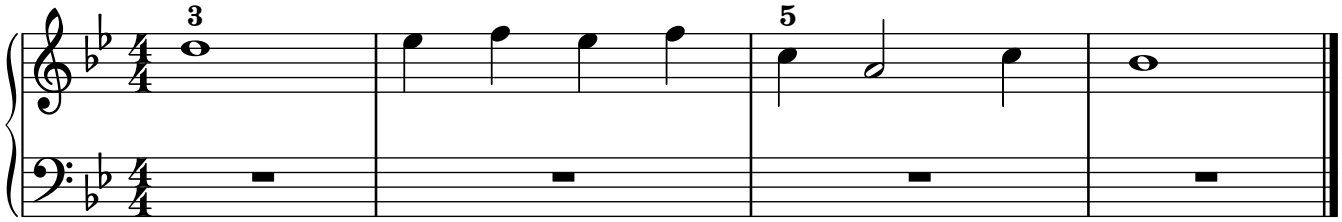
2. F position (F G A B-flat C) also fits B-flat major: the right hand often moves between the two.

3. Say 'B-flat, E-flat' aloud while you scan the key signature.

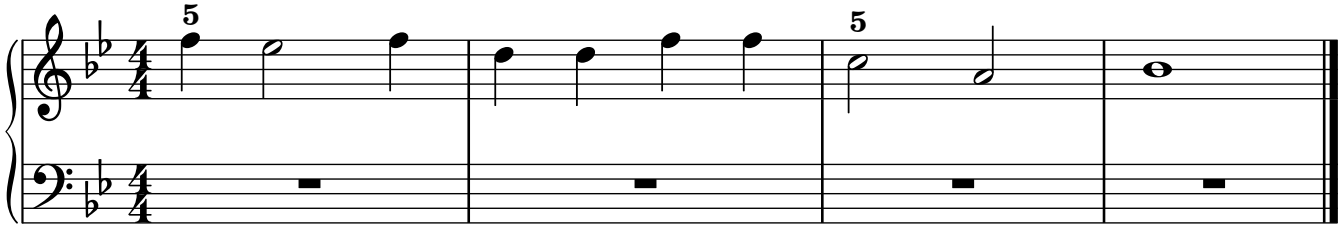
Part A: Right hand in B-flat major ♩ = 60

Right hand in B-flat major, moving between B-flat position and F position.
Metronome 60.

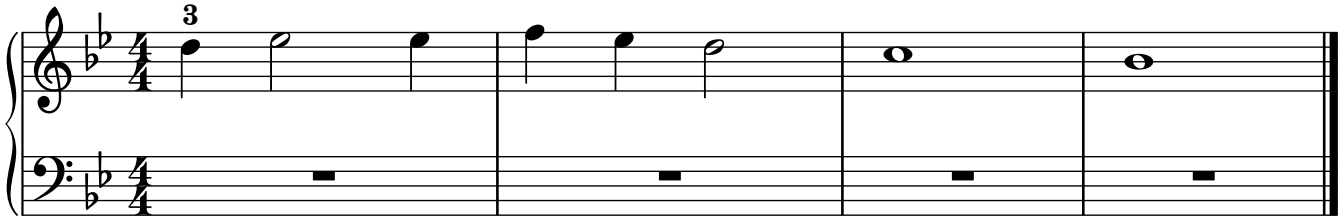
☐ **5.1**



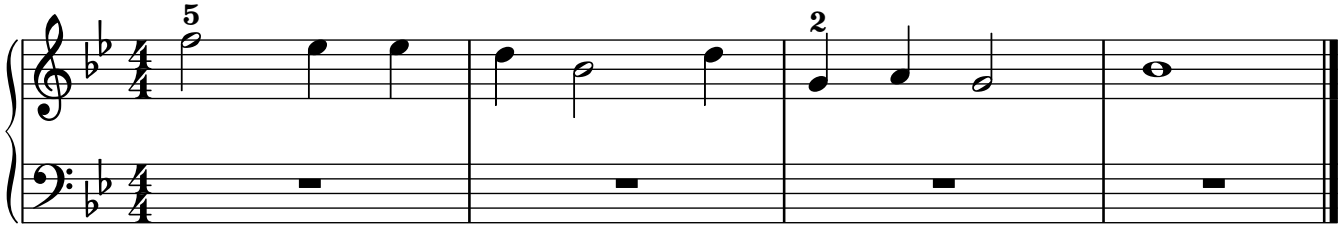
☐ **5.2**



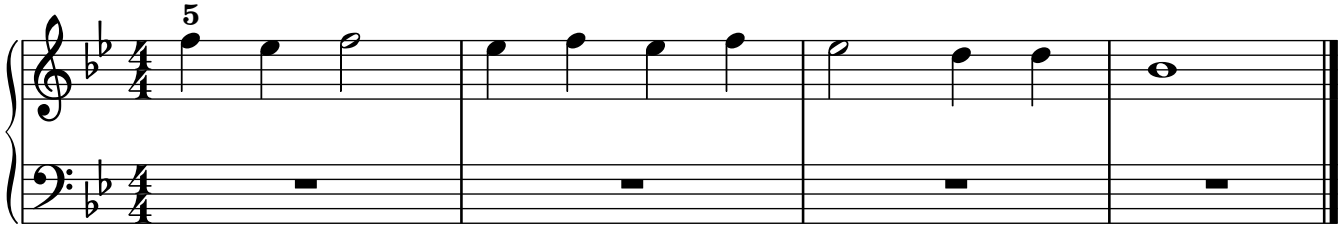
☐ **5.3**



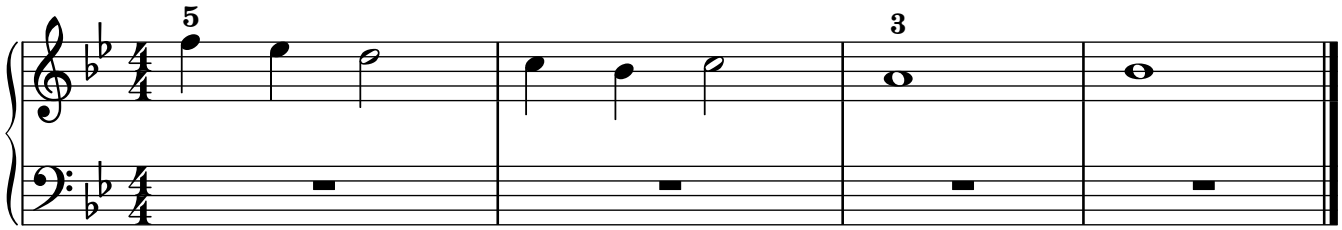
☐ **5.4**



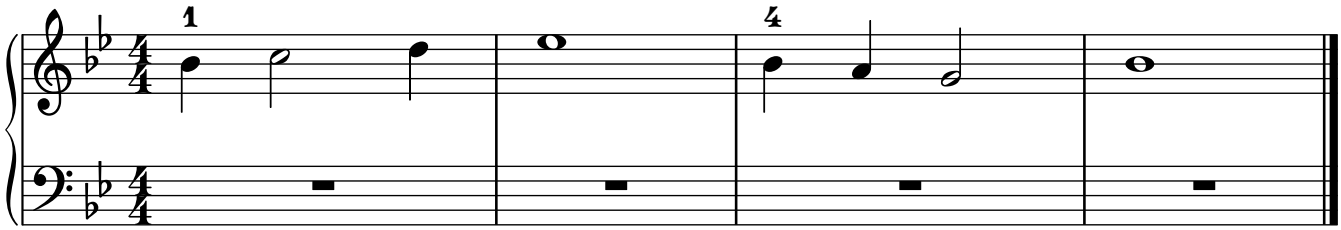
☐ **5.5**



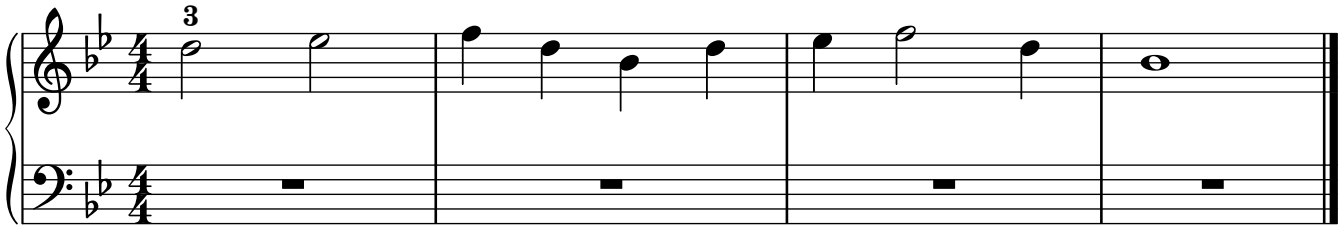
☐ **5.6**



☐ **5.7**



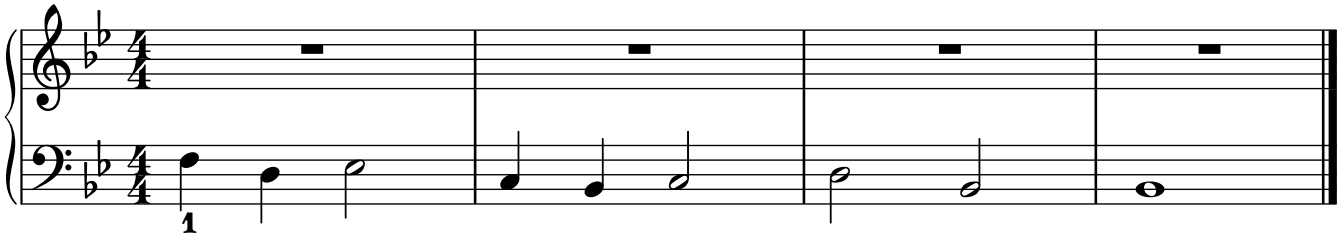
☐ **5.8**



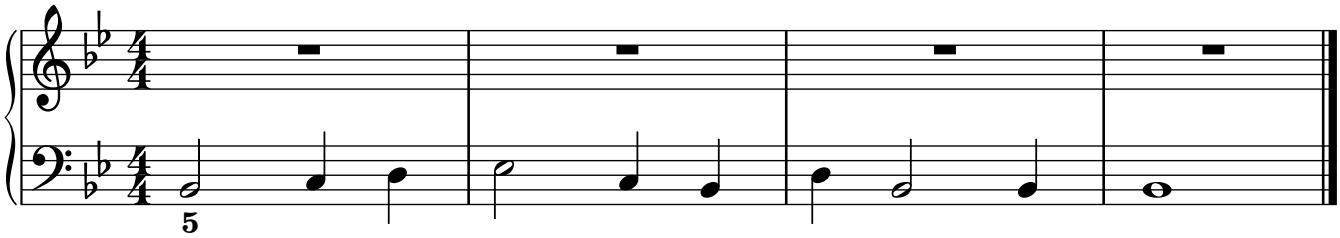
Part B: Left hand in B-flat major ♩ = 60

Left hand in B-flat position. B-flat is the second line; E-flat is the third space.

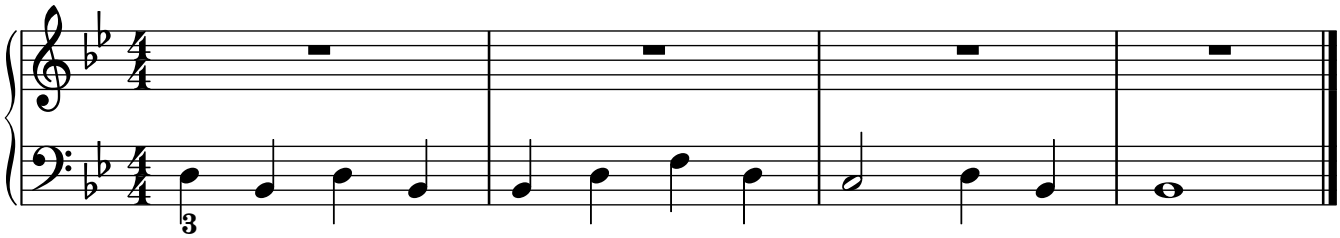
☐ **5.9**



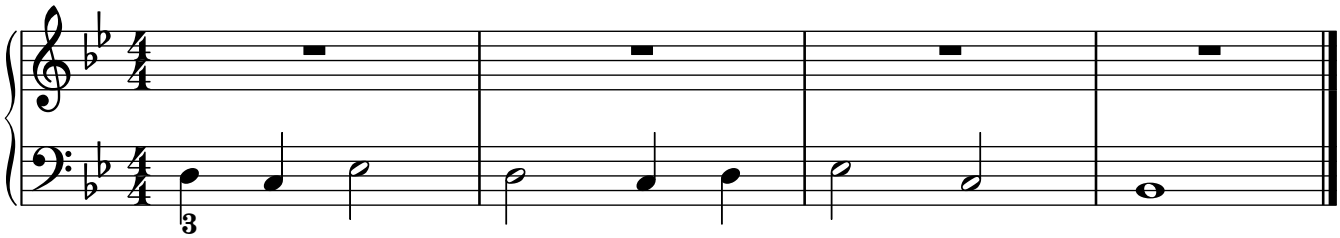
☐ **5.10**



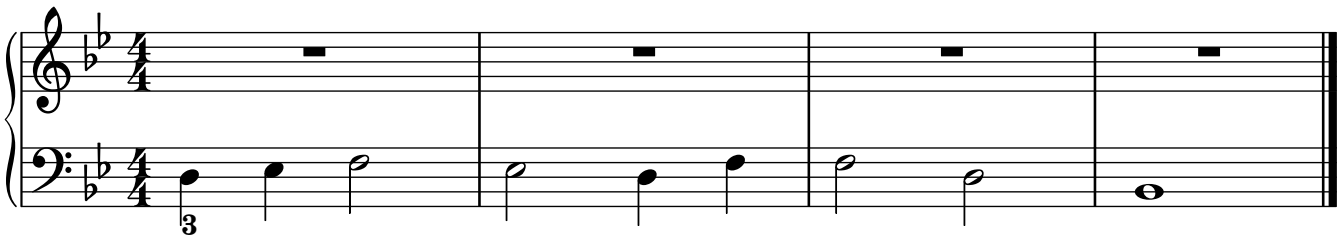
☐ **5.11**



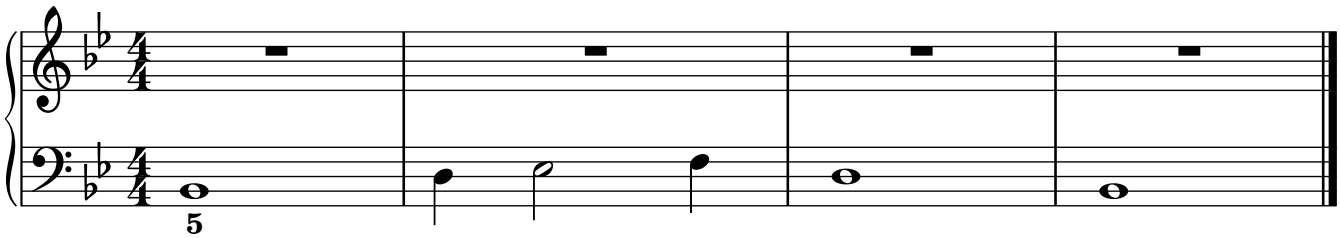
☐ **5.12**



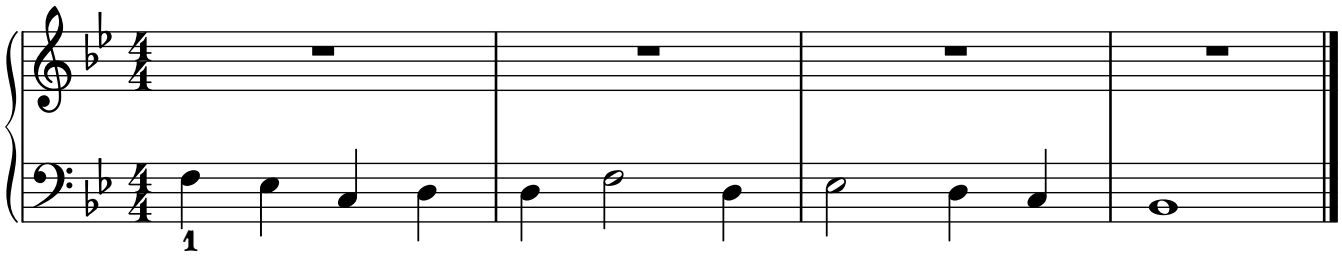
☐ **5.13**



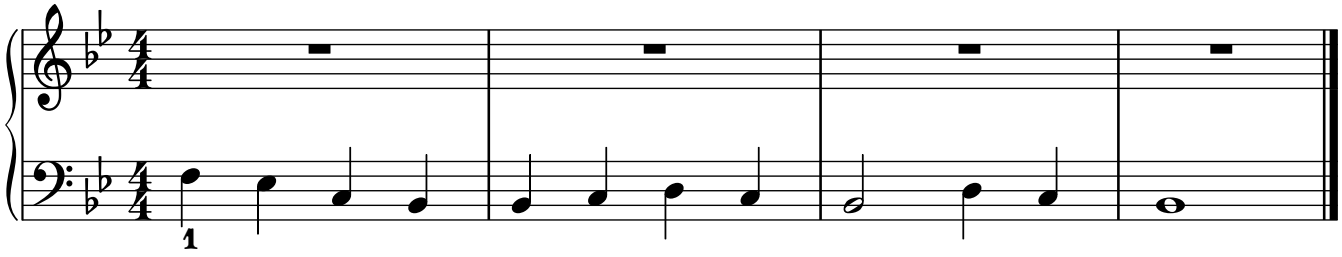
☐ **5.14**



5.15
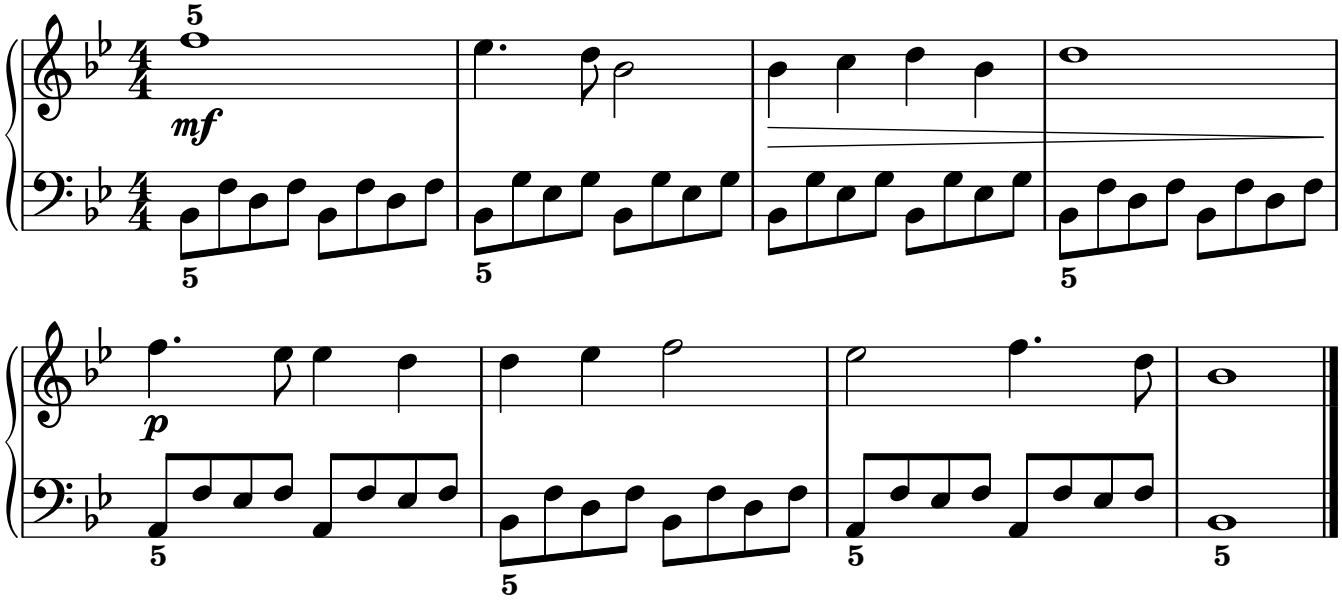


5.16
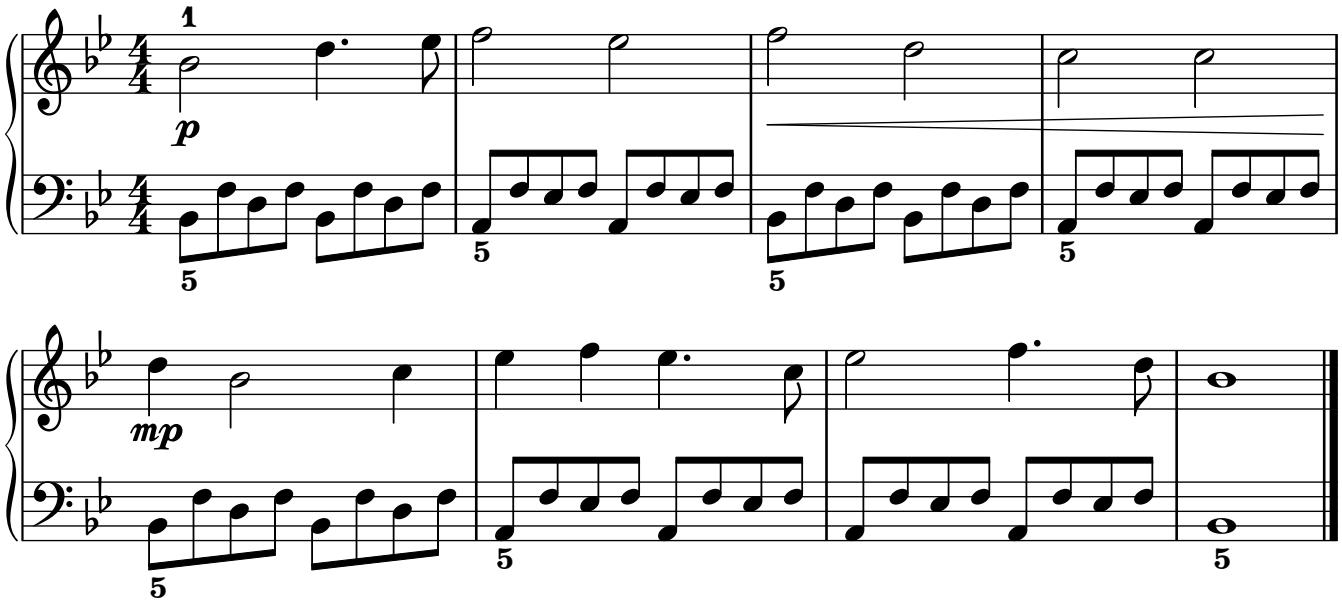


Part C: Alberti bass in B-flat major ♩ = 60

An Alberti bass in B-flat major.

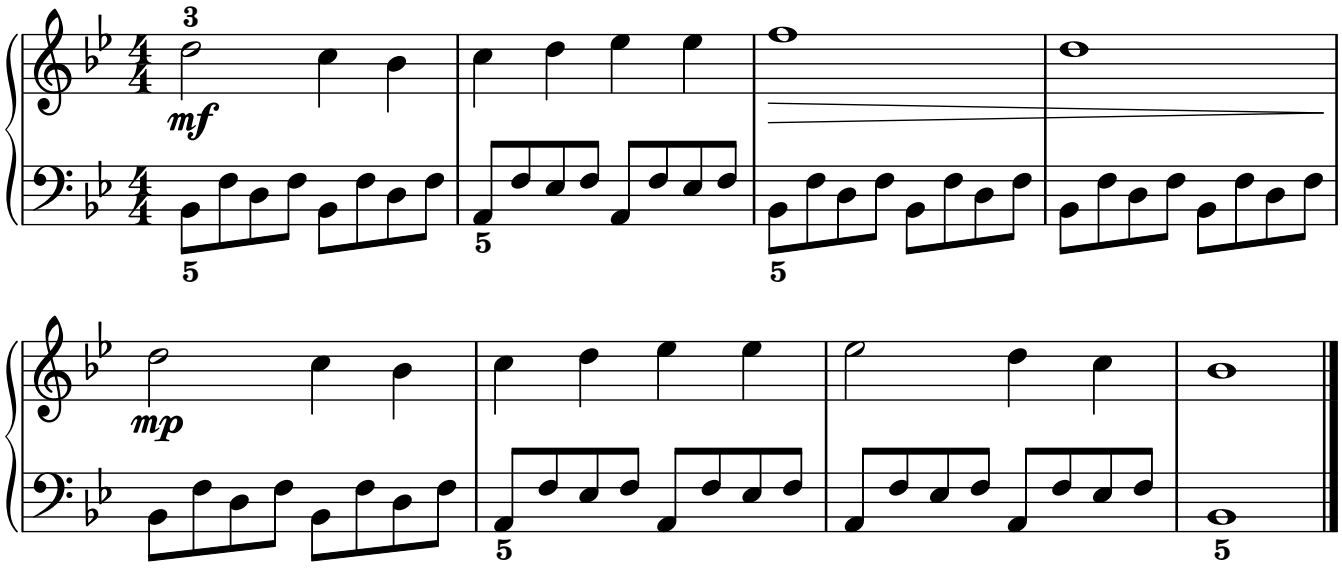
☐ **5.17**



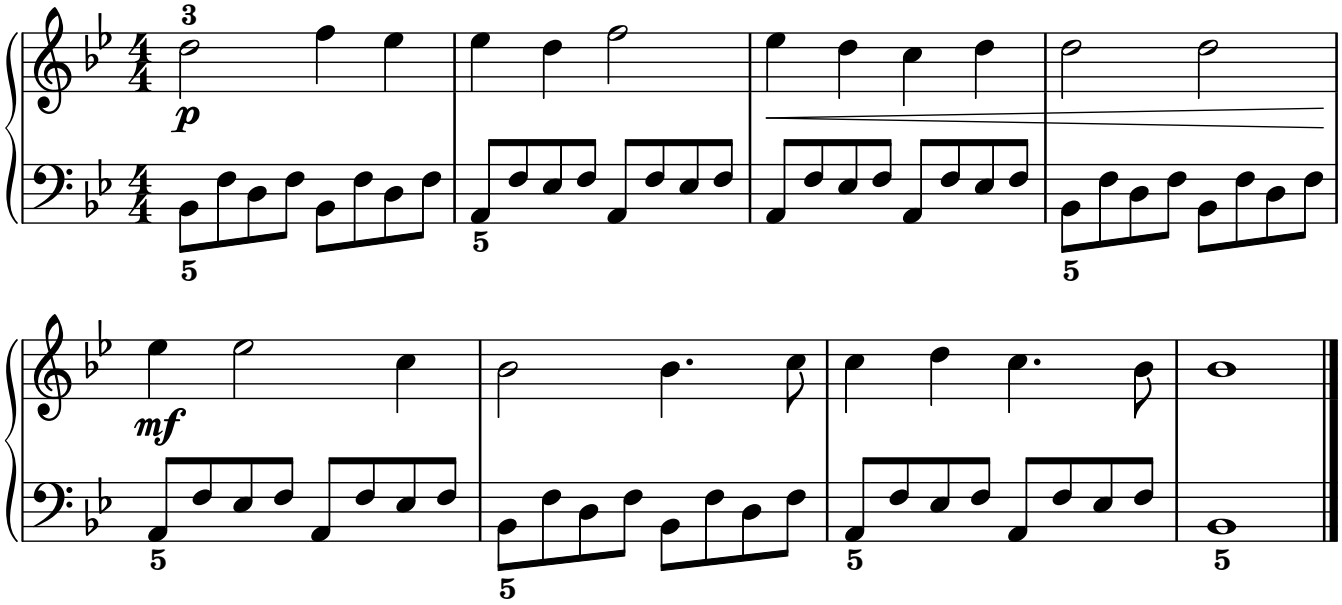
☐ **5.18**
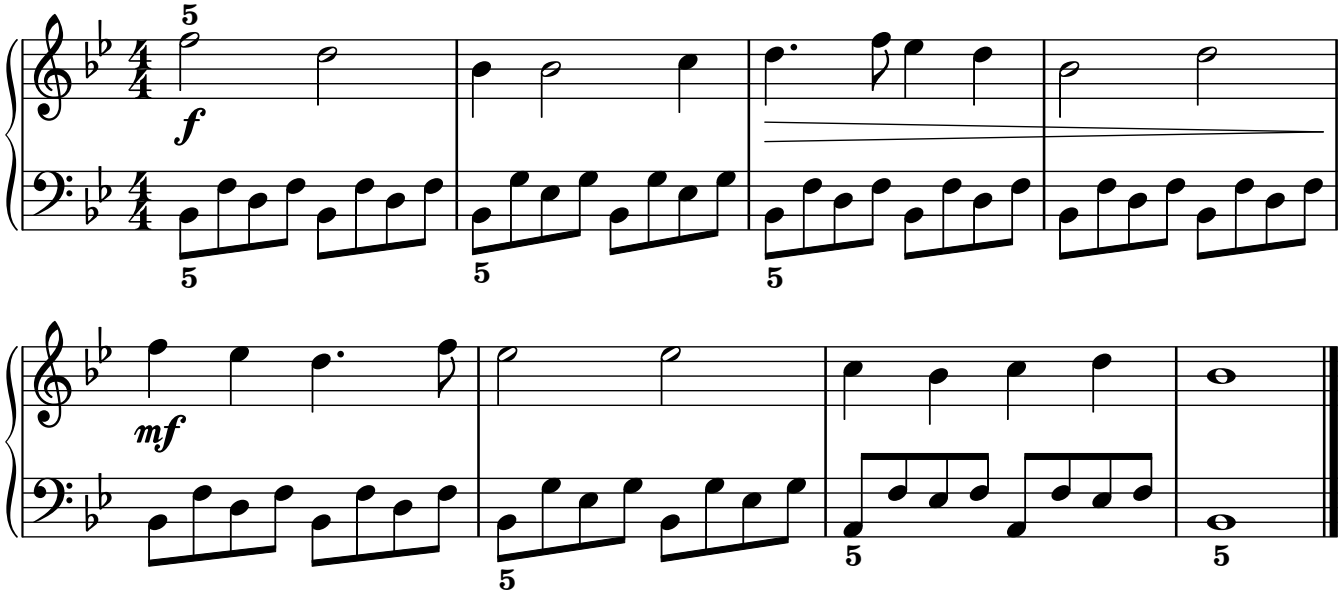


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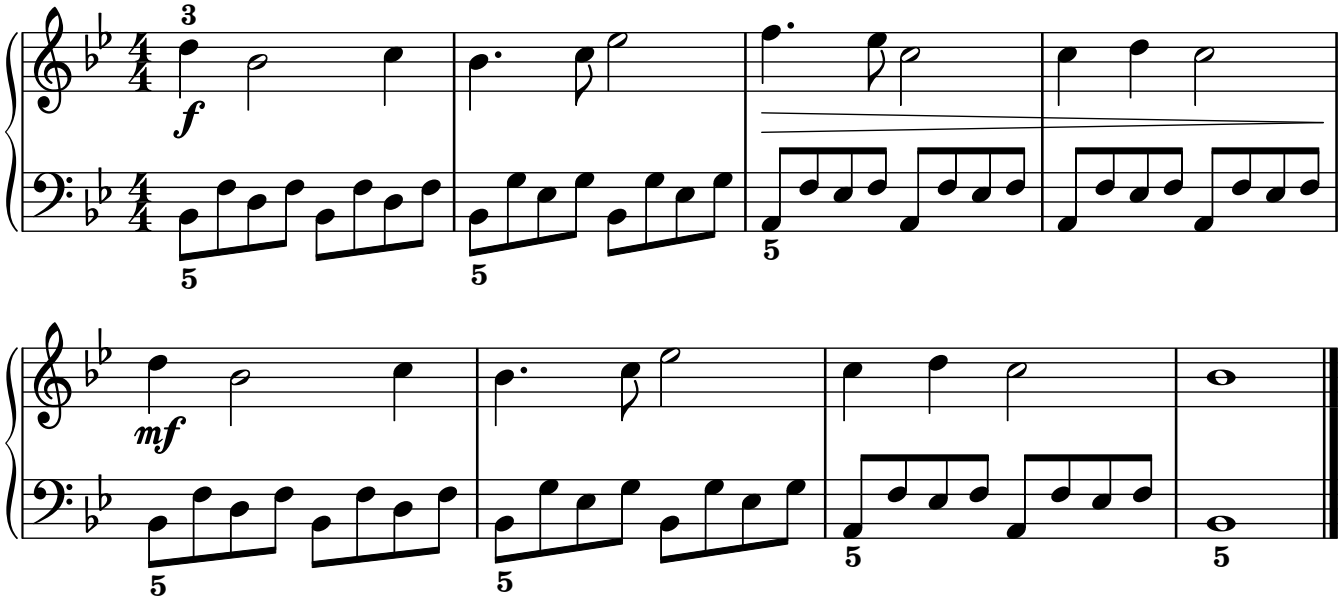


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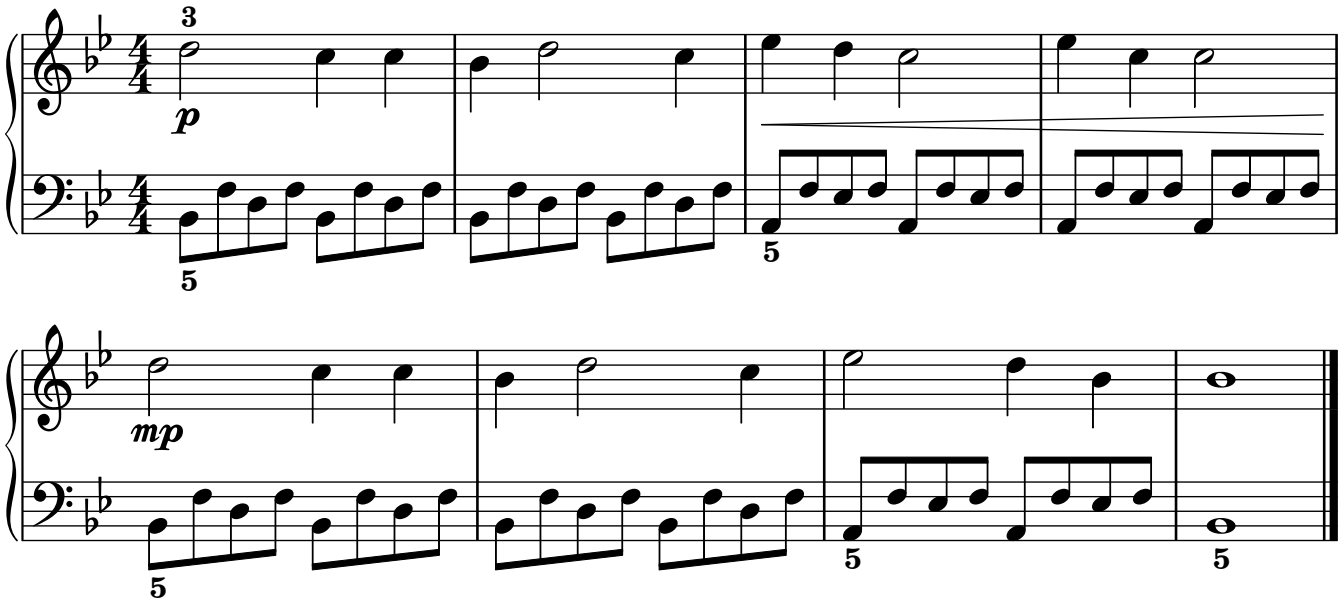
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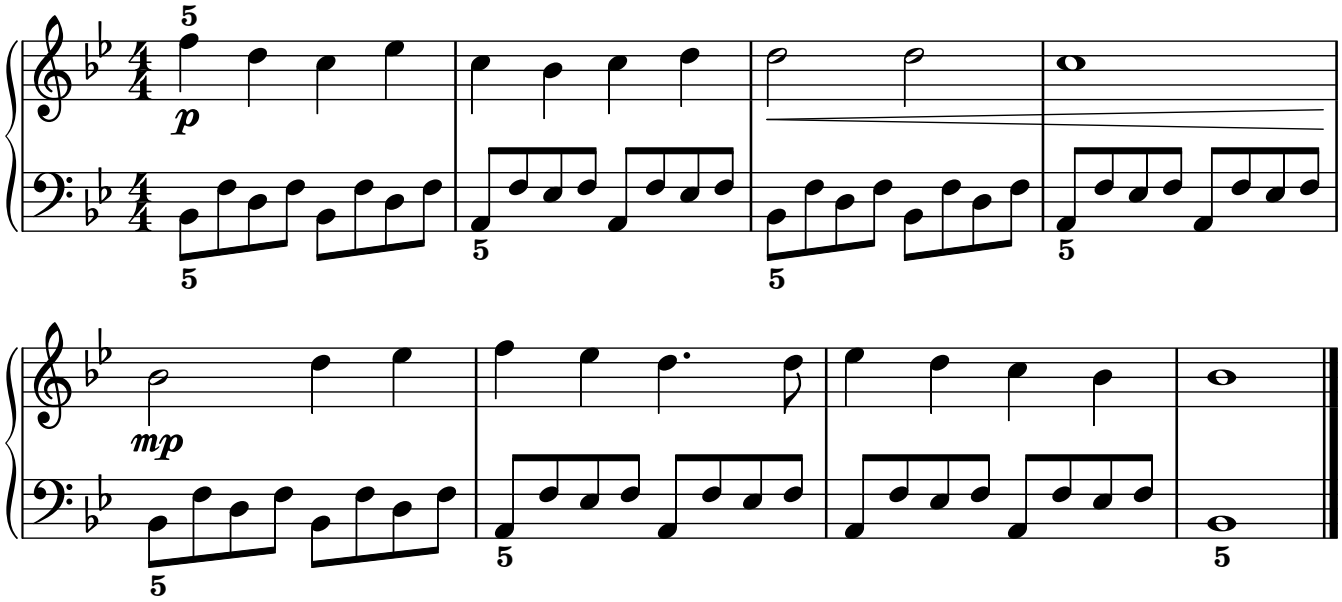
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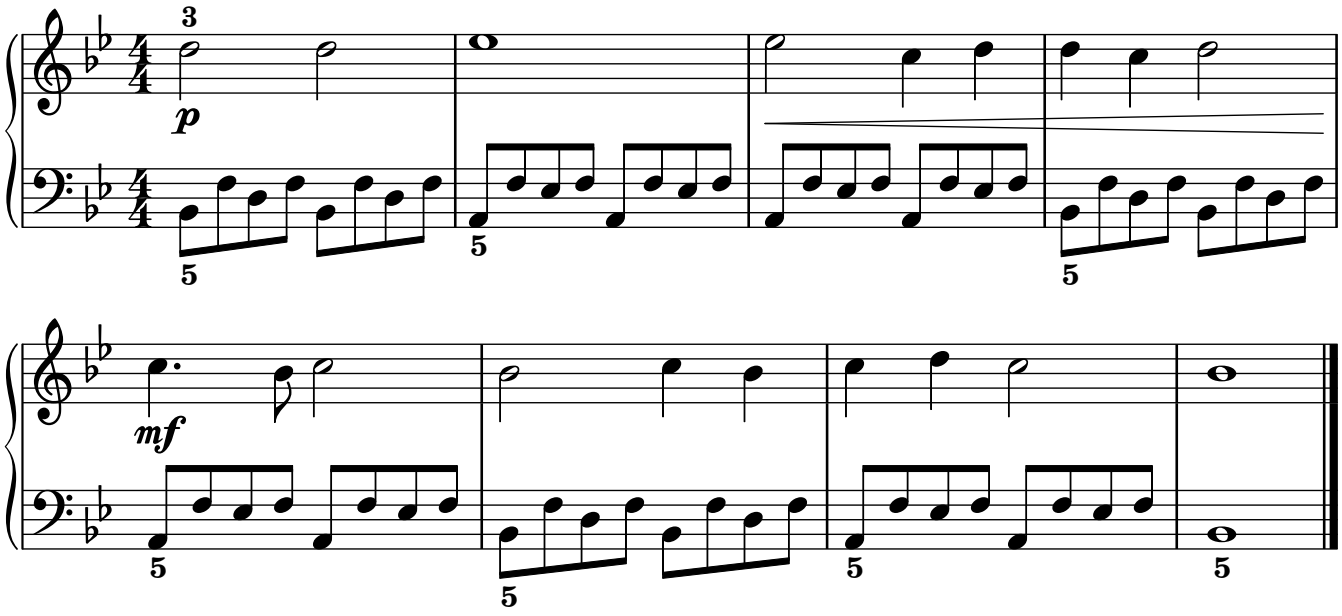
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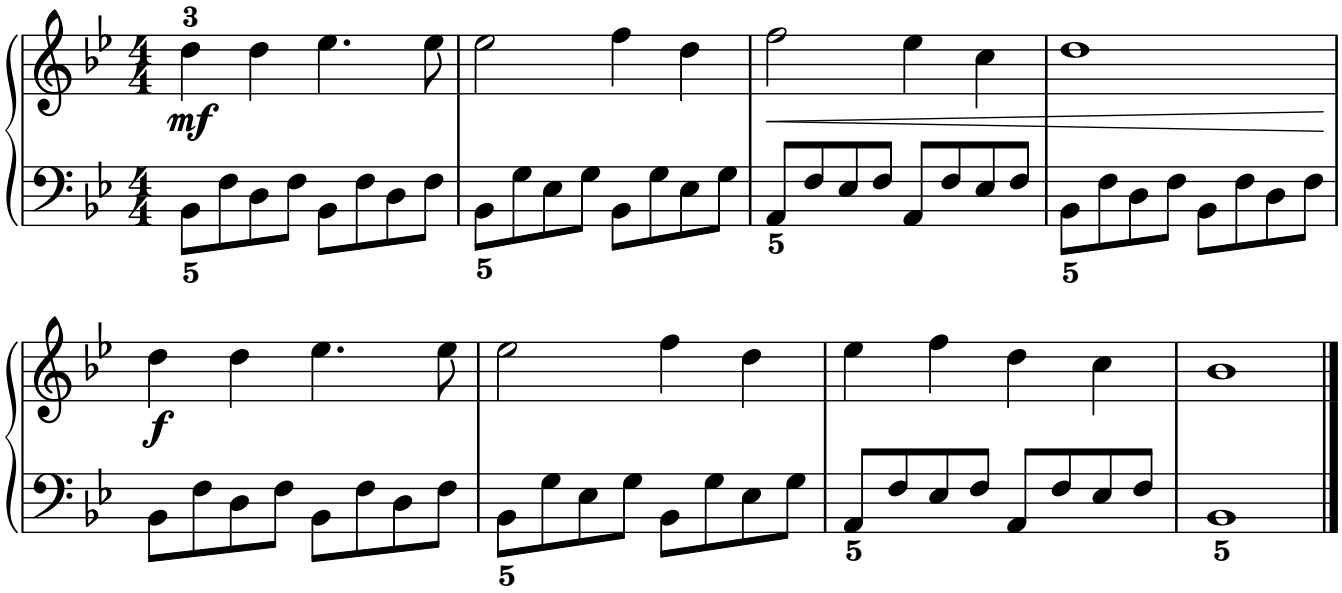


5.24



5.25



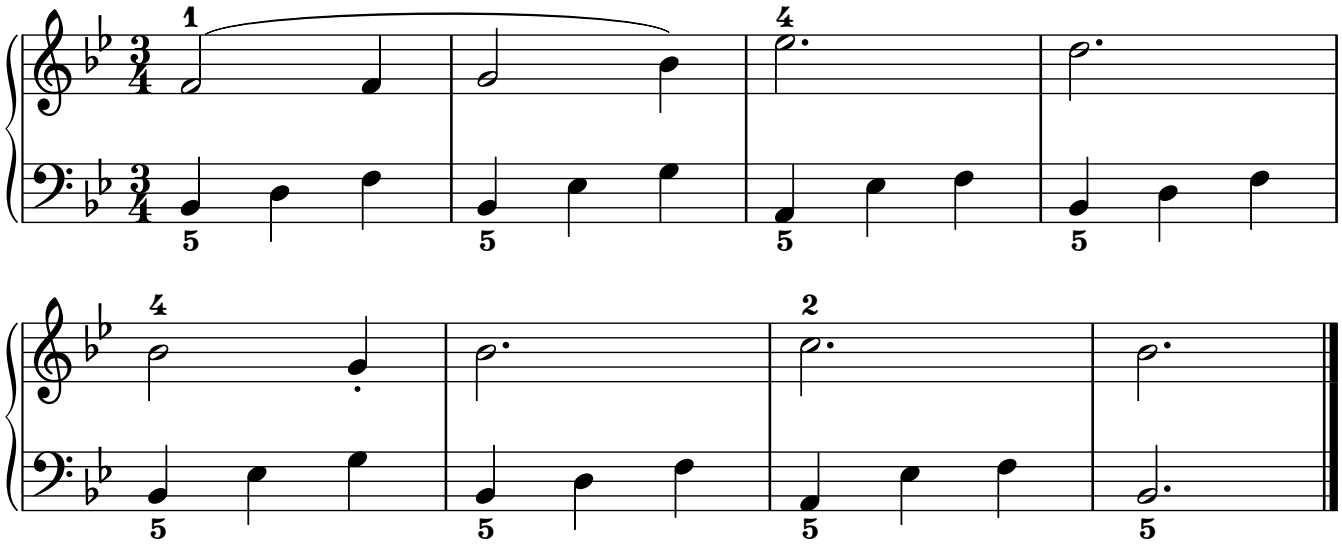
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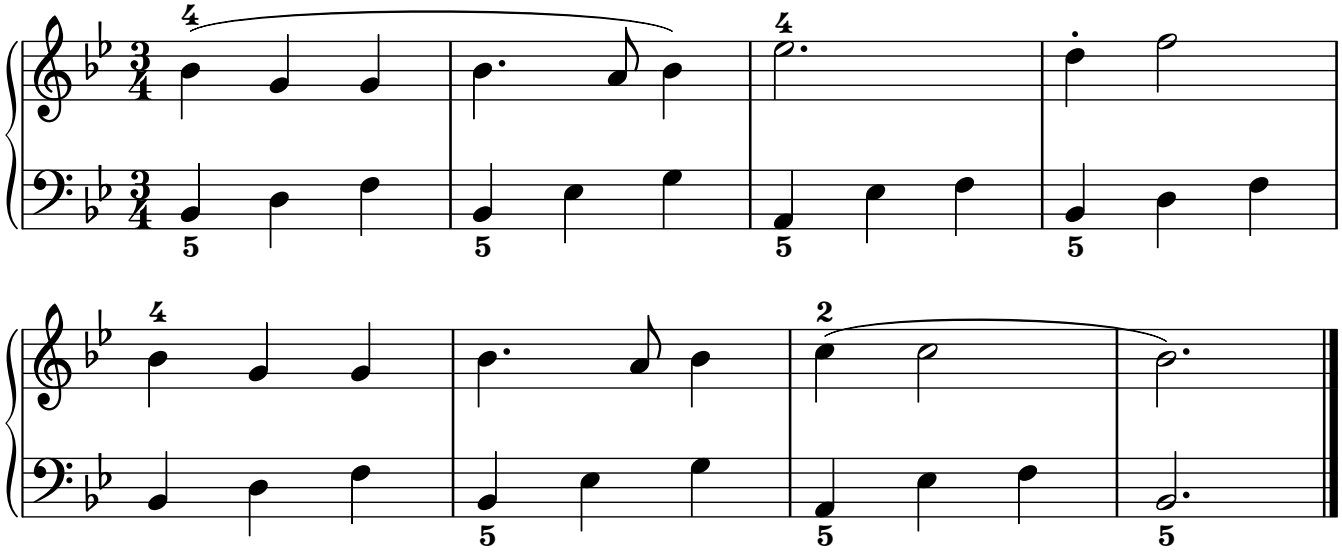


Part D: A B-flat waltz on the move ♩ = 72

A waltz. The right hand moves between F position and B-flat position.
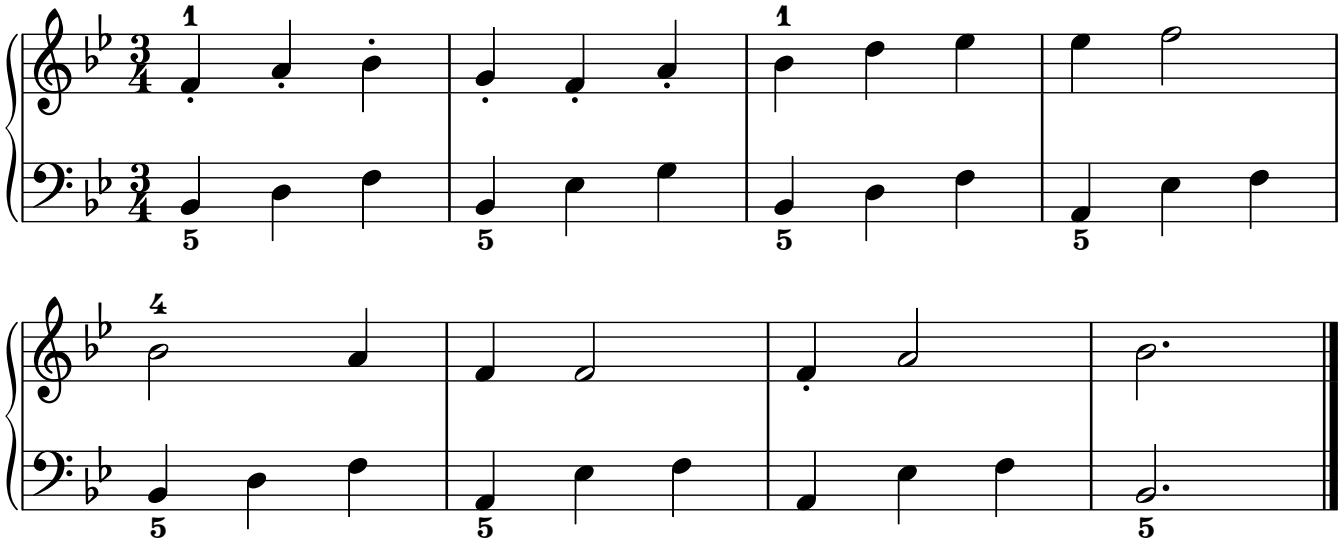
☐ **5.27**



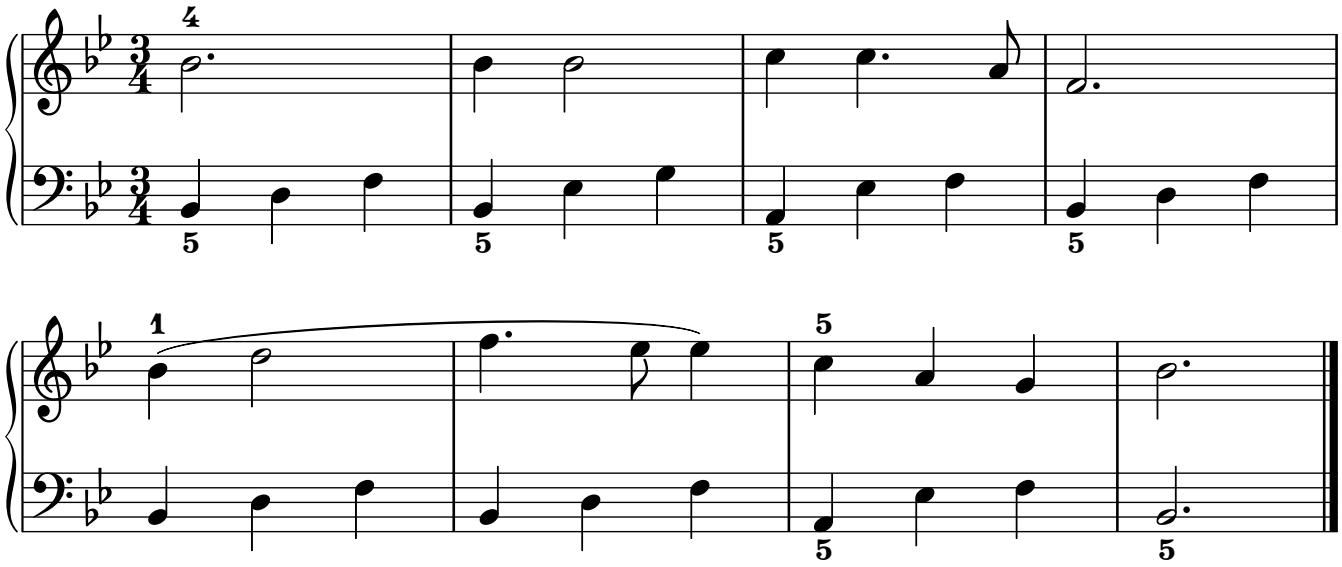
☐ **5.28**



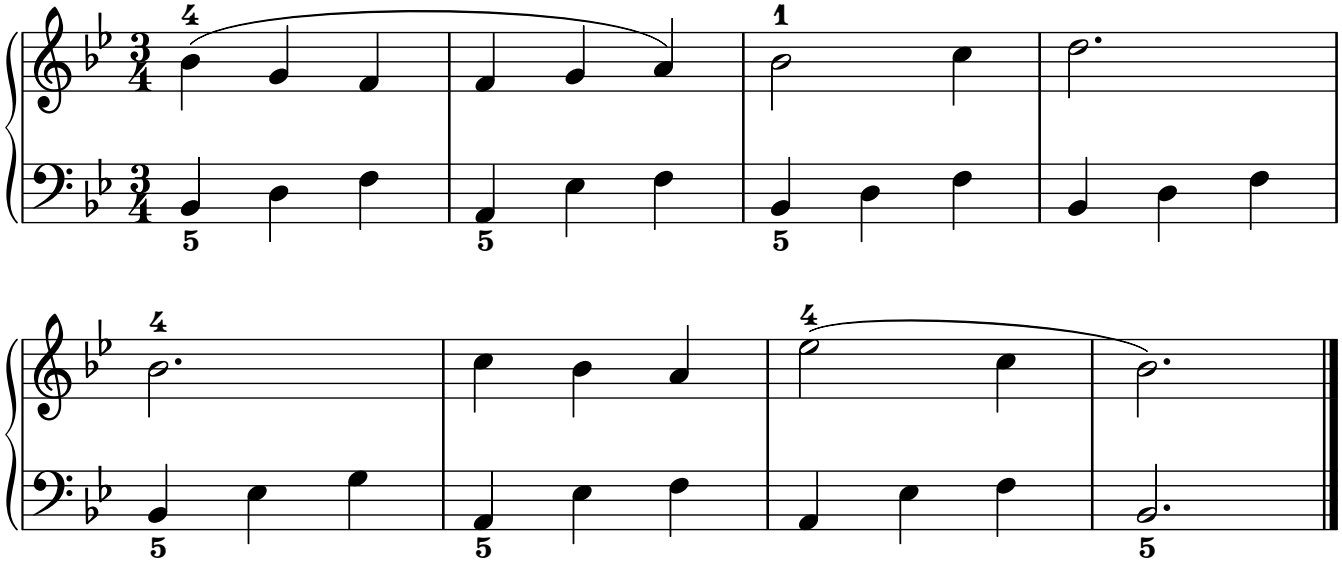
☐ **5.29**
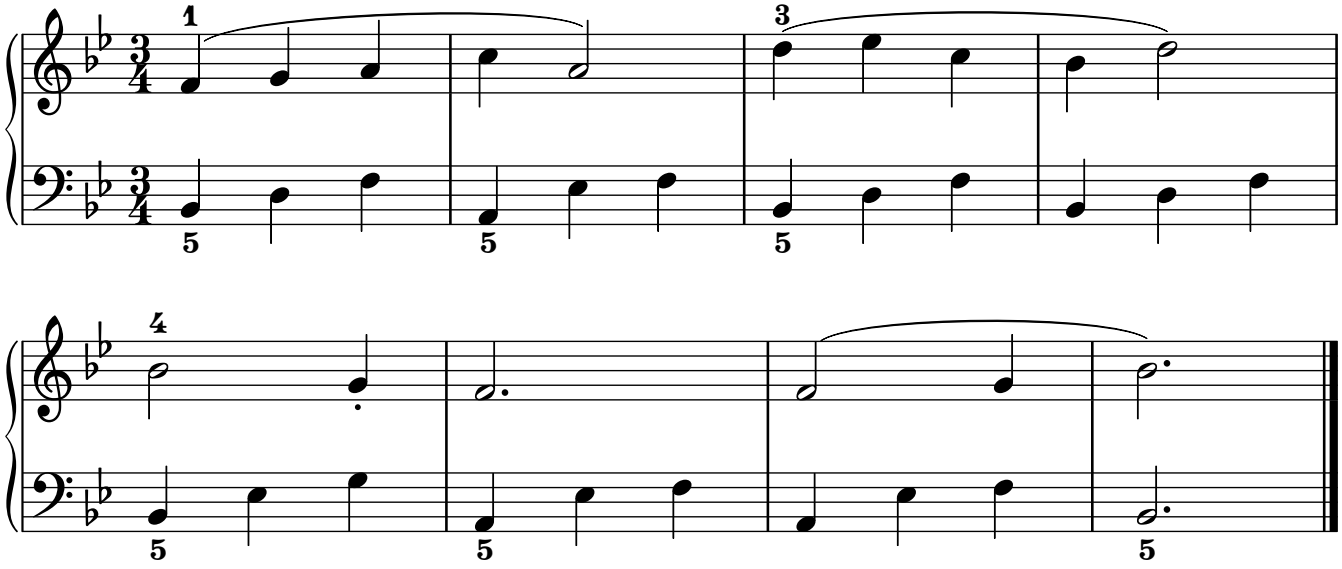


5.30



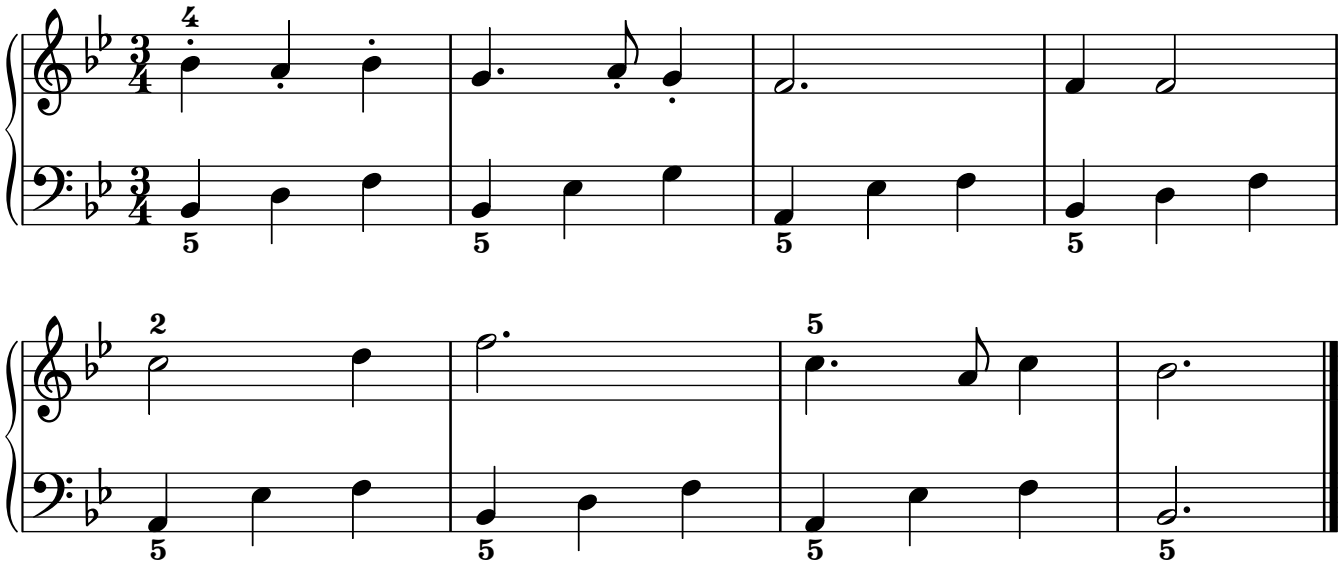
5.31



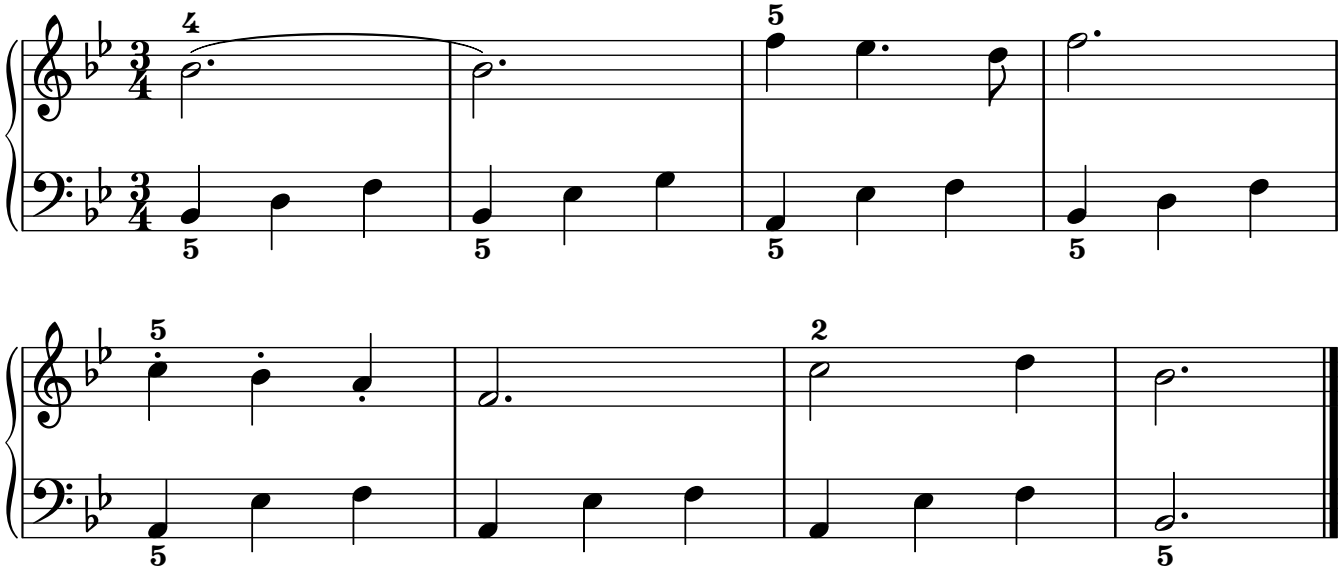
5.32



5.33



5.34
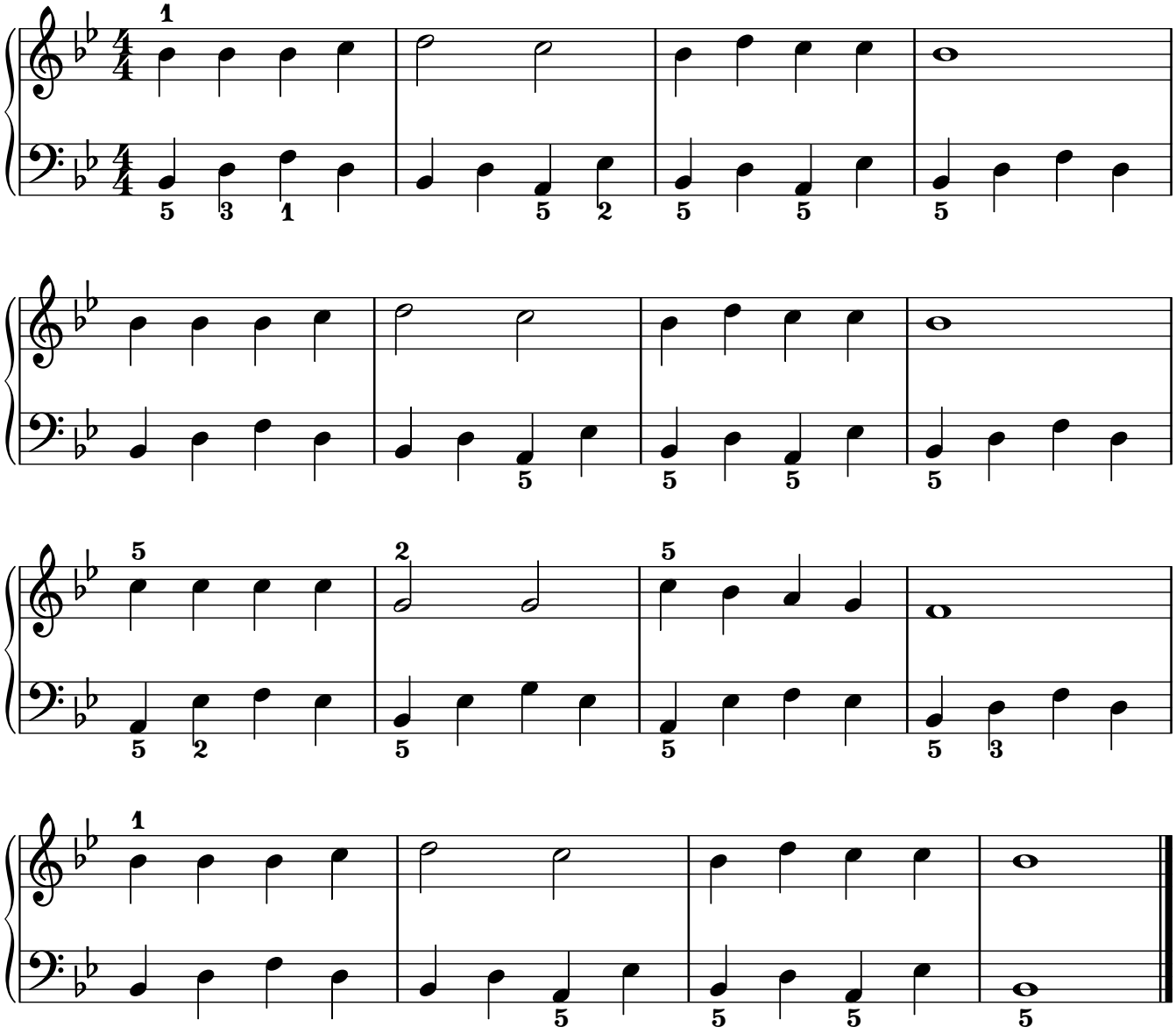


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Au clair de la lune ♩ = 84

Traditional French song

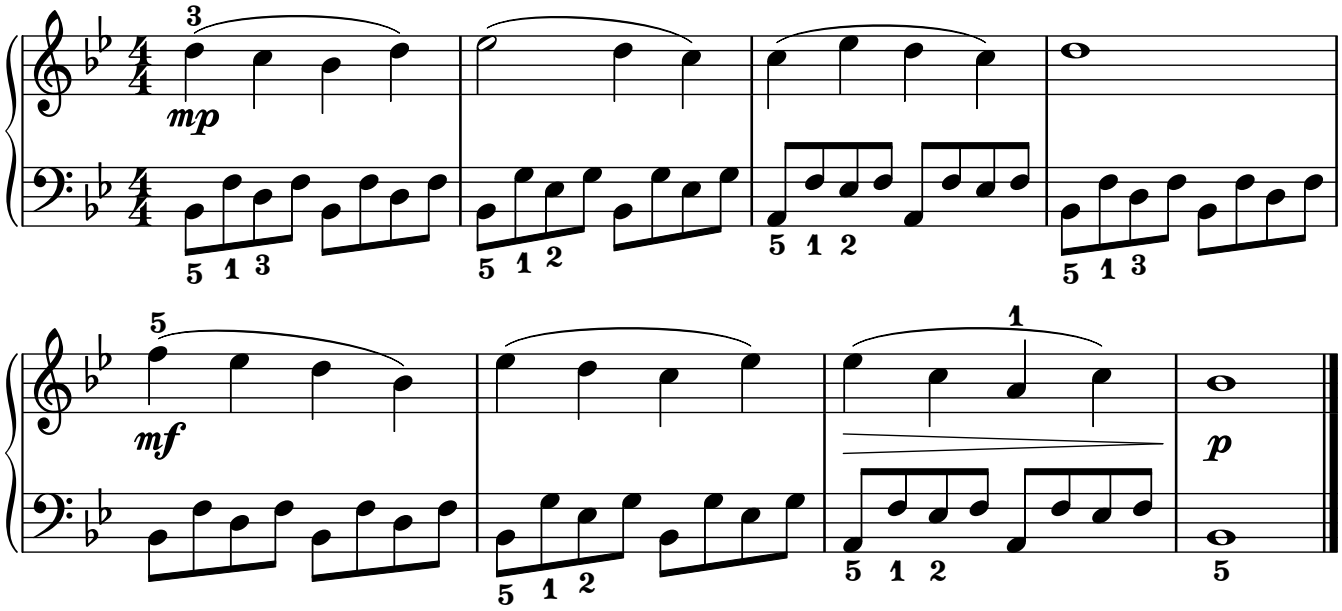
The song from Volume 1, now in B-flat major. In bar 9 the right hand moves down to F position (finger 5 on C) and in bar 13 back to B-flat position. The left hand plays broken chords.



Song in B-flat ♩ = 72

Original
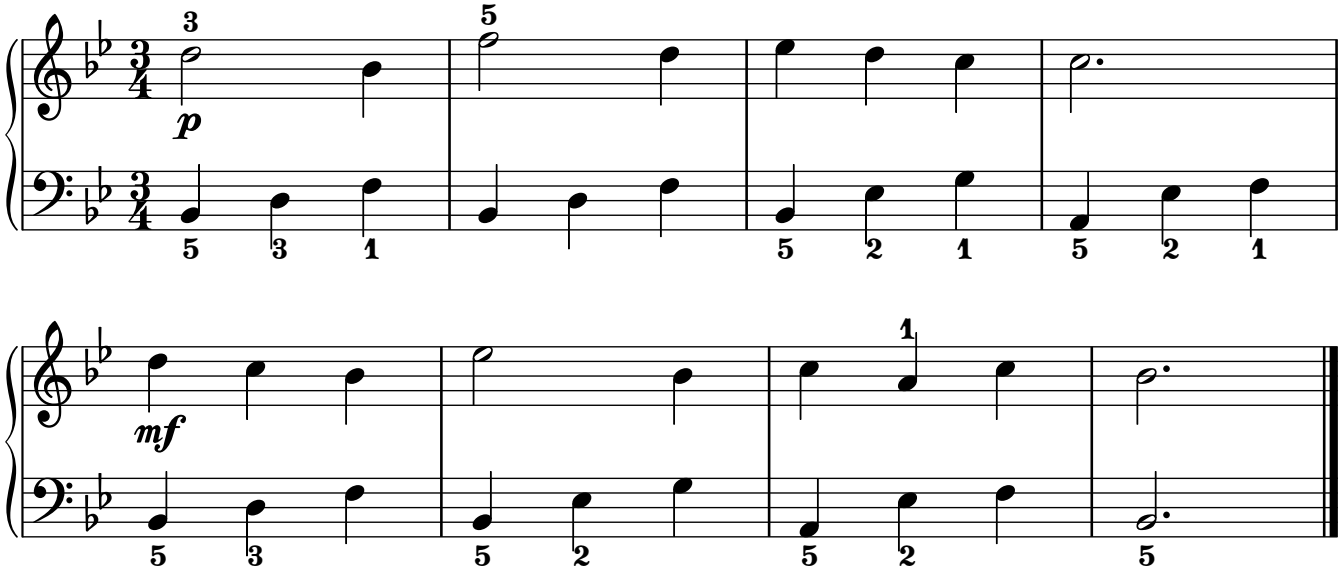
A singing tune over an Alberti bass. In bar 7 the right-hand thumb stretches down to A, the note below B-flat, and resolves up to B-flat.



Waltz in B-flat ♩ = 84

Original

Watch the left hand in bars 4 and 7: from the top of IV (G) it reaches down to A for V7.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 6?

- Play five new Part C or D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every B and E is flat, in both hands.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 6.

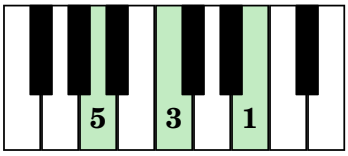
Unit 6

Accidentals

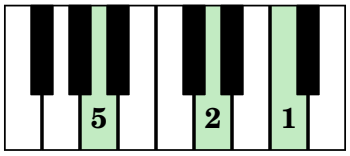
New: Sharps, flats and naturals inside the bar; the raised 7th in minor keys

A sharp, flat or natural written in the music, not in the key signature, is called an accidental. In minor keys you meet one all the time: the 7th note of the scale is raised by a half step so that it leads strongly home to the tonic. In A minor that note is G-sharp, although the key signature has no sharps at all.
This unit uses four minor keys: A minor and E minor from Volume 2, and two new ones, B minor (the relative minor of D major, two sharps) and G minor (the relative minor of B-flat major, two flats).

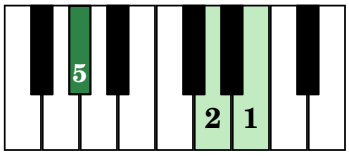
A minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Am

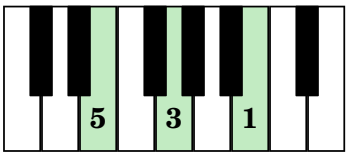


iv = Dm

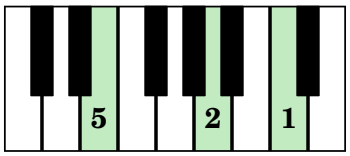


V7 = E7

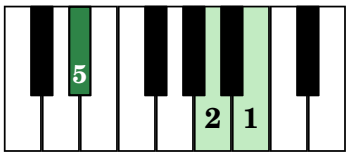
E minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Em

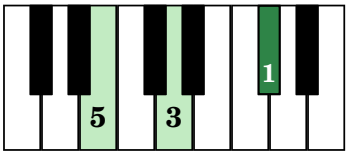


iv = Am

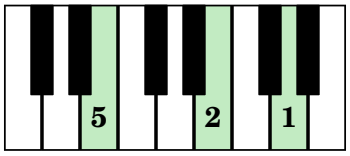


V7 = B7

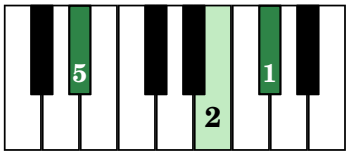
B minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Bm

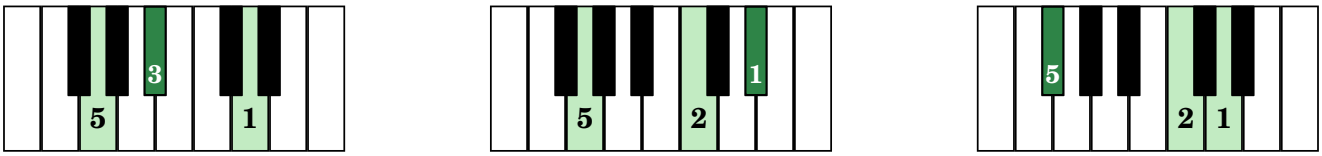


iv = Em



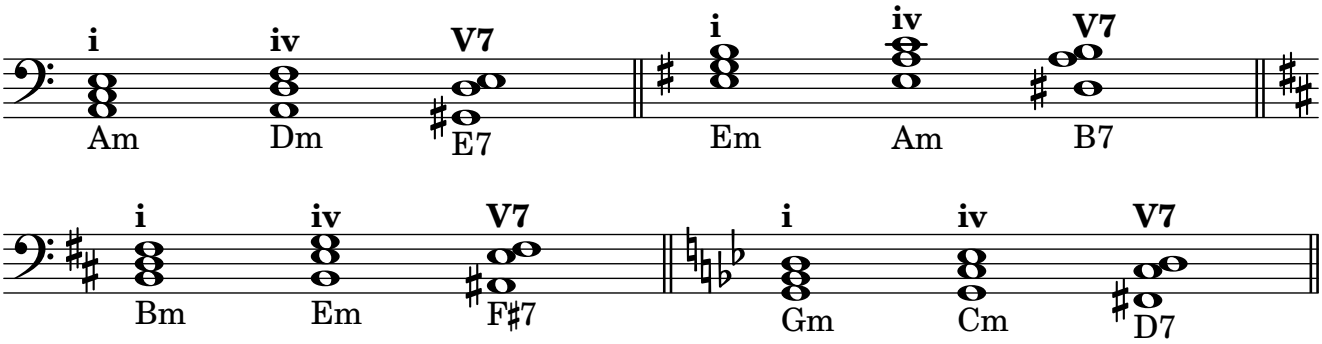
V7 = F♯7

G minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Gm **iv** = Cm **V7** = D7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

How long an accidental lasts

An accidental lasts until the next bar line, for that note only. In the next bar the key signature is back in charge. Here a reminder natural (or sharp) is printed in the next bar to help you.

The raised 7th

A minor: G-sharp. E minor: D-sharp. B minor: A-sharp. G minor: F-sharp. It appears in the V7 chord and, in the right hand, just below the tonic, where the thumb stretches down to it.

Minor chord shapes

i and iv are minor chords (lower-case numbers); V7 is the same shape as in a major key but its bottom note is the raised 7th, so it carries the accidental.

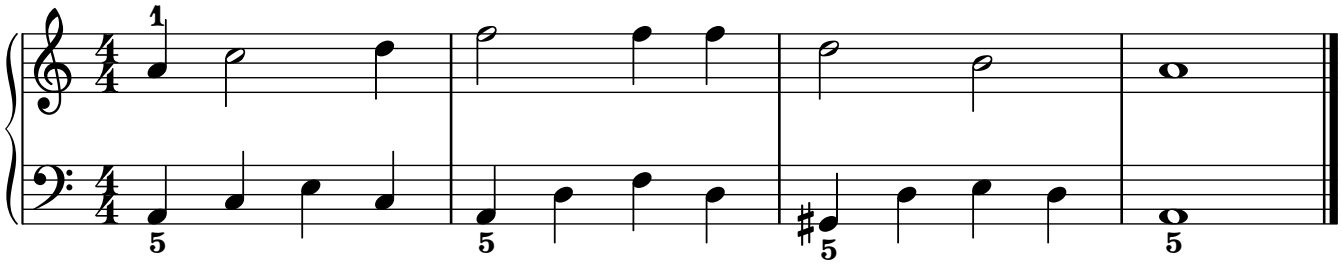
Reading tips

1. In your scan, look for the accidentals: in these keys they come in the V7 bars, usually near the end.
2. When you see the raised 7th, expect the tonic next.
3. After a bar with an accidental, read the next bar carefully: the note goes back to the key signature.

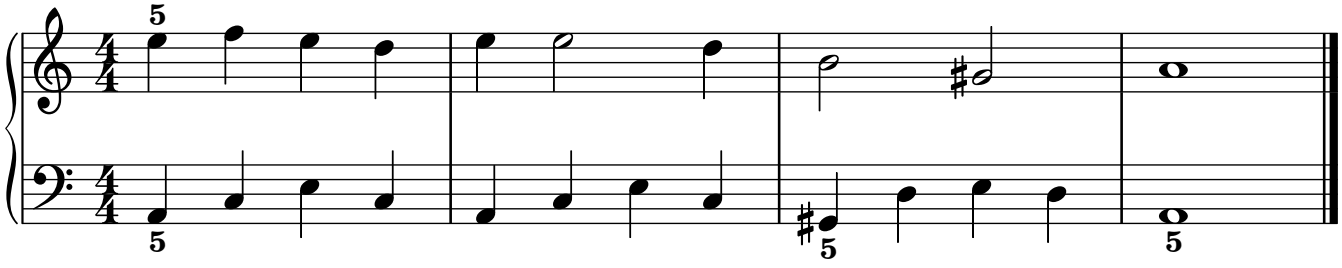
Part A: A minor: G-sharp ♩ = 60

A minor. G-sharp appears in the V7 shape (finger 5) and, in the right hand, under the thumb.

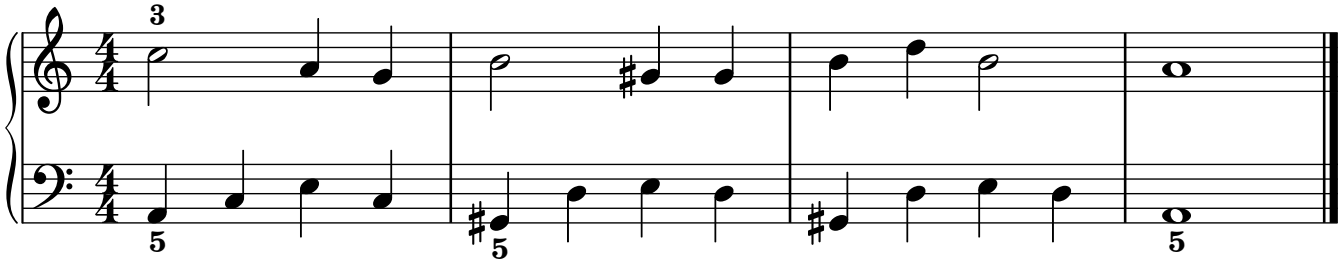
☐ **6.1**



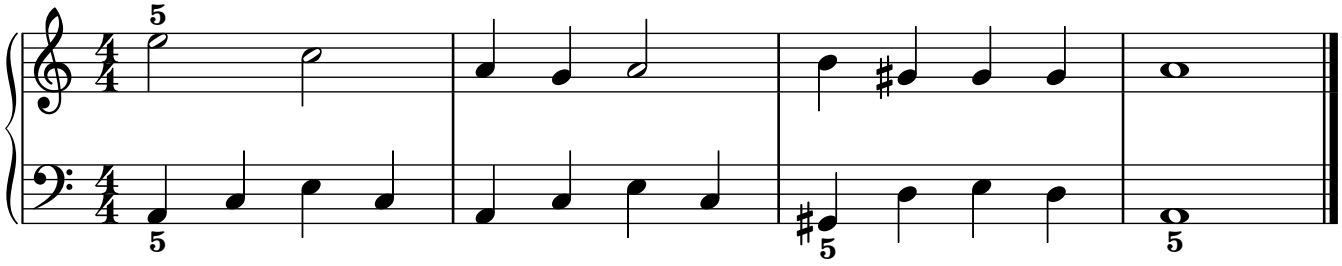
☐ **6.2**



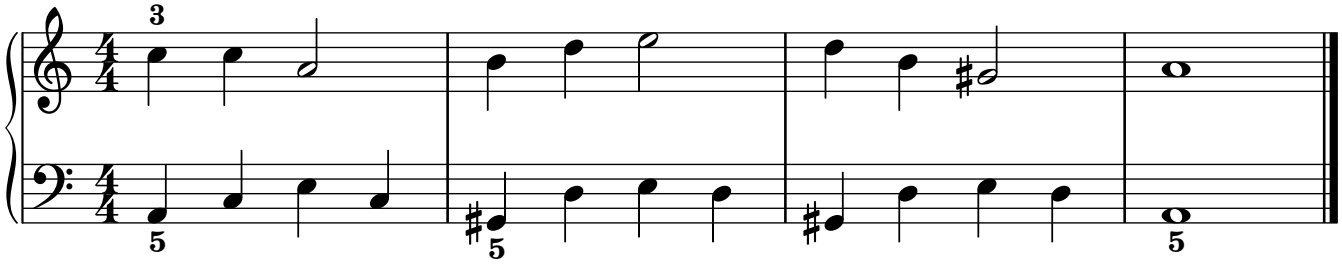
☐ **6.3**



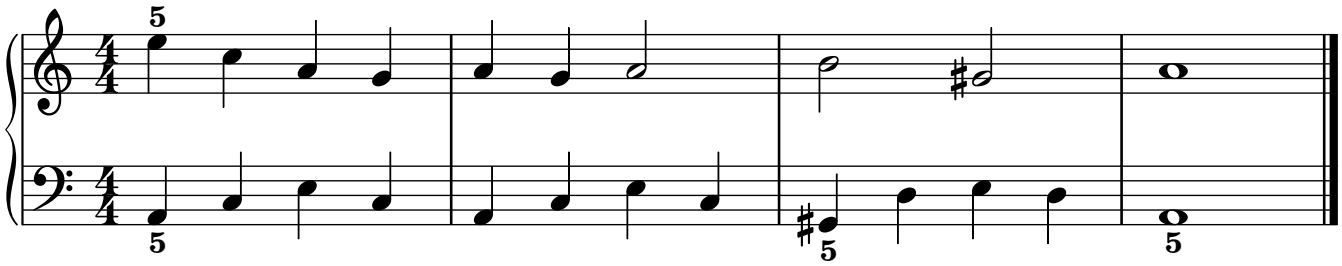
☐ **6.4**



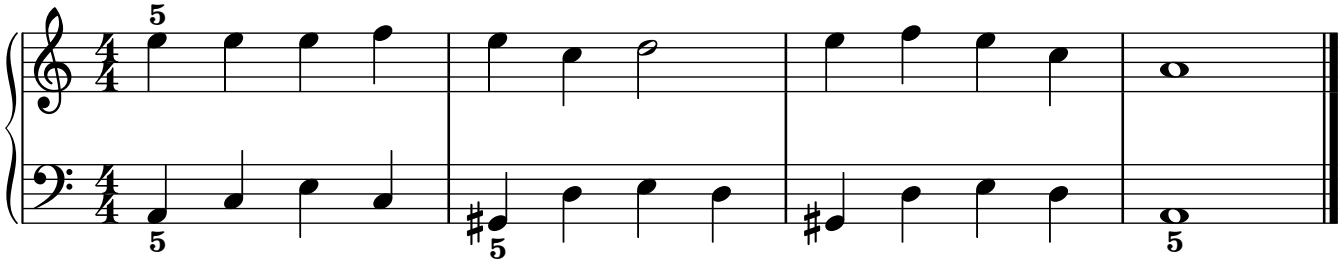
☐ **6.5**



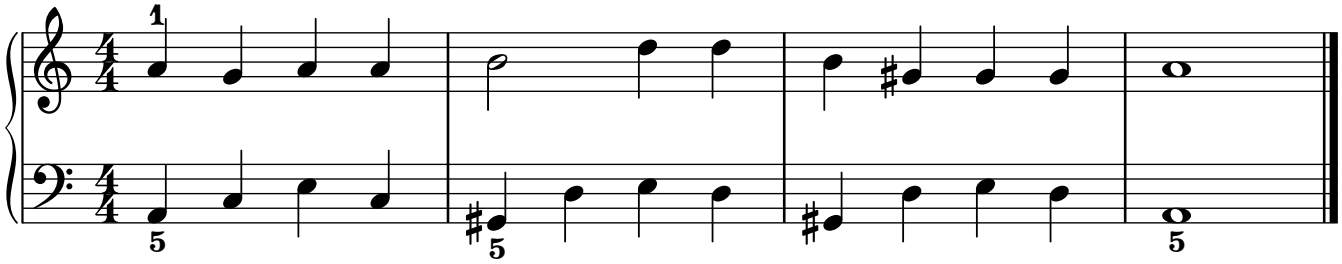
6.6



6.7



6.8
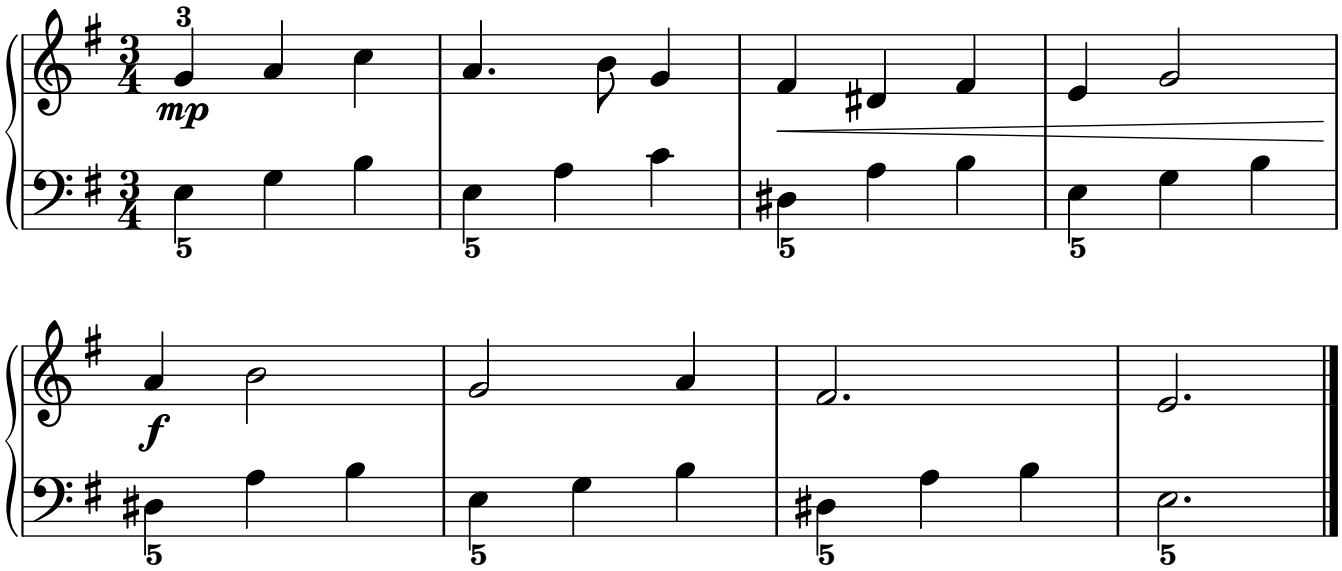


Part B: E minor: D-sharp
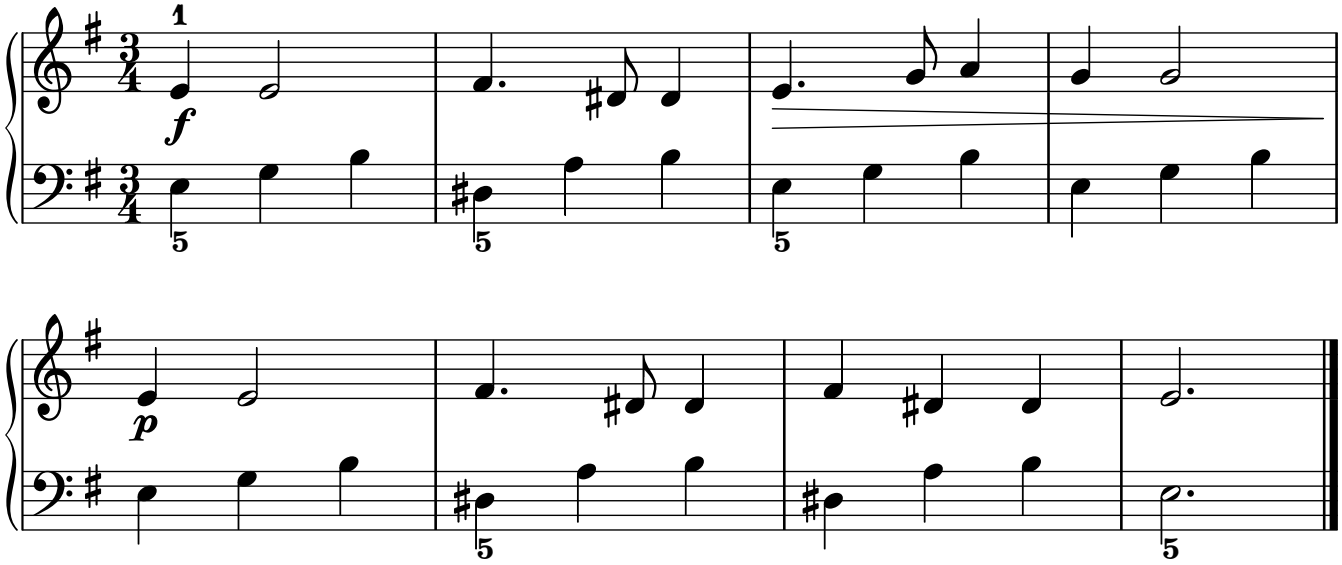
♩ = 72

E minor in 3/4. The raised 7th is D-sharp.

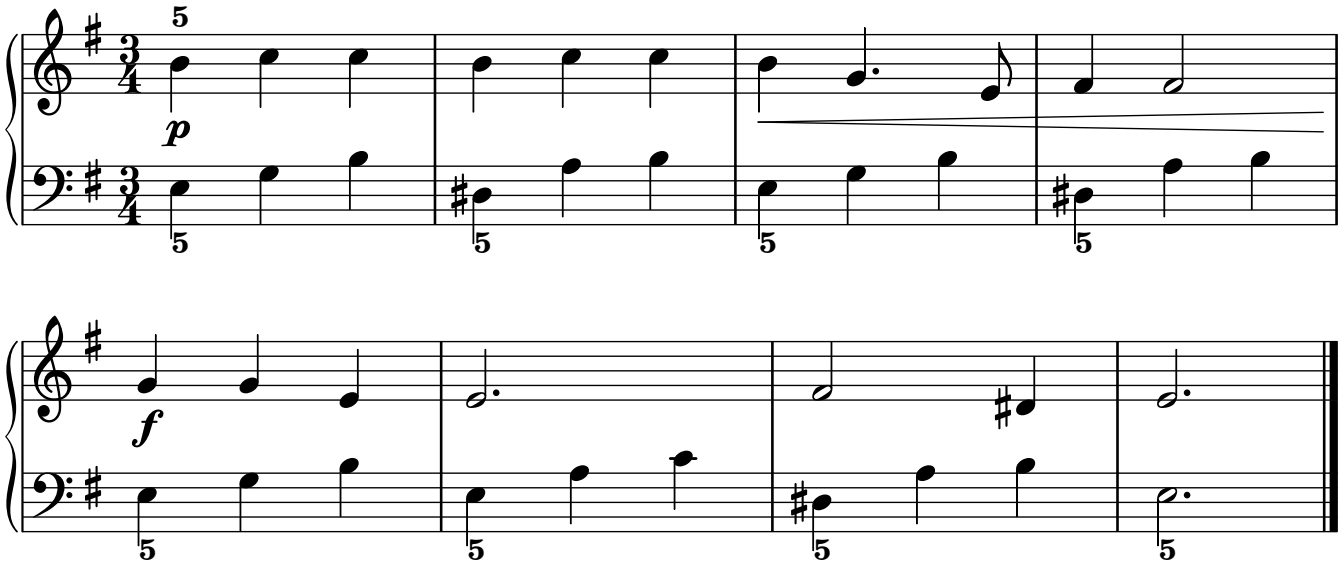
☐ **6.9**
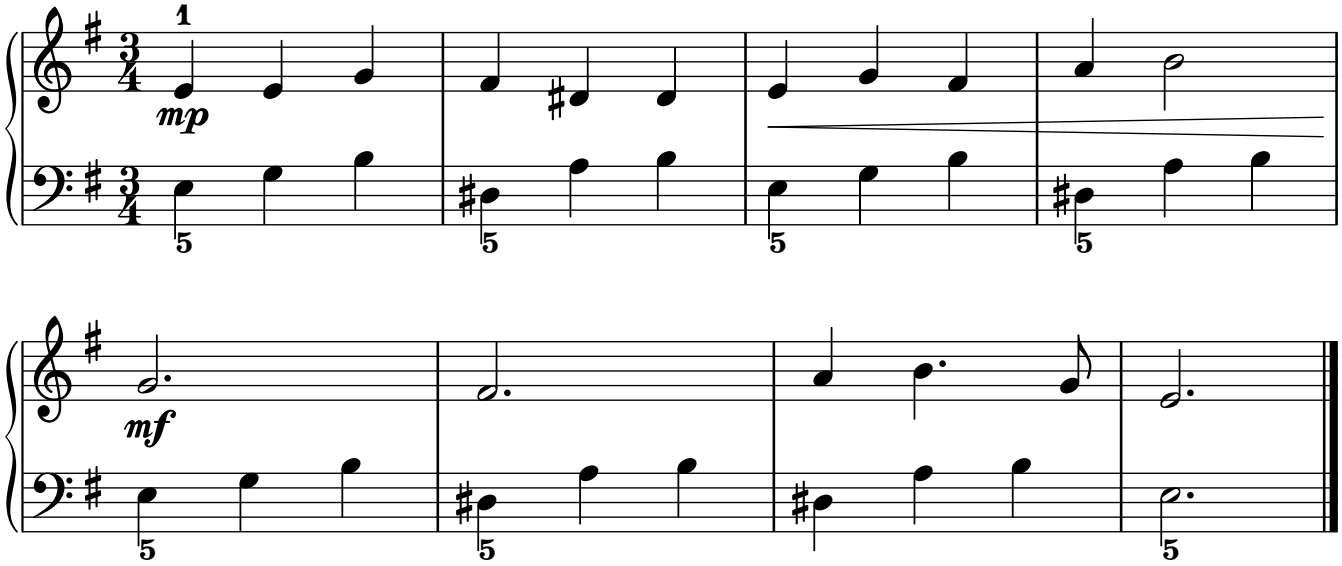


☐ **6.10**
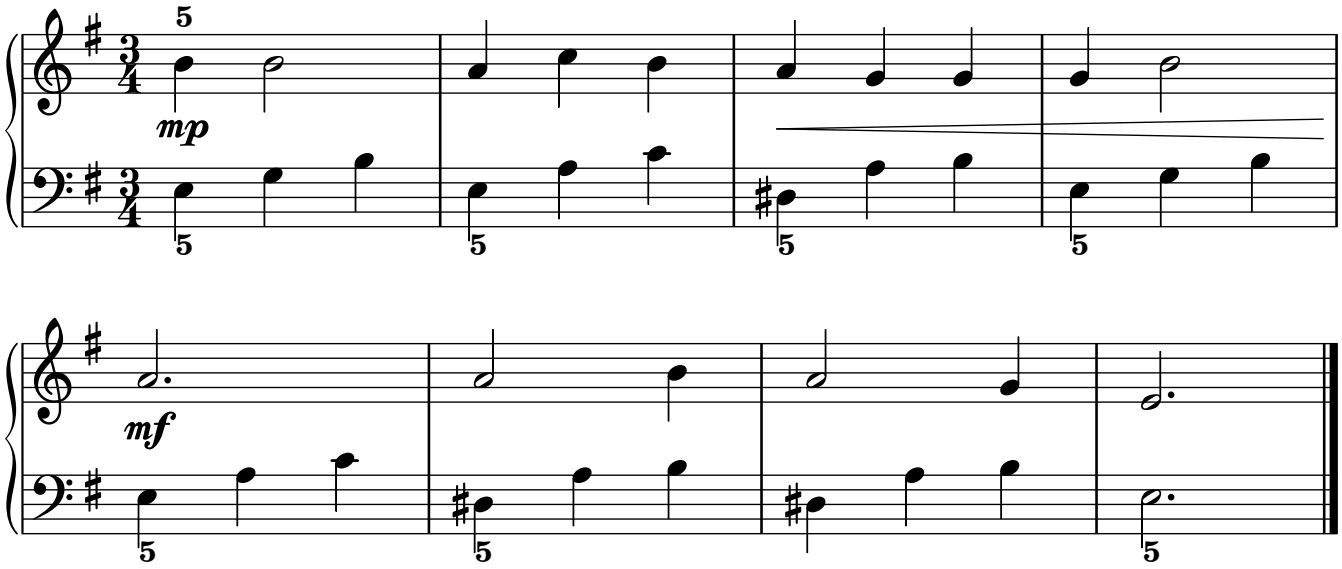


6.11
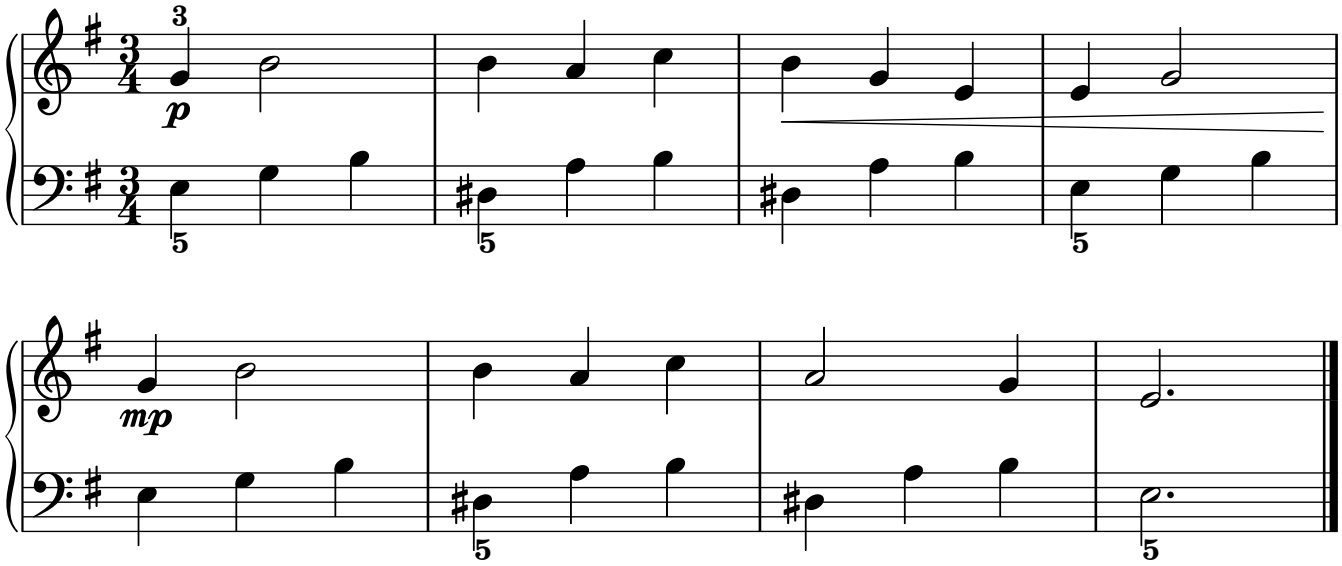


6.12



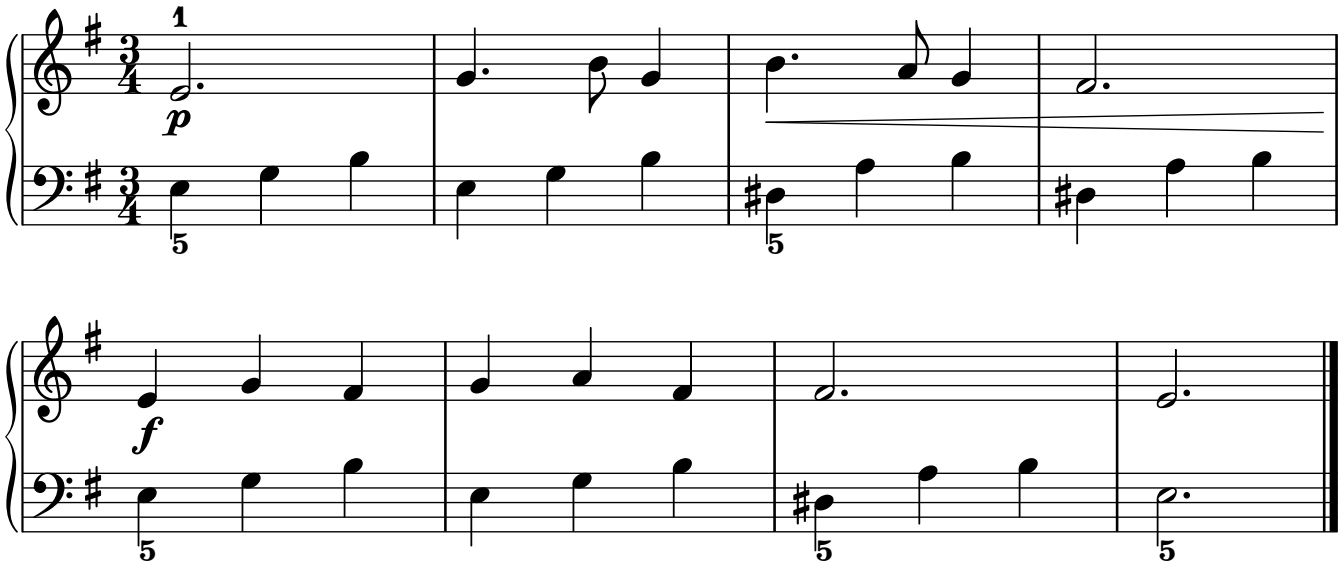
6.13
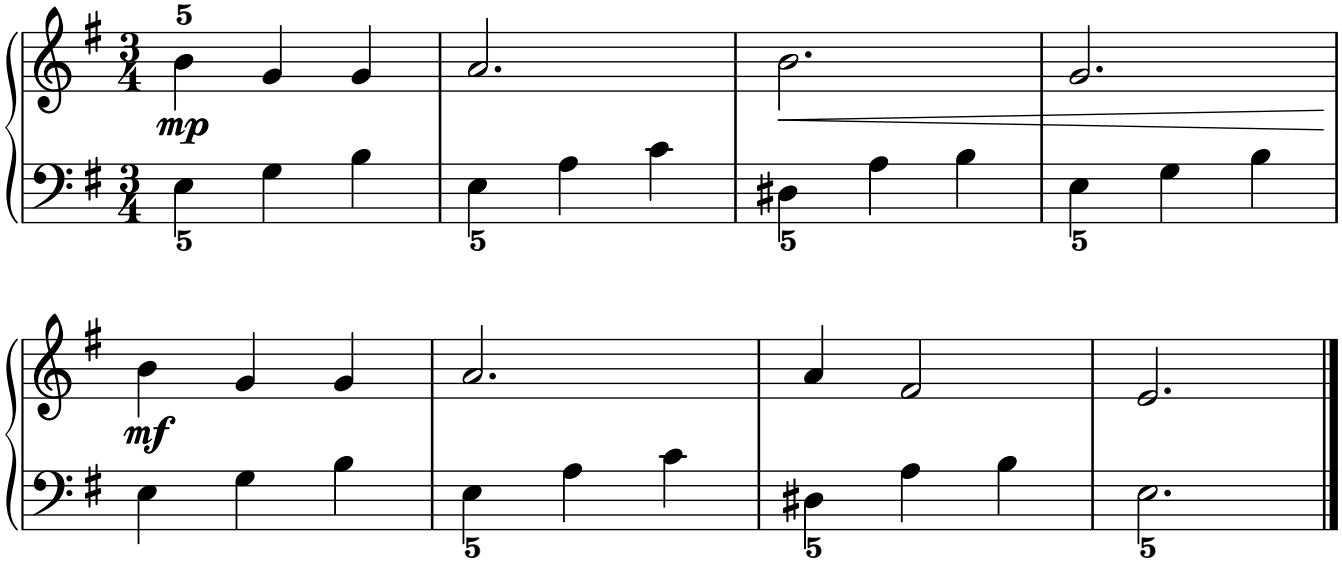


6.14



6.15



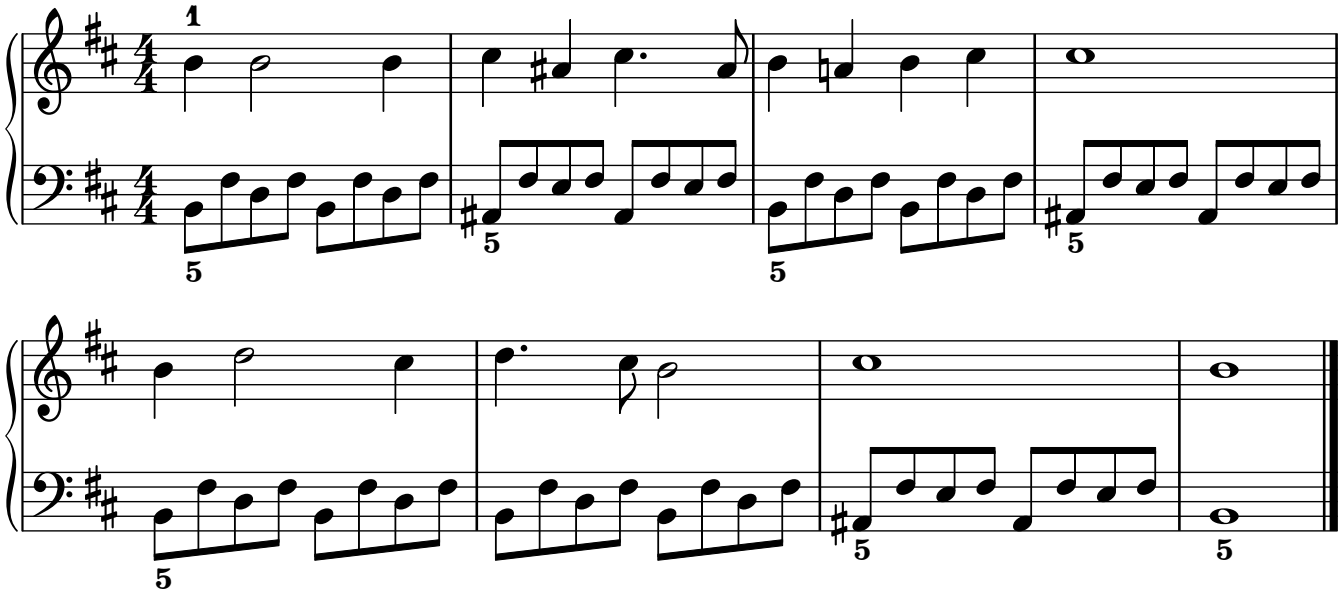
6.16
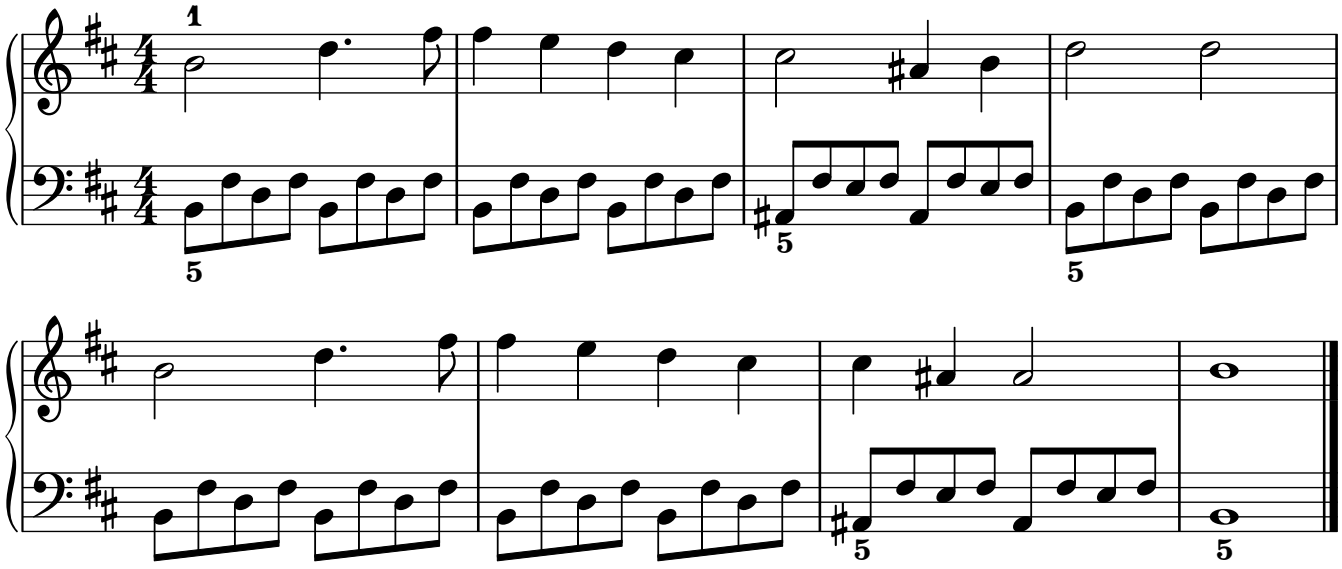


Part C: B minor: A-sharp ♩ = 60

B minor with an Alberti bass. Two sharps in the key signature, and A-sharp as an accidental.
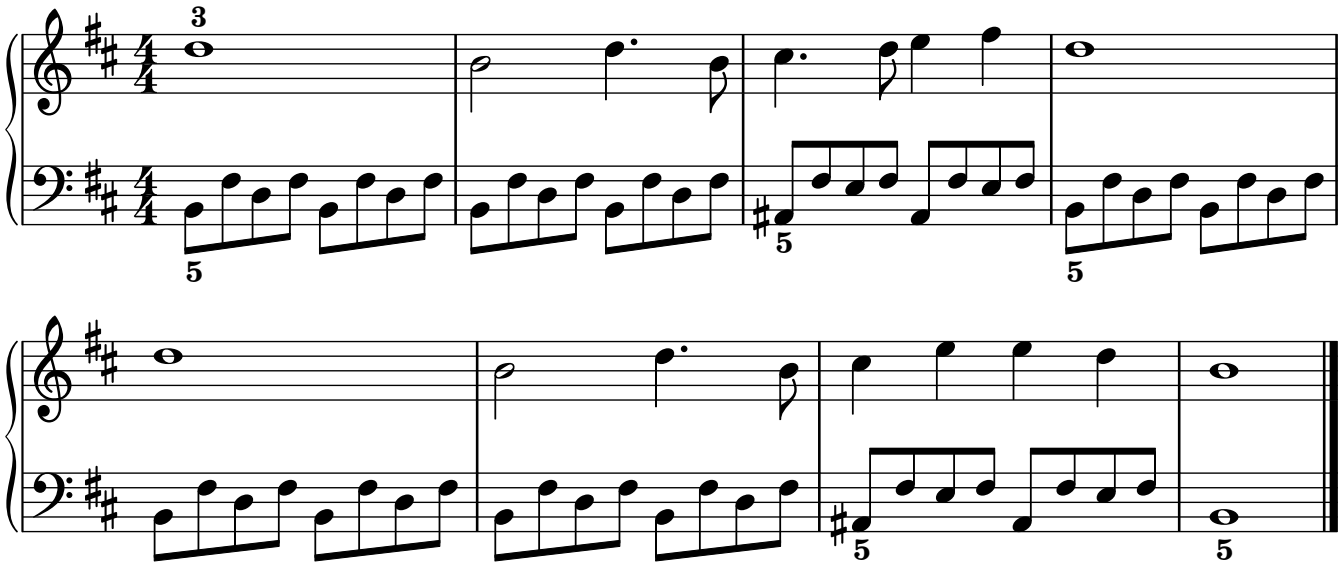
☐ **6.17**
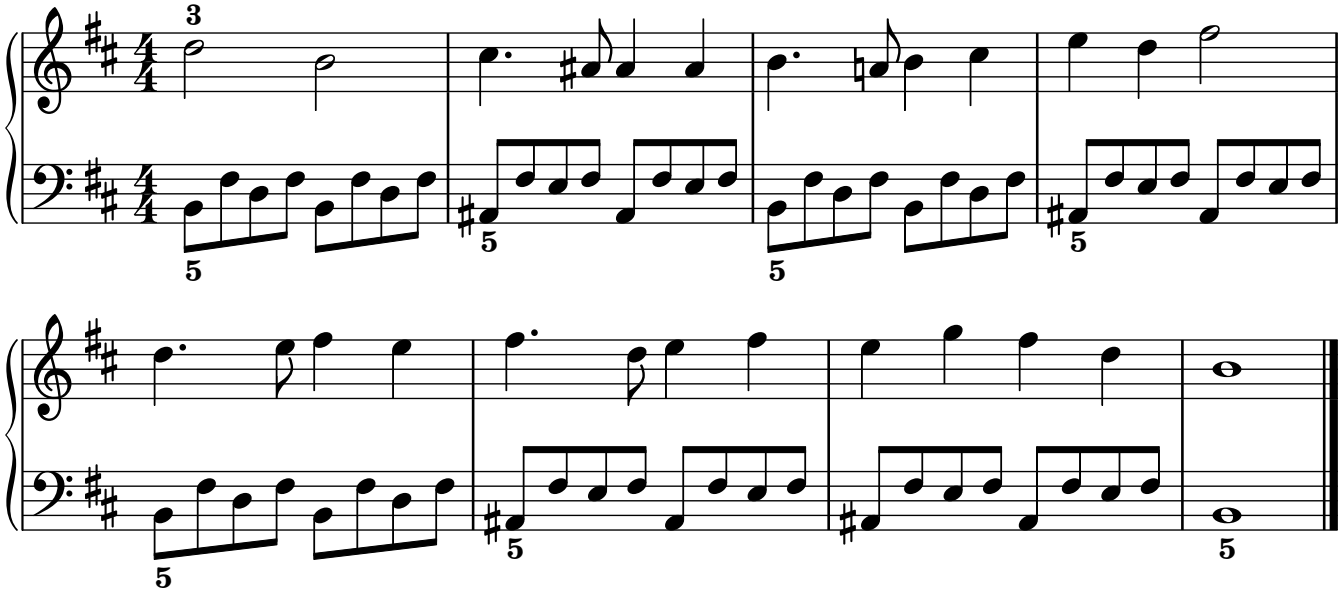


☐ **6.18**
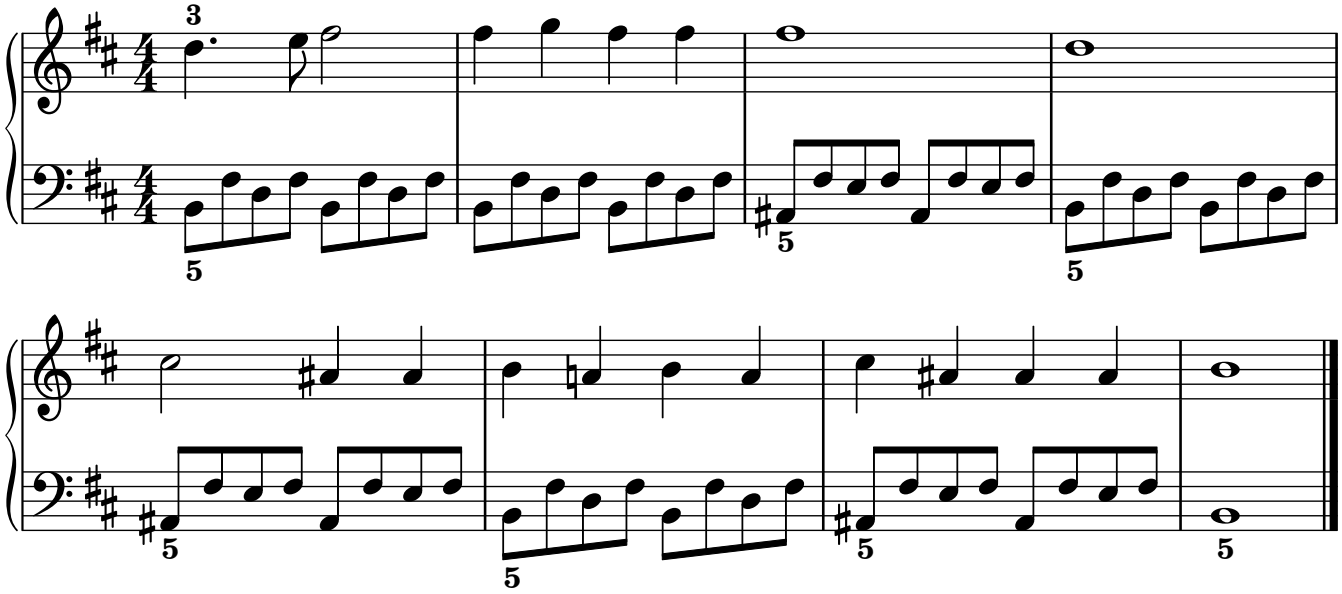


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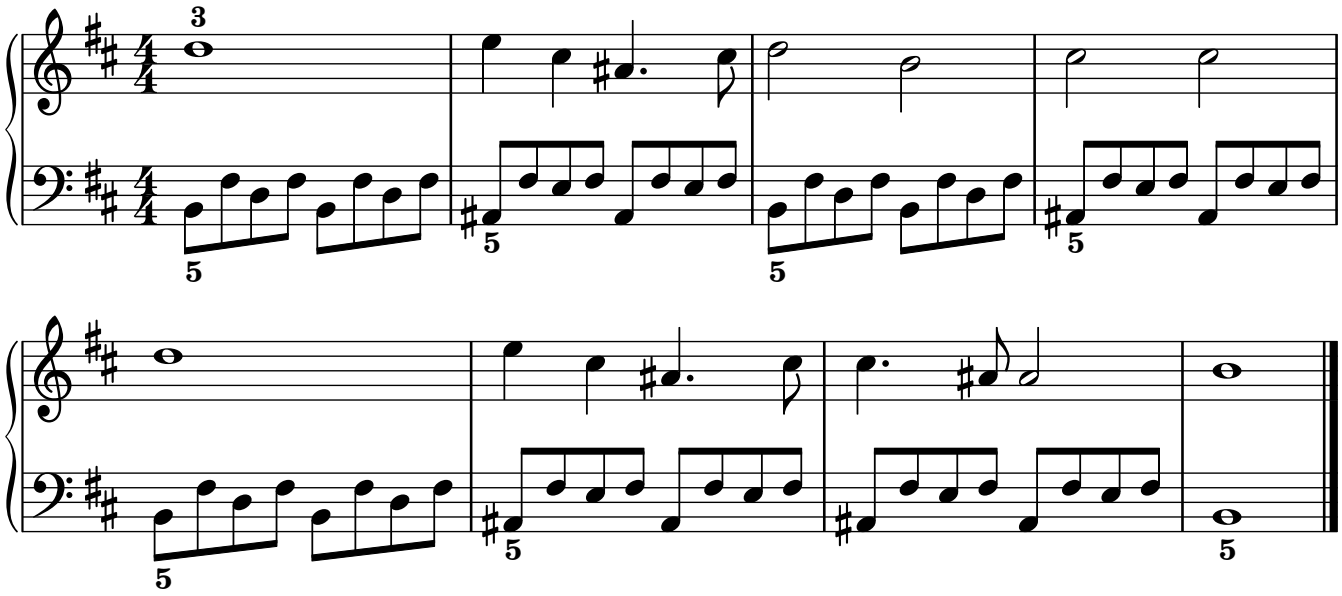


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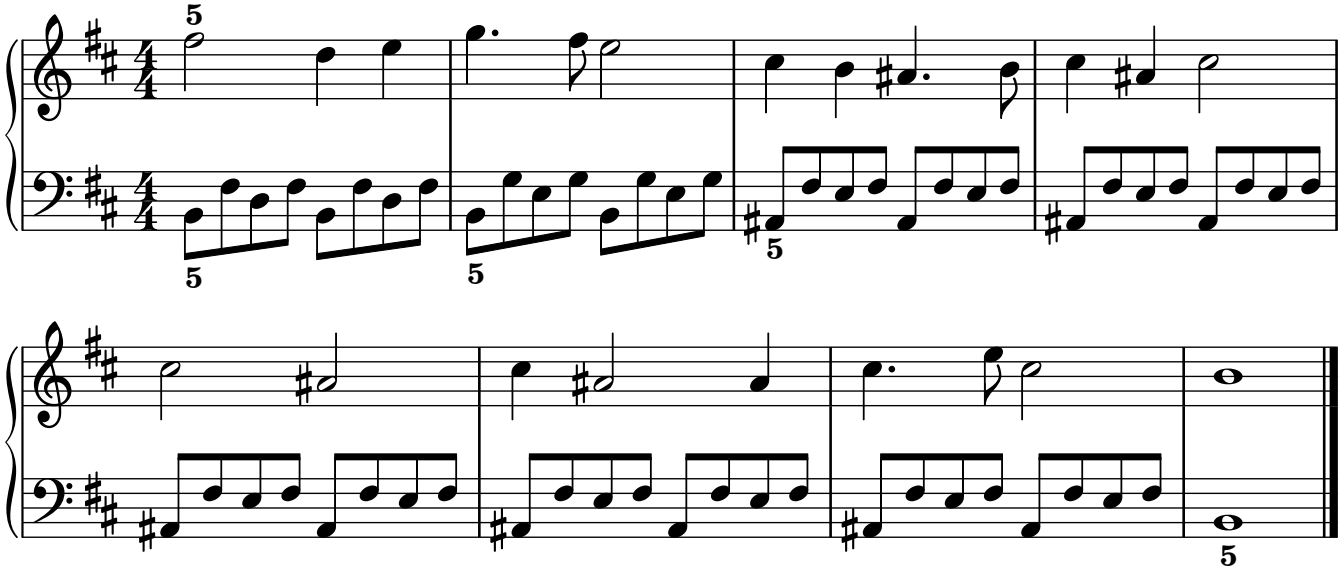


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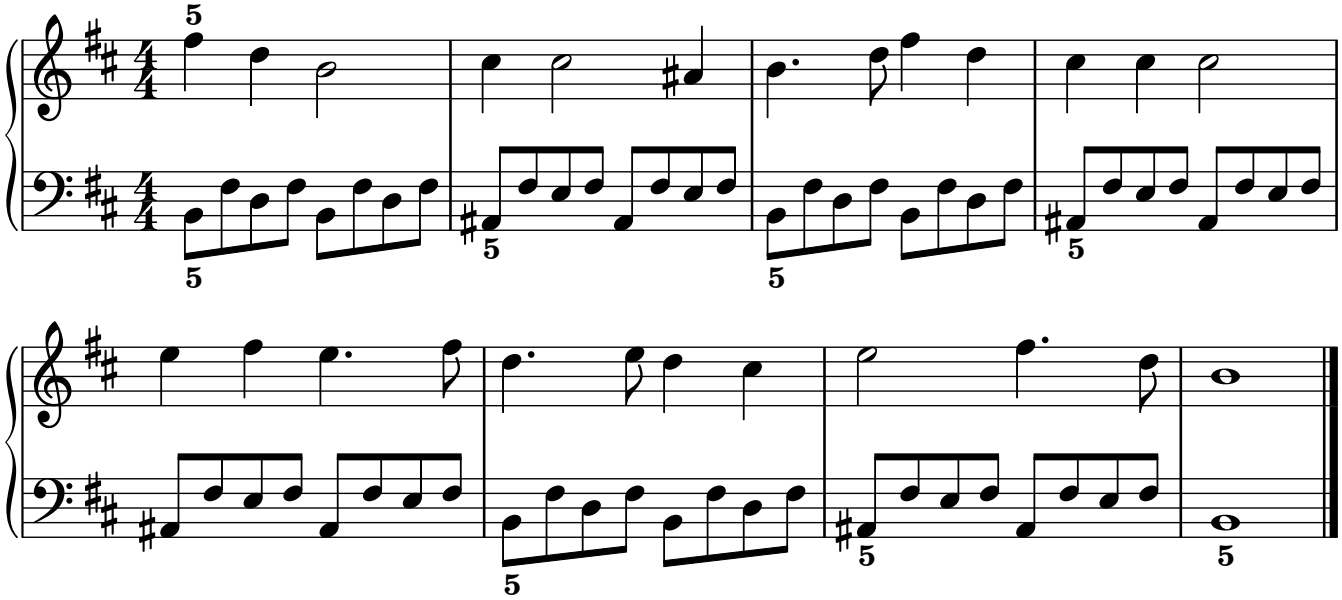


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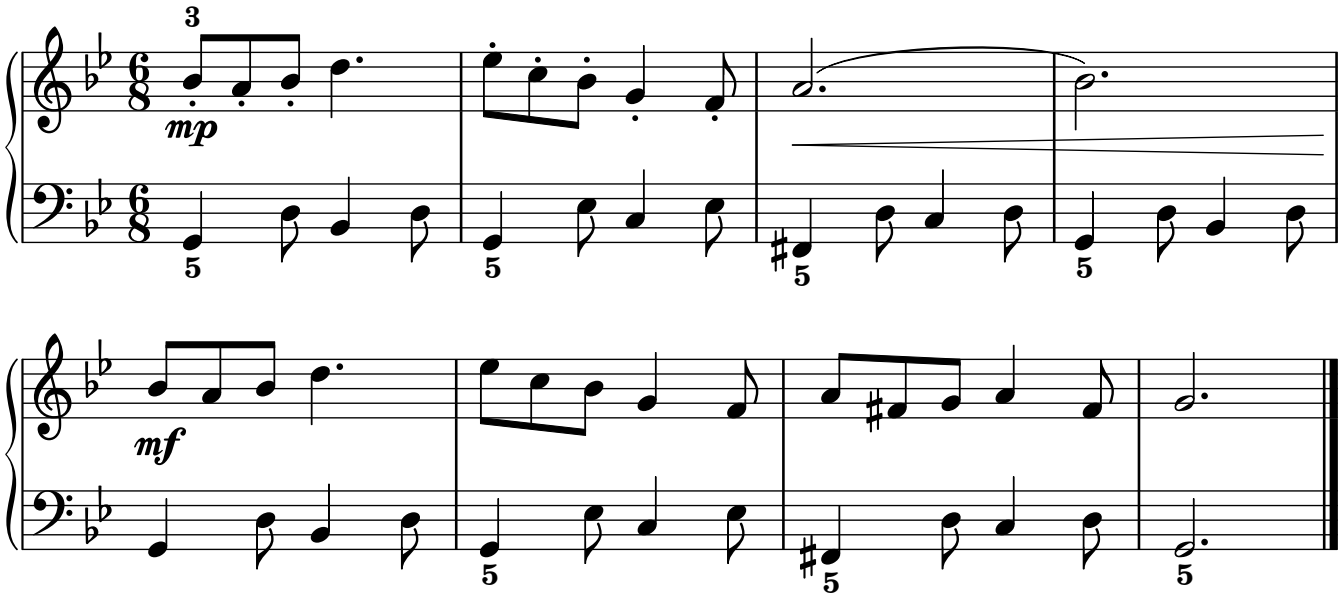


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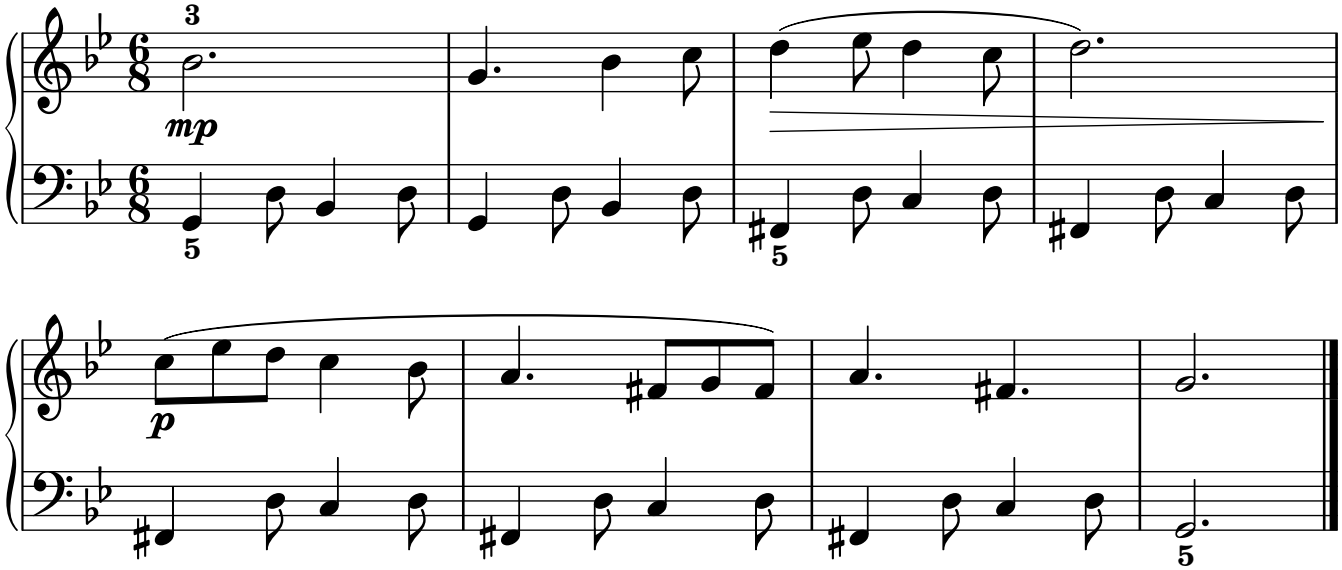


Part D: G minor: F-sharp ♩. = 50

G minor in 6/8. Two flats in the key signature, and F-sharp as an accidental.
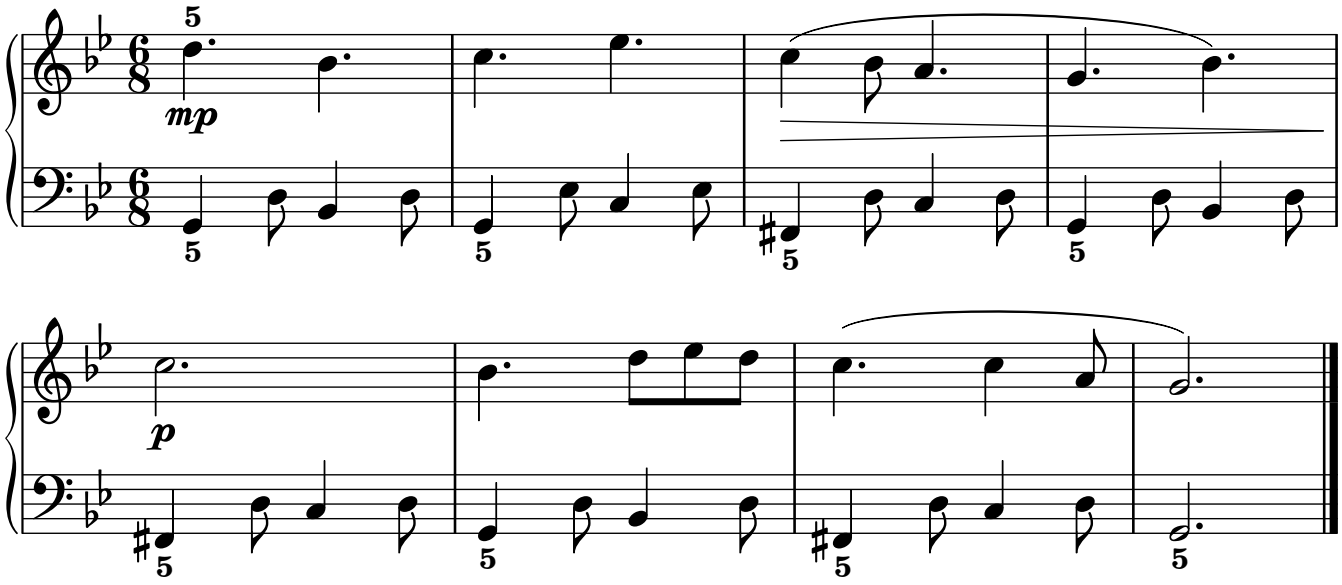
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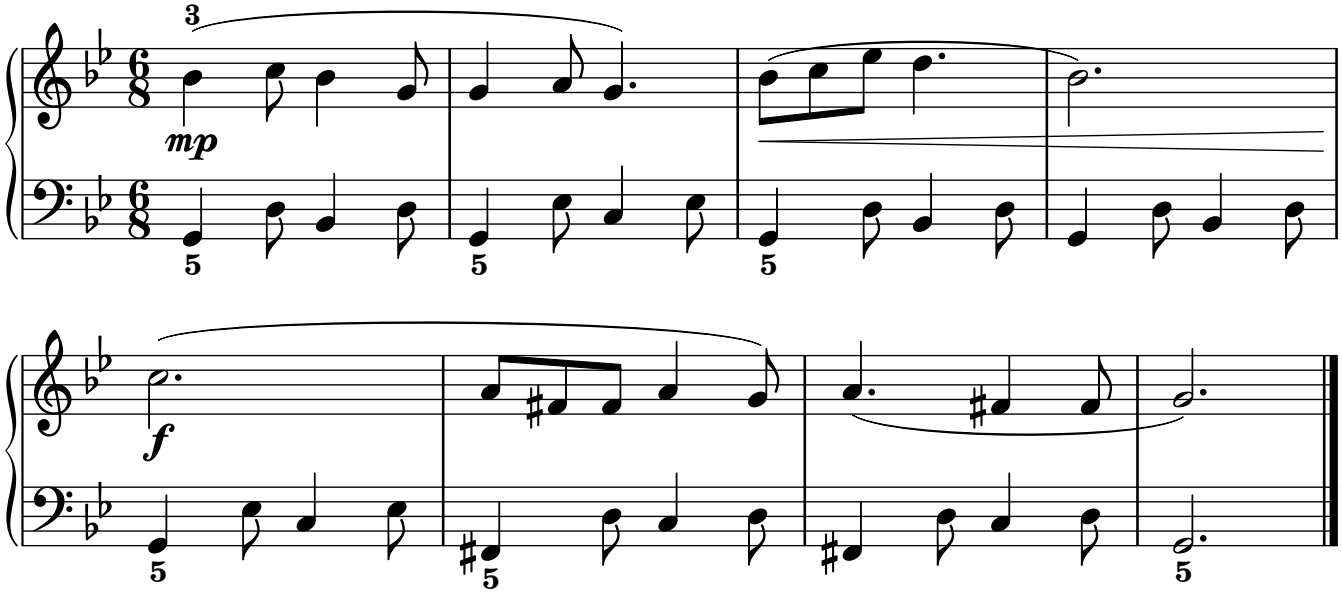


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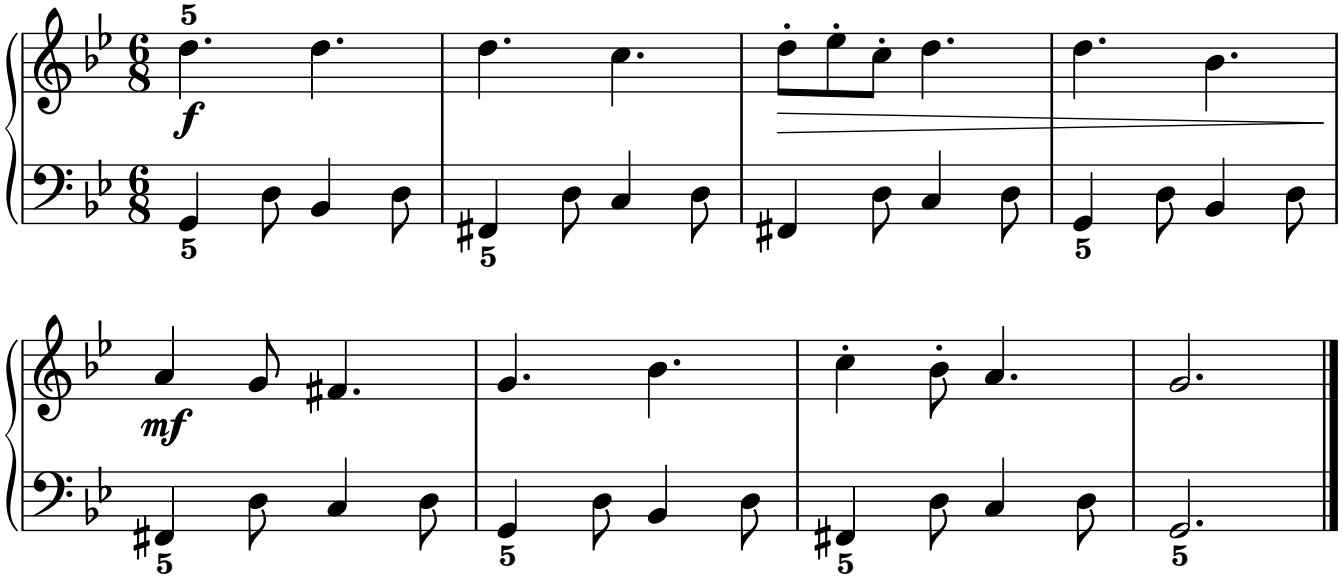


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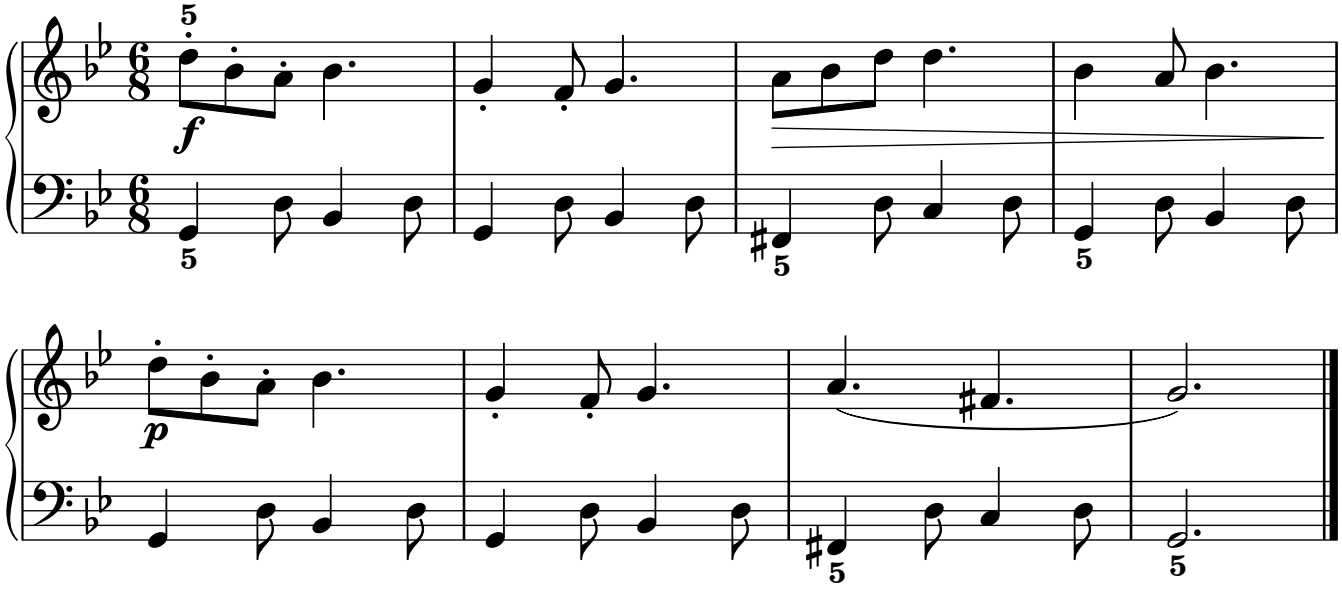


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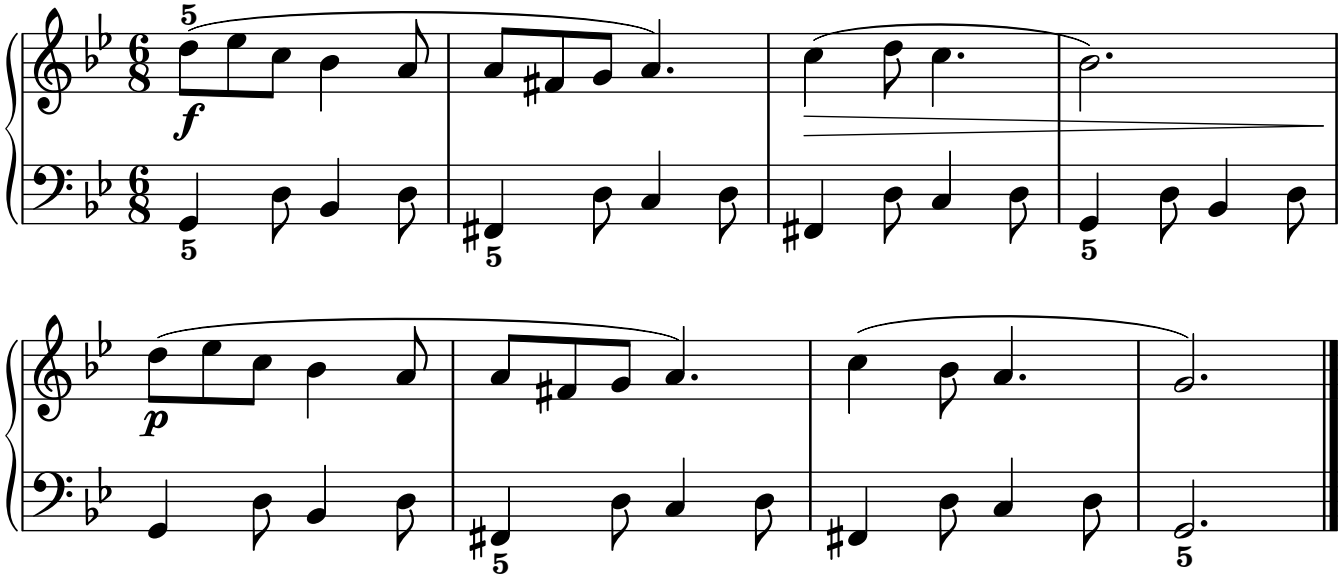


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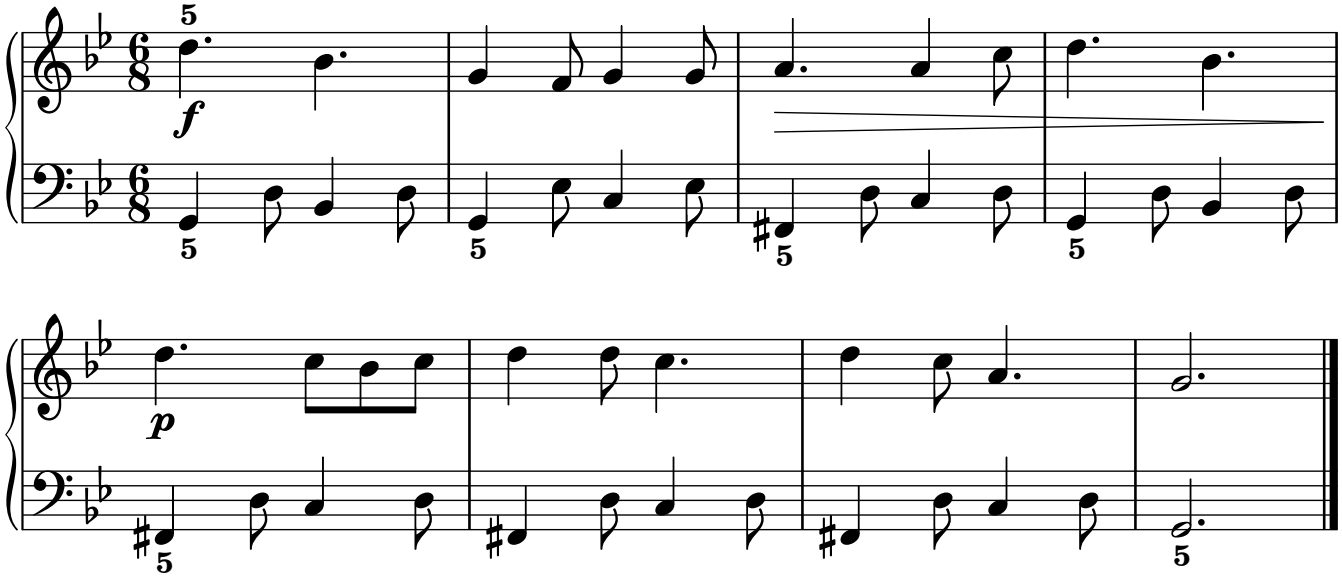


6.30



6.31



6.32
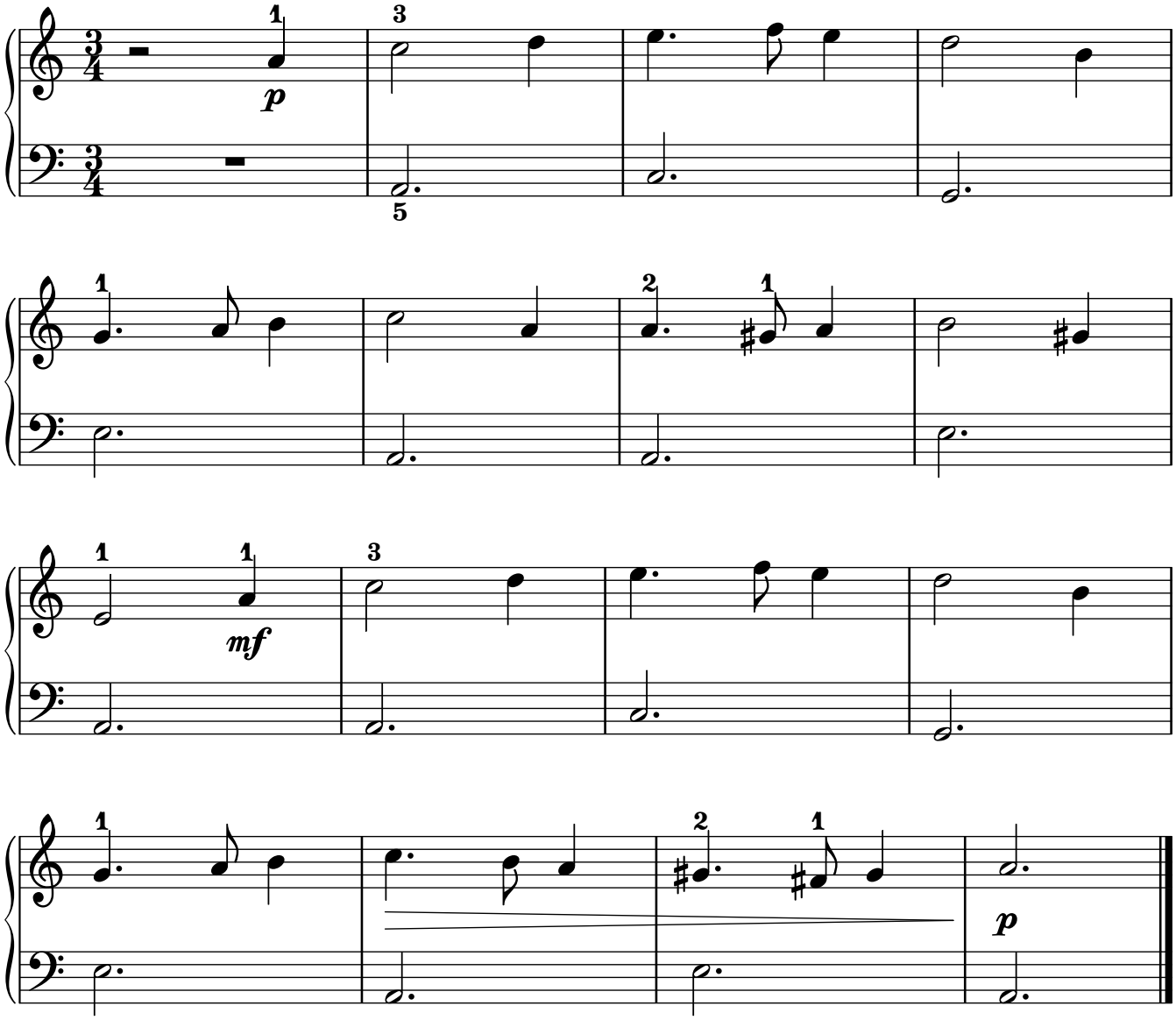


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Greensleeves ♩ = 76

Traditional English tune (16th century) - simplified
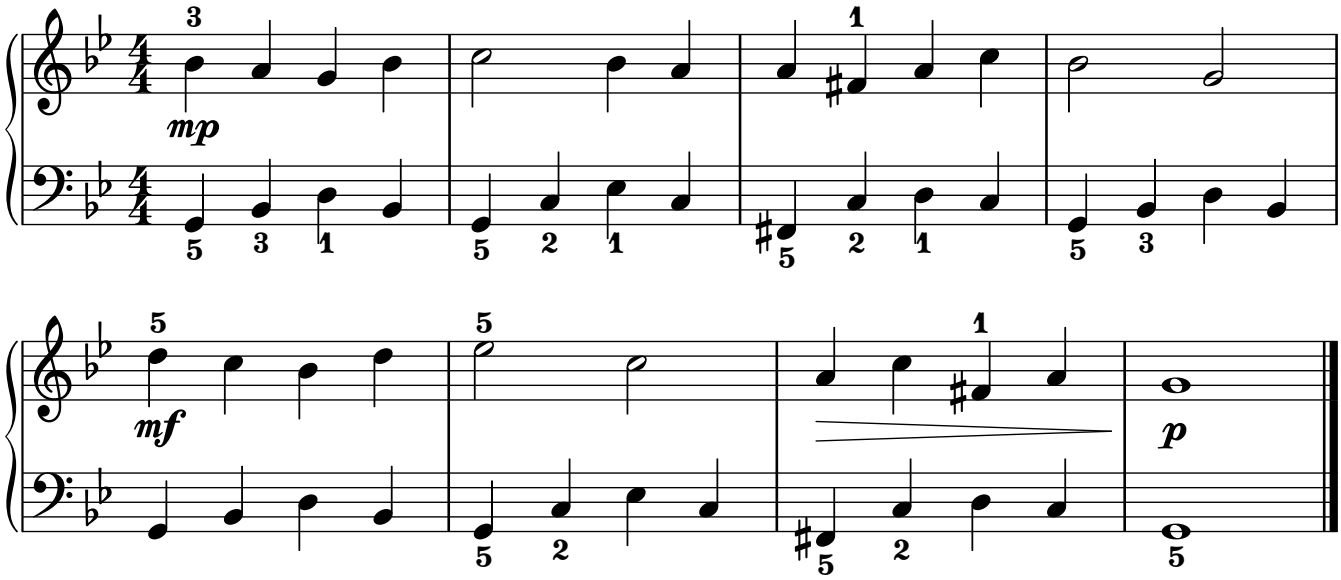
The tune uses G and G-sharp: G in bars 4 and 12, G-sharp (with F-sharp) in bars 6, 7 and 14. Each sharp lasts only to the end of its bar. The right hand stays near A position; the thumb moves down for the low E in bar 8 and the F-sharp in bar 14.



Song in G minor ♩ = 72

Original
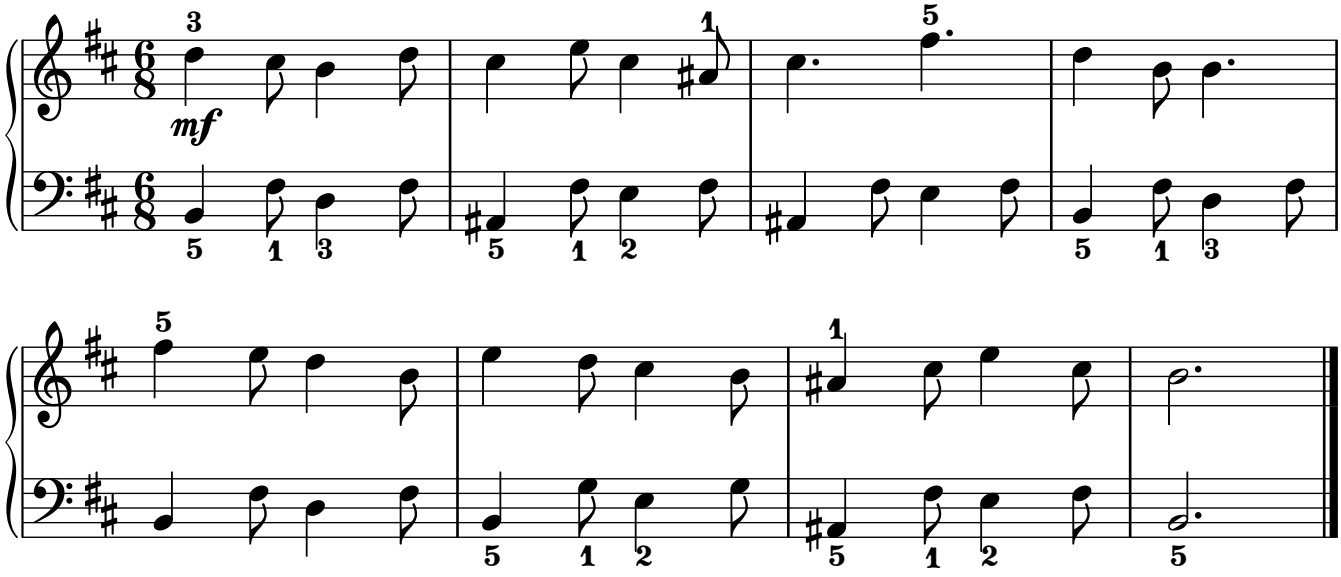
Two flats in the key signature and an F-sharp in every V7 bar, in both hands. In bar 6 the right hand stretches finger 5 up to E-flat.



Dance in B minor ♩. = 56

Original

A-sharp is the raised 7th of B minor. The right-hand thumb stretches down to it in bars 2 and 7, and it is the bottom note of the left hand's V7 shape.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 7?

- Play five new exercises from Parts B to D at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every raised 7th is played sharp, and the same note in the next bar goes back to the key signature.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 7.

Unit 7

Two Notes at Once

New: Right-hand thirds and sixths: reading two notes together

So far the right hand has played one note at a time. Now it plays two together. Two notes a third apart look like a little snowman on the staff: both on lines or both in spaces, one just above the other. Read the top note as the tune, and let the lower note come along with it.

What is new

Thirds

Line-line or space-space, touching: C-E, D-F, E-G. In a five-finger position you play them with fingers 1-3, 2-4 or 3-5.

Sixths

Further apart: one note on a line and the other in a space, with two lines between them, such as C-A or D-B. The hand stretches: thumb on the lower note, finger 5 on the upper one.

Which note is the tune?

The top note. Play it a little louder than the lower note, so the melody still sings.

Reading two notes

Don't read the two notes separately. Read the top note, then recognise the shape below it: a third (touching) or a sixth (wide).
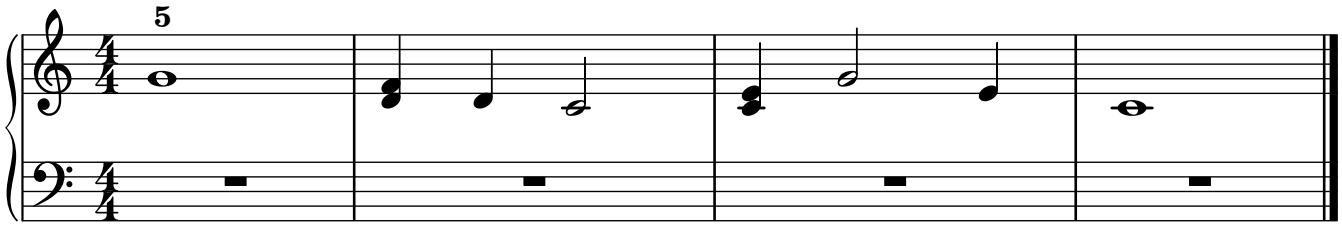
Reading tips

1. In your scan, find the two-note chords and decide which fingers will play each one.
2. Keep both notes exactly together: drop the hand, not two separate fingers.
3. If a two-note chord trips you up, play only its top note and keep going.

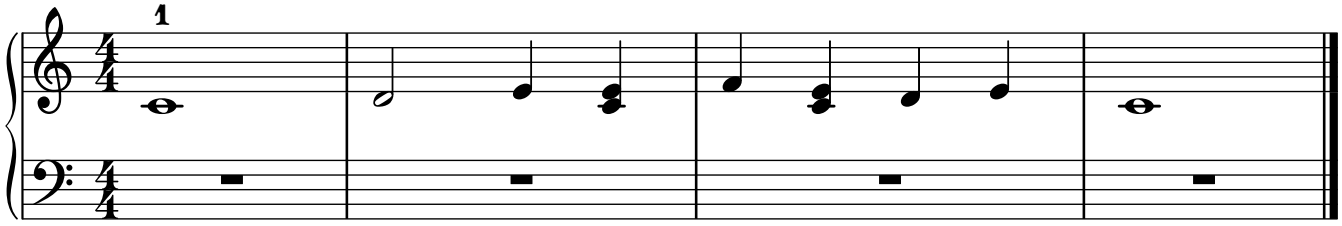
Part A: Thirds in the right hand ♩ = 56

Right hand alone in C position, with some thirds. Metronome 56.
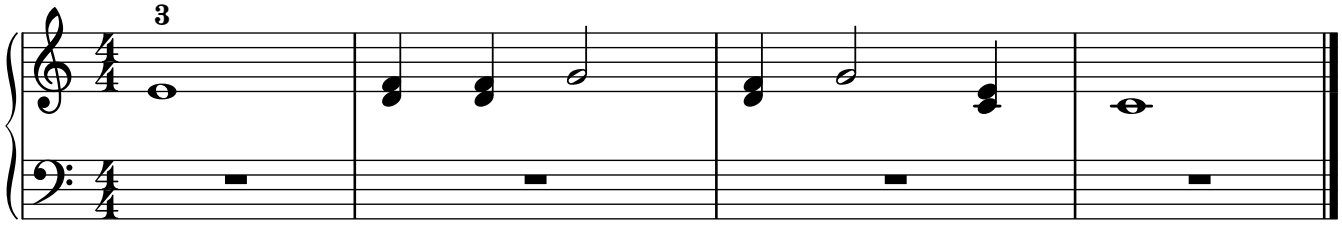
☐ **7.1**



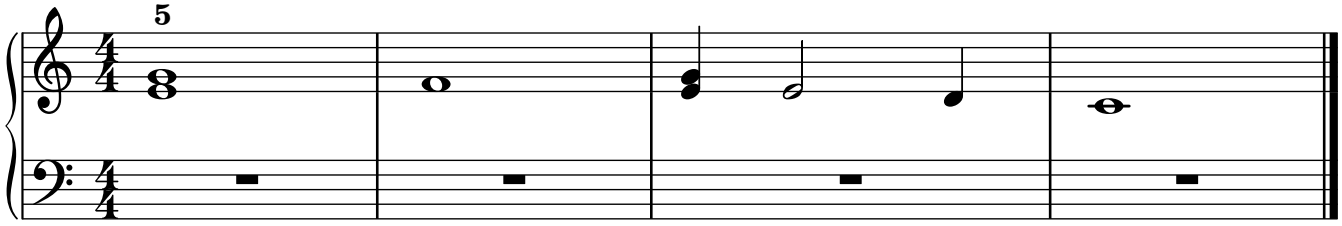
☐ **7.2**



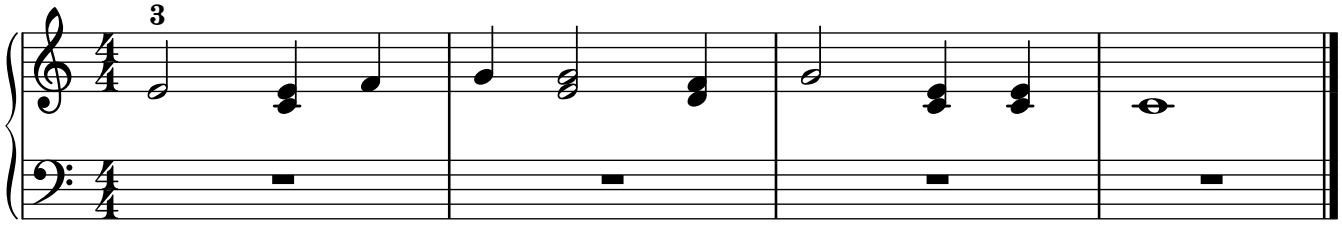
☐ **7.3**



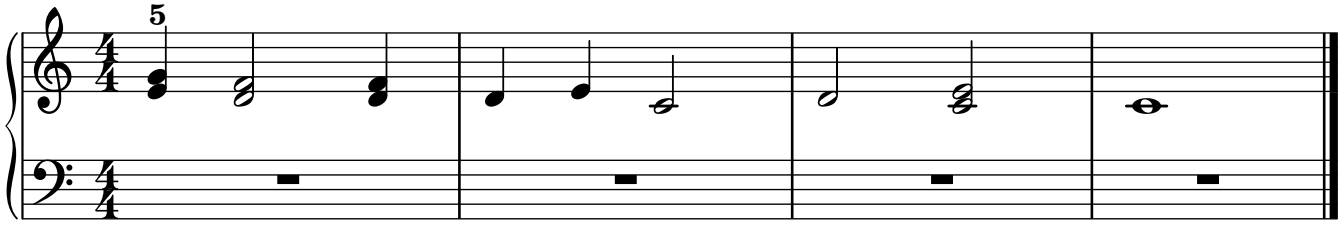
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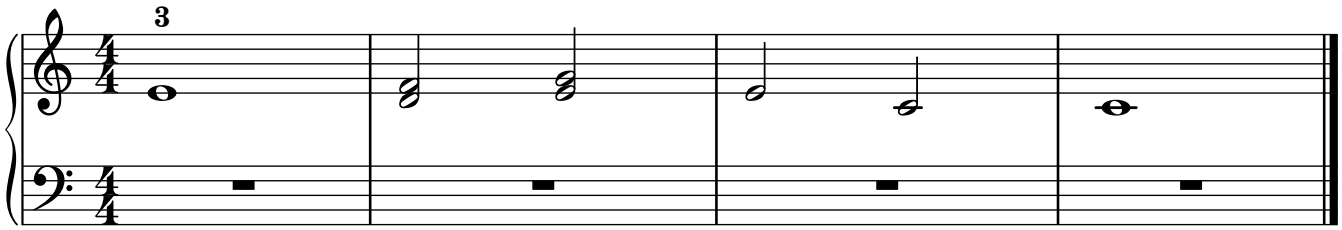


☐ **7.5**



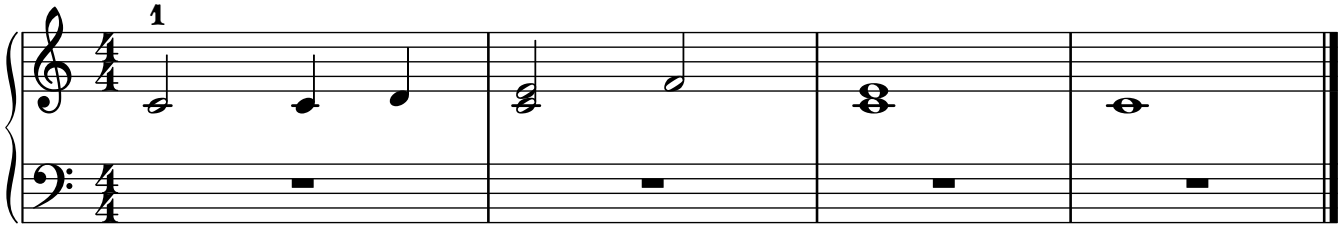
☐ **7.6**



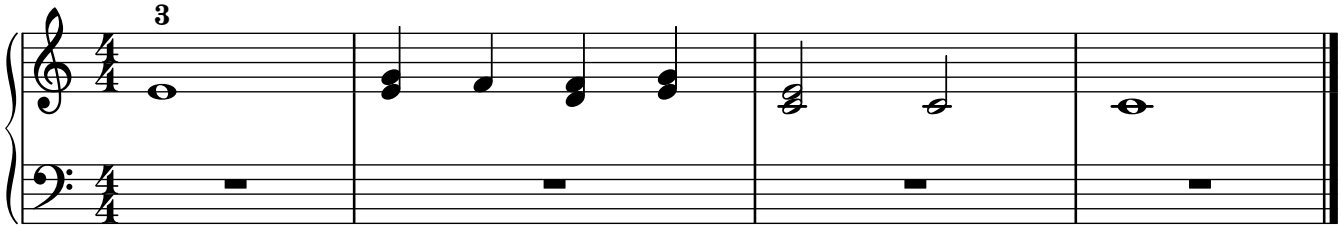
☐ **7.7**
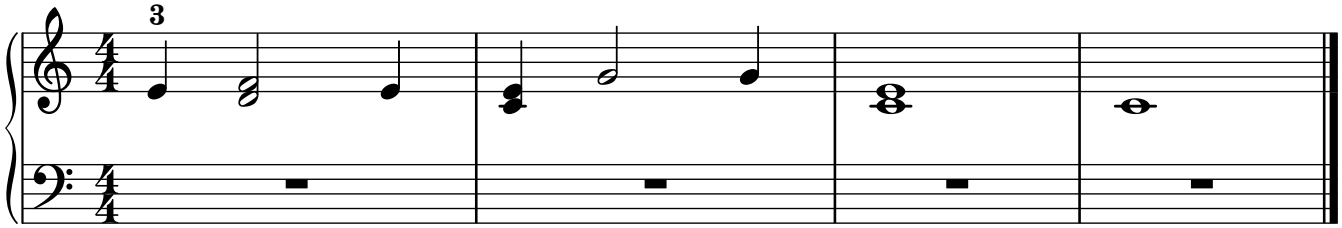


☐ **7.8**



☐ **7.9**



☐ **7.10**
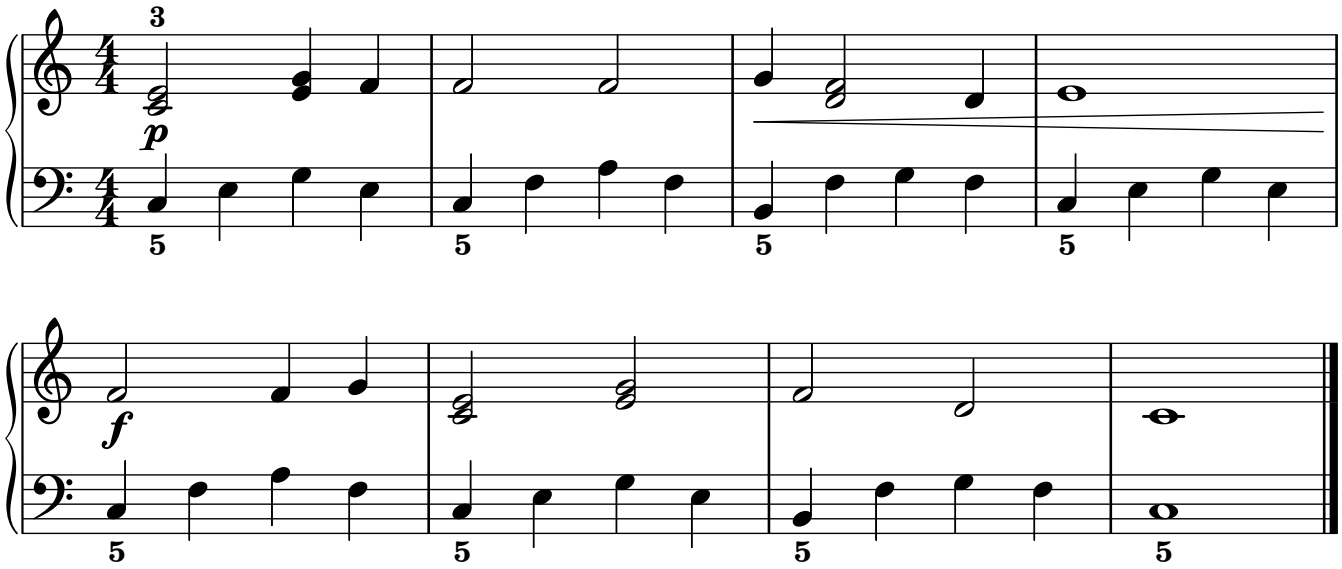


Part B: Thirds over broken chords
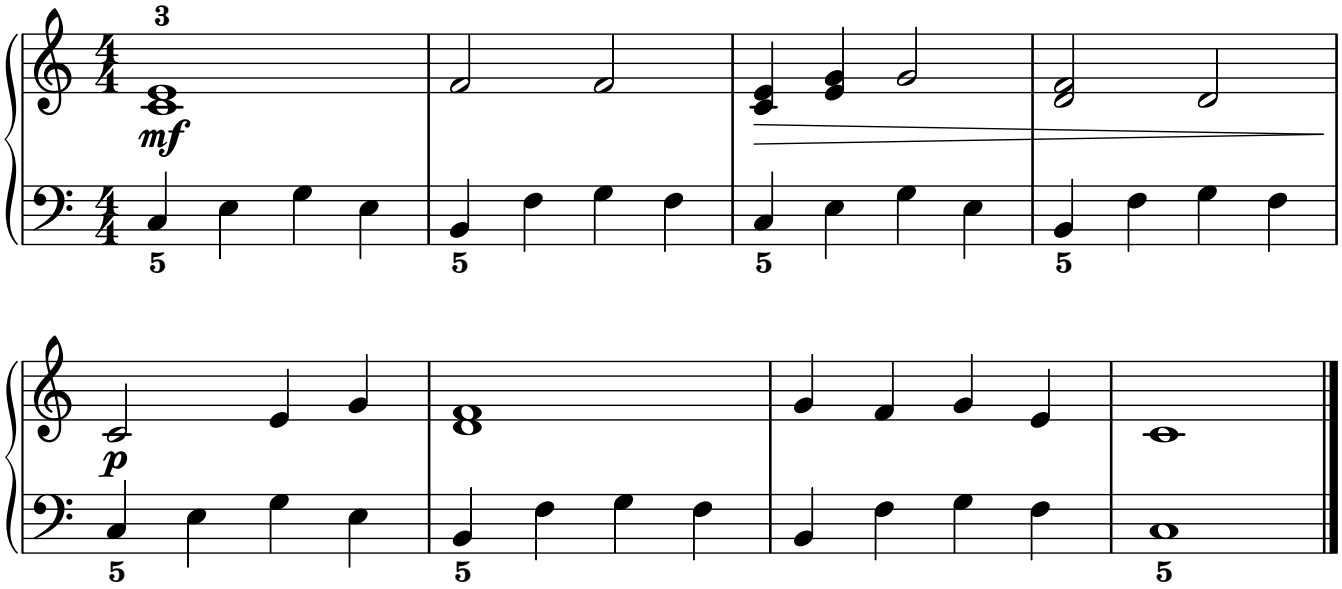
♩ = 60

Thirds over broken chords in C major.
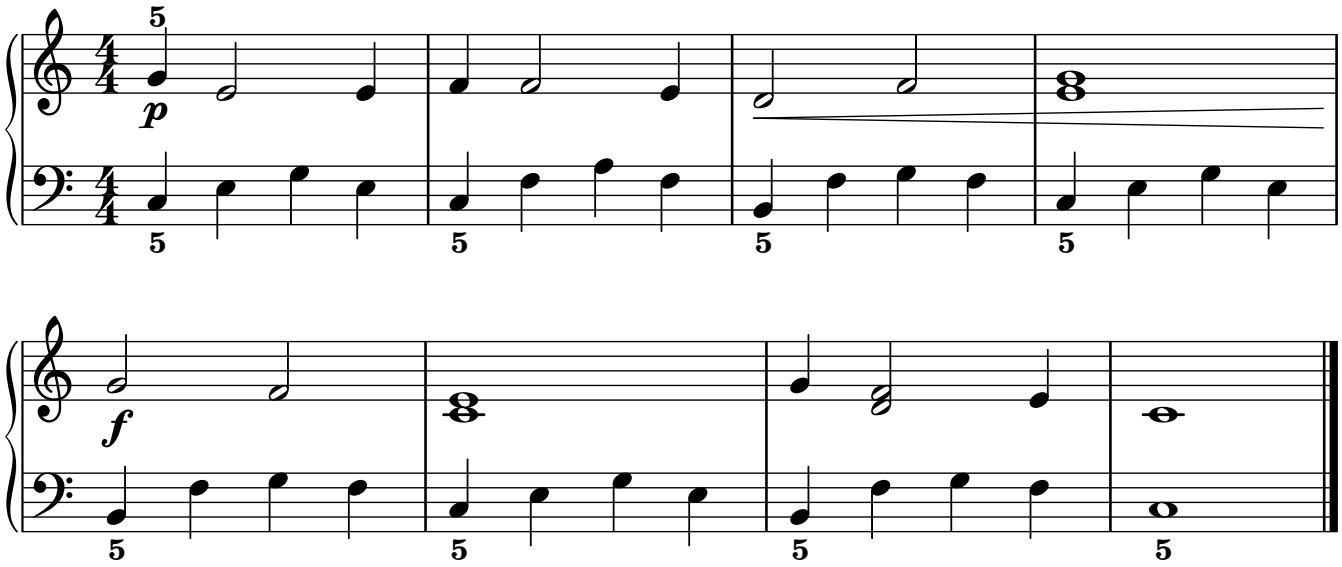
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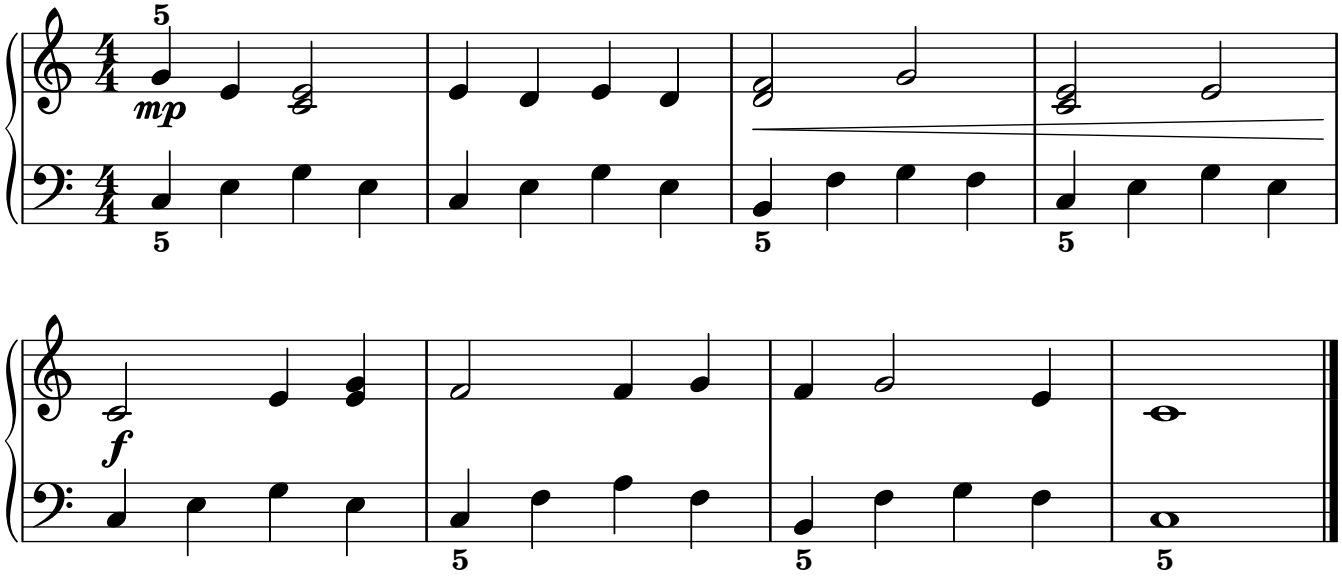


☐ **7.12**
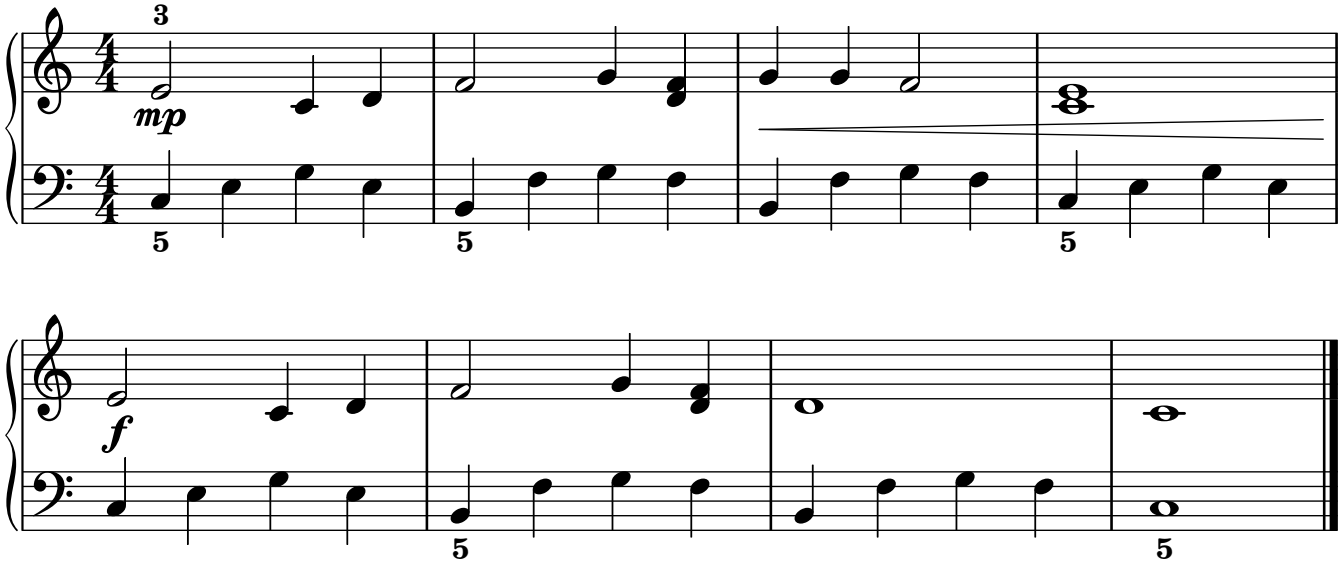


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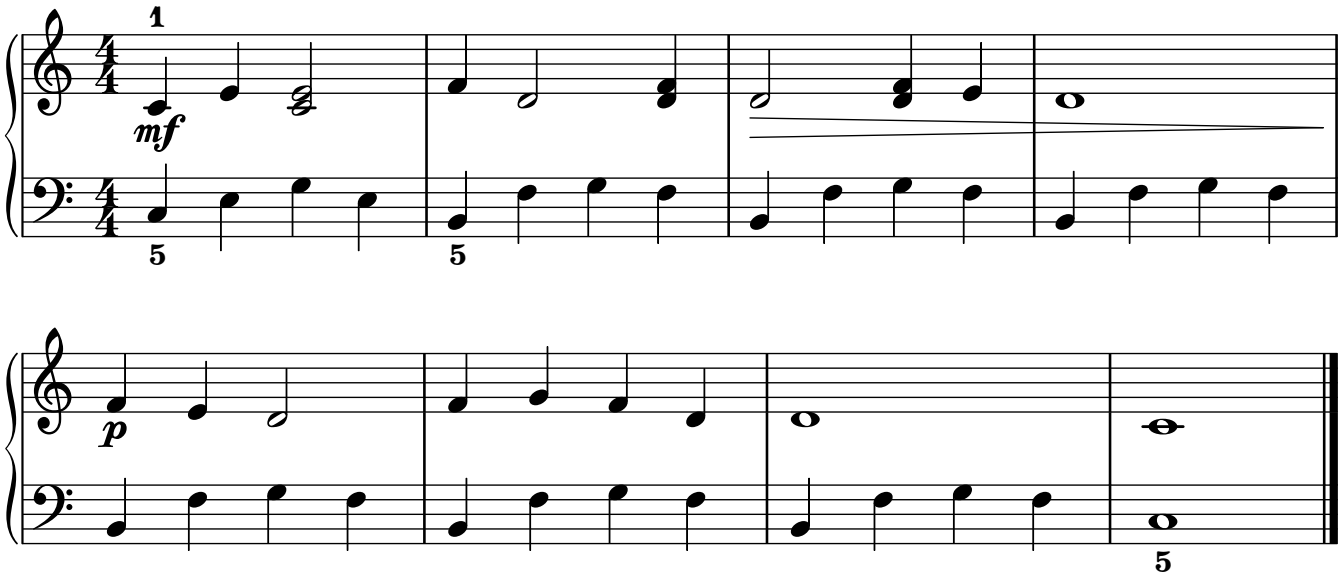


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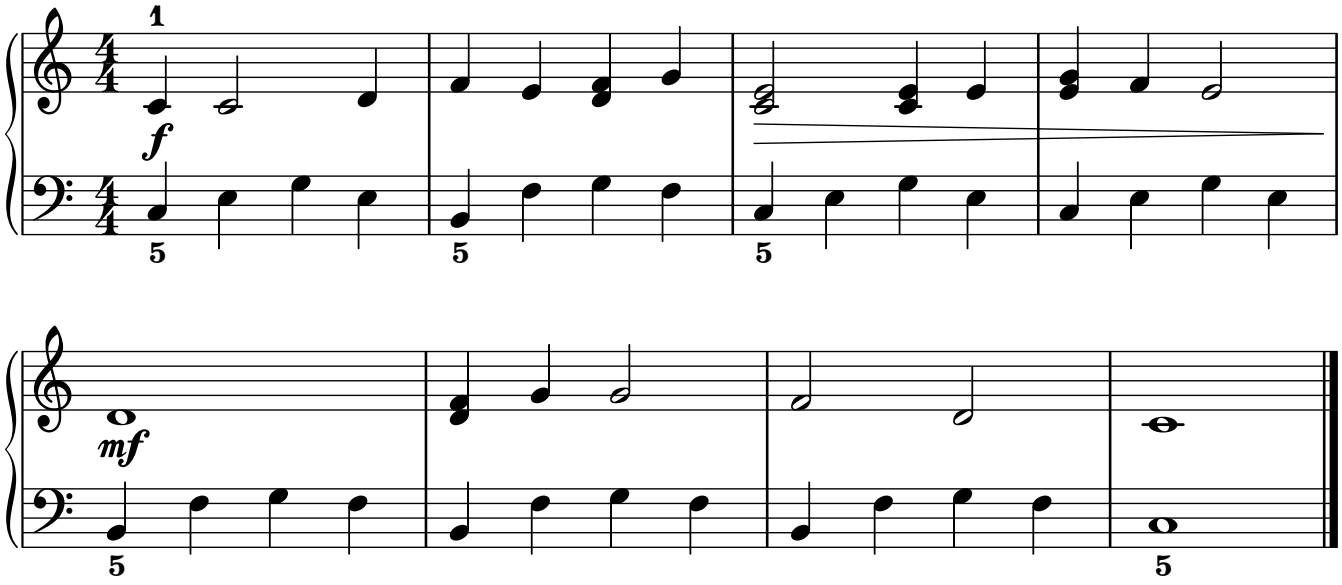


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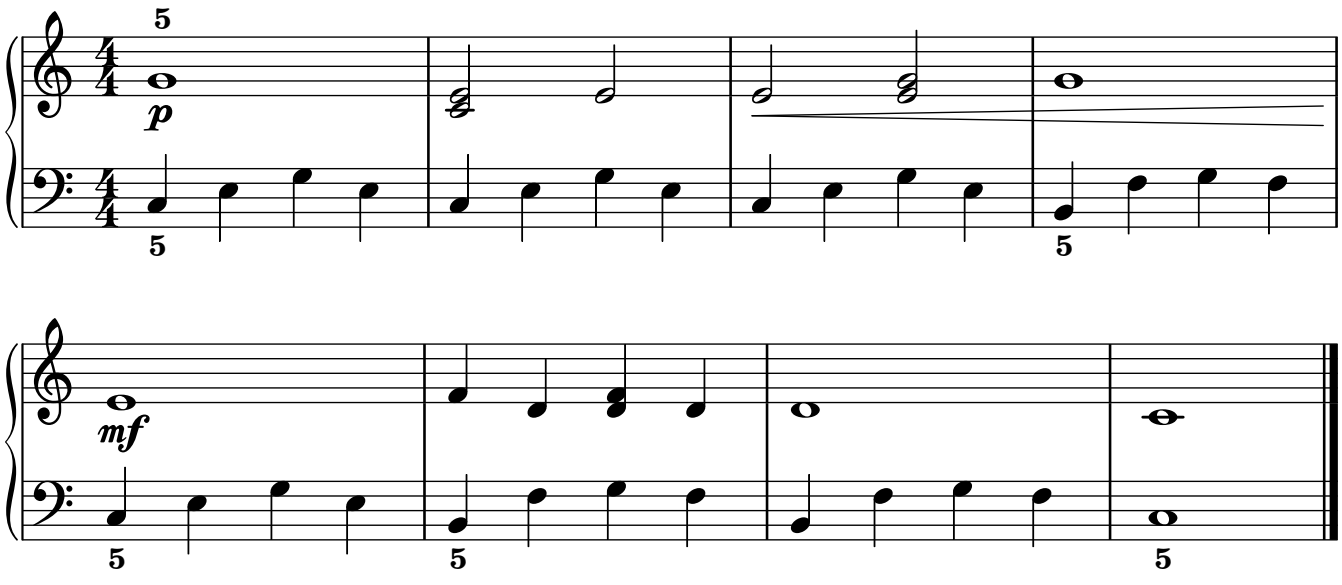


7.16



7.17



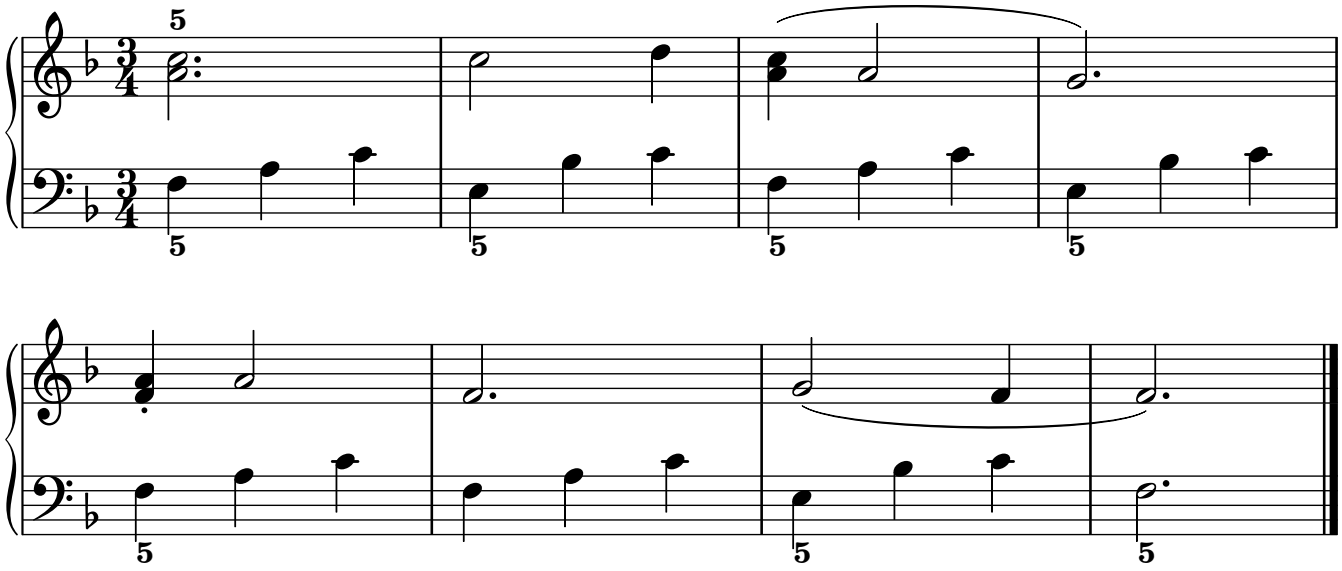
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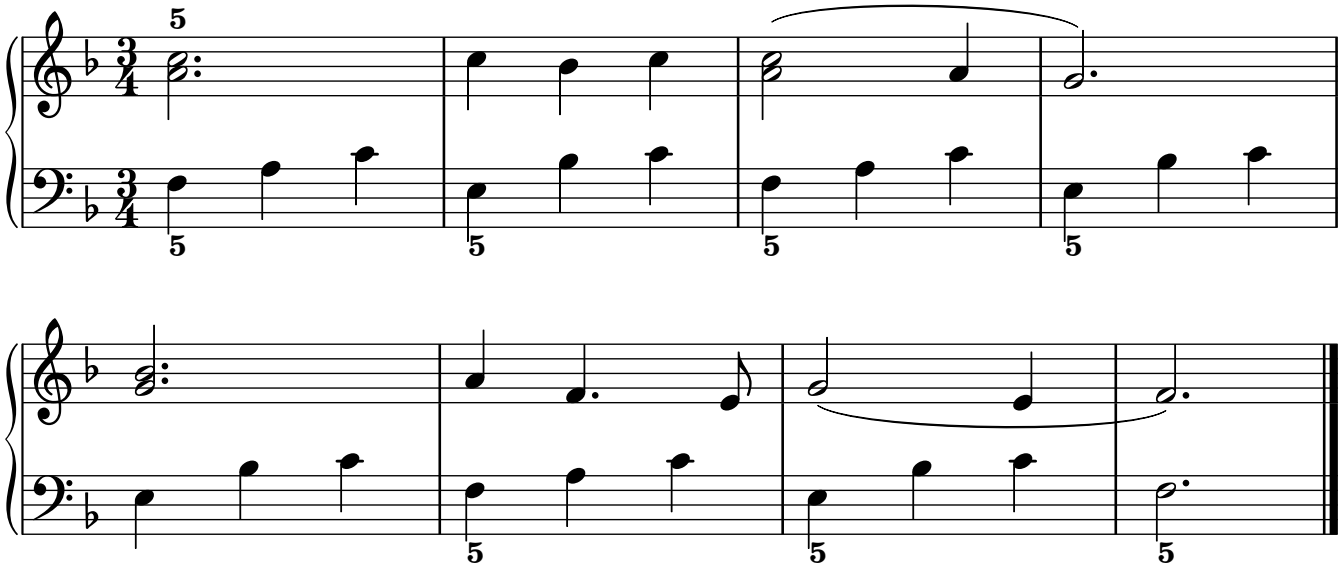
Part C: Thirds and sixths in F major ♩ = 69

F major in 3/4. The right hand stretches to E and D, which makes a few sixths possible.

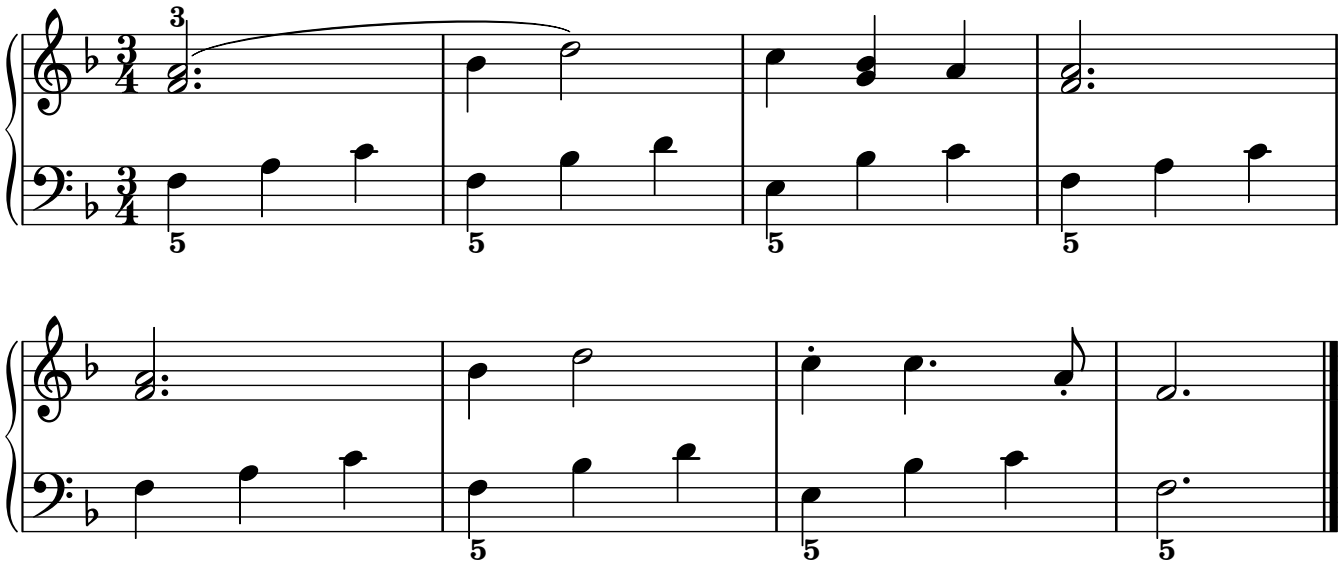
☐ **7.19**



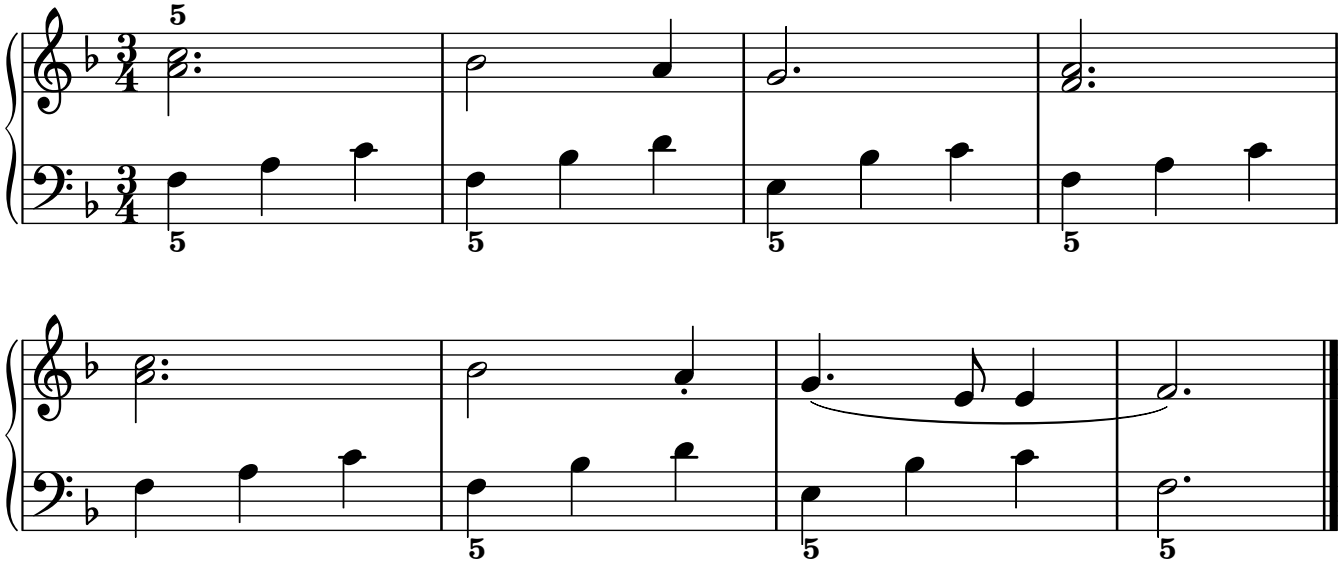
☐ **7.20**



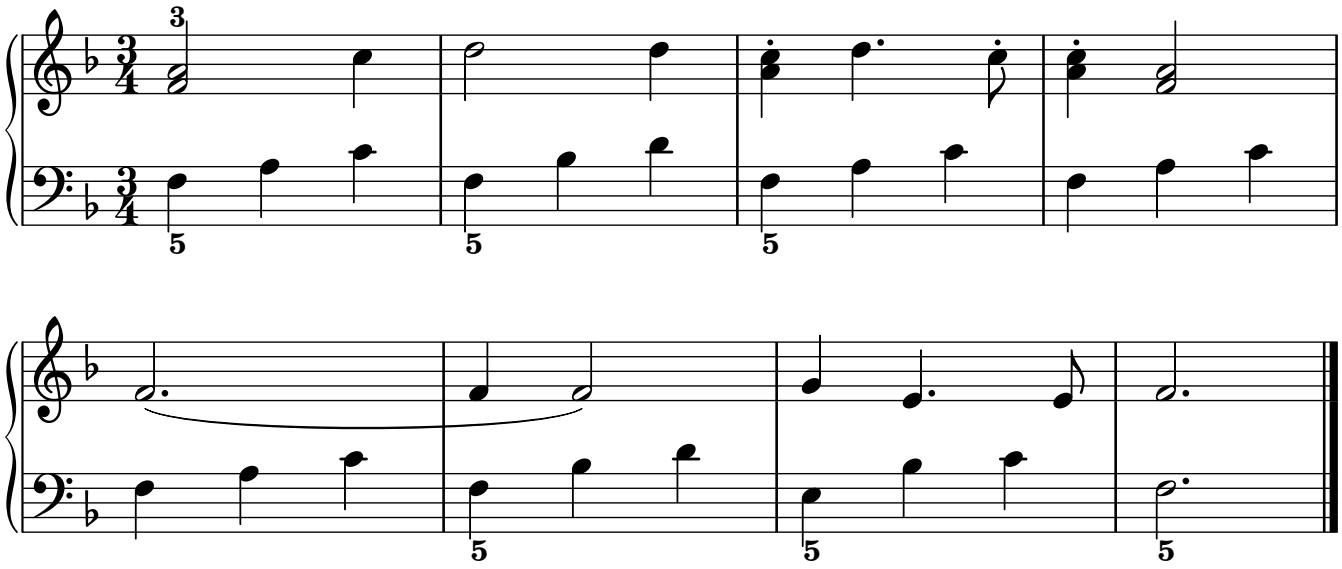
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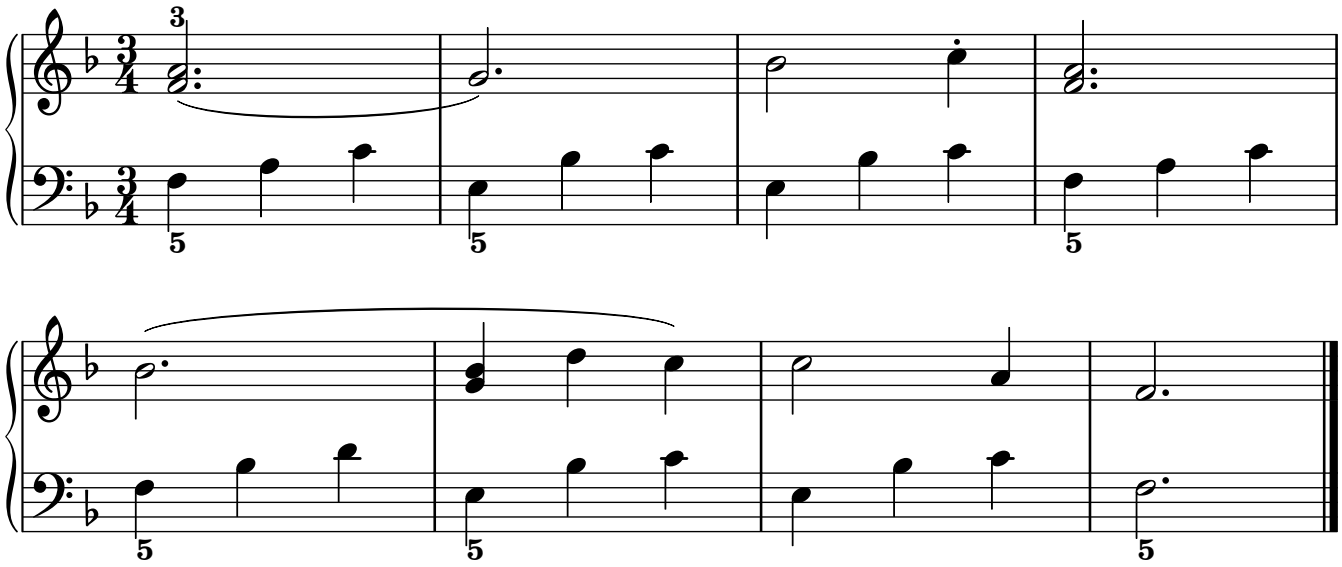
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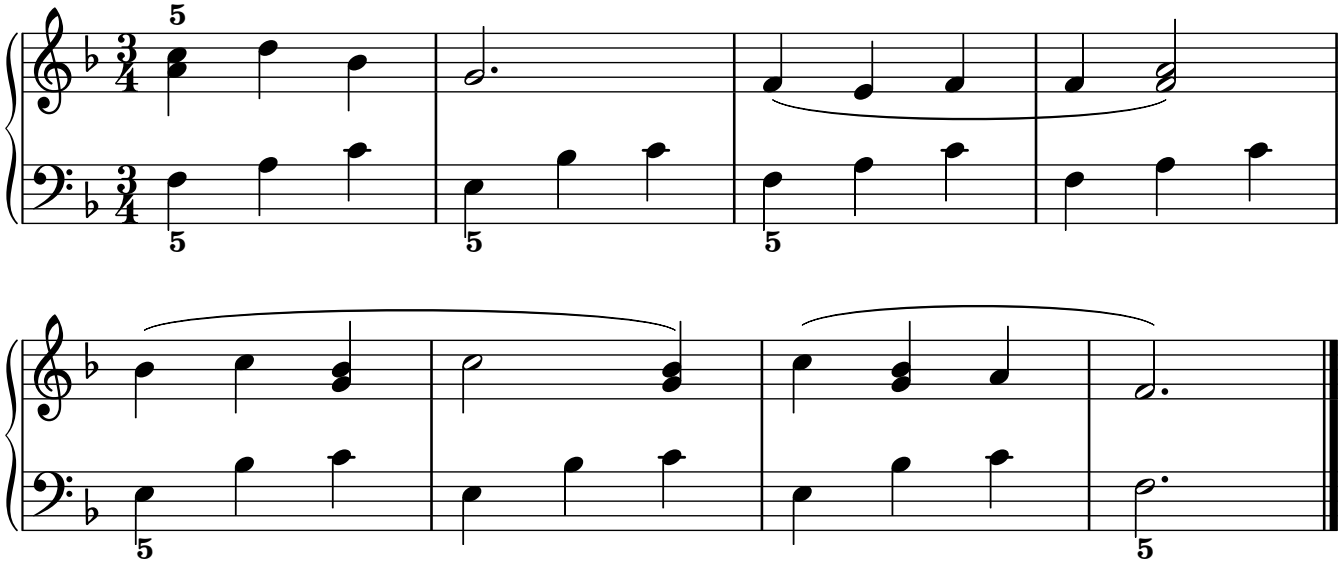
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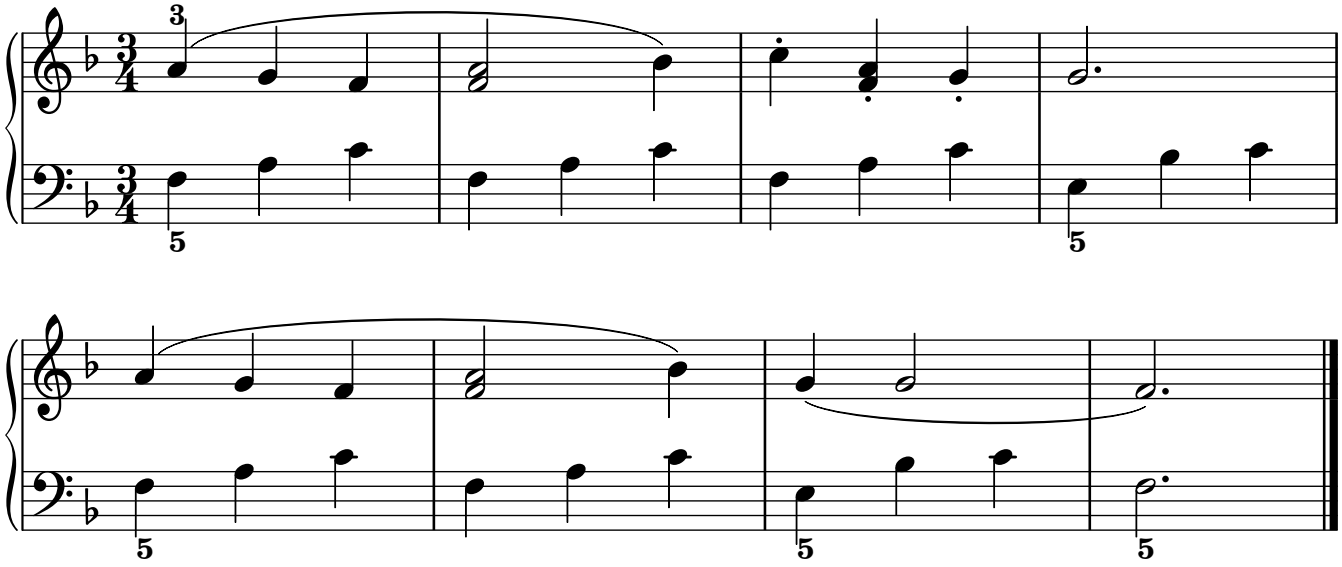
7.24



7.25



7.26

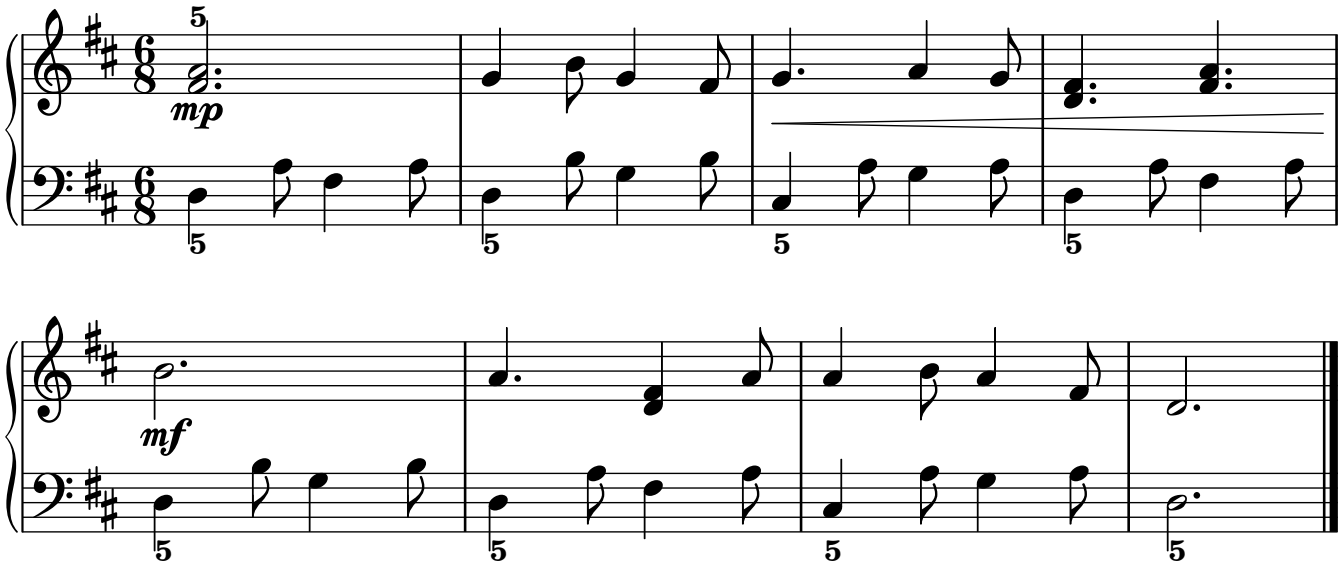


Part D: Two notes at once in 6/8
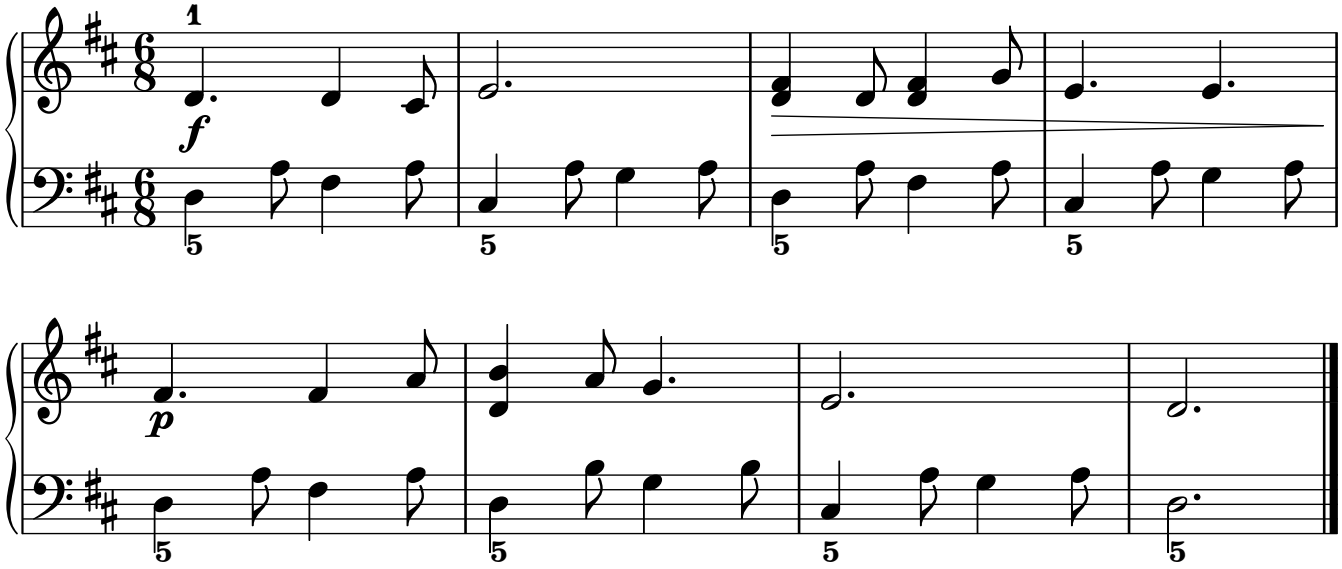
♩. = 50

D major in 6/8, with thirds and sixths.

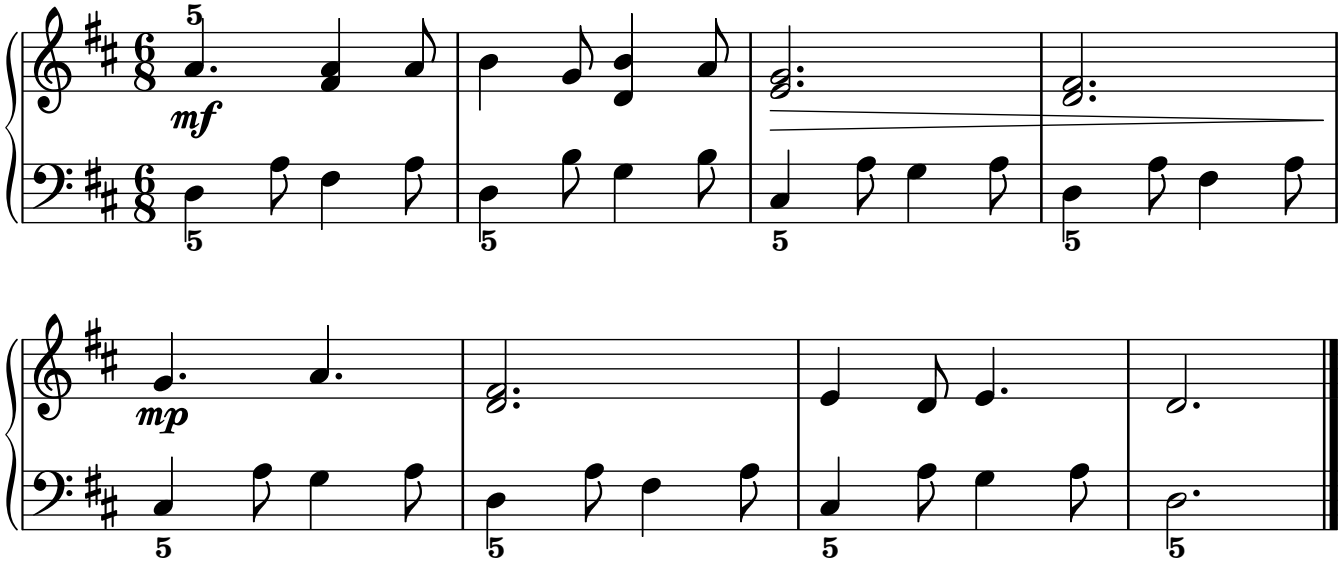
☐ **7.27**



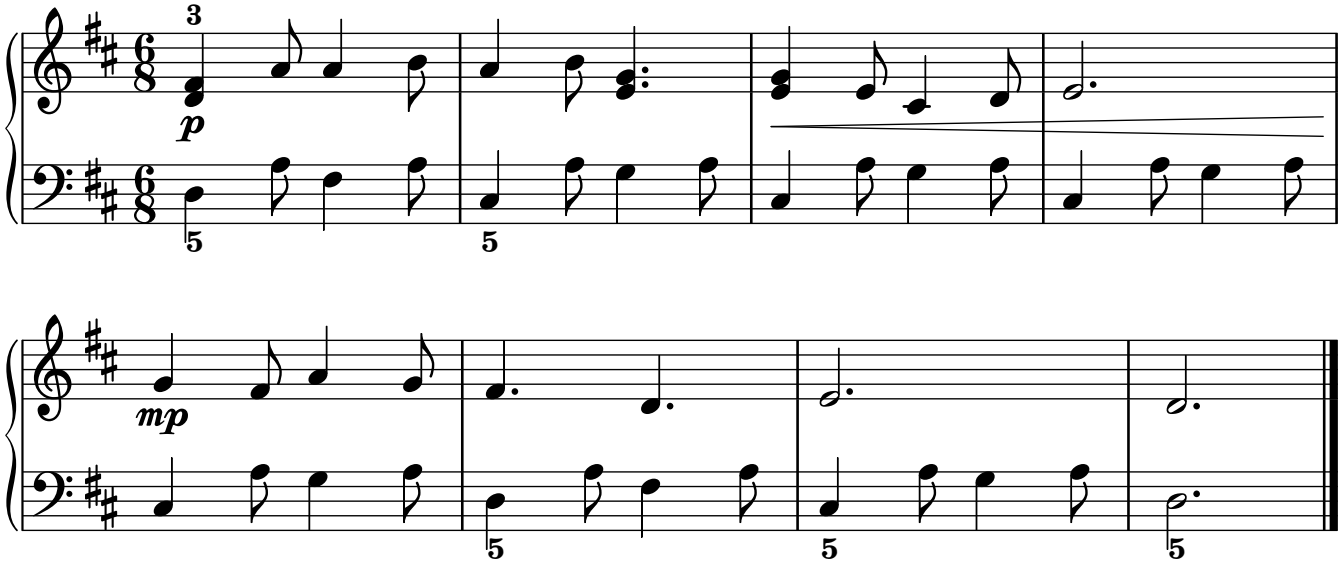
☐ **7.28**



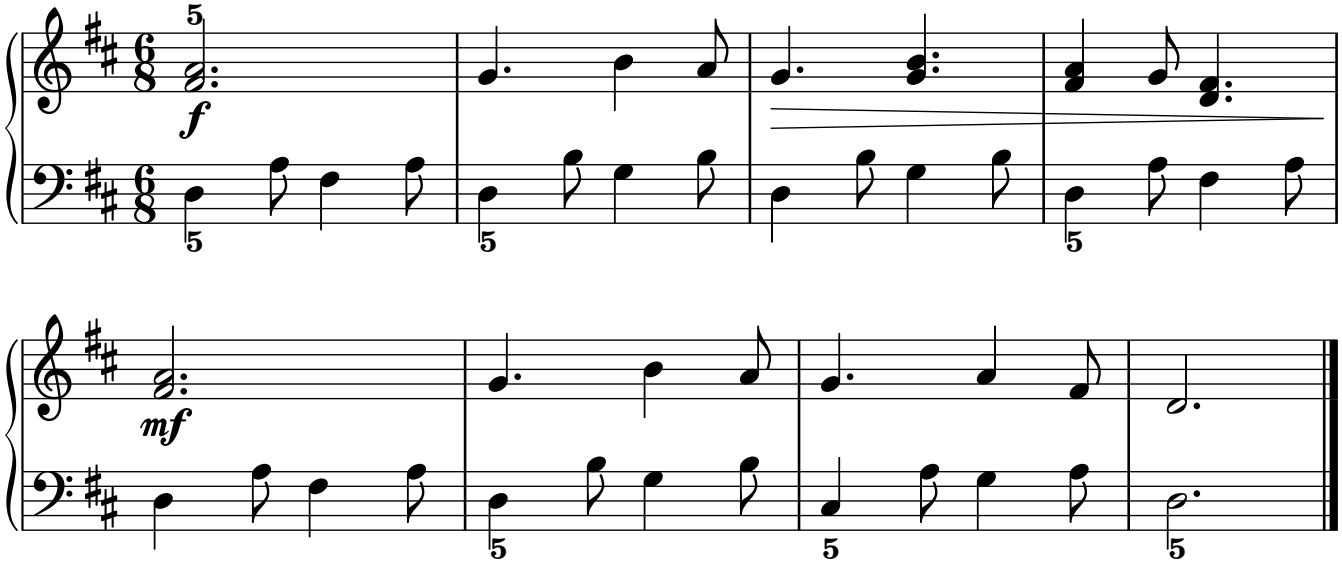
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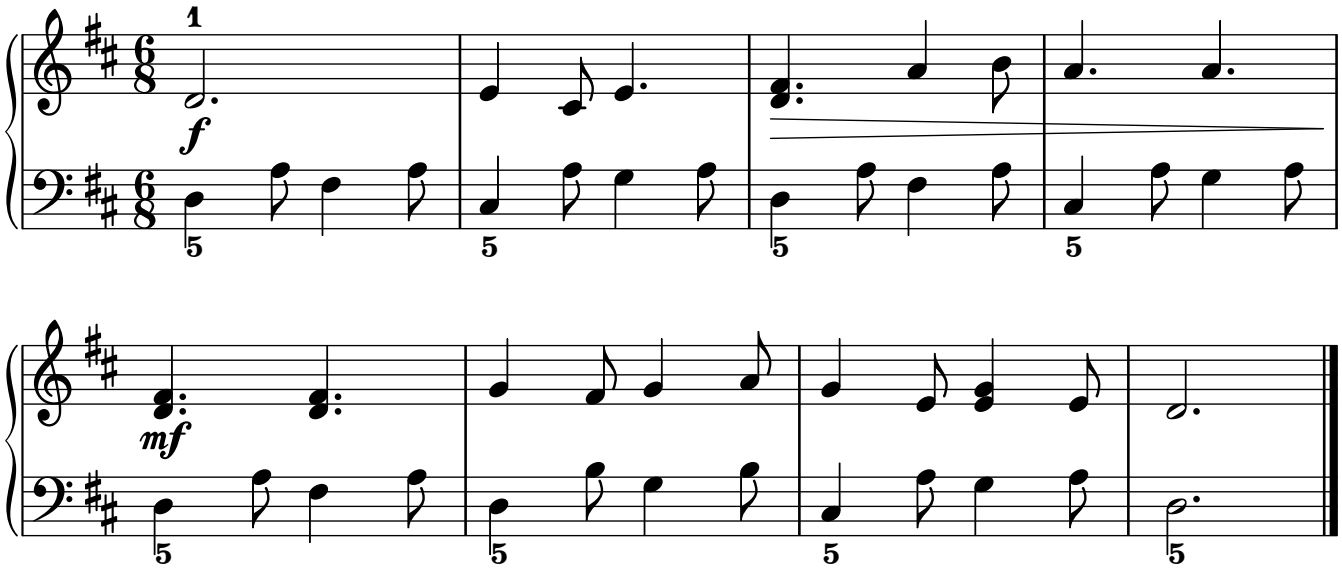
7.30



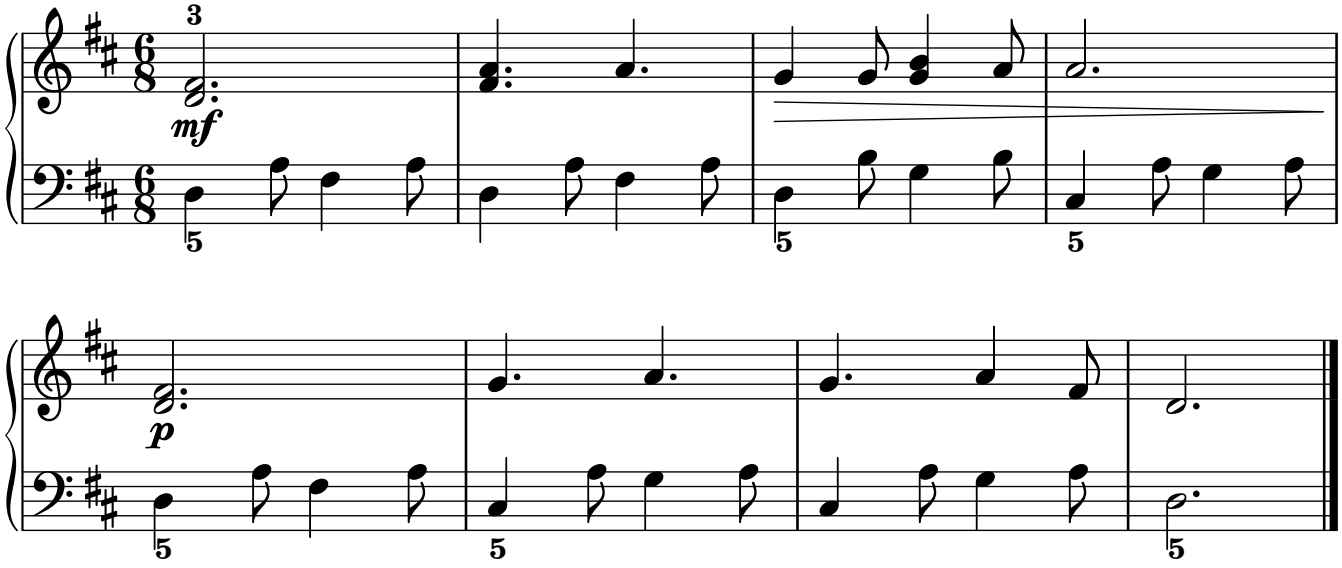
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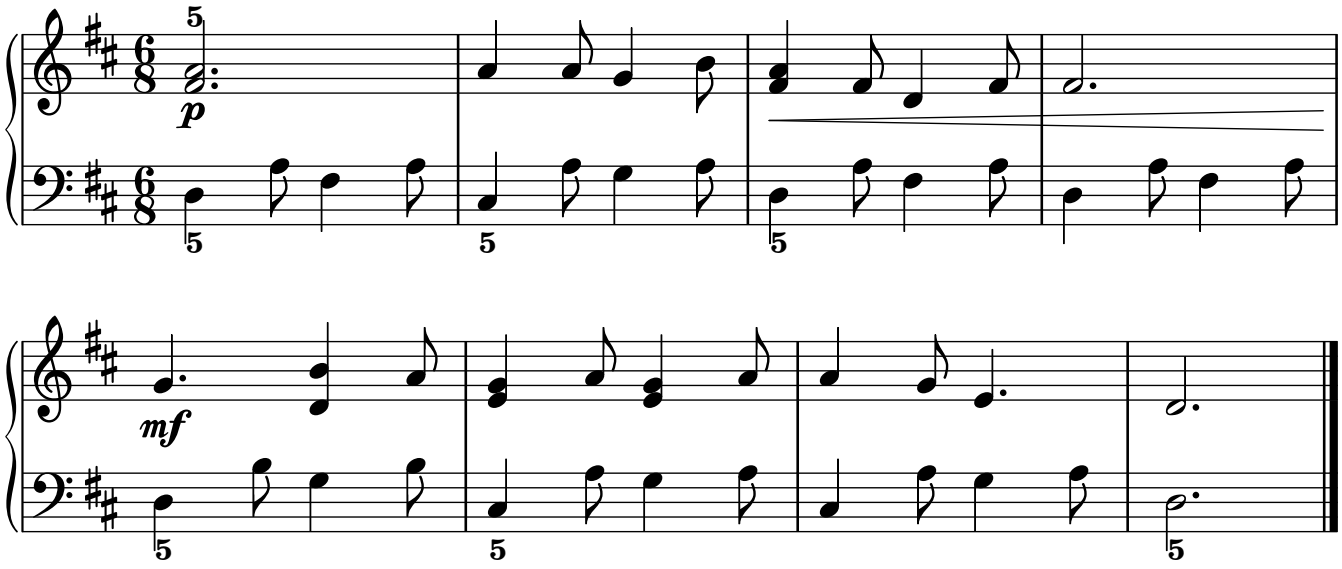
7.32



7.33



7.34



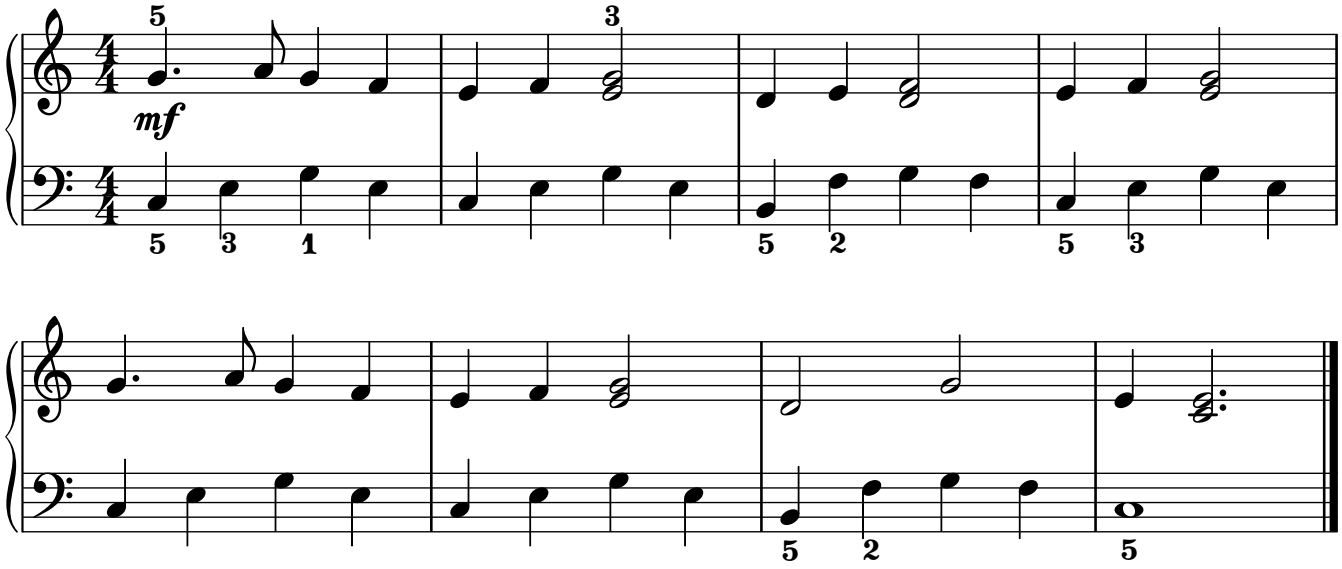
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

London Bridge ♩ = 84

Traditional English nursery rhyme

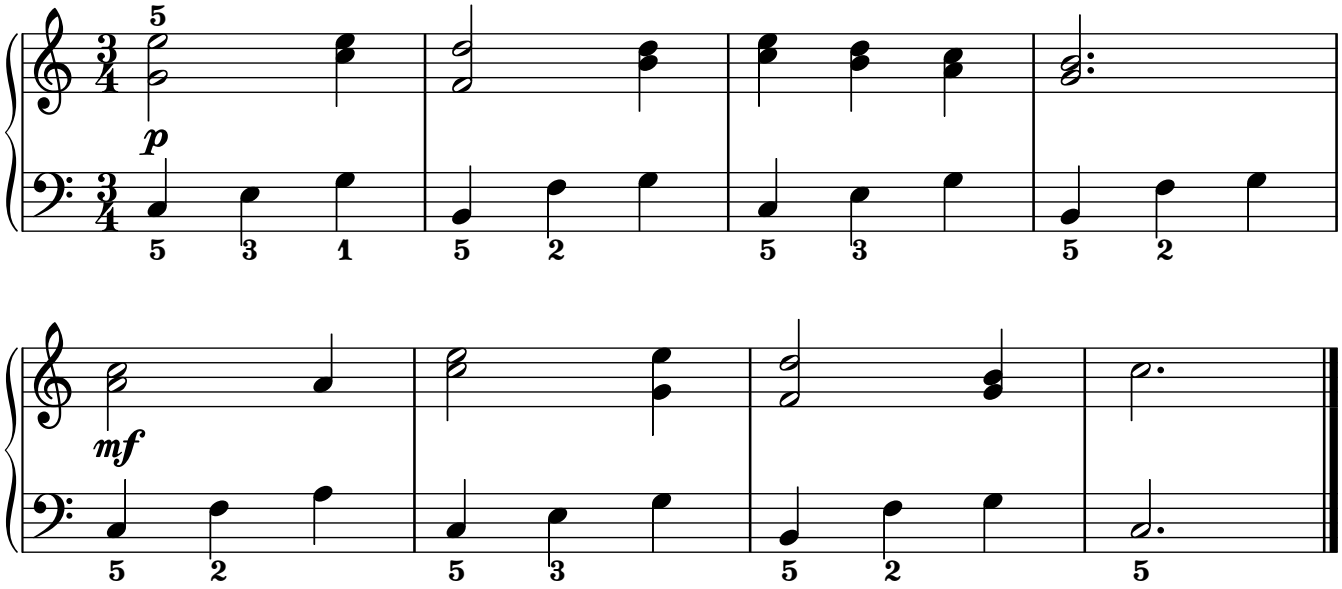
The long notes are doubled a third below. Play them with fingers 3 and 5 (E-G) or 2 and 4 (D-F), and keep the tune on top.



Two by Two ♩ = 76

Original
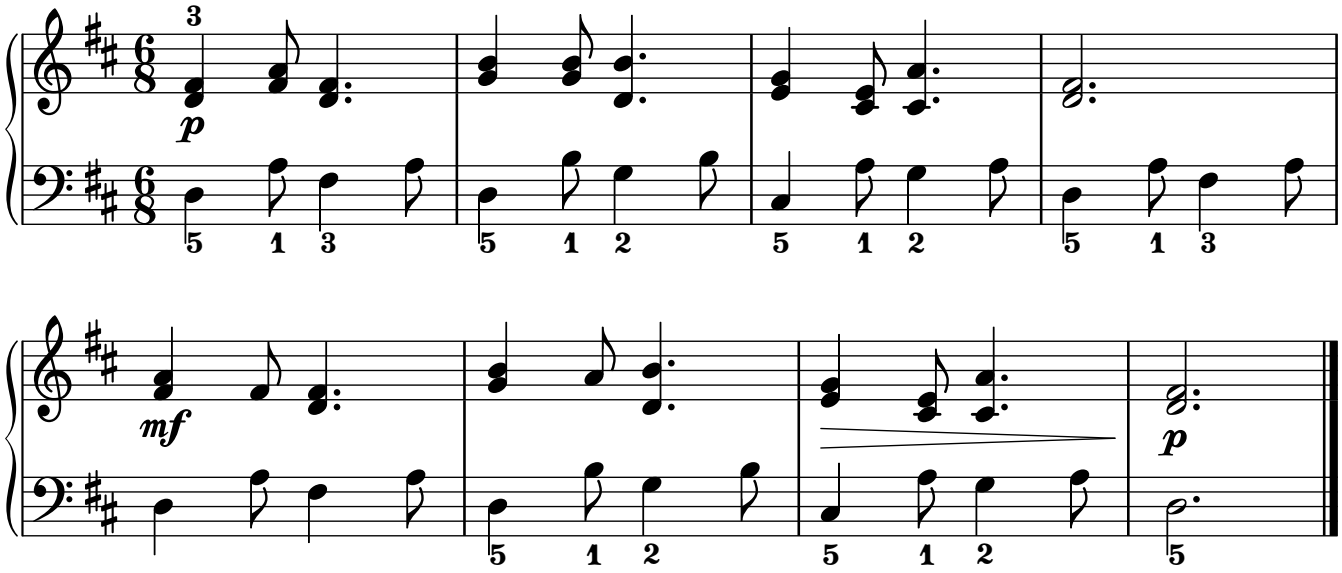
Thirds and sixths in G position. The sixths G-E (bars 1 and 6) and F-D (bars 2 and 7) need a stretch: thumb on the lower note, finger 5 on the upper one.



Barcarolle in D ♩. = 52

Original

A barcarolle is a boat song, in a gently rocking 6/8. The right hand plays thirds and three sixths: D-B in bars 2 and 6, C-sharp-A in bars 3 and 7.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 8?

- Play five new exercises from Parts B to D at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Both notes of every two-note chord sound together, and the top note sings.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 8.

Unit 8

Two Independent Voices

New: A left-hand melody against the right hand: contrary and parallel motion

Until now the left hand has accompanied: it held notes or played chord patterns. Now it plays a real melody of its own, a second voice. Each hand has its own rhythm and its own direction, and the two voices fit together beat by beat. Music written like this, with independent lines, is called counterpoint.

What is new

Contrary motion

One hand goes up while the other goes down. It is the easiest motion to read: the hands move like a mirror.

Parallel and oblique motion

Parallel: both hands move the same way, often a third or sixth apart. Oblique: one hand holds a note while the other moves.

How the voices fit

On the main beats the two hands sound a third, sixth, fifth or octave apart. A note that clashes falls between the beats, on the way from one note to the next.

Read down, then across

Look at both staves on beat 1 of each bar, then follow each line. In Part B the tune is in the left hand; let it sing louder than the right.

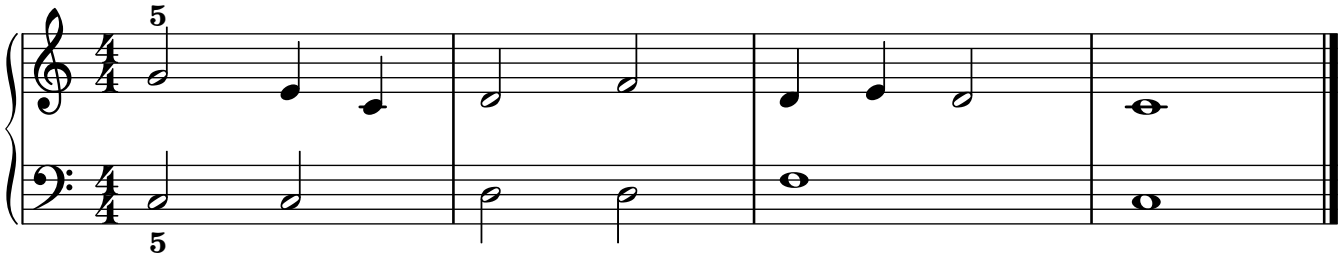
Reading tips

1. Before you start, follow the direction of each hand through the first two bars.
2. Count out loud: two independent rhythms only fit together if the beat is steady.
3. If one hand has long notes, keep them held for their full length while the other hand moves.

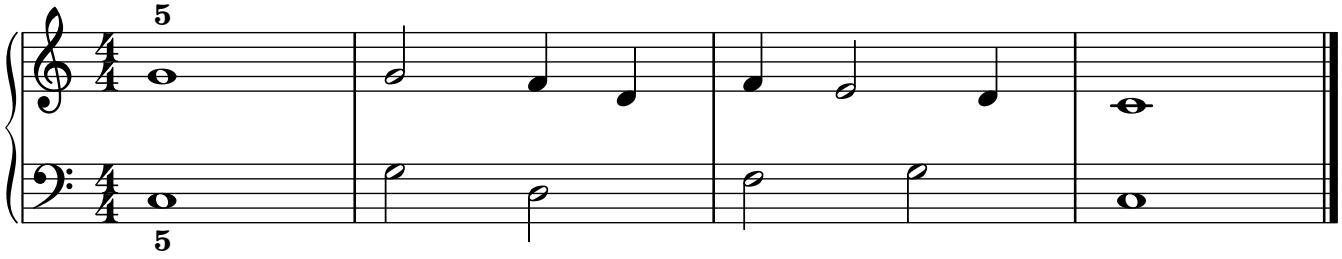
Part A: A second voice in the left hand ♩ = 60

The right hand has the tune; the left hand answers in half notes, often moving the other way.

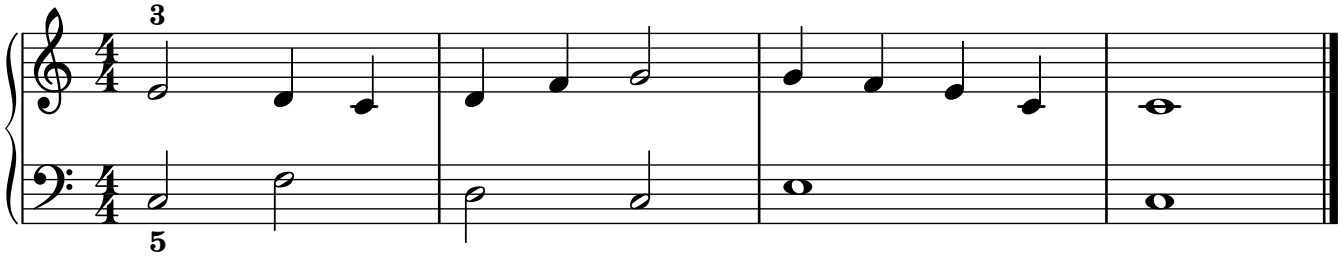
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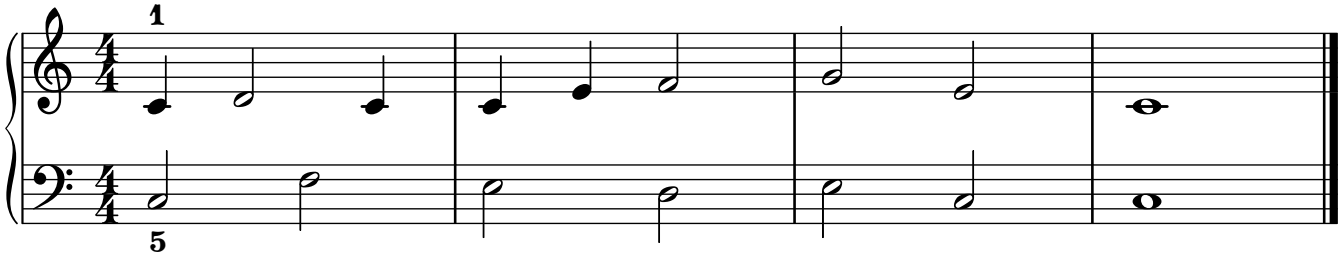
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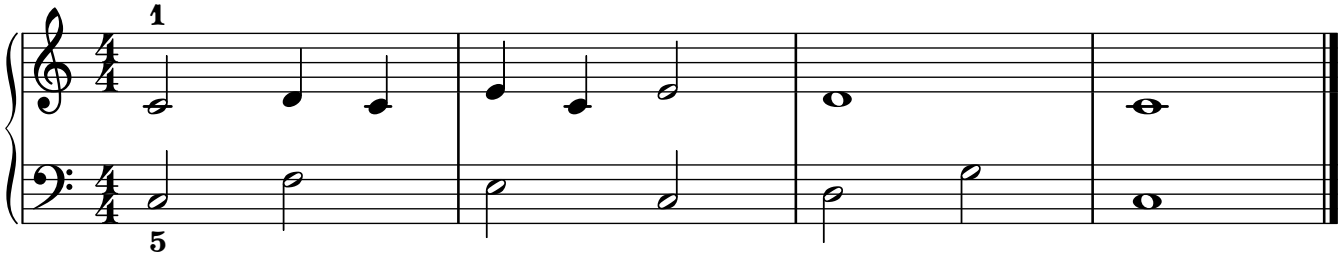
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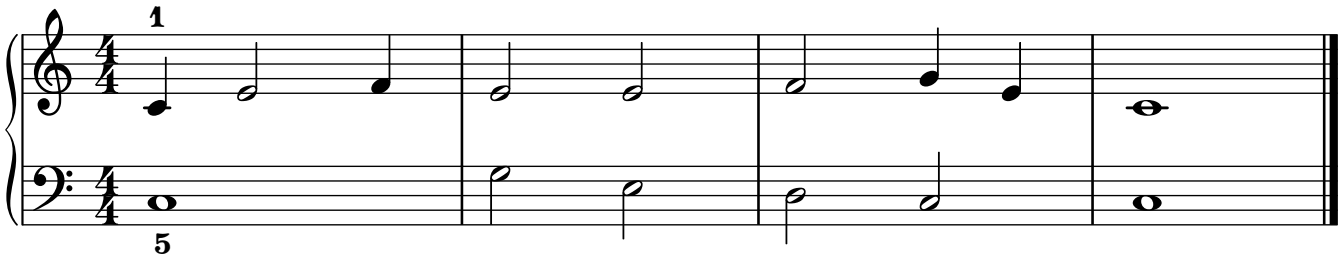
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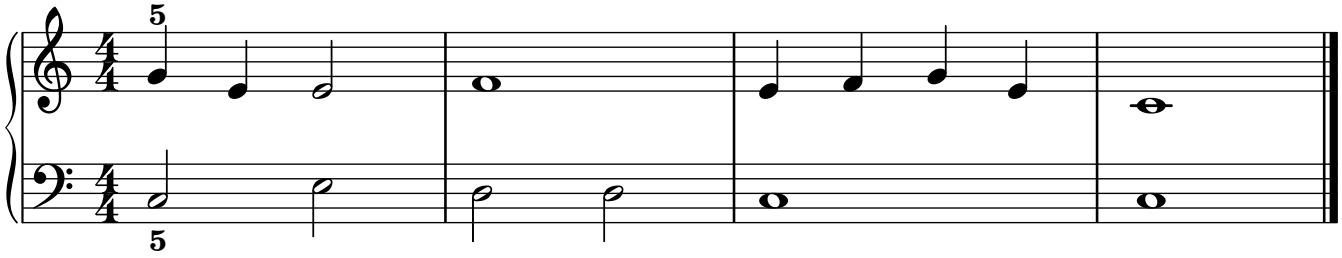
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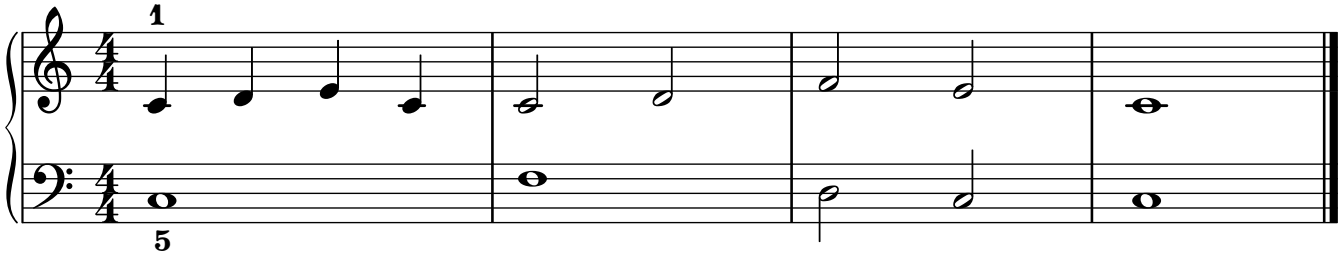
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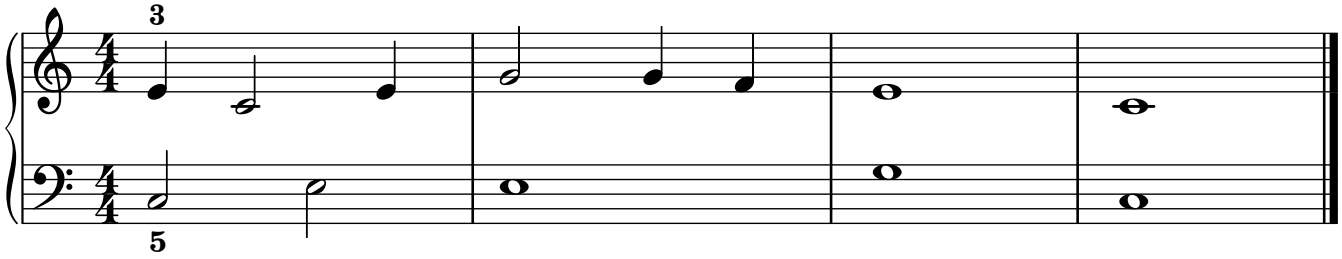
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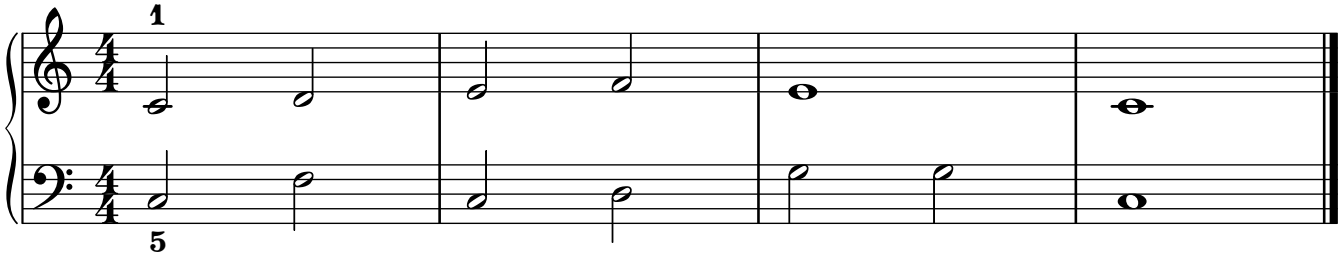
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☐ **8.9**



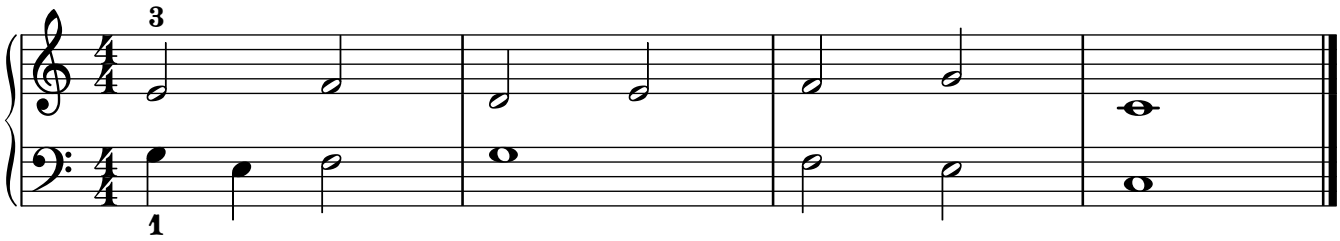
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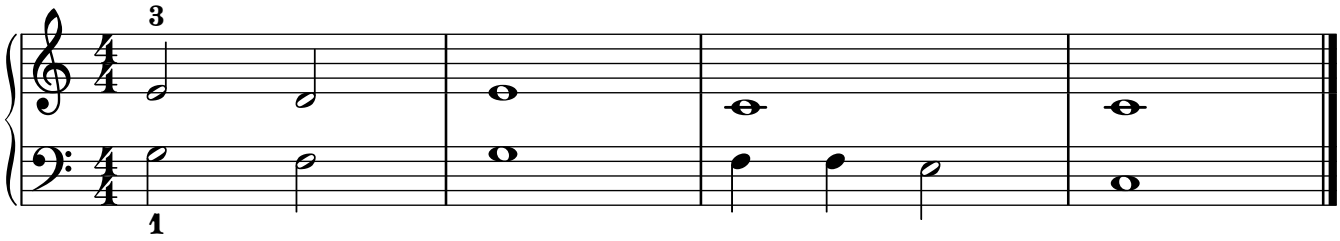
Part B: The tune in the left hand ♩= 60

The tune is in the left hand. The right hand plays long notes above it.

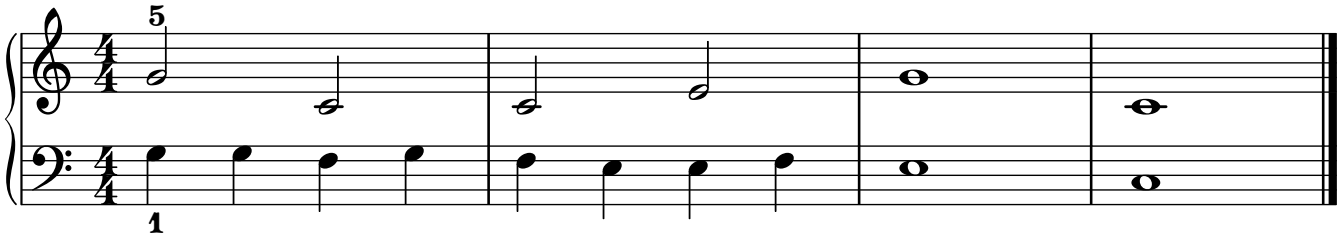
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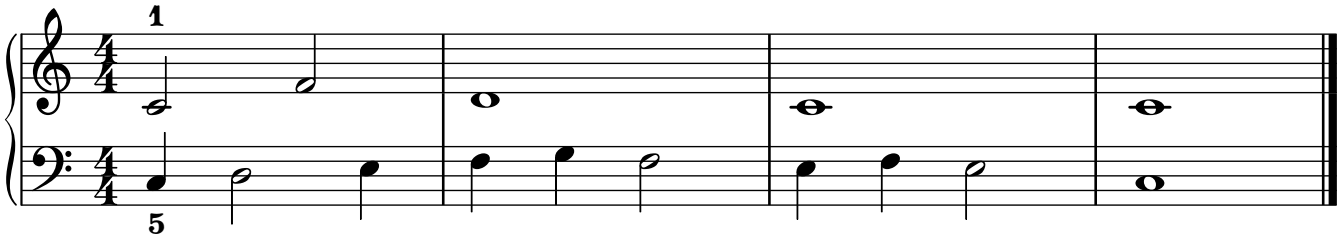
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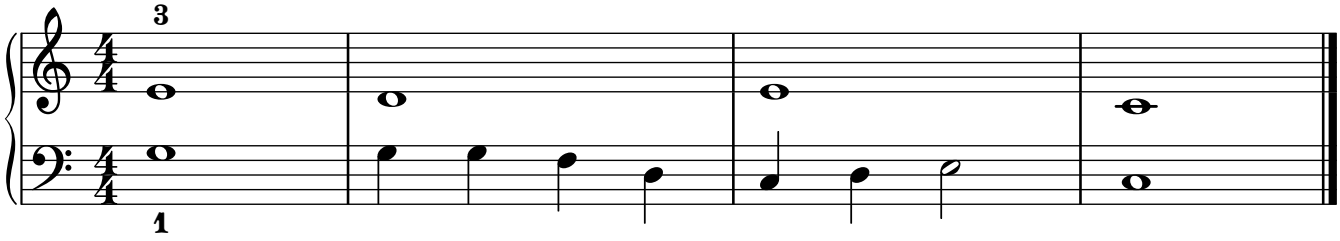
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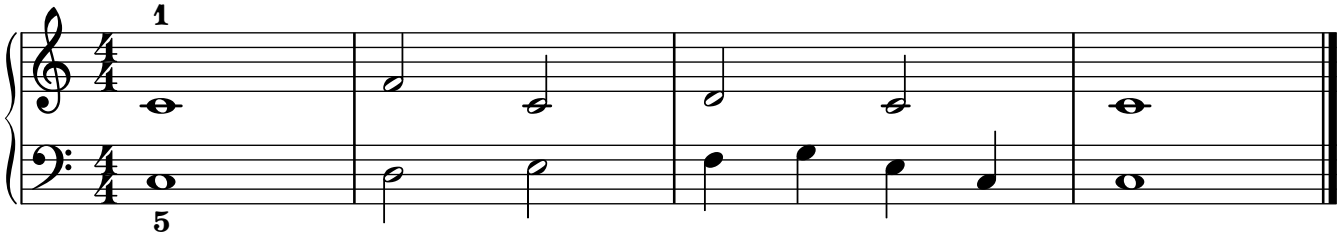
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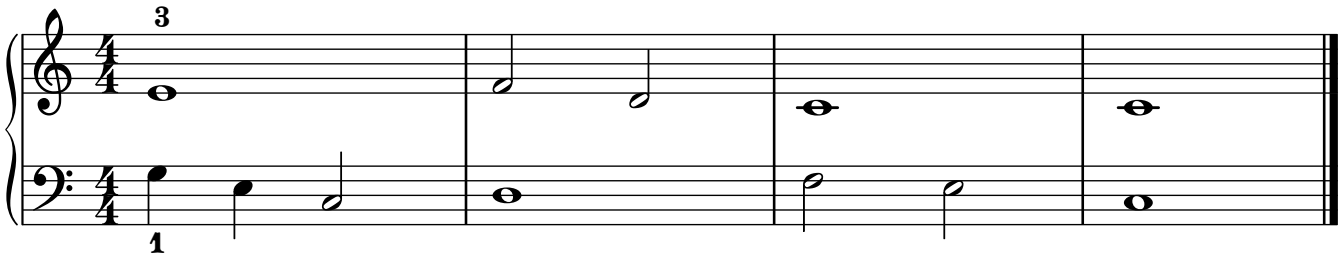
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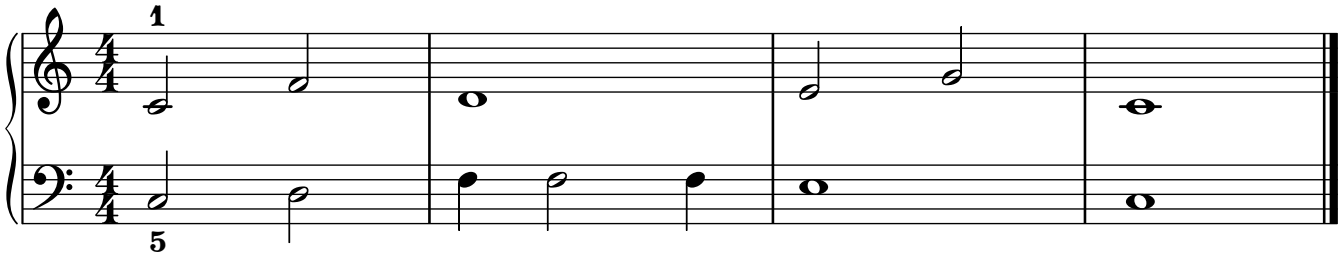
☐ **8.16**



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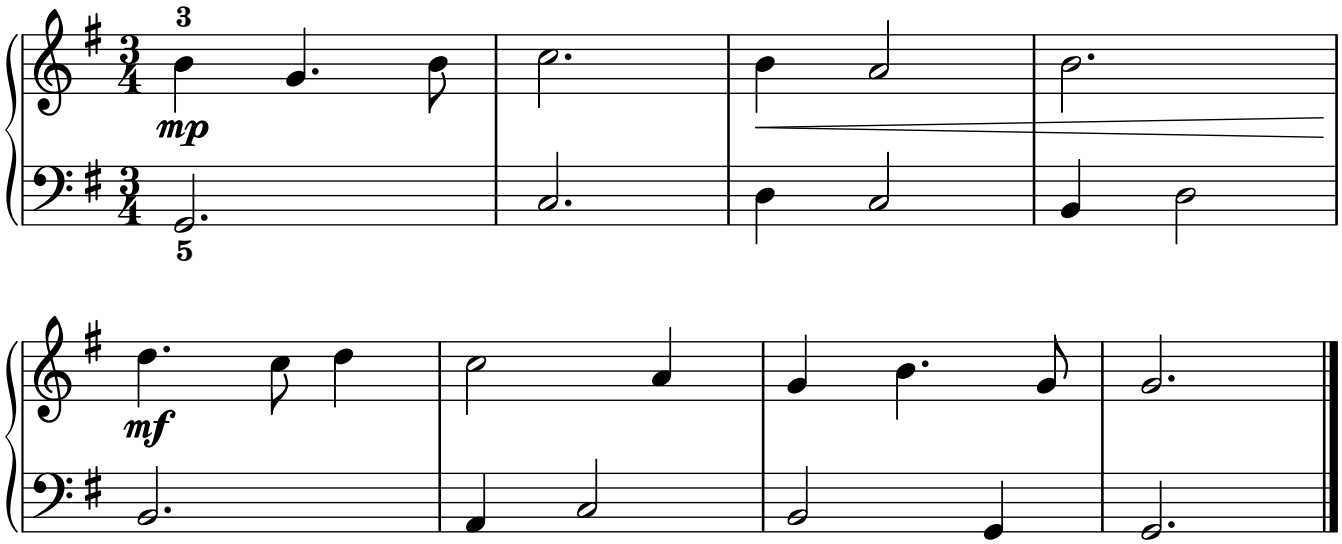


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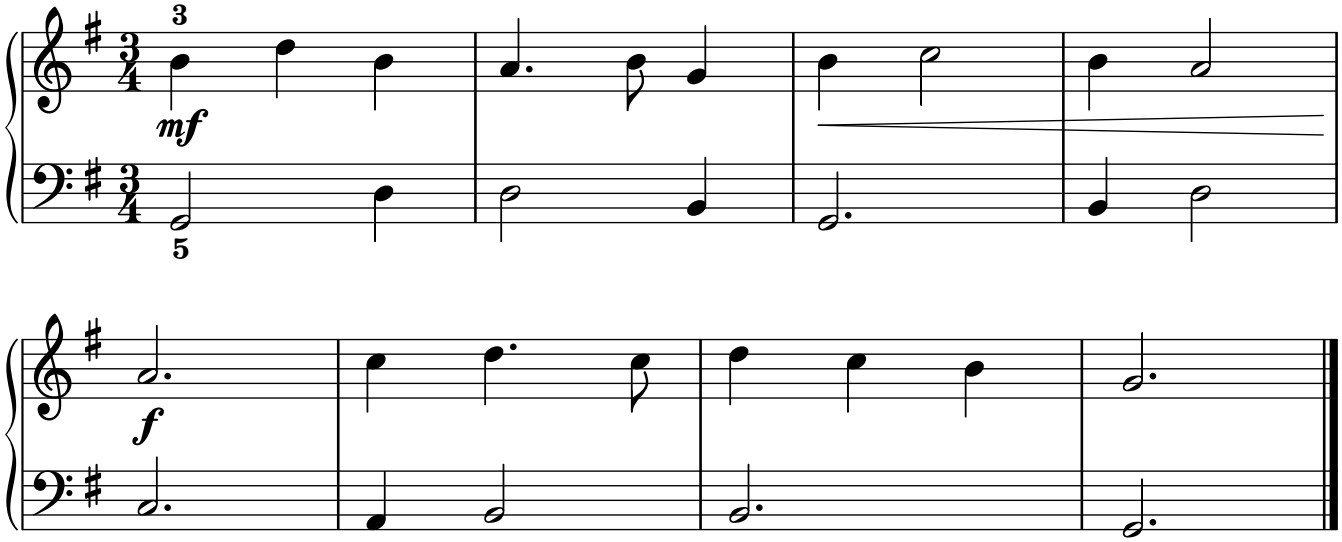


Part C: Two voices in 3/4 ♩= 72

Two voices in G major, in 3/4. The left hand moves in quarter and half notes.
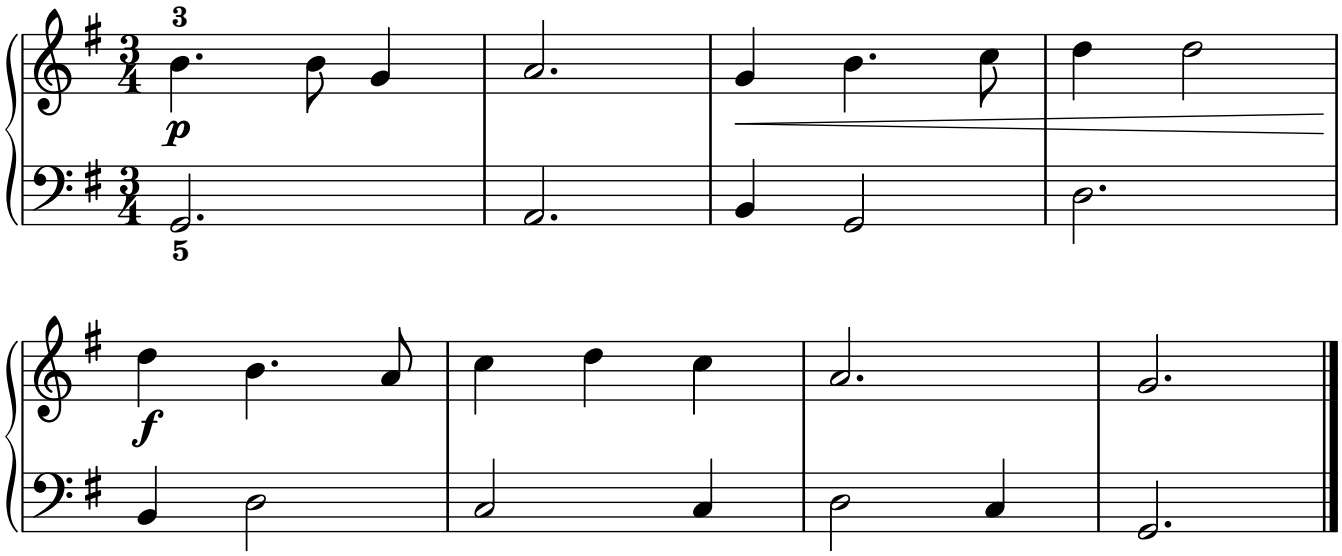
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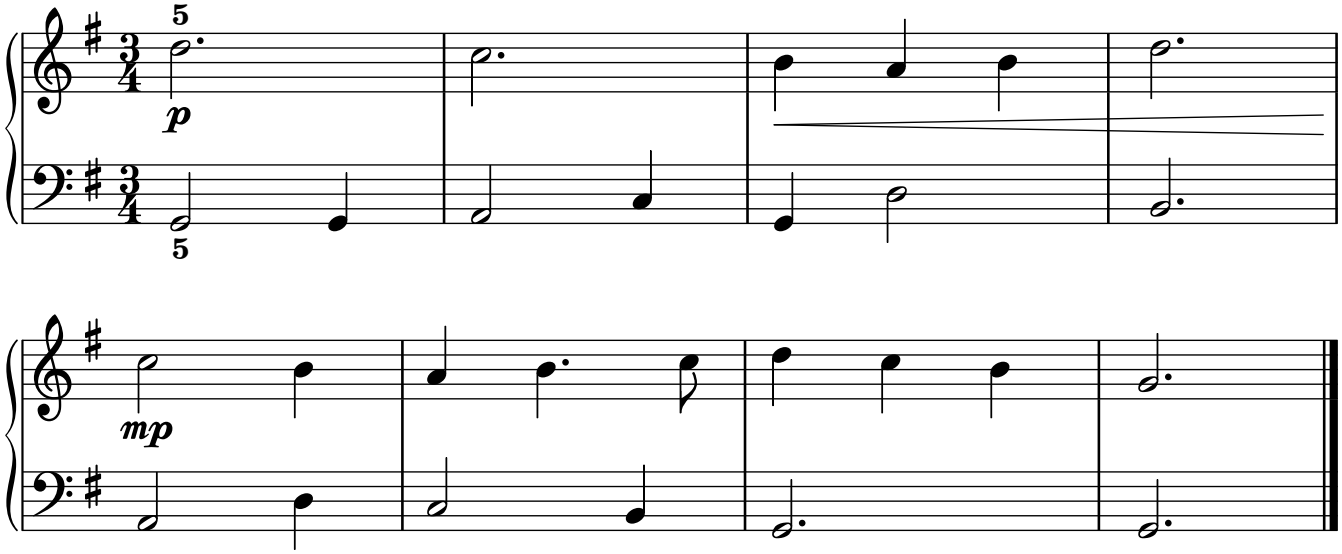


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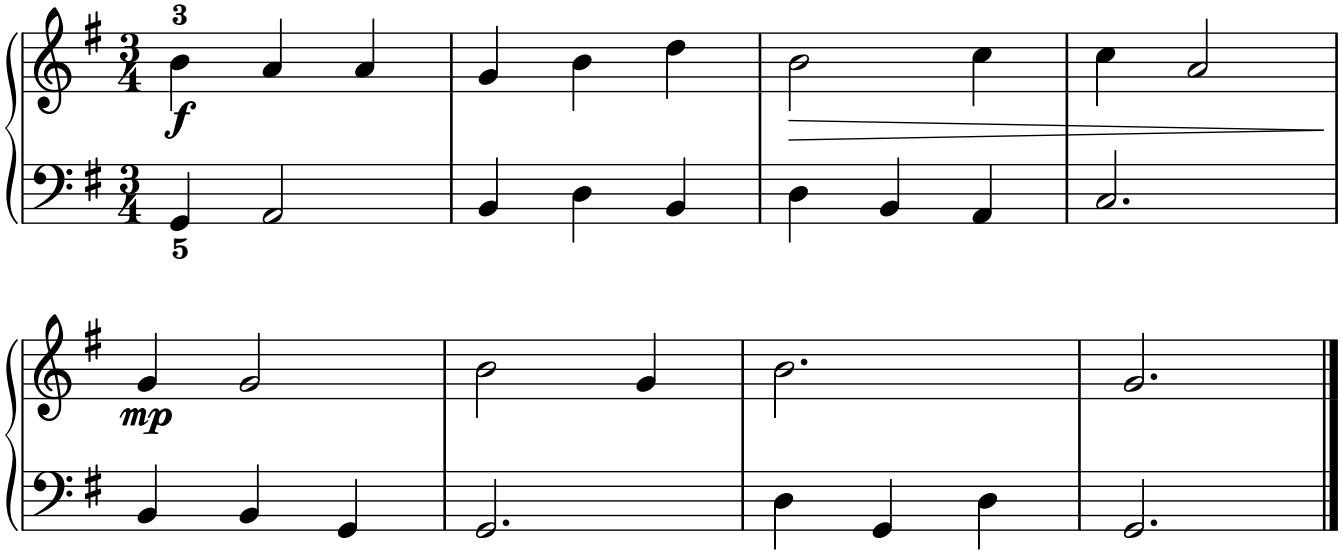


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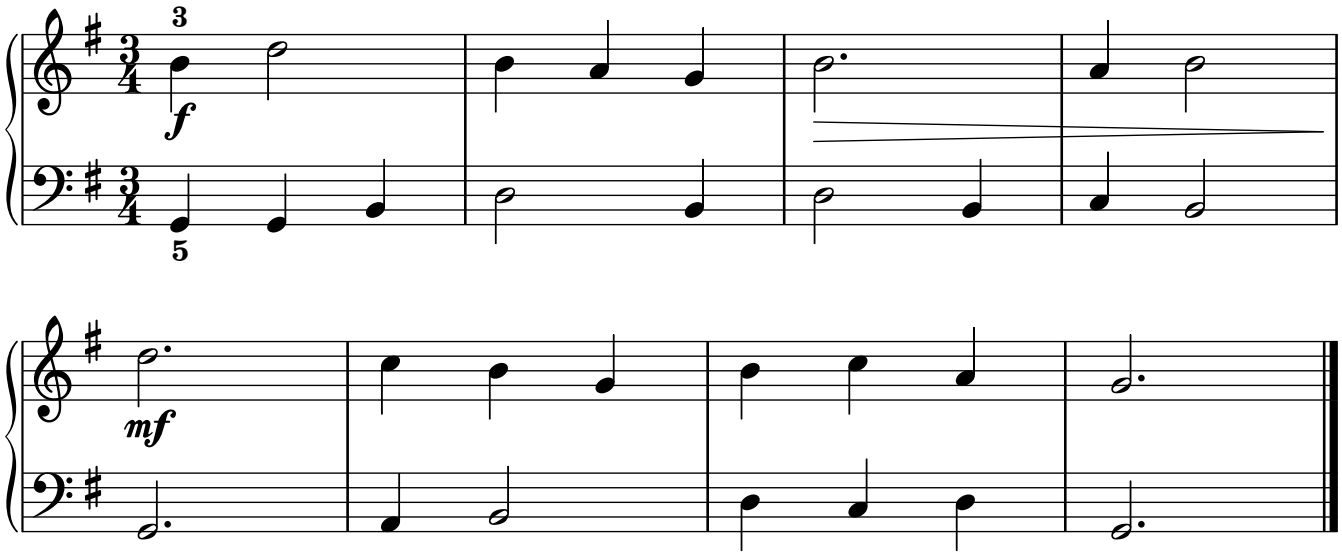


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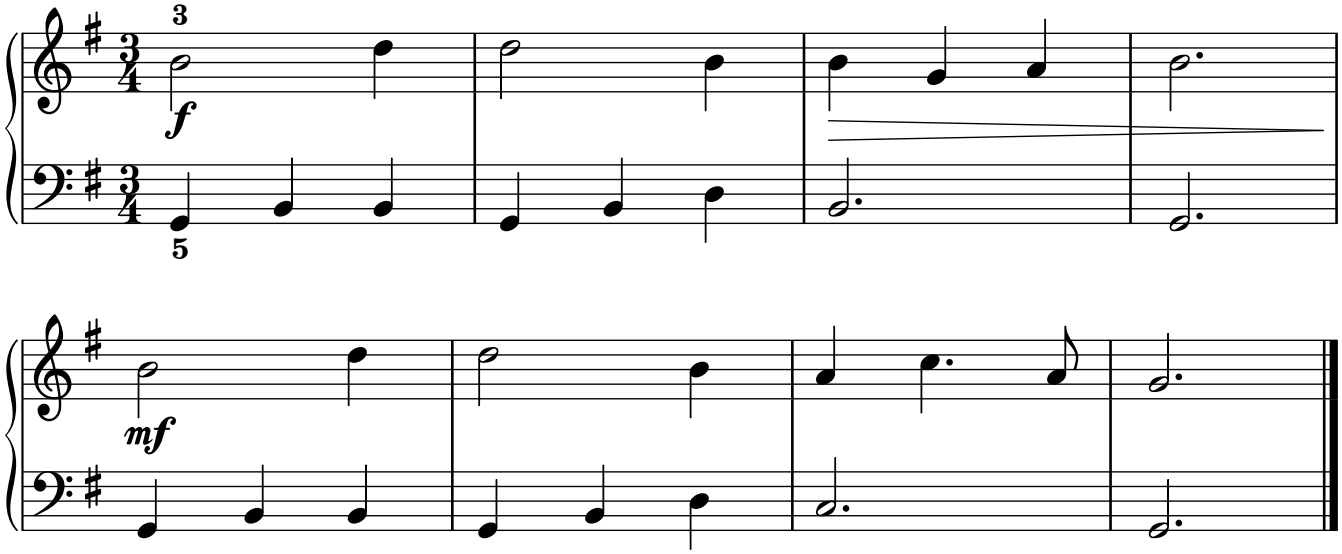


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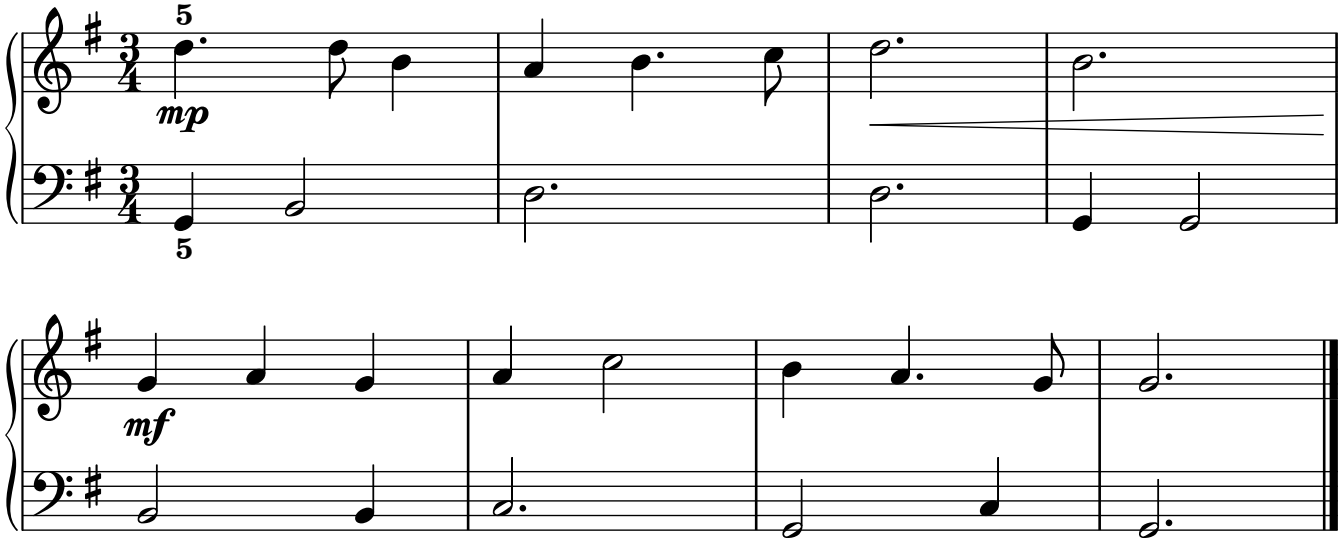


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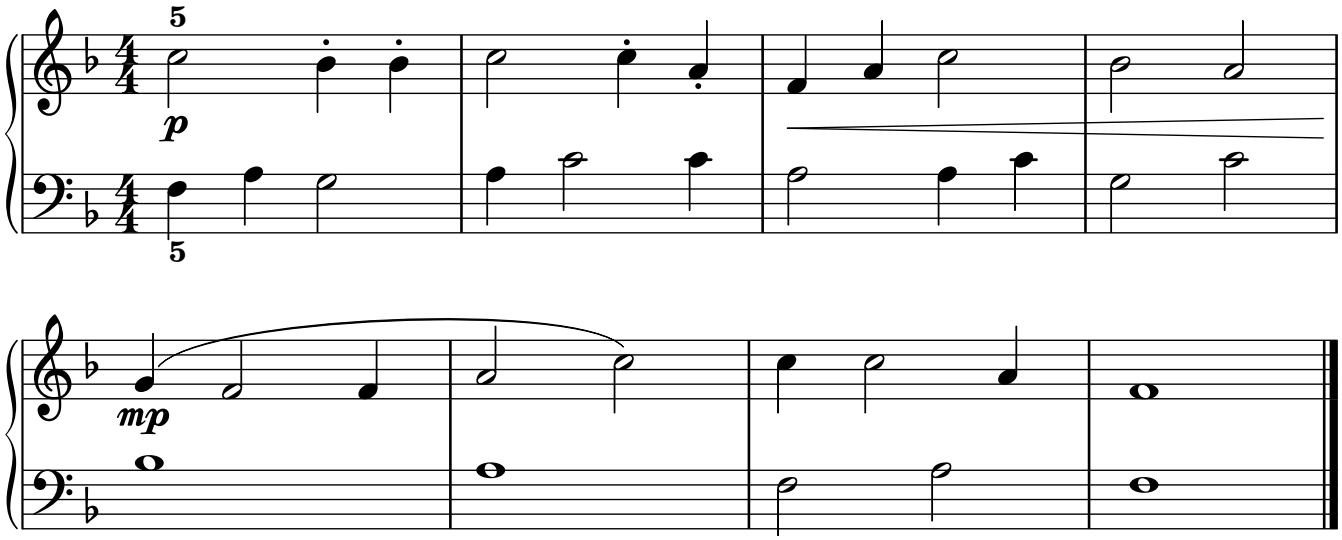


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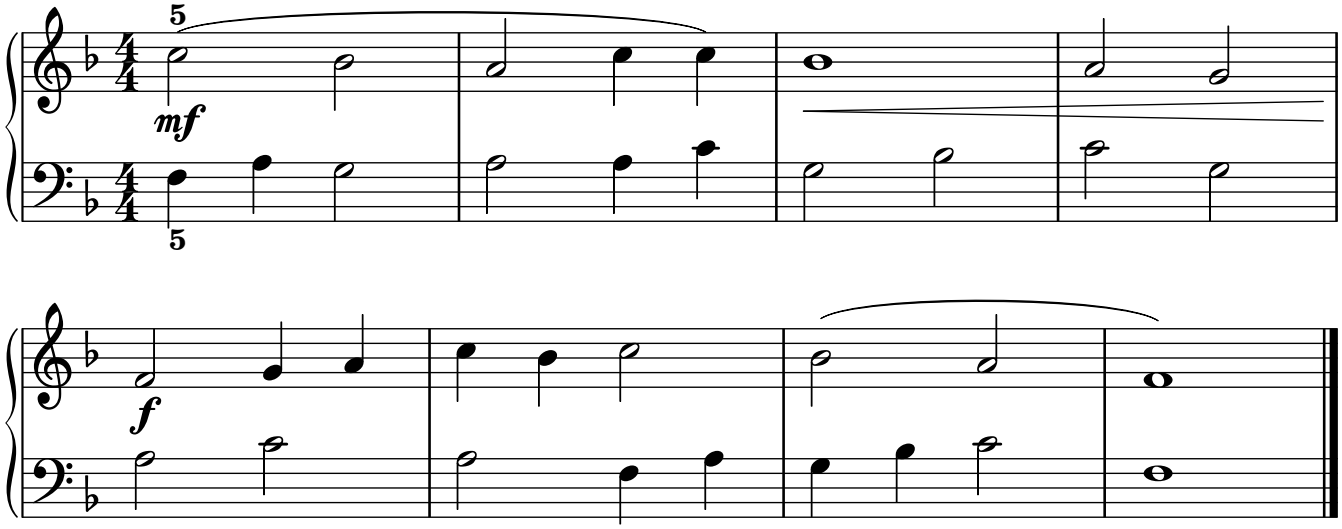


Part D: Quarter against quarter ♩ = 60

Both hands in quarter notes: real two-part writing in F major.
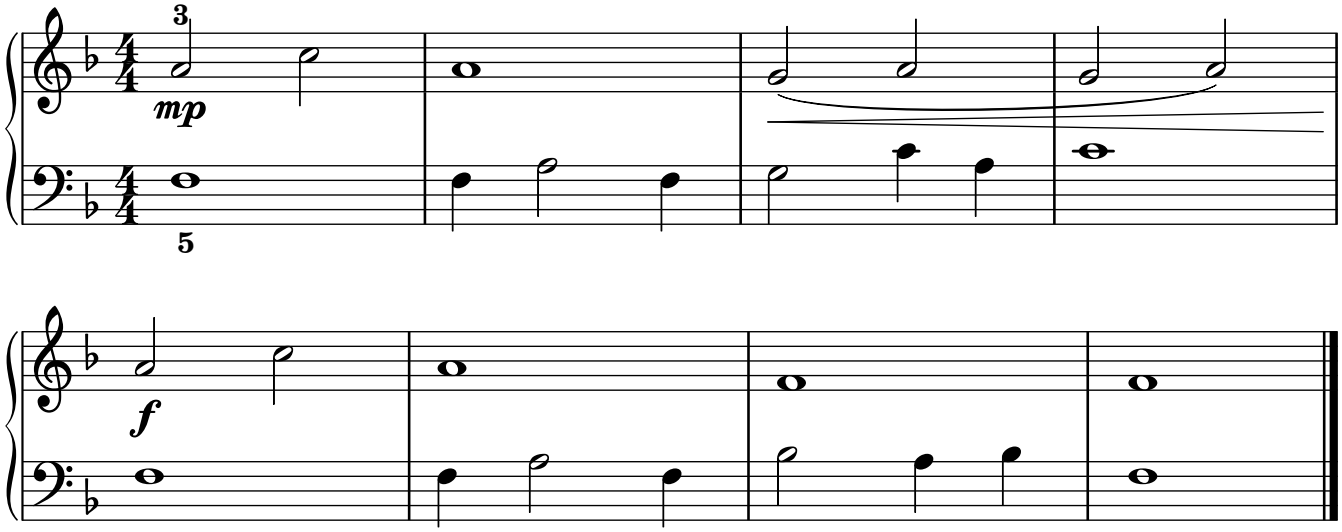
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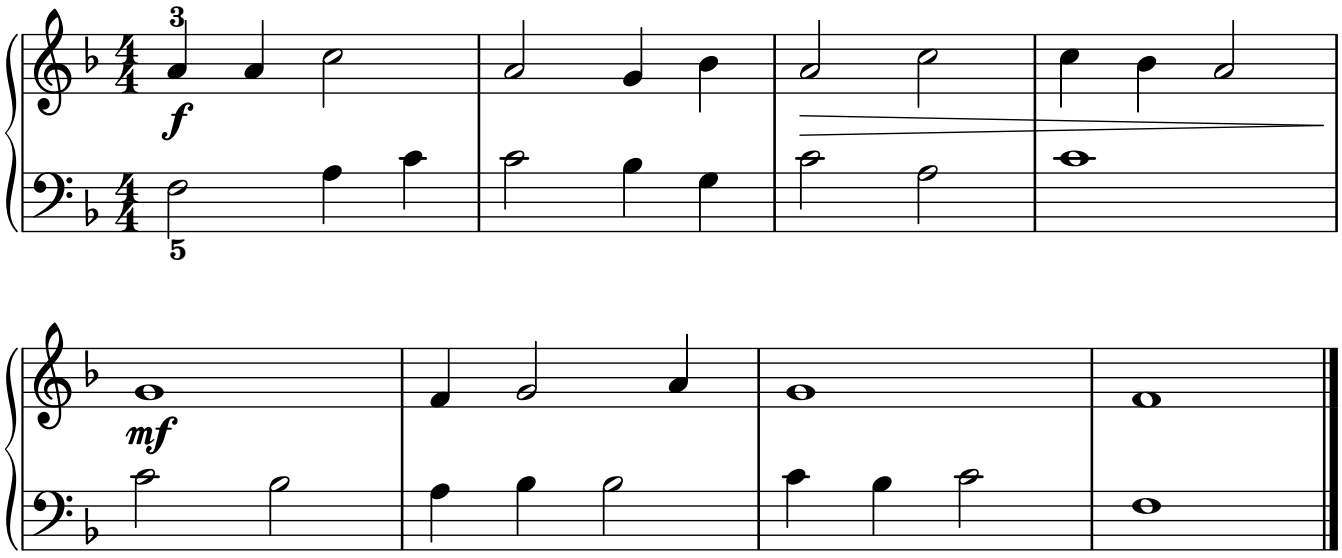


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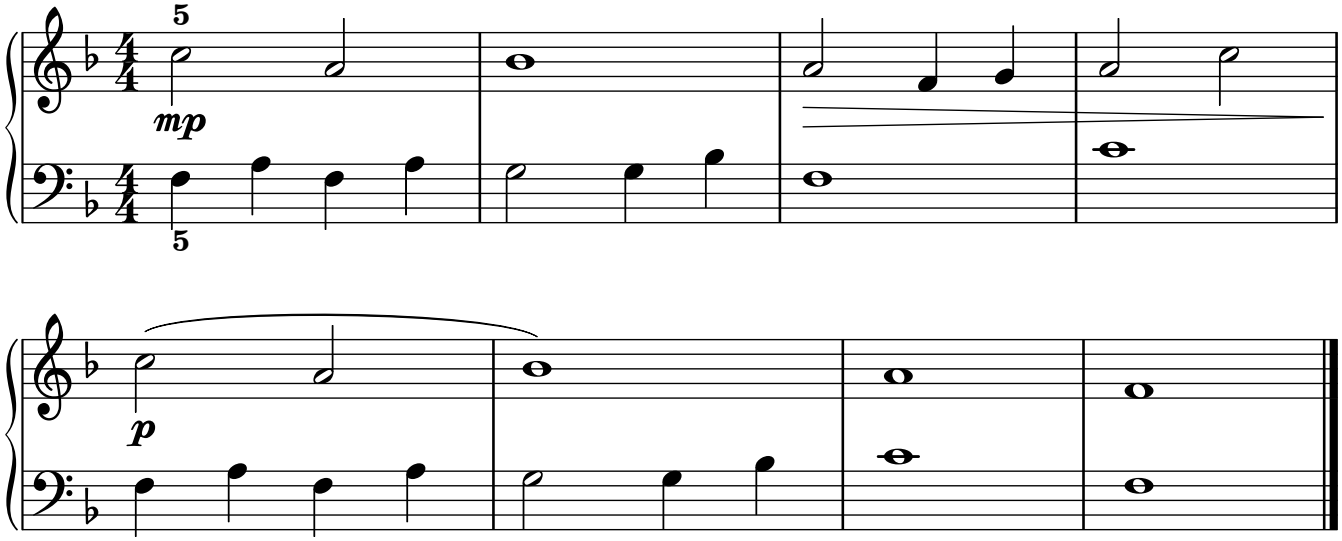
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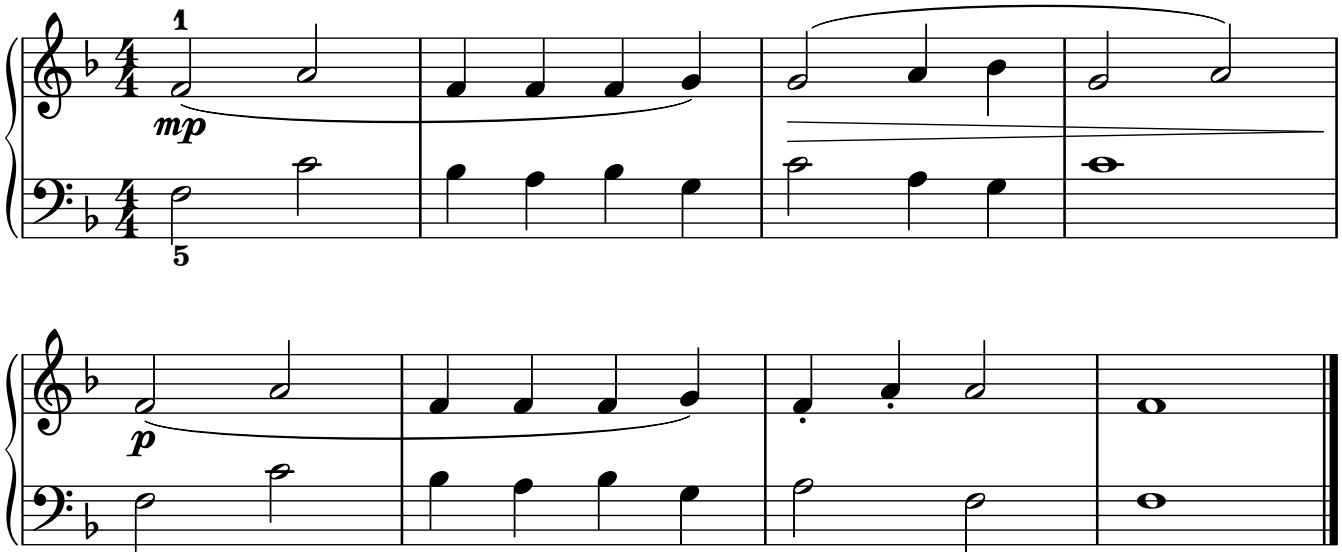
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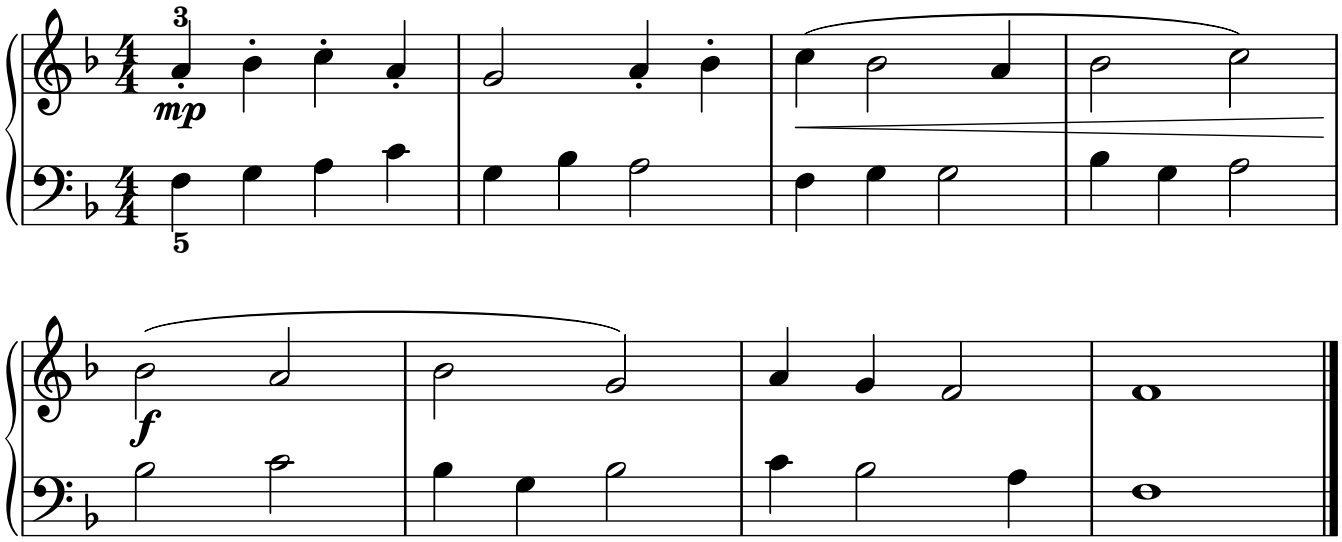


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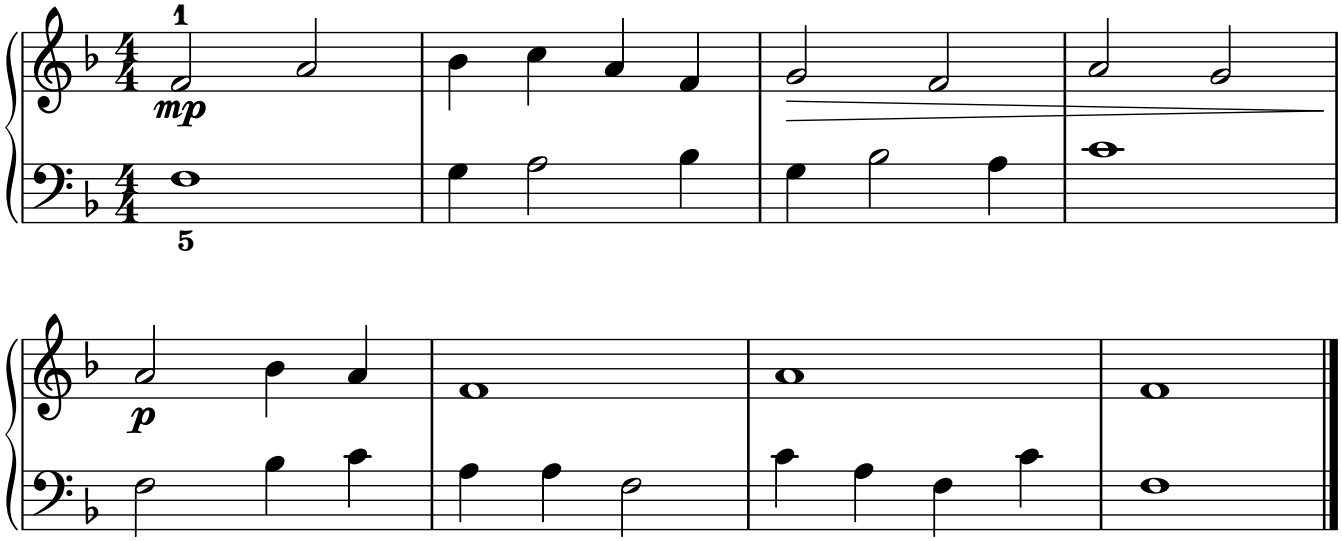


8.32



8.33



8.34
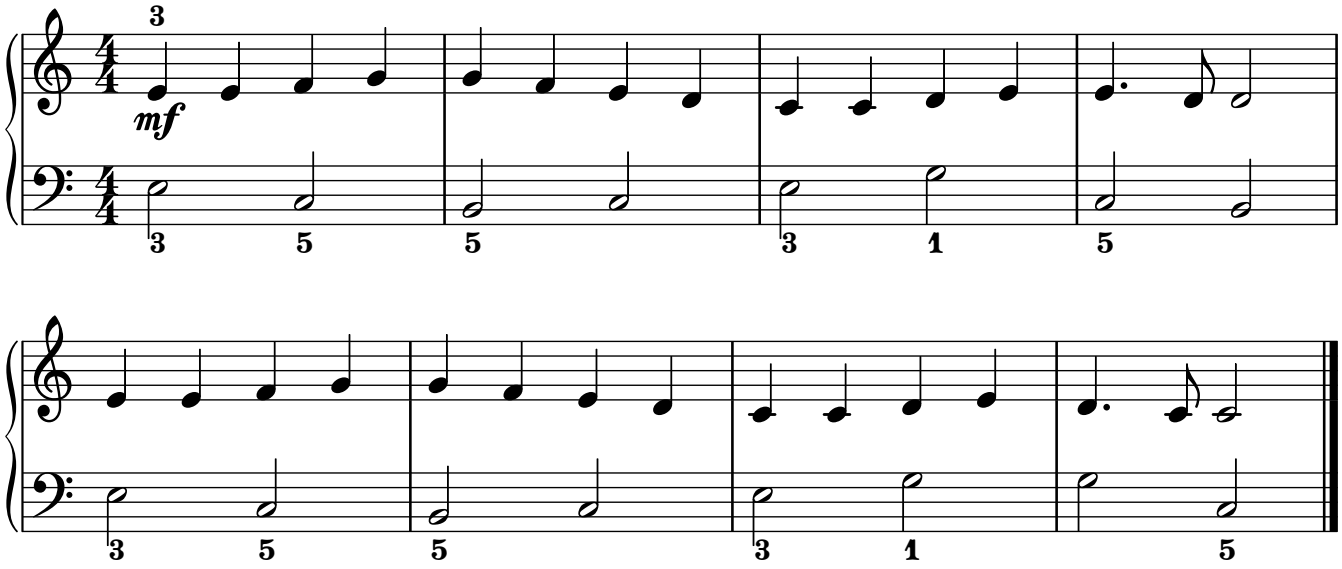


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Ode to Joy in Two Voices ♩ = 72

Ludwig van Beethoven, theme from Symphony No. 9 - with an added second voice
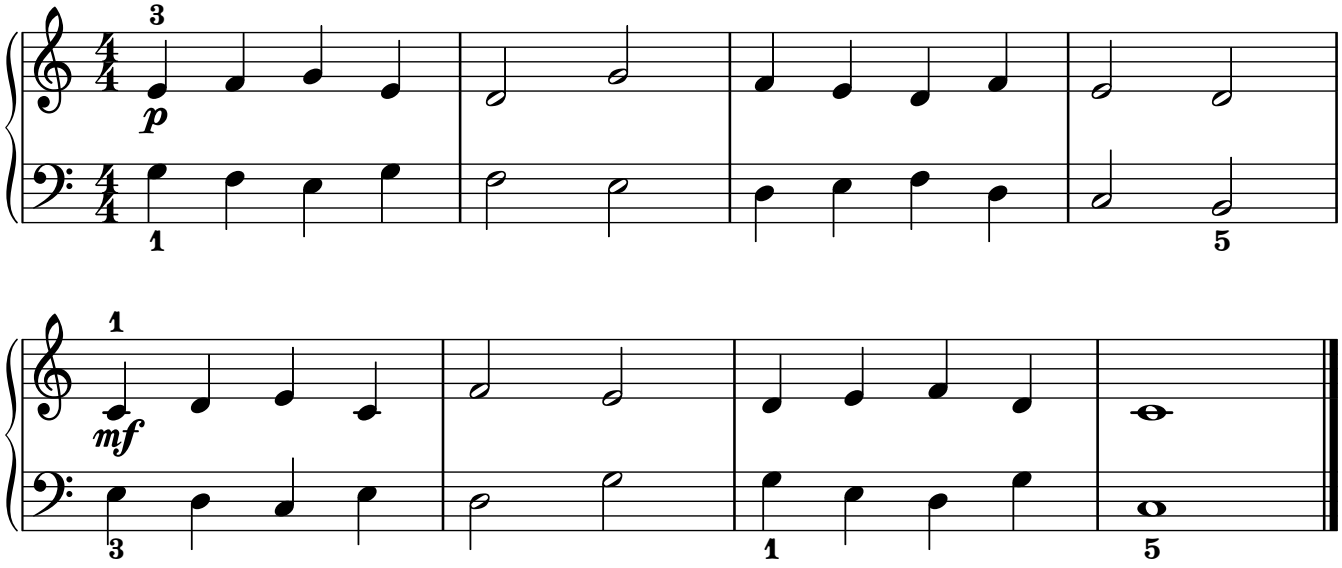
The tune from Unit 1, now with a left-hand melody in half notes instead of broken chords. In bar 1 the hands move apart: the right hand climbs while the left hand falls.



Mirror Talk ♩ = 72

Original
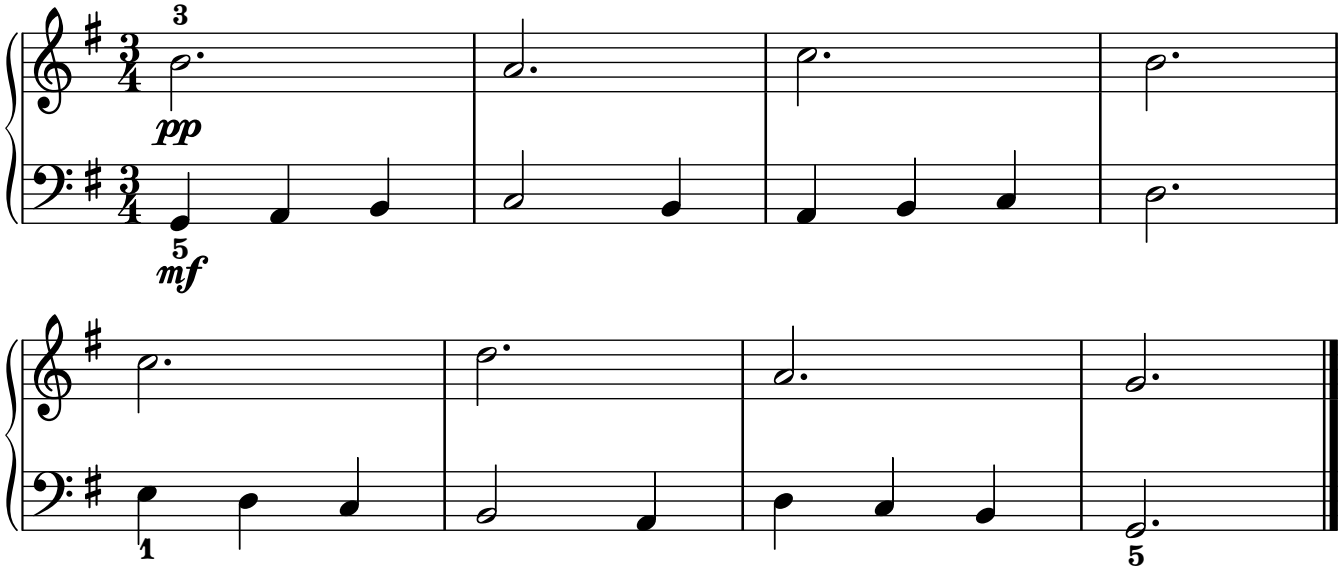
Quarter notes in both hands, mostly in contrary motion: when the right hand steps up, the left hand steps down. Both hands are in C position; the left hand stretches finger 5 down to B in bar 4.



The Cellist ♩ = 80

Original

The tune is in the left hand, low like a cello. Let it sing; the right hand holds quiet notes above.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 9?

- Play five new exercises from Parts B to D at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Both lines are clear: long notes are held, and the tune sings in whichever hand has it.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 9.

Unit 9

Imitation

New: Simple counterpoint: one hand answers the other with the same tune

In imitation, one voice plays a tune and another voice repeats it a little later, while the first voice goes on with something new. It is the oldest trick in counterpoint, and the simplest kind of music in which two voices are truly equal. In this unit the right hand plays a short tune and the left hand answers with the same tune, an octave or two lower, two bars later.

What is new

Spot the tune once, play it twice

The left hand's entry looks exactly like the right hand's first two bars, moved down. You have already read it, so you can watch the right hand while the left hand repeats it.

The other voice keeps going

While the left hand imitates, the right hand plays a new, slower line above it. Hold its long notes for their full length.

Rounds and canons

When the second voice copies the whole tune, the piece is a round or canon, like Frère Jacques.

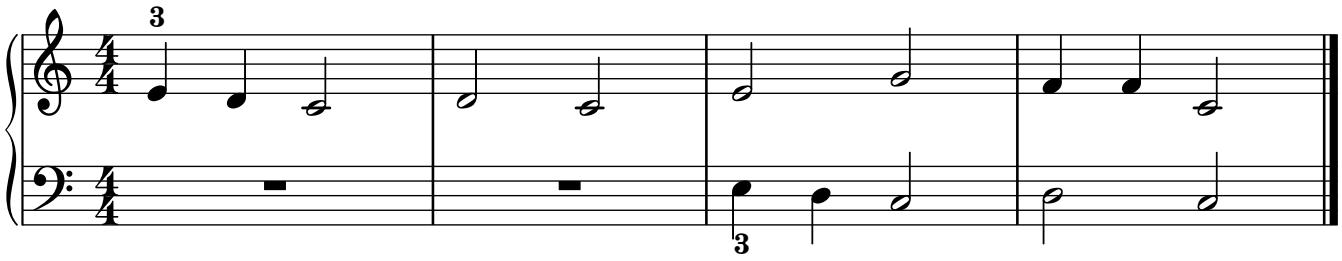
Reading tips

1. In your scan, compare bars 1-2 (right hand) with bars 3-4 (left hand): the shape is the same.
2. Bring out whichever hand has the tune at the moment.
3. Count the rests at the start carefully, so the left hand comes in exactly on time.

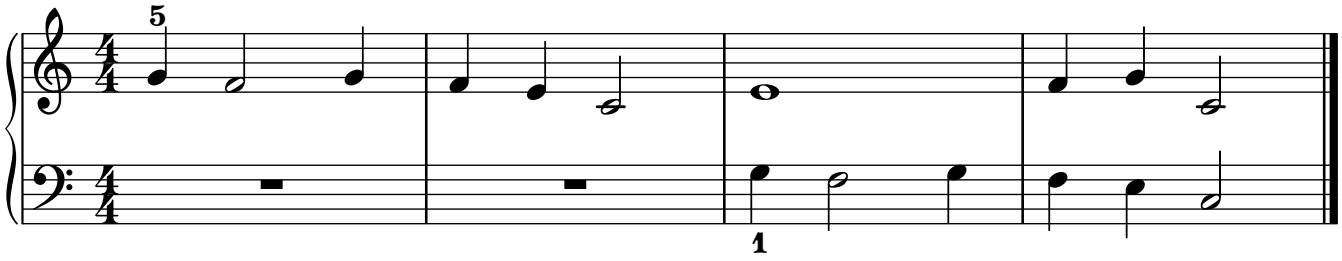
Part A: The left hand answers ♩ = 60

C major, four bars: the left hand repeats the right hand's tune an octave lower.

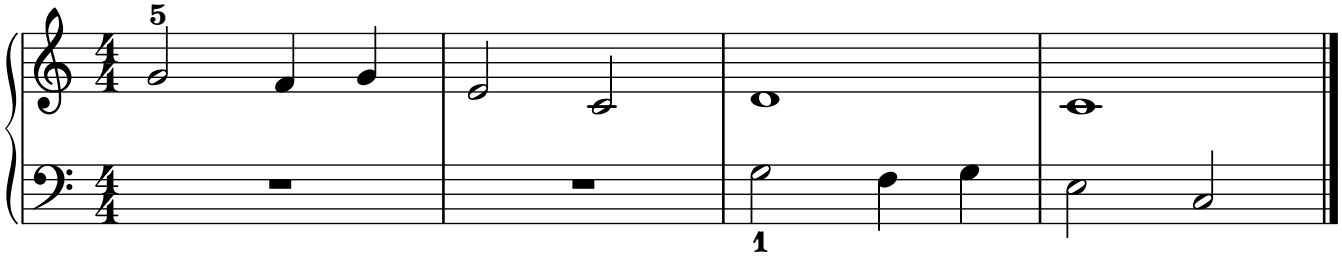
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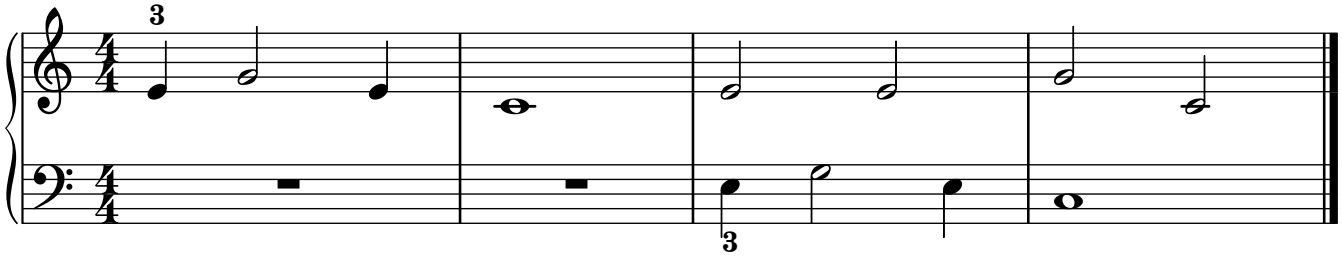
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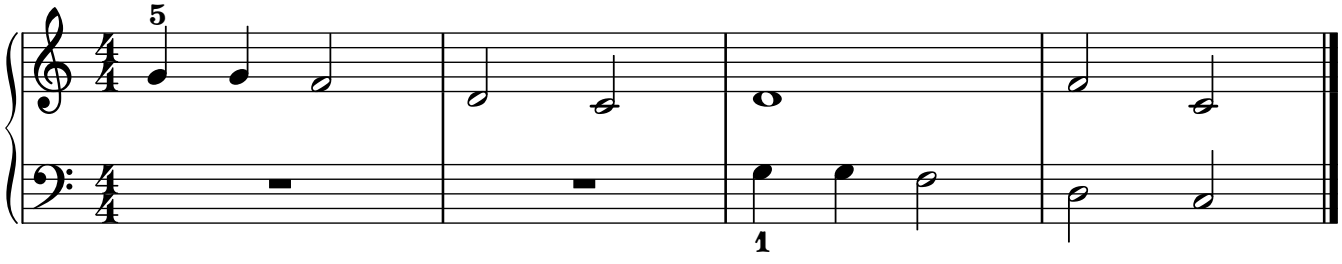
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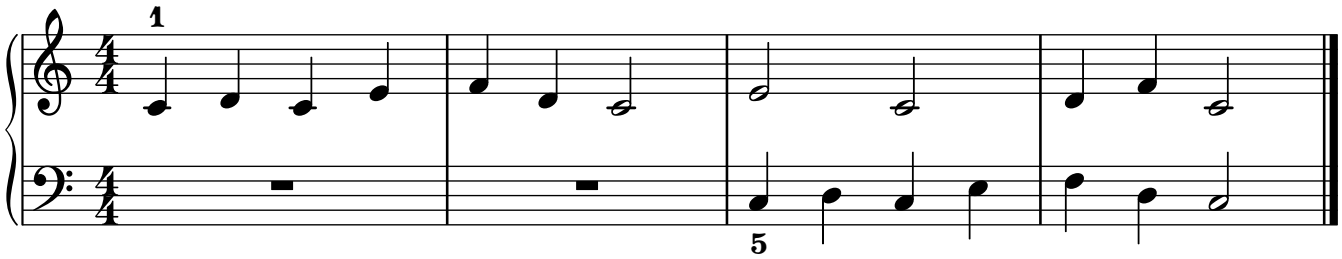
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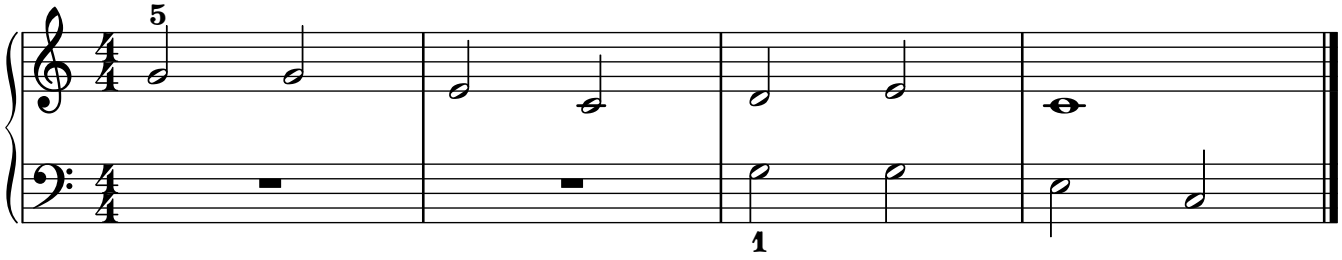


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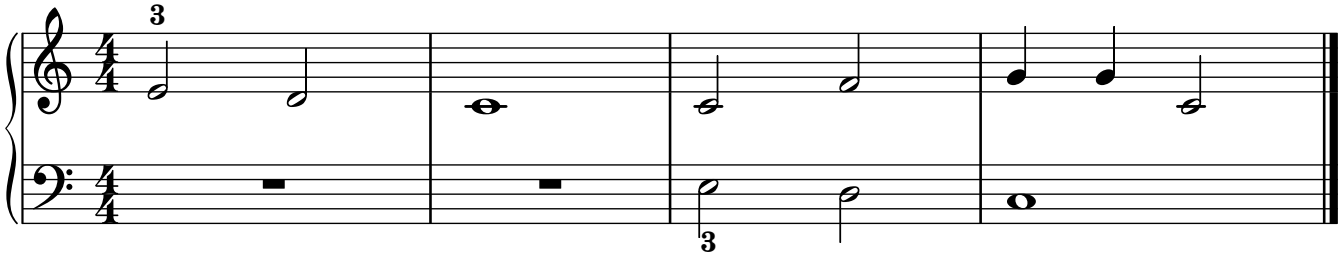
☐ **9.6**



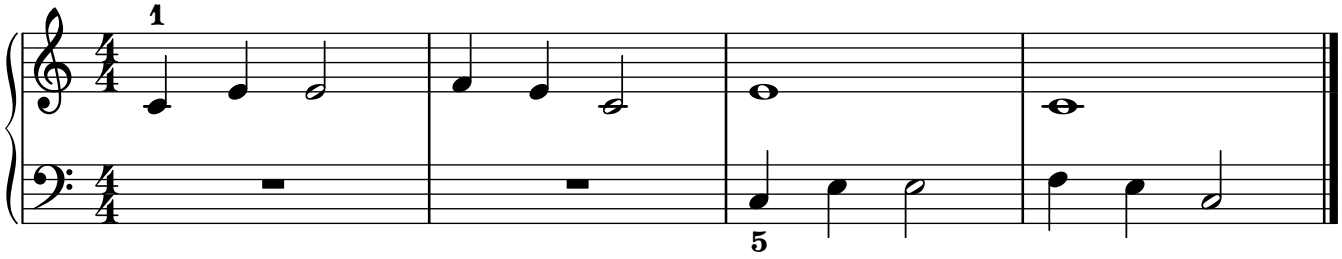
☐ **9.7**



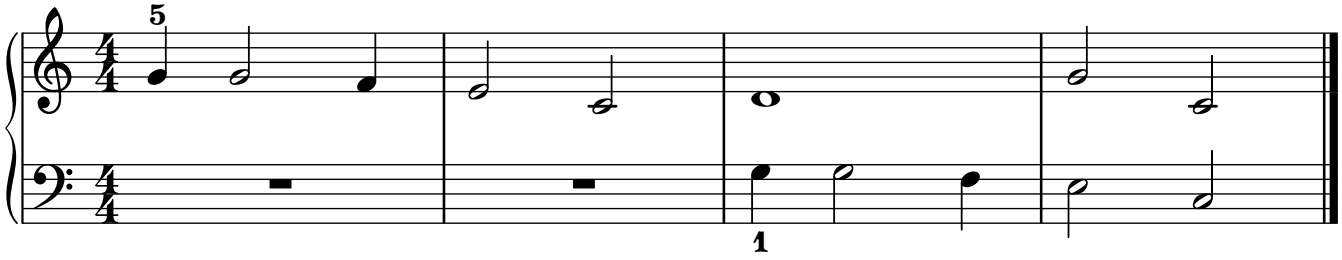
☐ **9.8**



☐ **9.9**



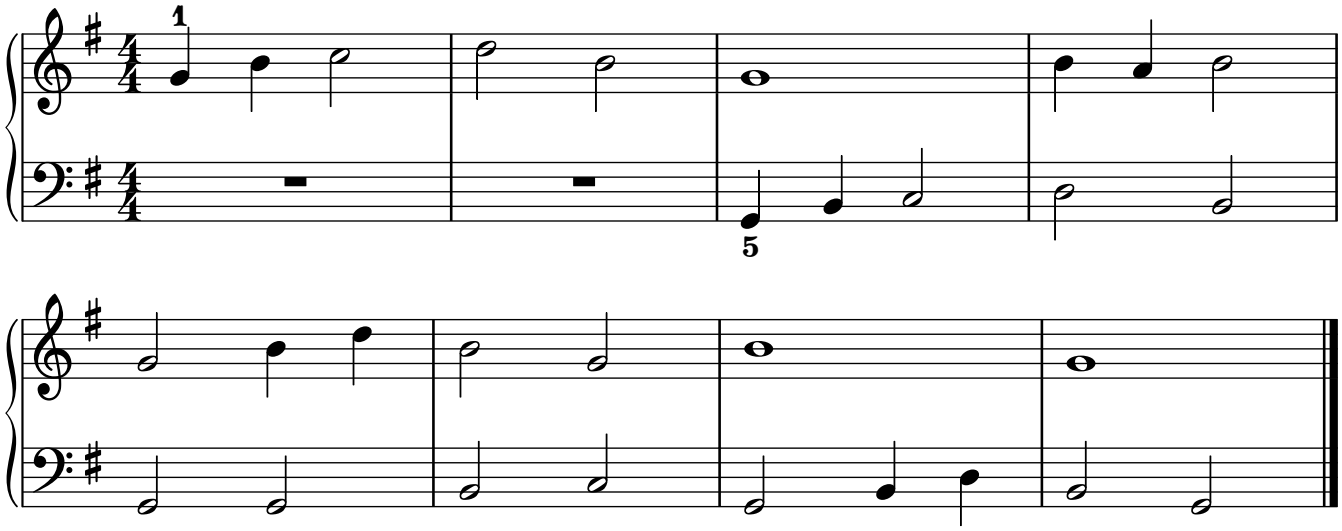
☐ **9.10**



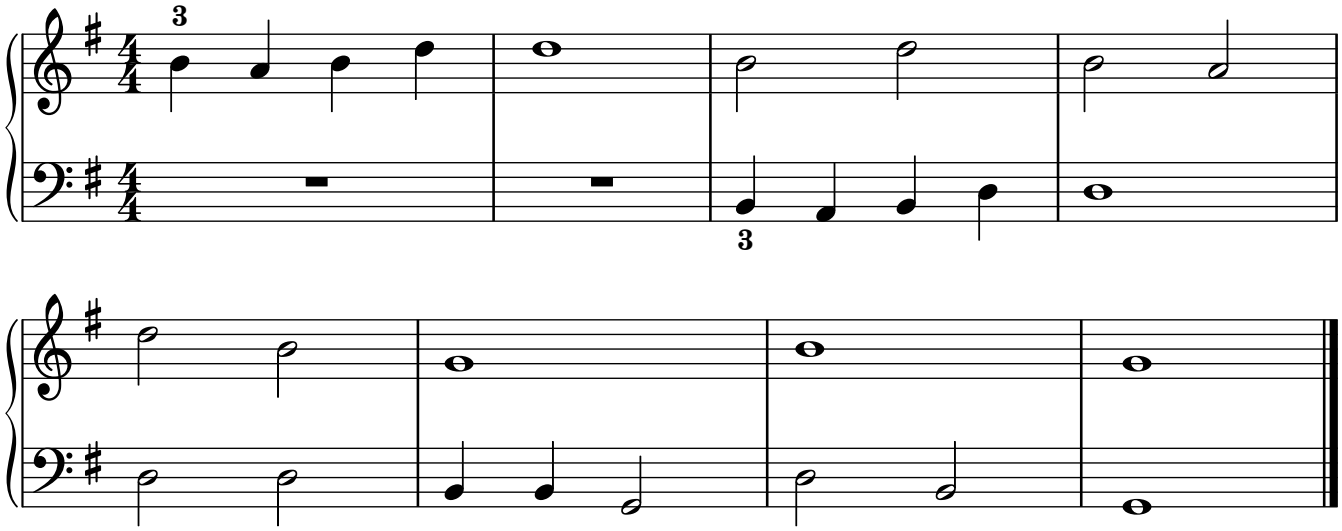
Part B: Two tunes, two answers ♩ = 60

G major, eight bars: two tunes, each answered two octaves lower. In bars 5-6 the left hand has a counter-melody under the second tune.

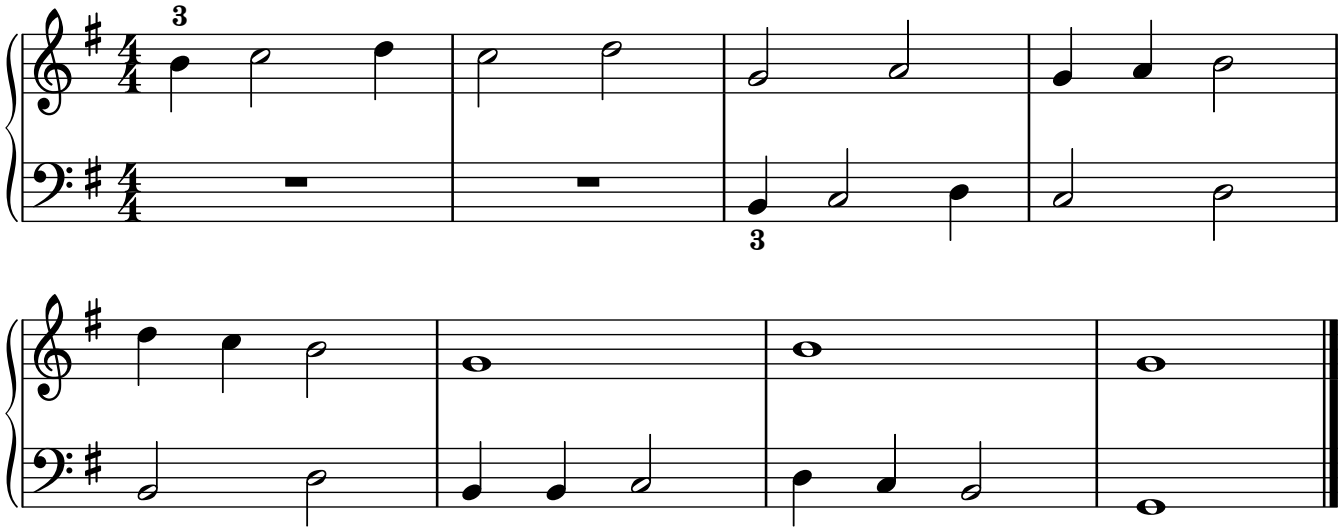
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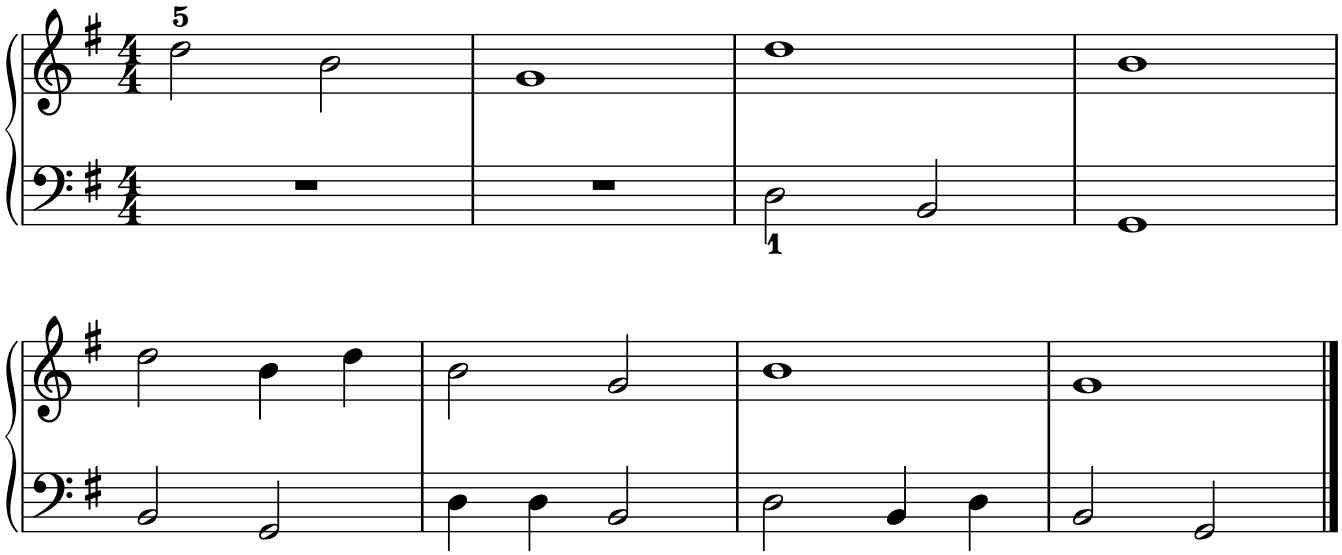


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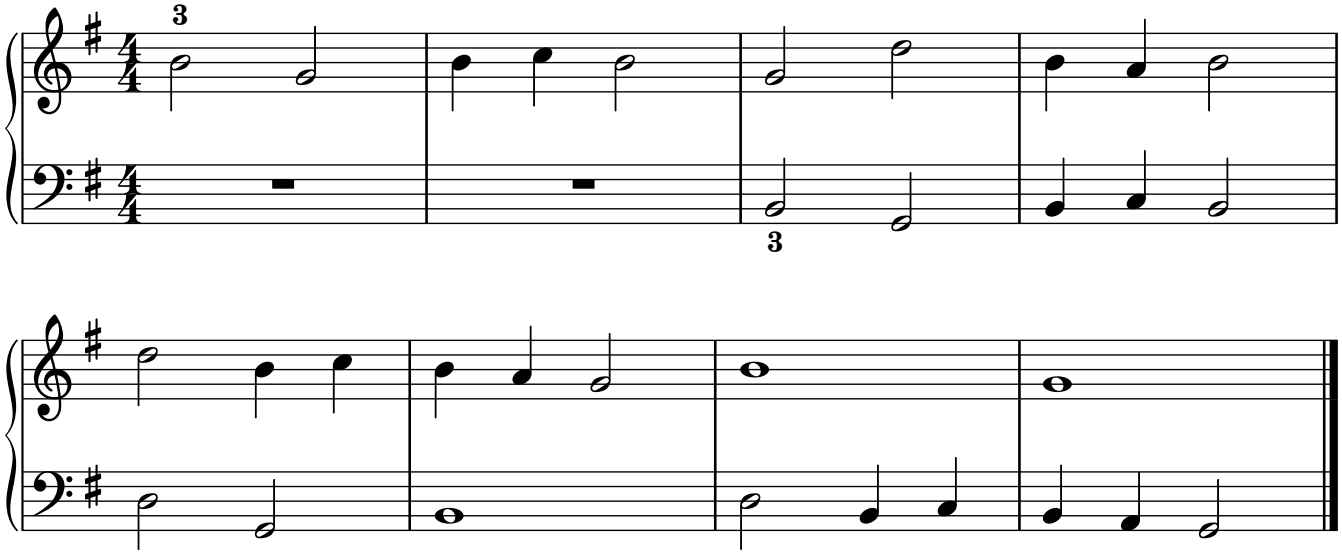
☐ **9.13**



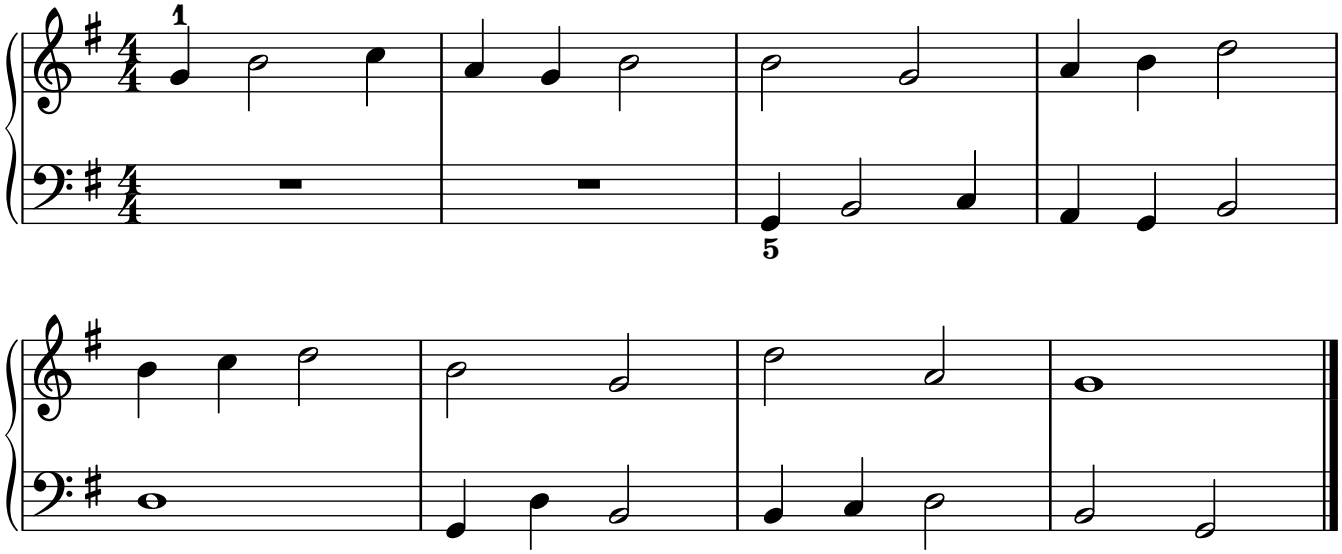
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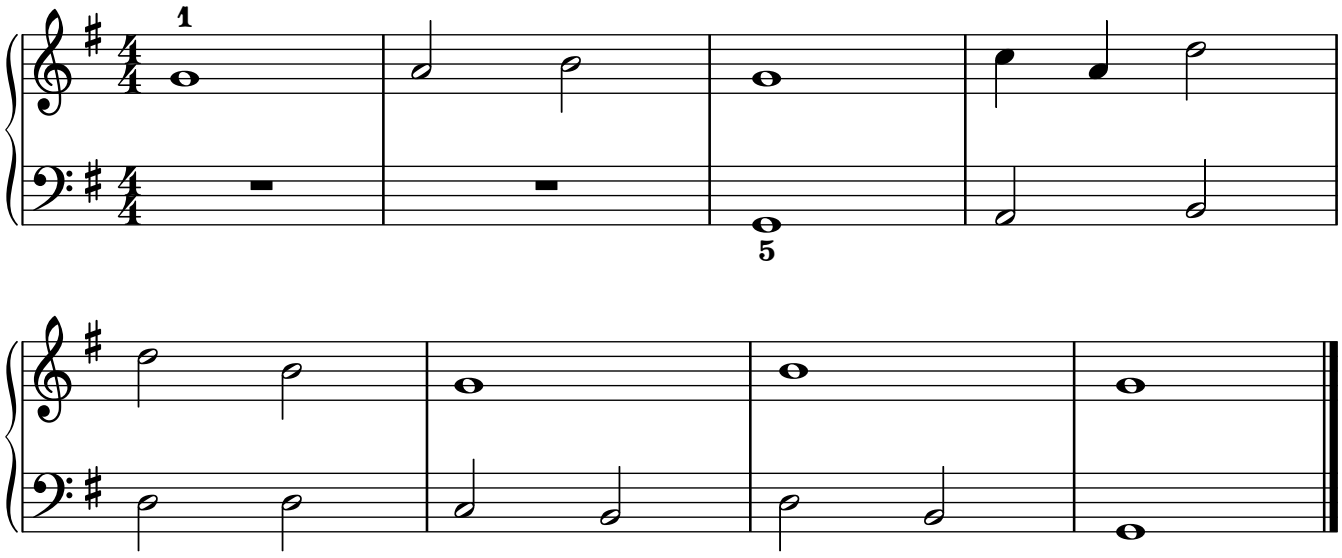
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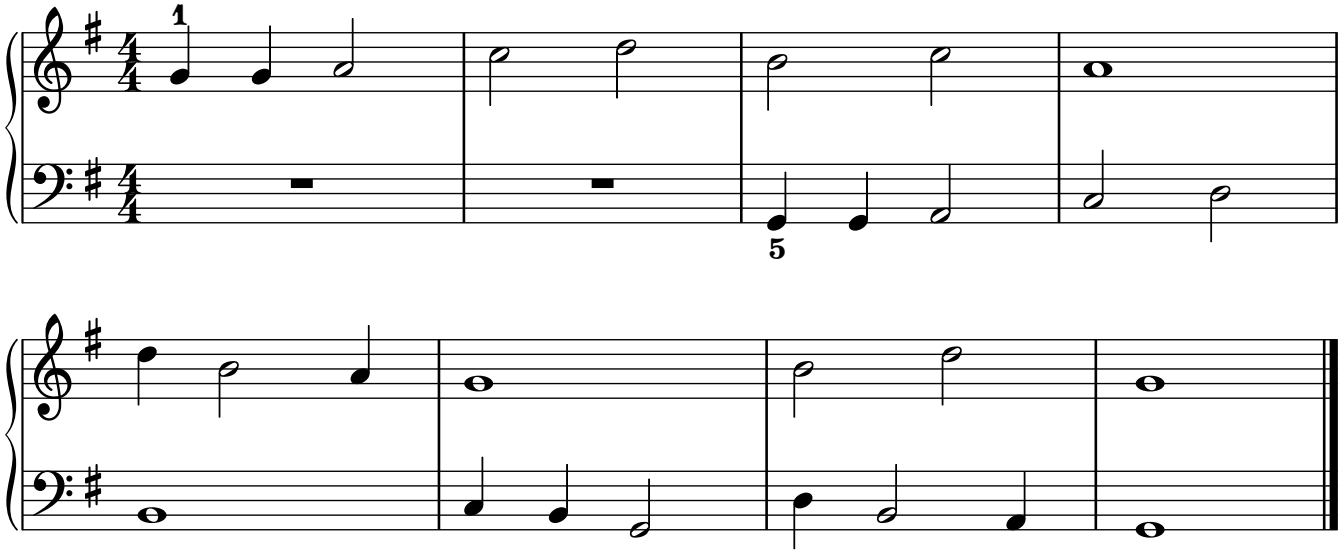


9.16



9.17



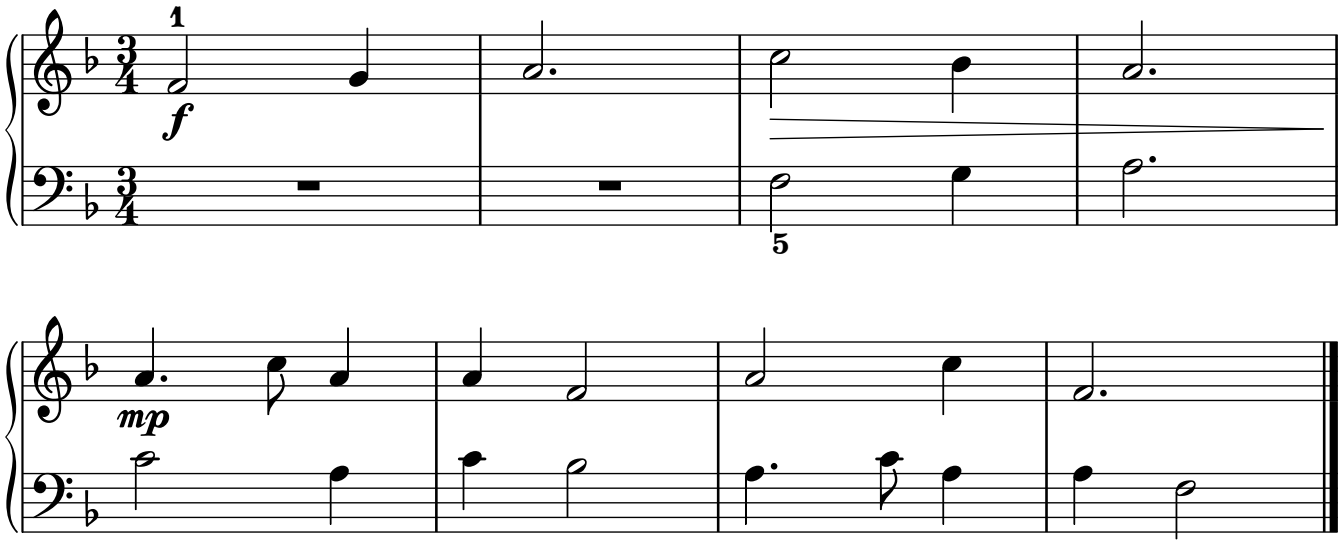
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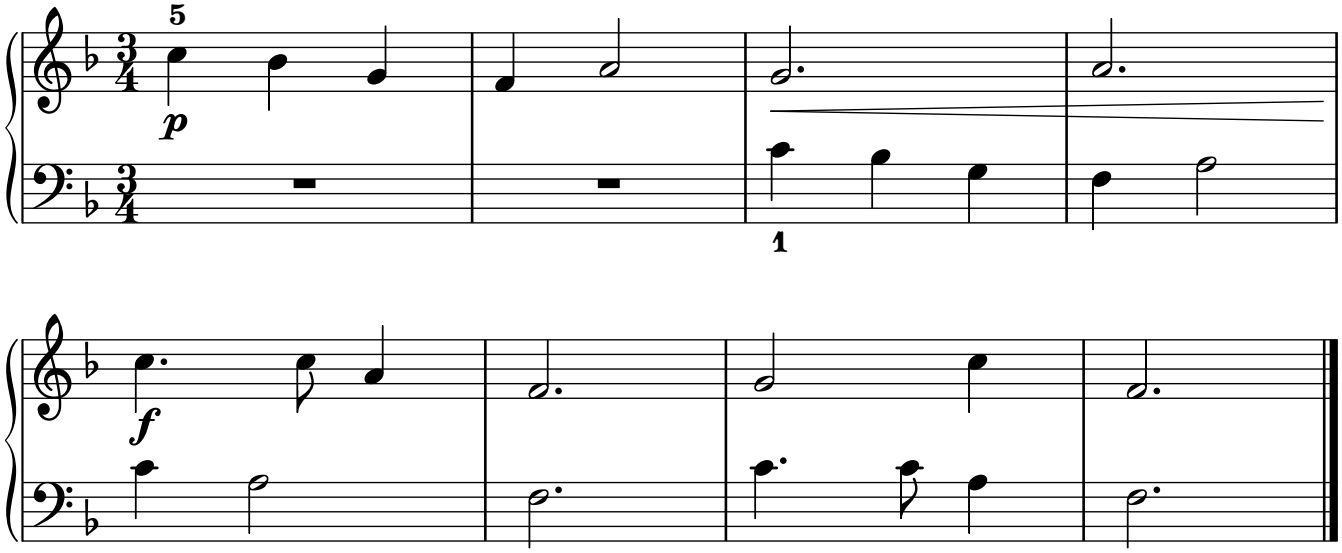


Part C: Imitation in 3/4 ♩ = 72

F major in 3/4.
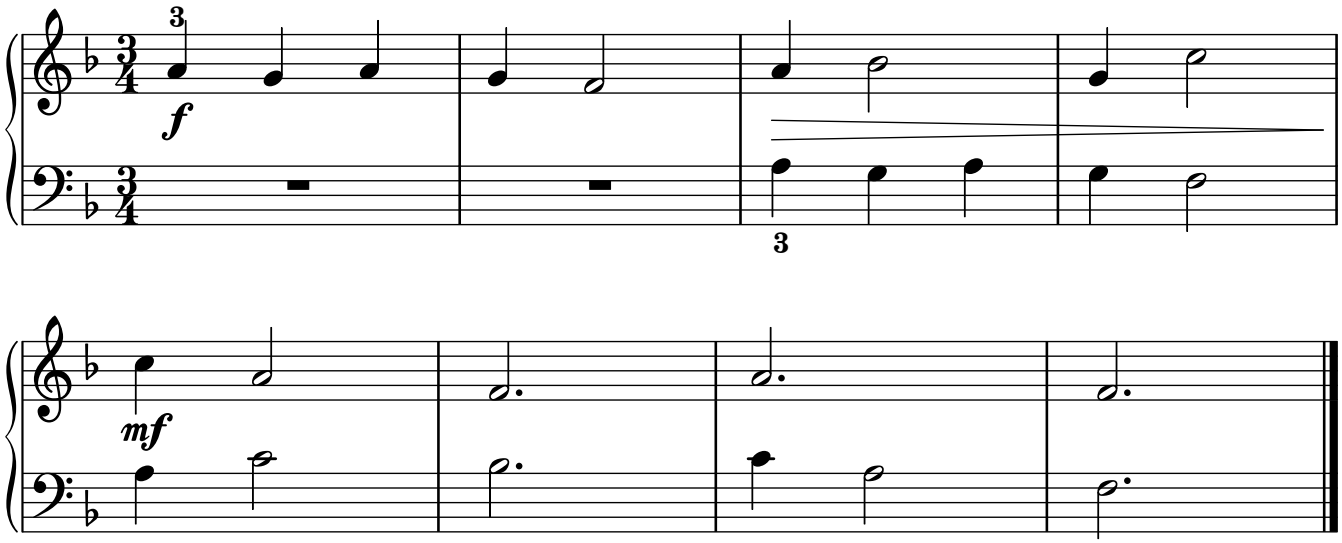
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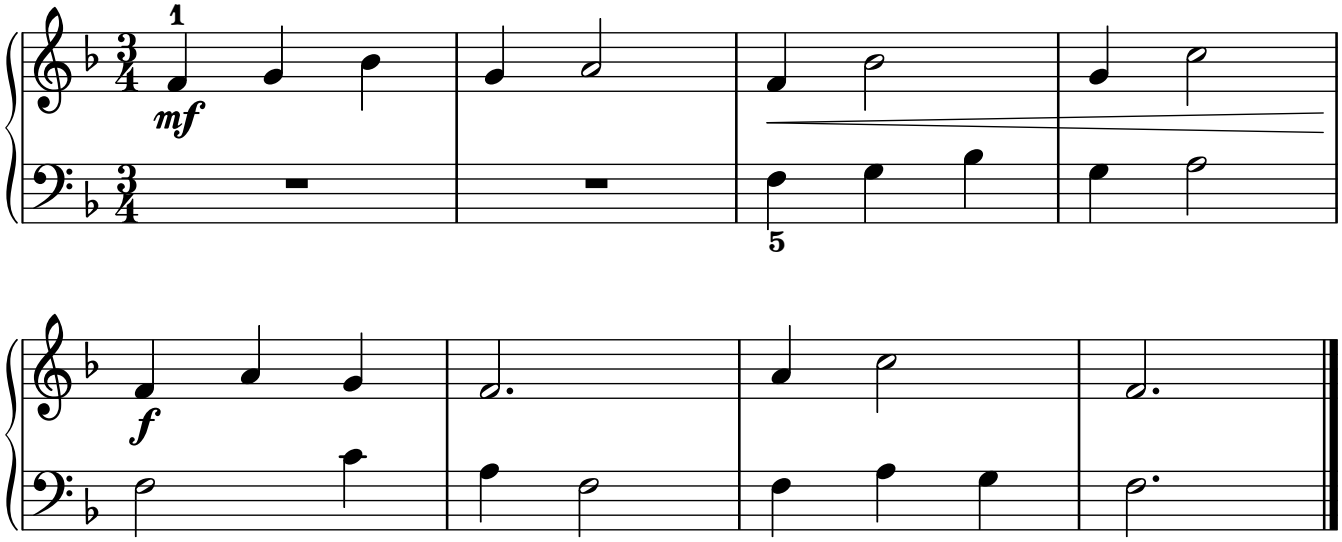


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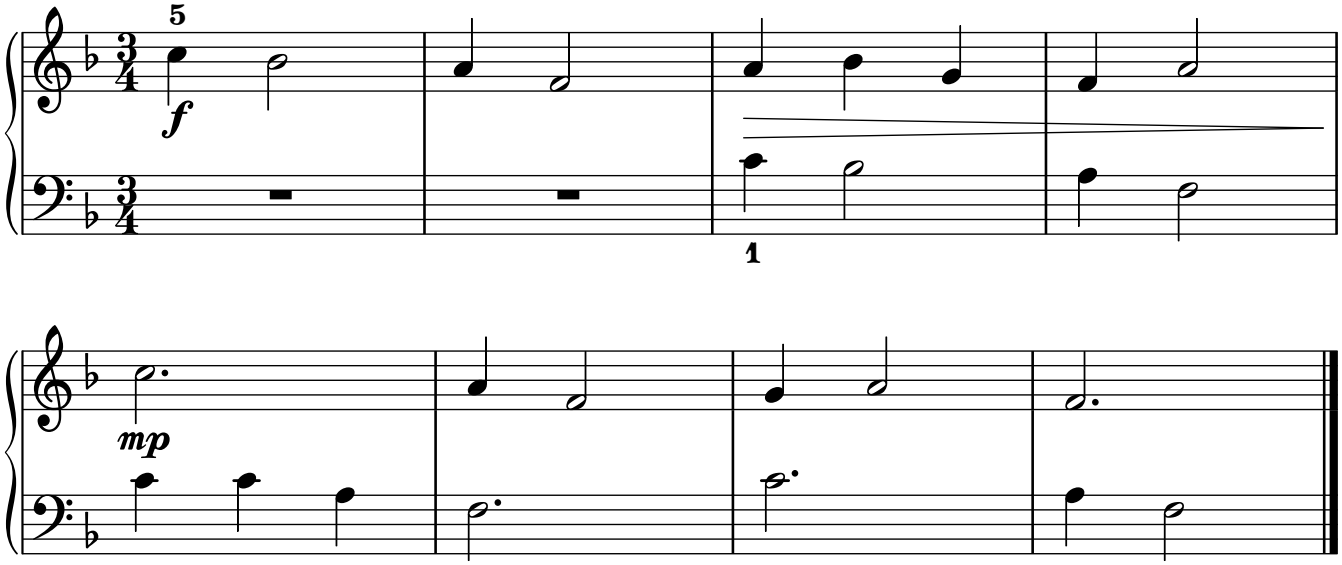


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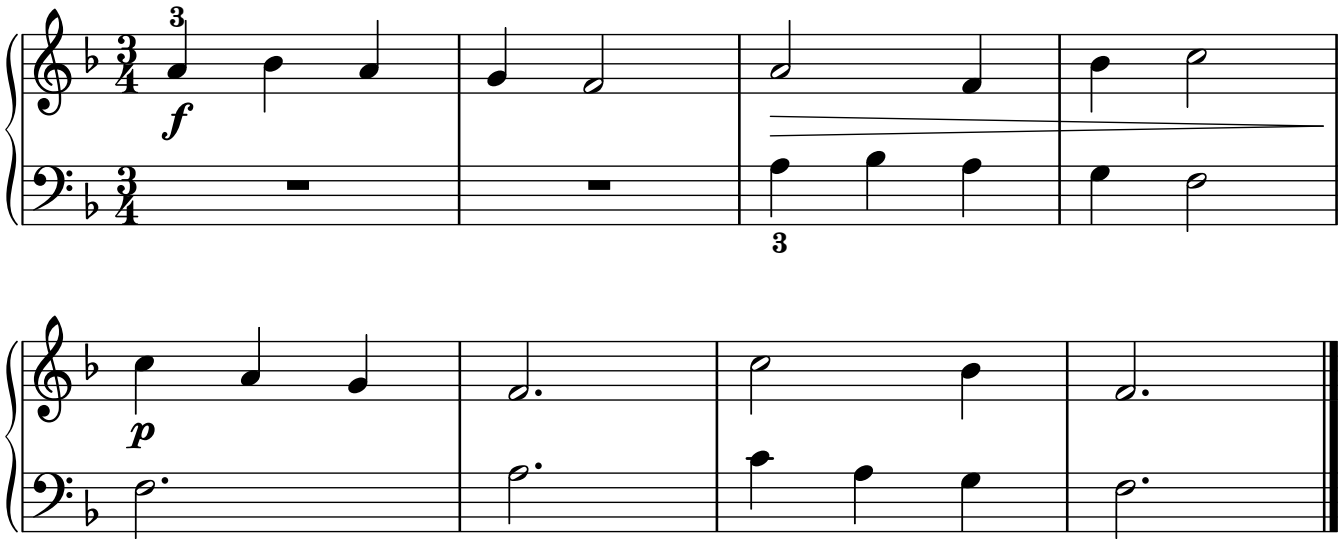


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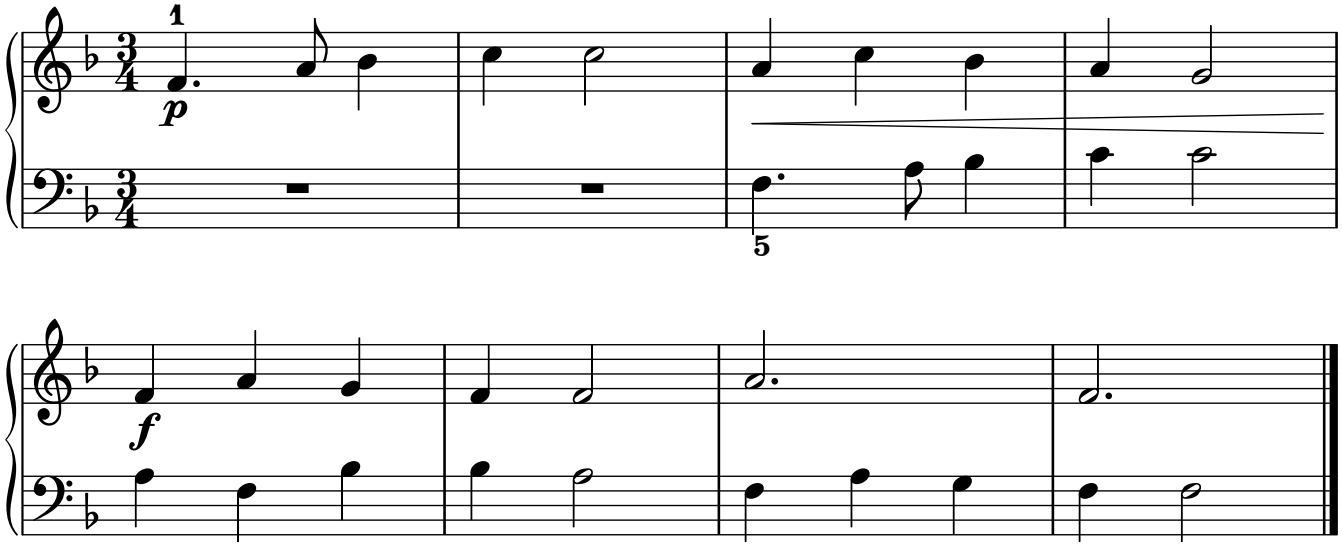


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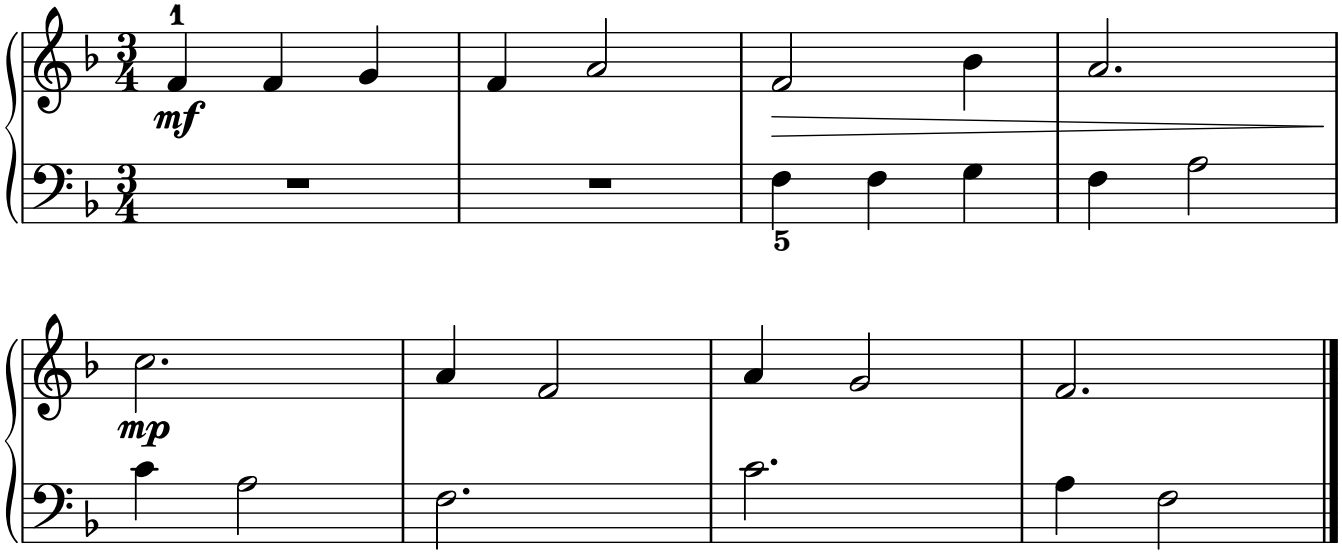


9.24



9.25



9.26
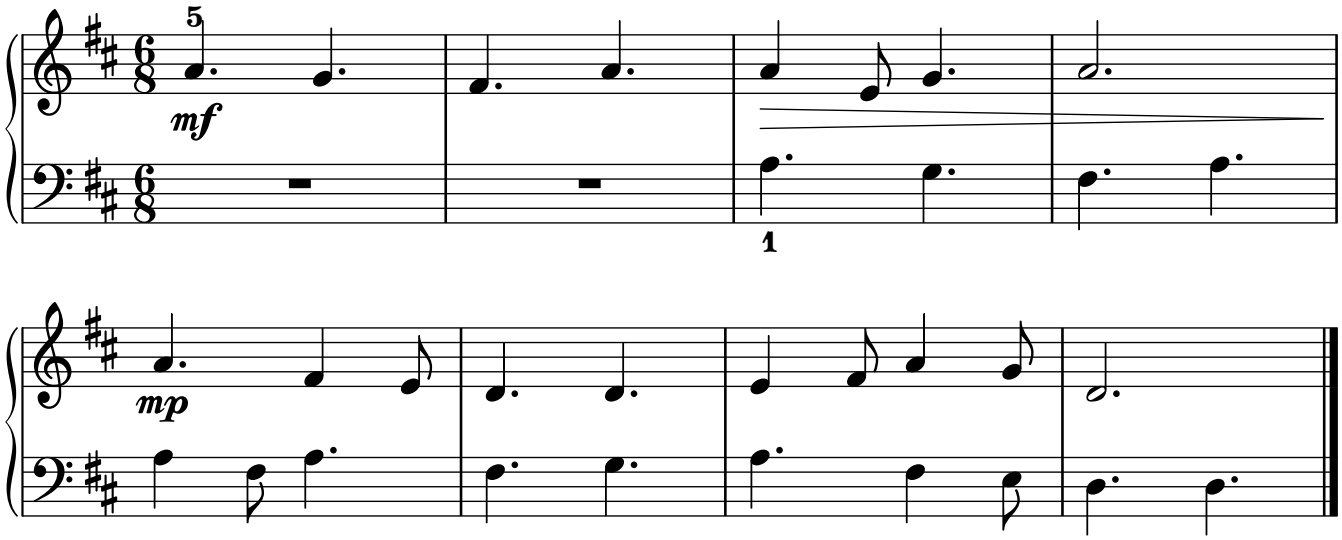


Part D: Imitation in 6/8
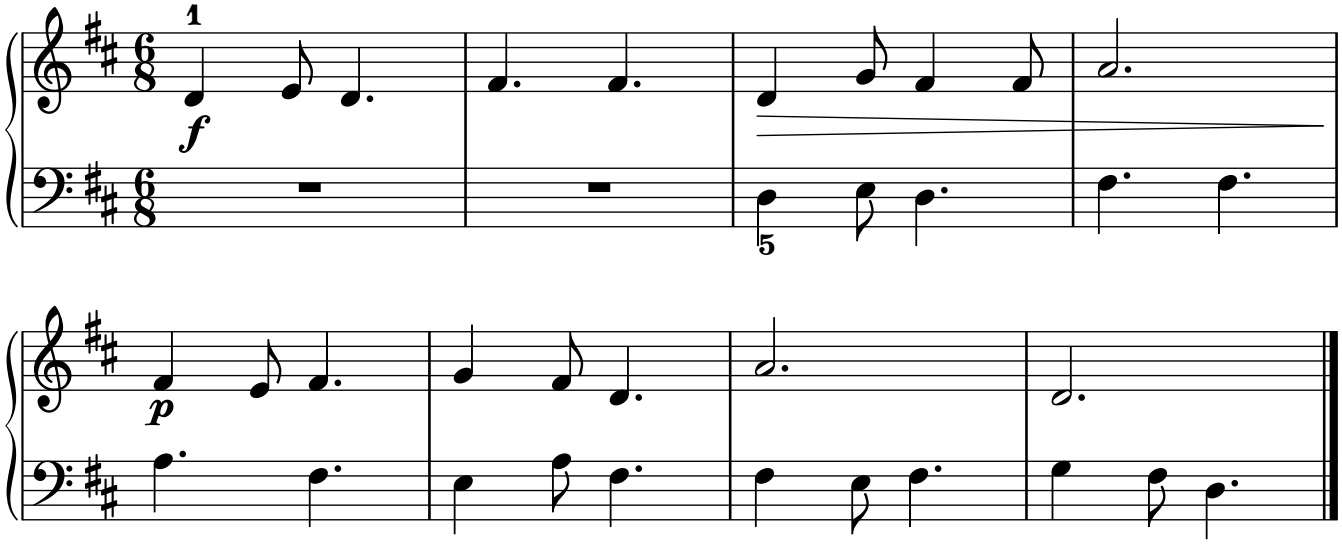
♩. = 50

D major in 6/8.
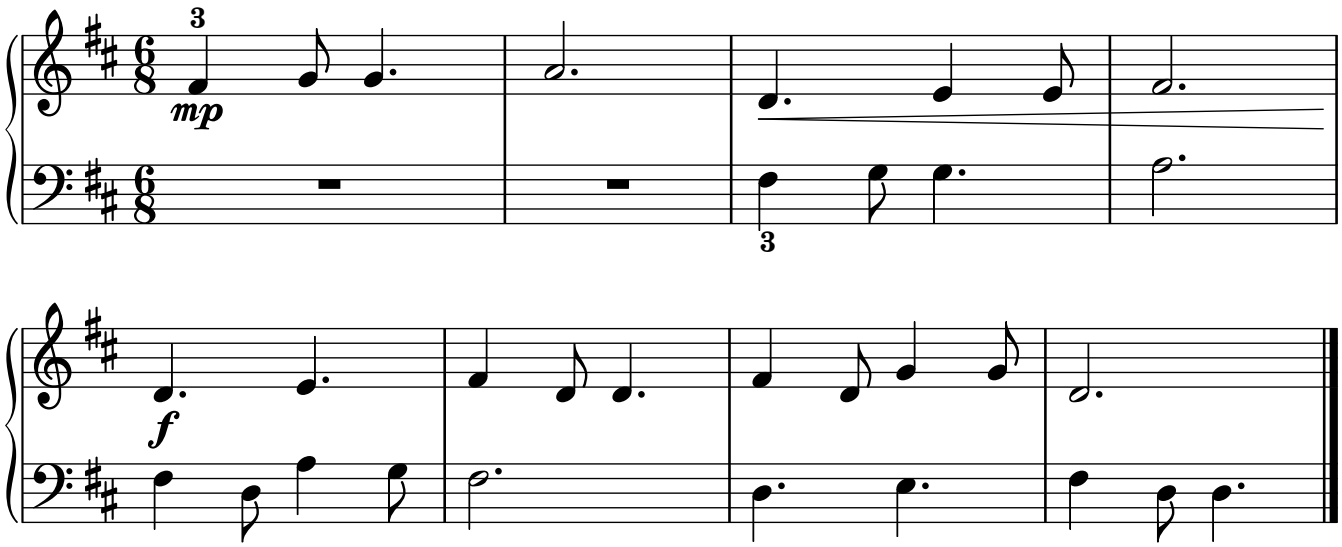
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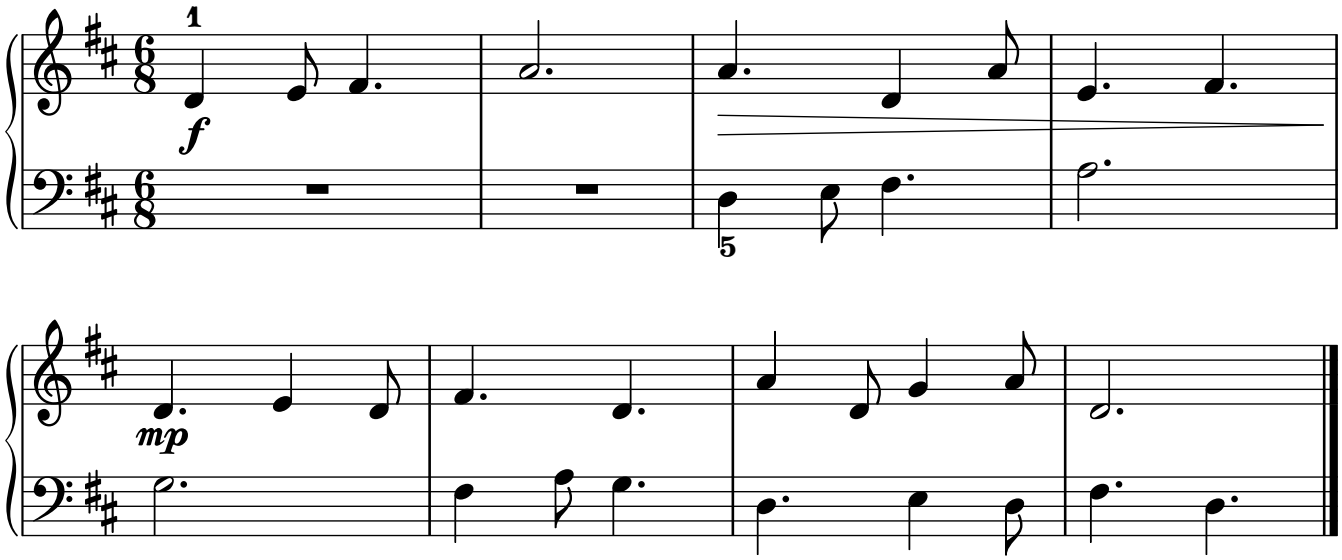


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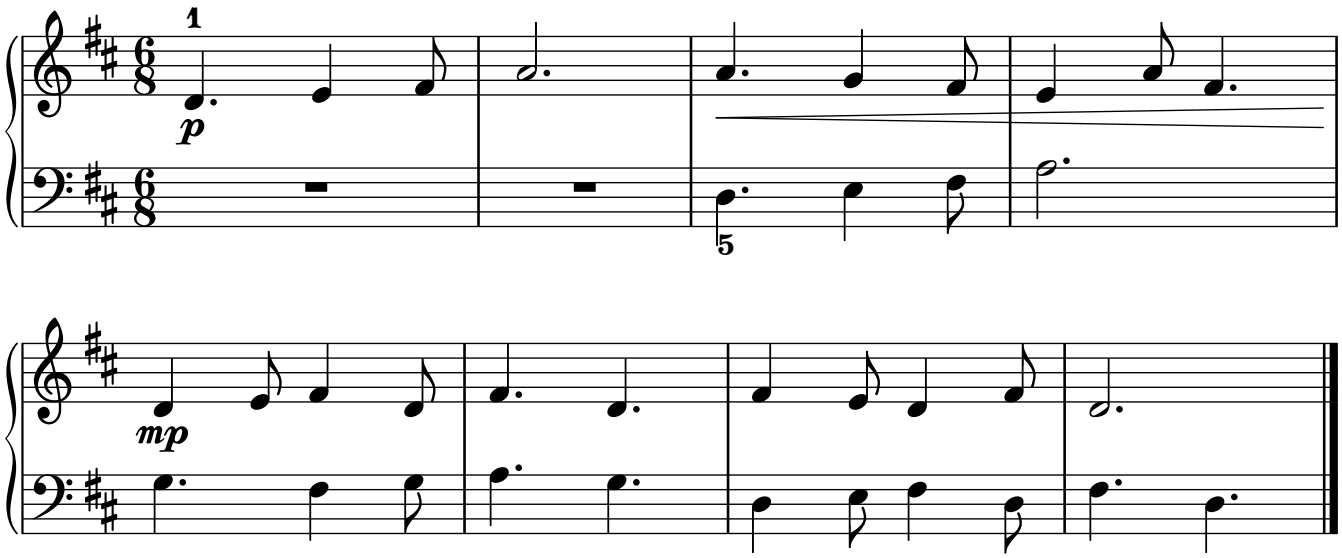


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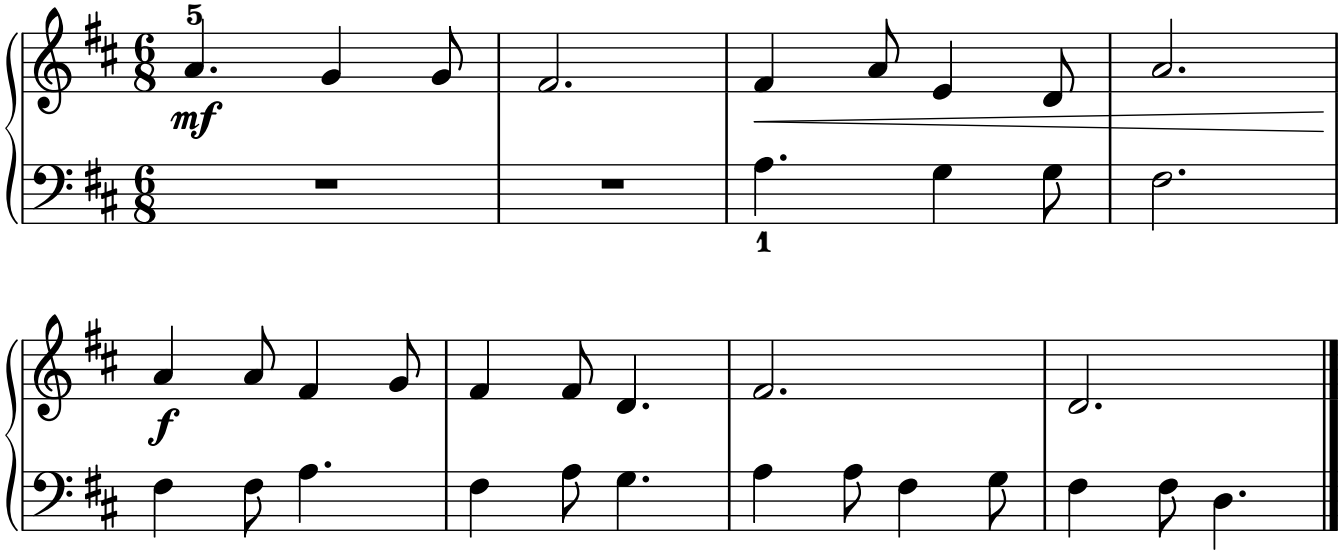


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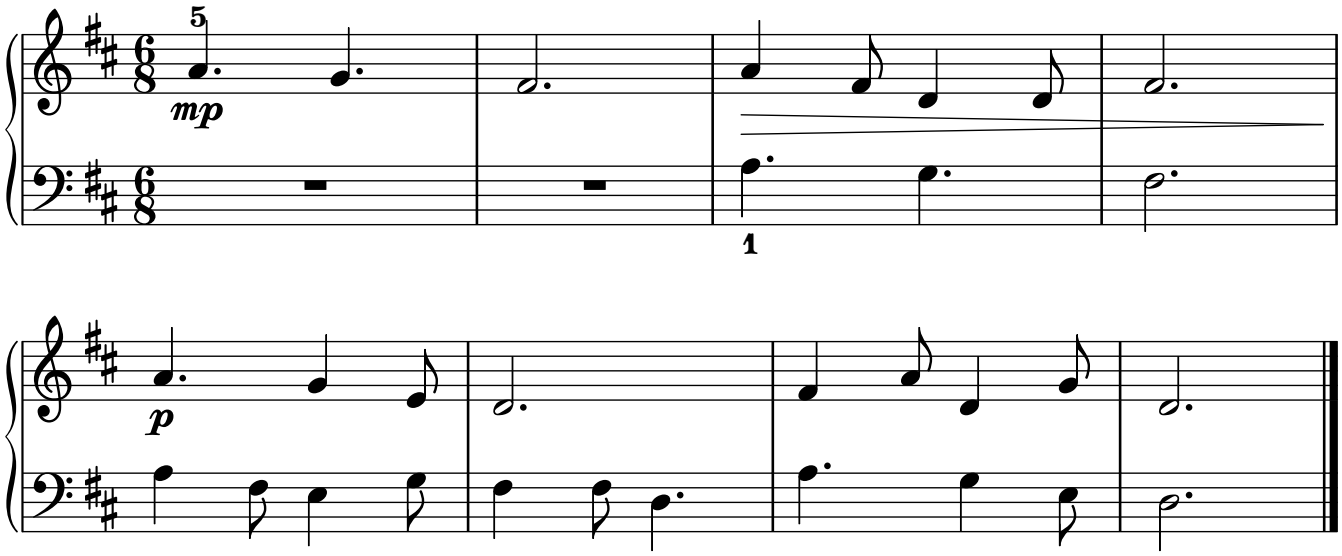


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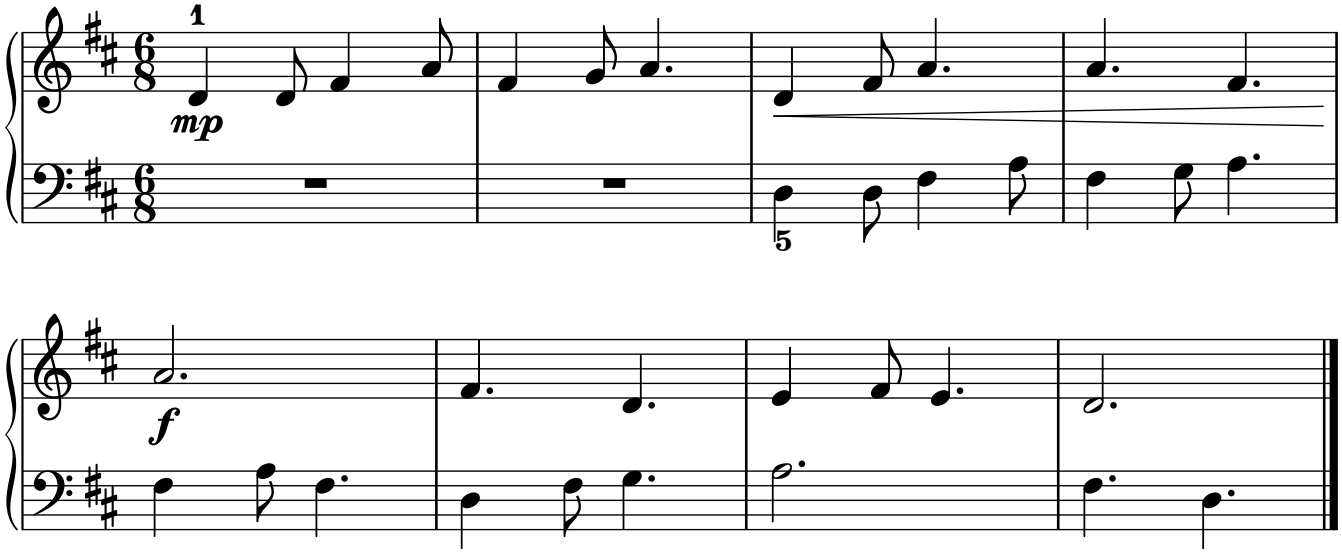


9.32



☐ **9.33**



☐ **9.34**
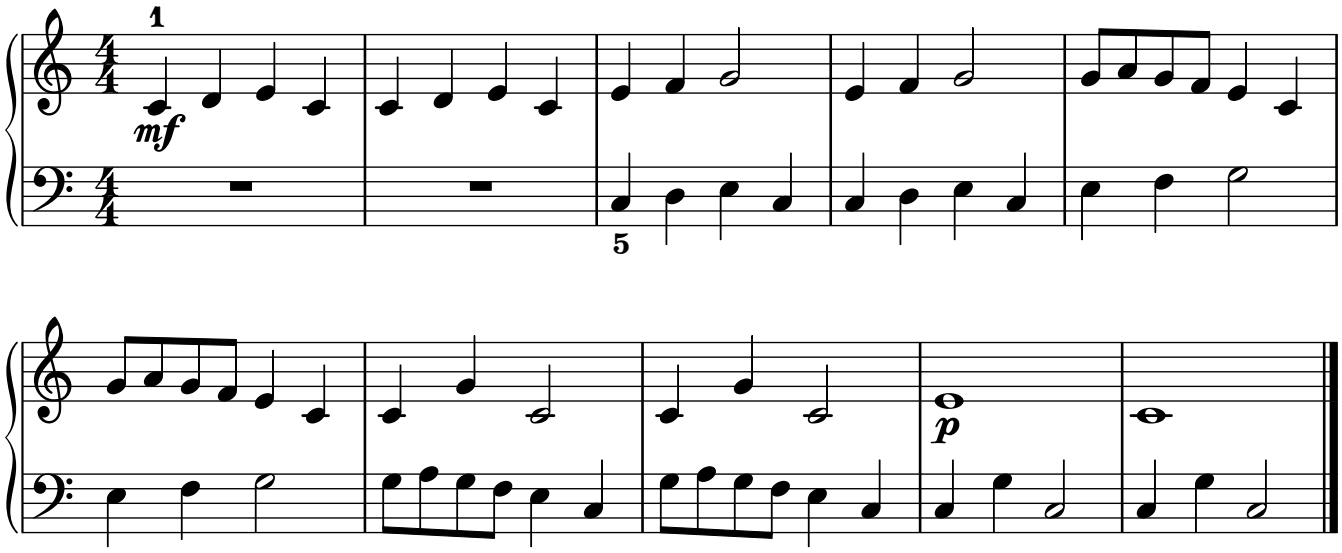


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Frère Jacques ♩ = 84

Traditional French round - simplified
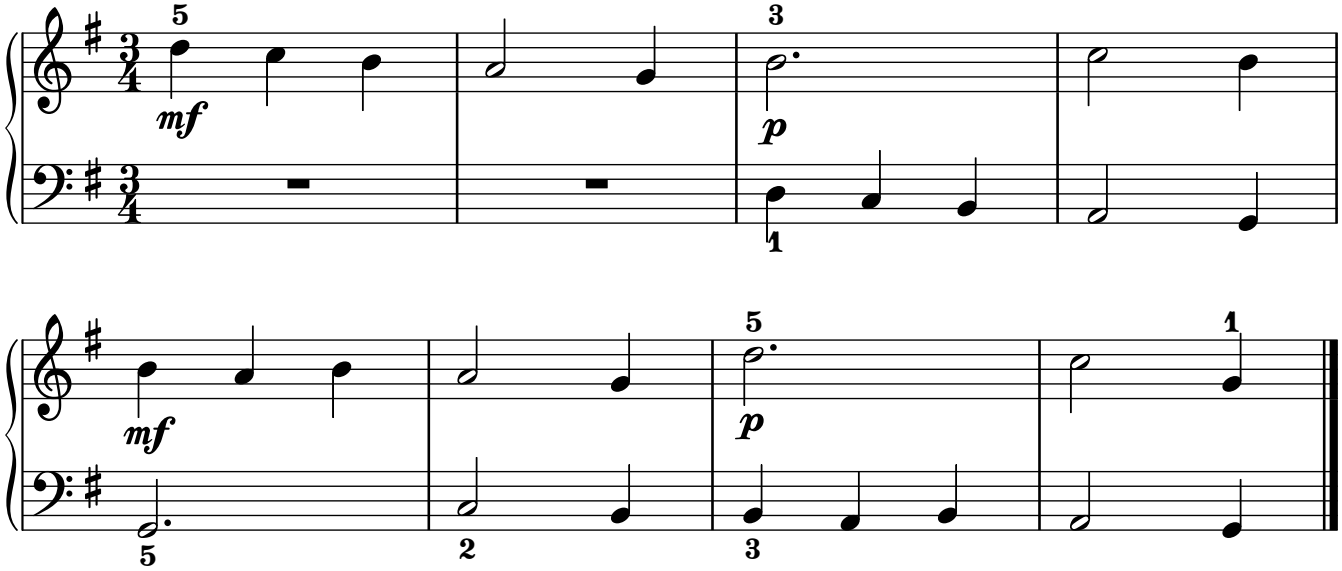
A round: the left hand starts the same song two bars after the right hand. In the last line of the tune each hand jumps up to G instead of down.



Echo Waltz ♩ = 84

Original

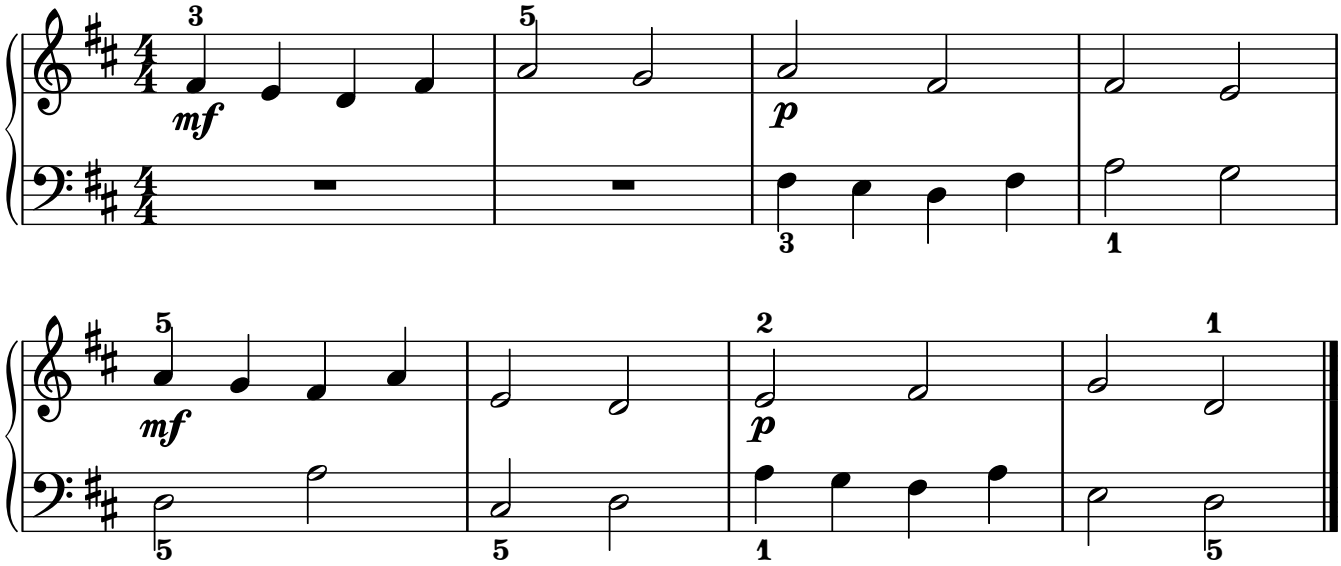
Two little tunes, each echoed two octaves lower by the left hand, under long right-hand notes.



Follow the Leader ♩ = 80

Original

Each two-bar tune is copied an octave lower by the left hand, in D position. In bar 6 the left hand stretches finger 5 down to C-sharp.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 10?

- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- The left hand comes in on time, and the tune passes clearly from hand to hand. Then move on to Unit 10.

Unit 10

Review

New: Everything in Volume 3 together

This unit mixes everything in Volume 3: broken chords and Alberti basses, 6/8, the keys of D major and B-flat major, B minor with its raised 7th, two notes at once, two independent voices and imitation. Before each exercise, use the five-point scan below.

What is new

1. Key
Two sharps, two flats, or a minor key? In a minor key, look for the raised 7th.

2. Time
4/4, 3/4 or 6/8? In 6/8, feel two beats in a bar.

3. Left hand
Broken chords, Alberti bass, lilting bass, or a melody of its own? Find the first chord shape or the first note and finger.

4. Right hand
Two-note chords, stretches, and accidentals.

5. Entries
In imitation, where does the left hand come in, and with which tune?

Reading tips

1. Read in two-bar phrases, not note by note: most patterns repeat.
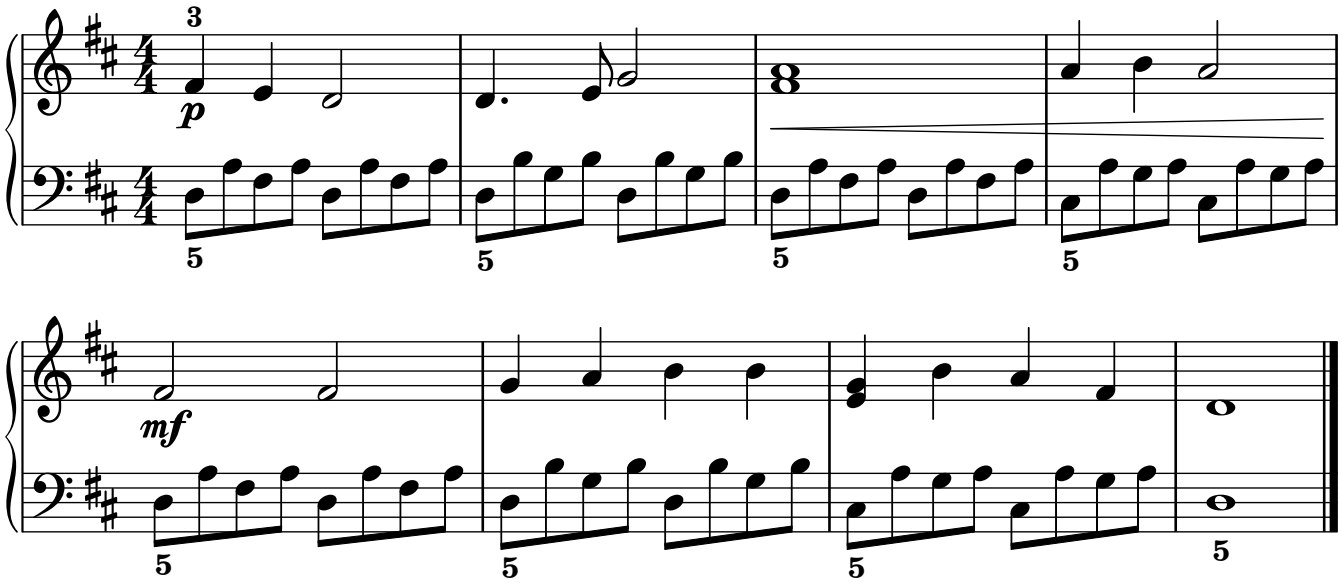
2. Keep the accompaniment softer than the tune, whichever hand has it.

3. If something goes wrong, keep the beat and rejoin at the next bar line.
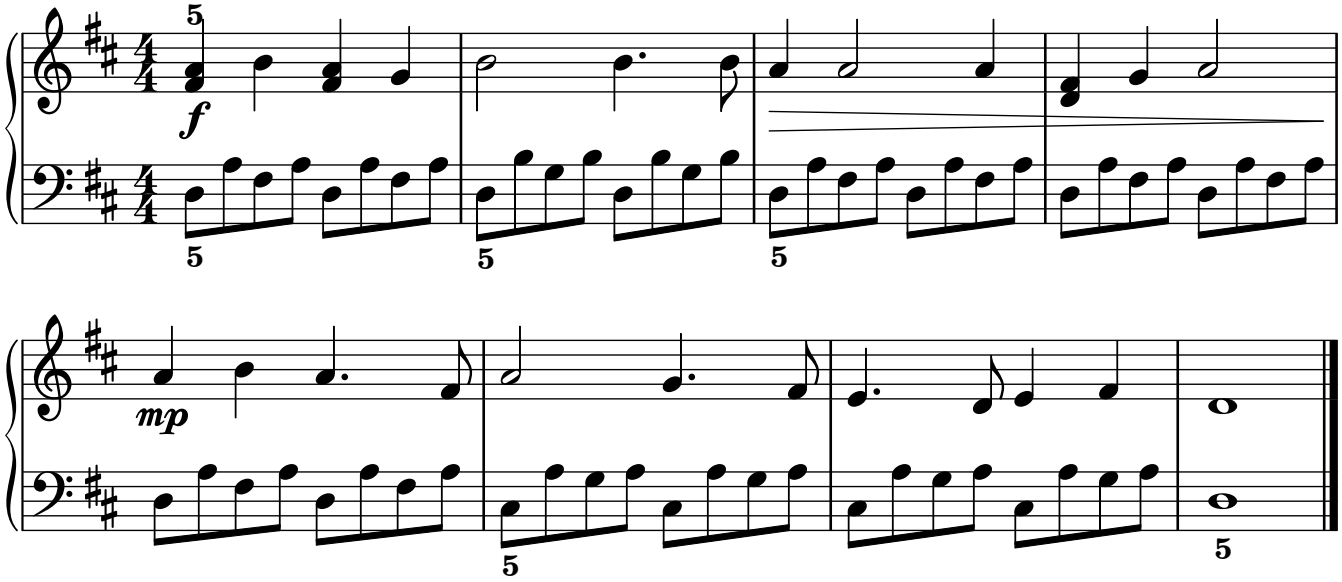
Part A: D major: Alberti bass and thirds ♩ = 60

D major: an Alberti bass under a tune with some thirds.
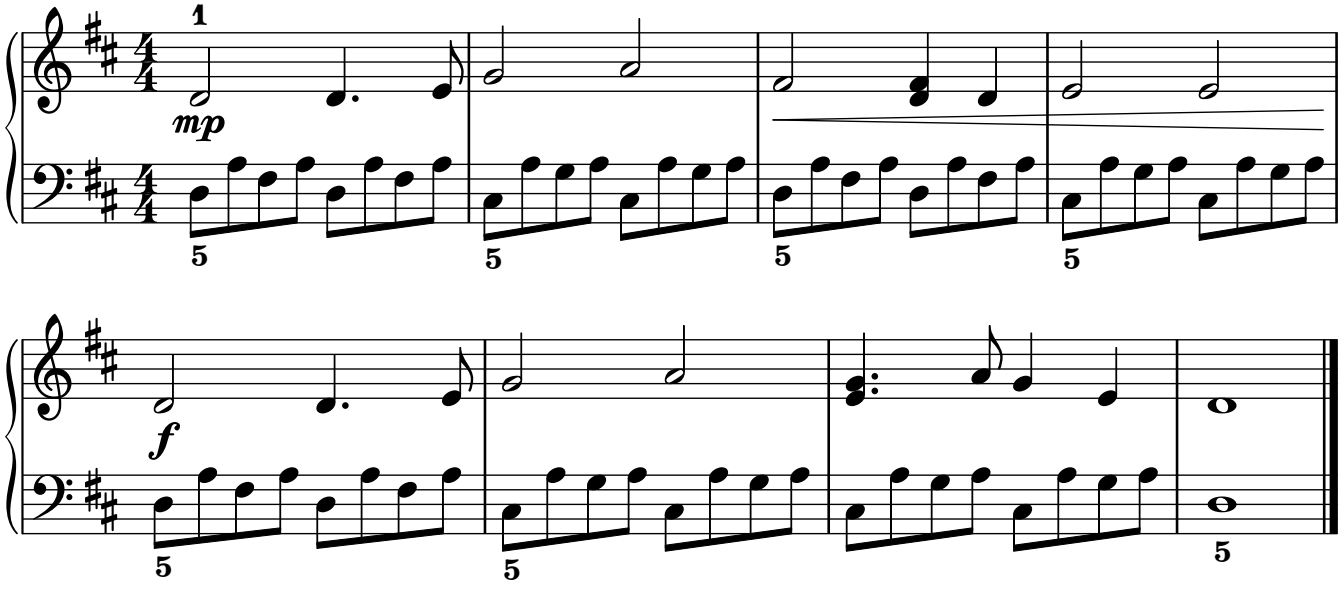
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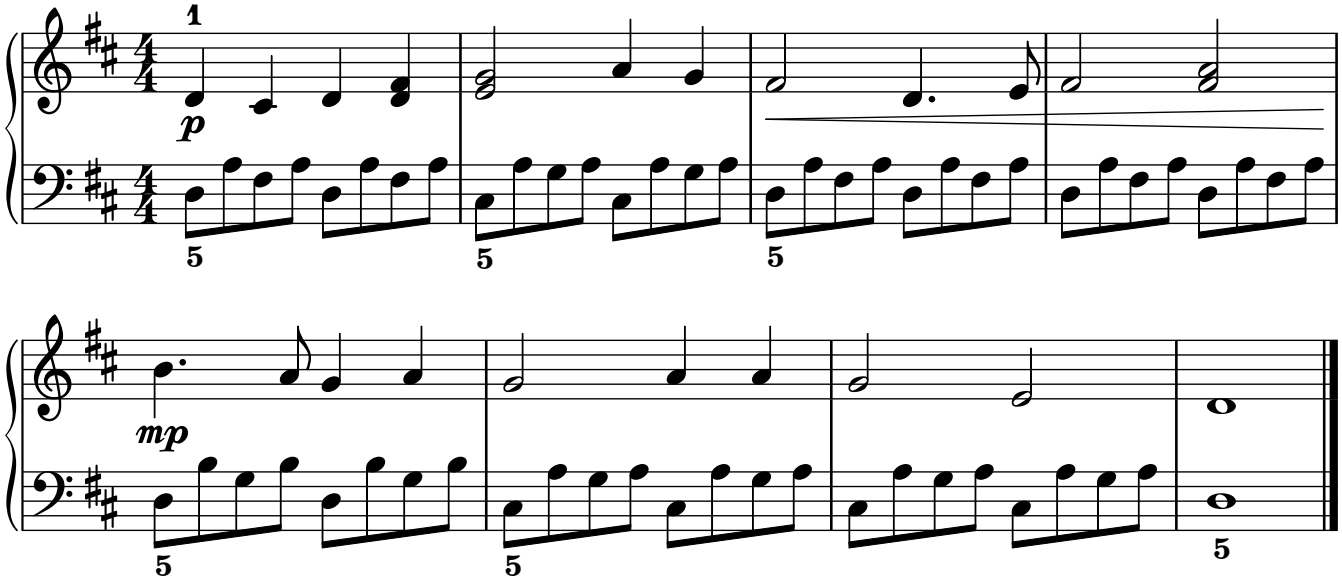


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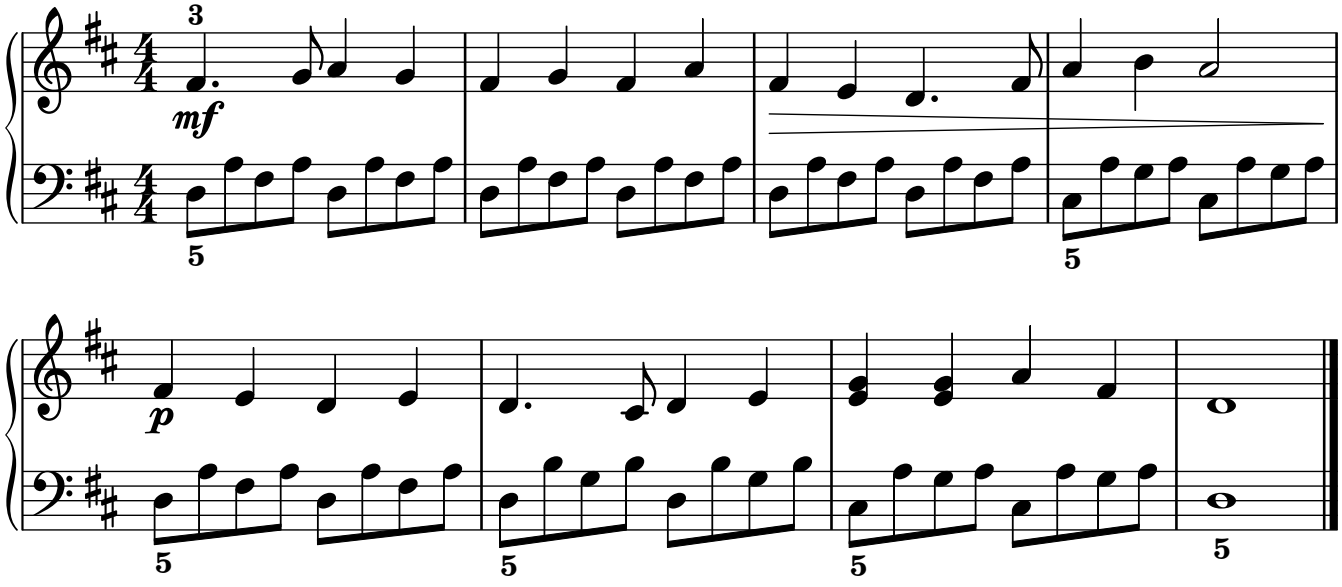


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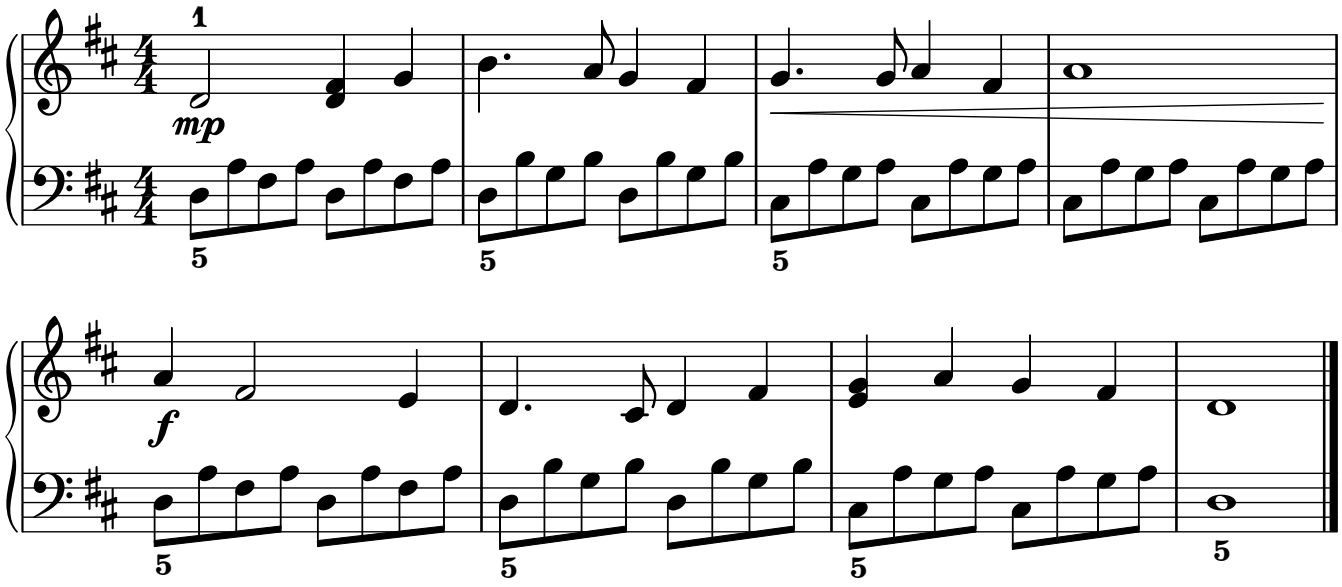


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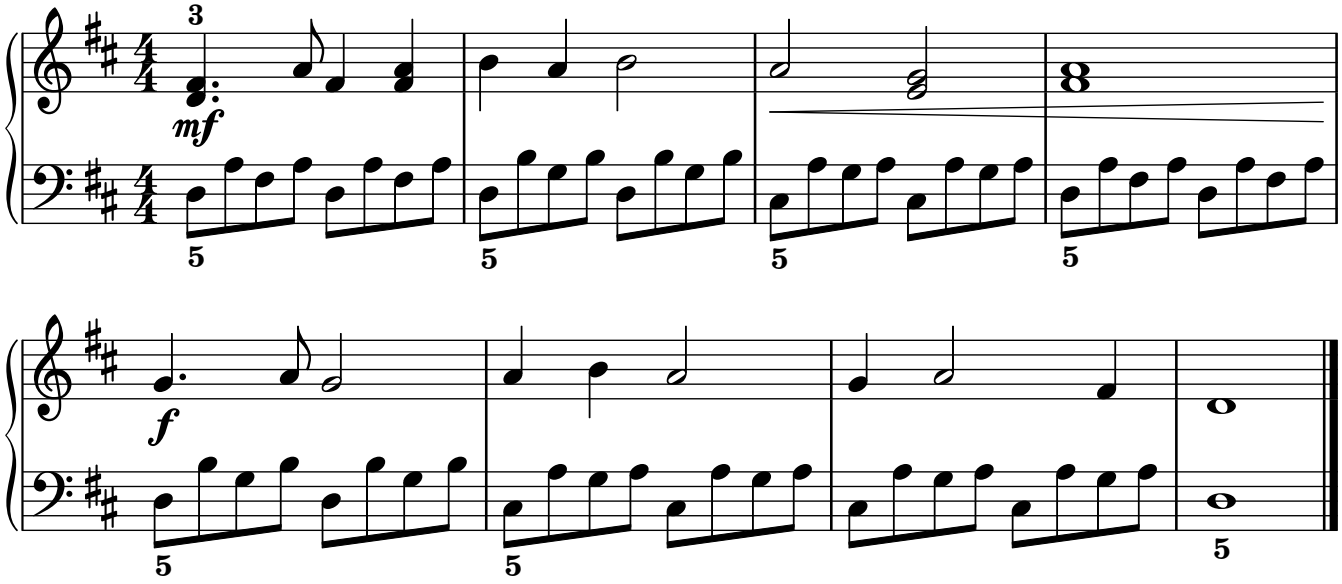


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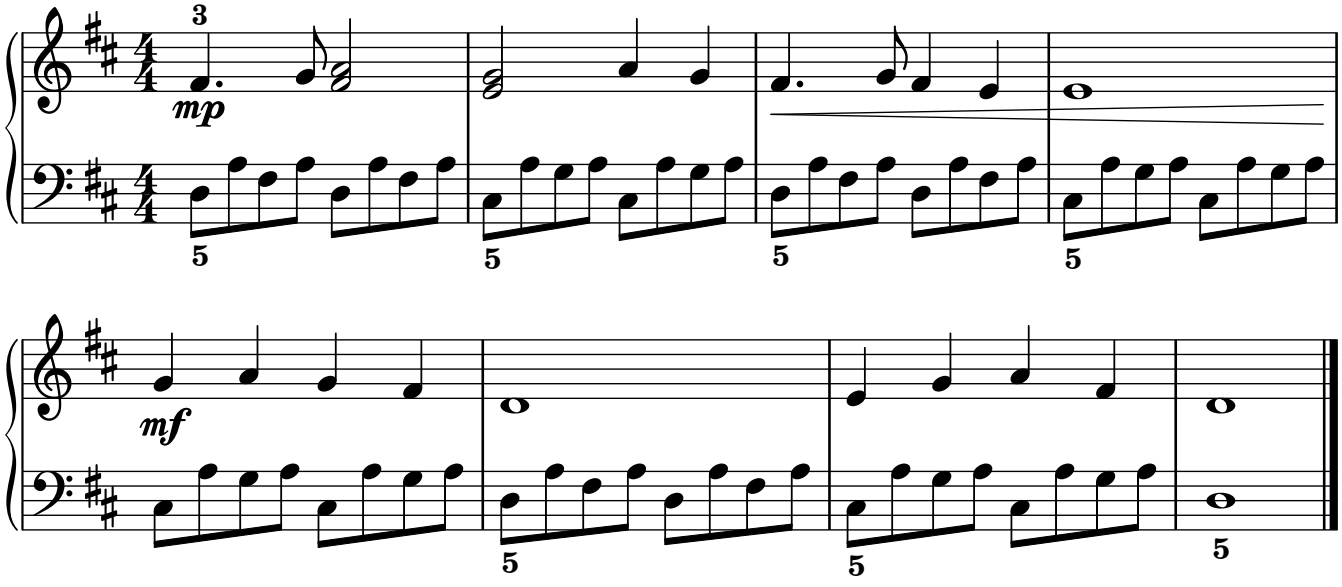


10.6



10.7



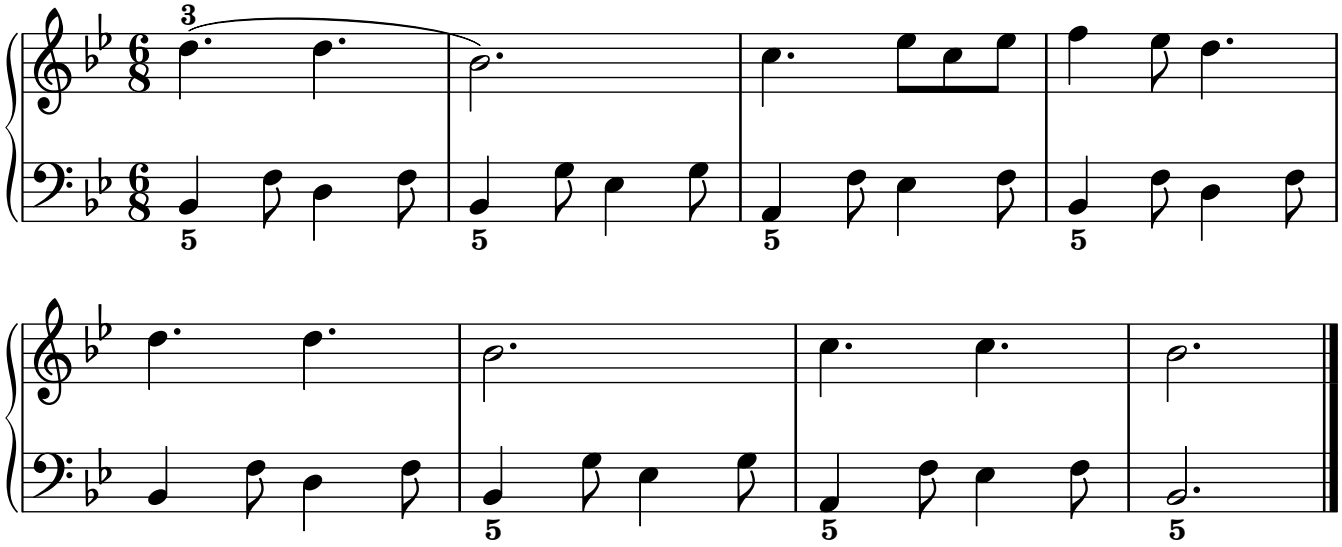
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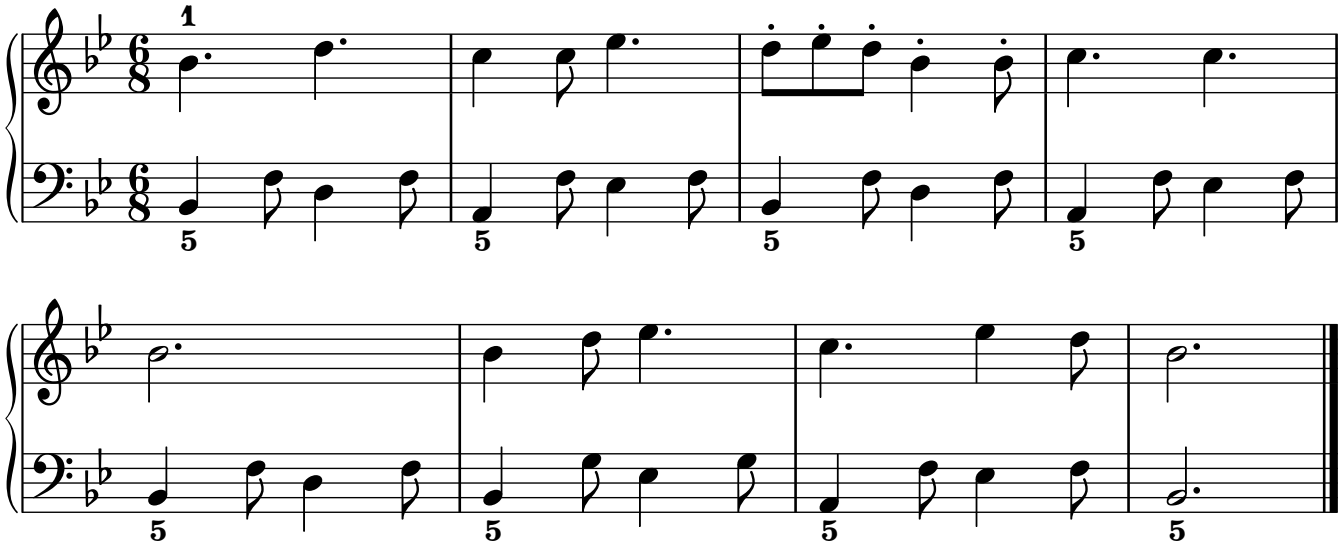


Part B: B-flat major in 6/8 ♩. = 50

B-flat major in 6/8, with the lilting bass.
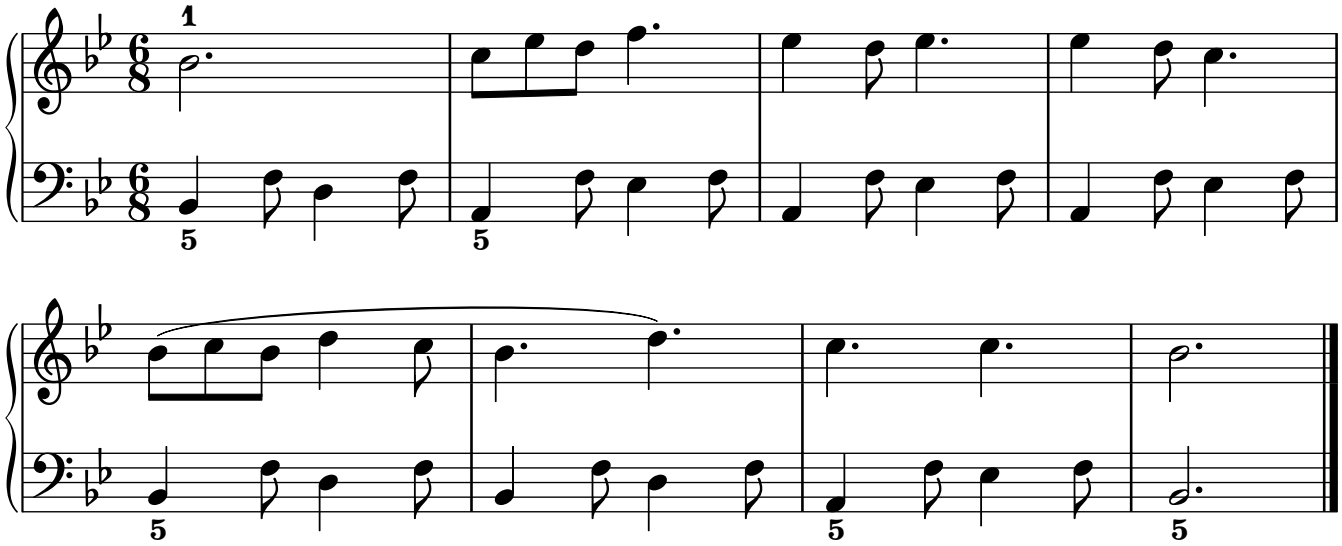
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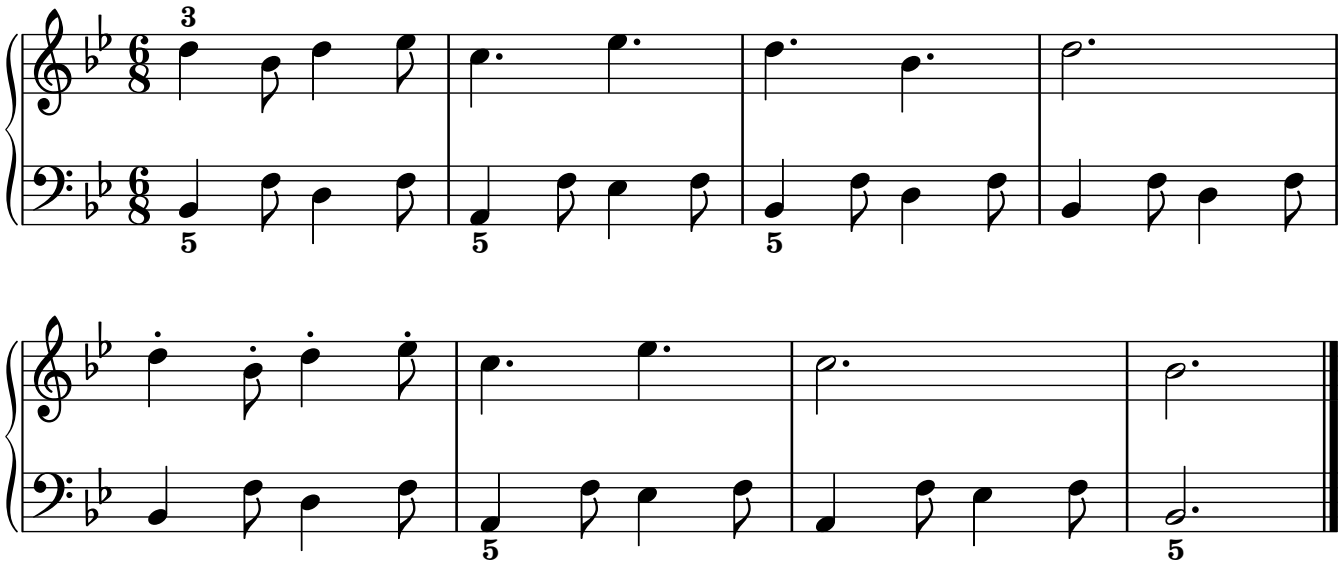


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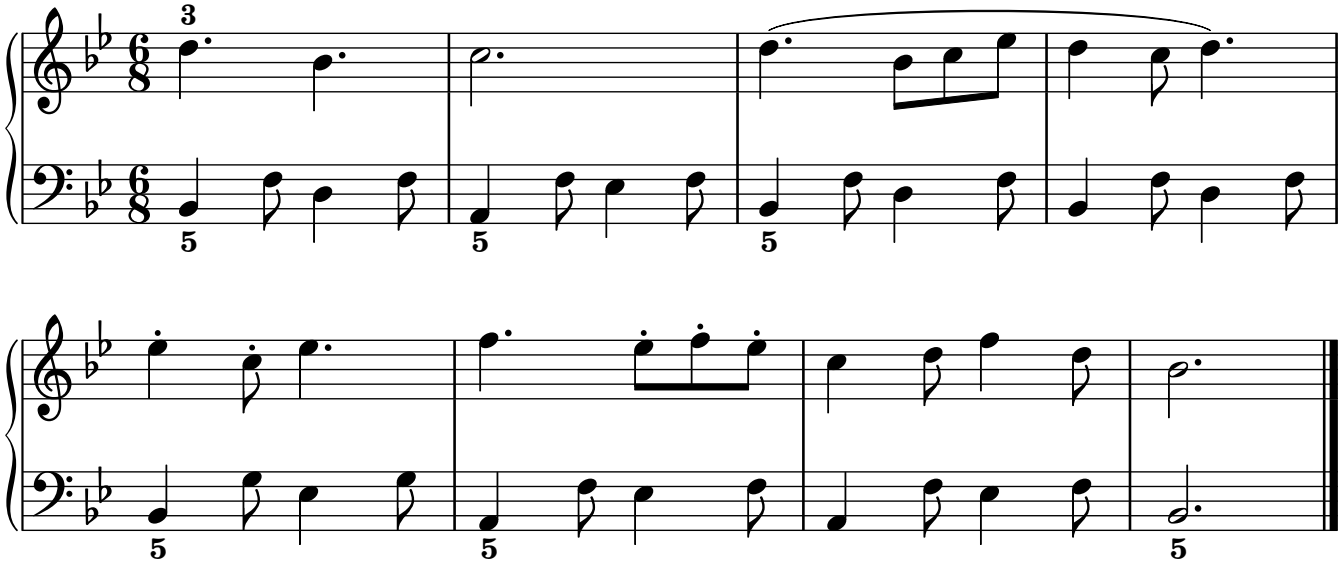


☐ **10.11**
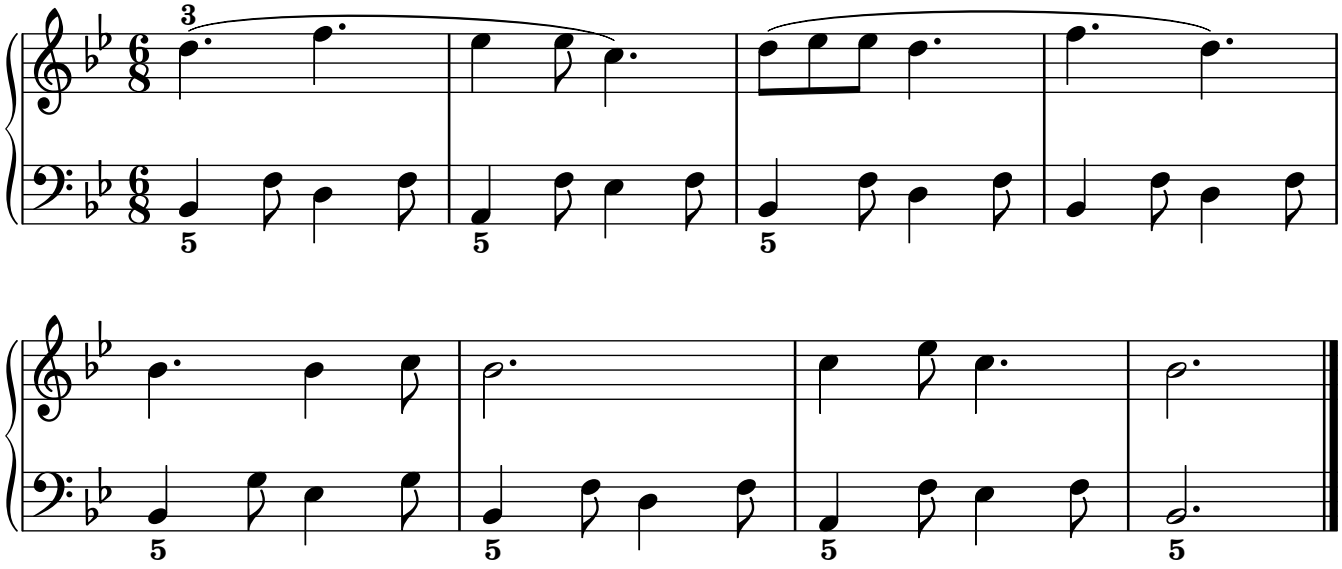


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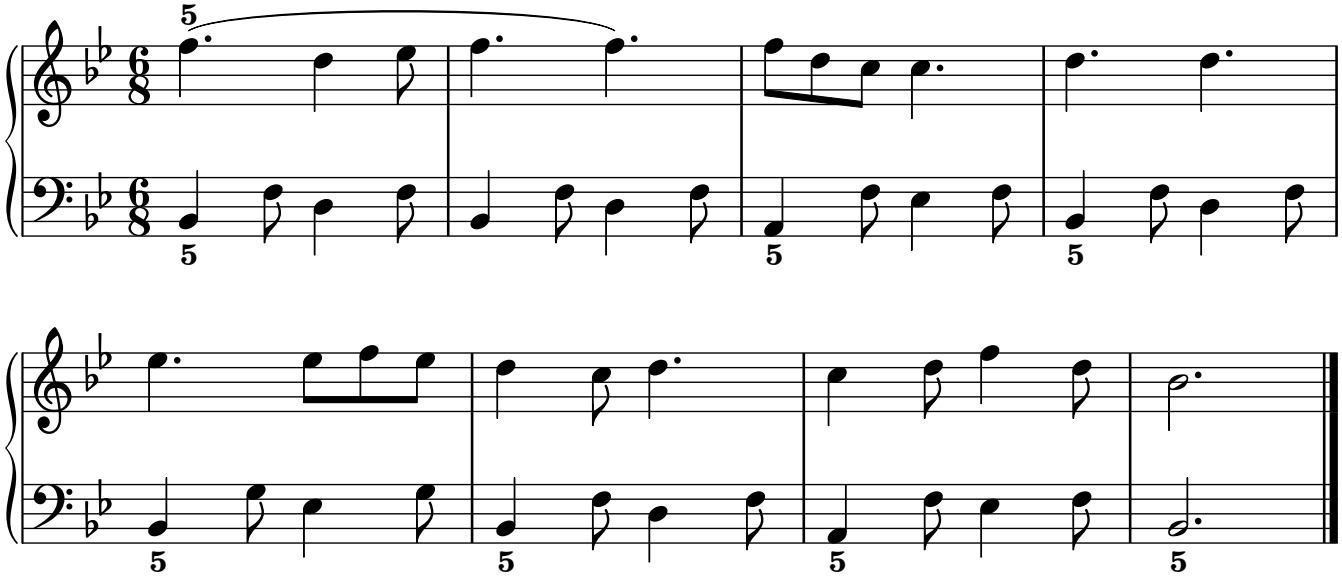
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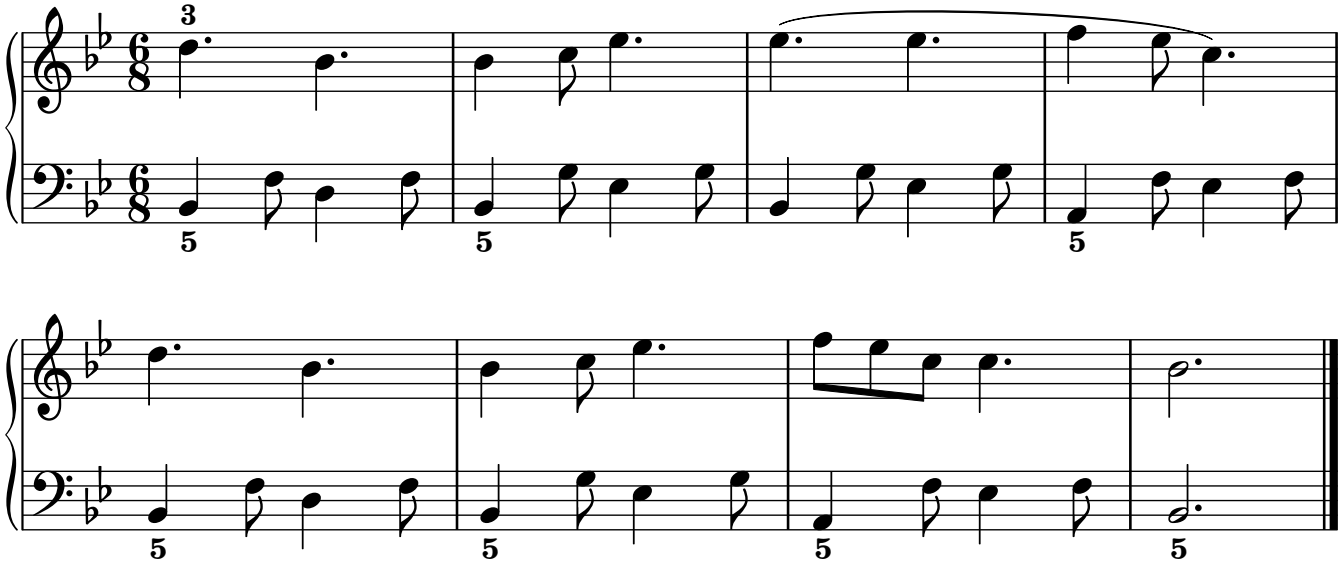


10.14



10.15
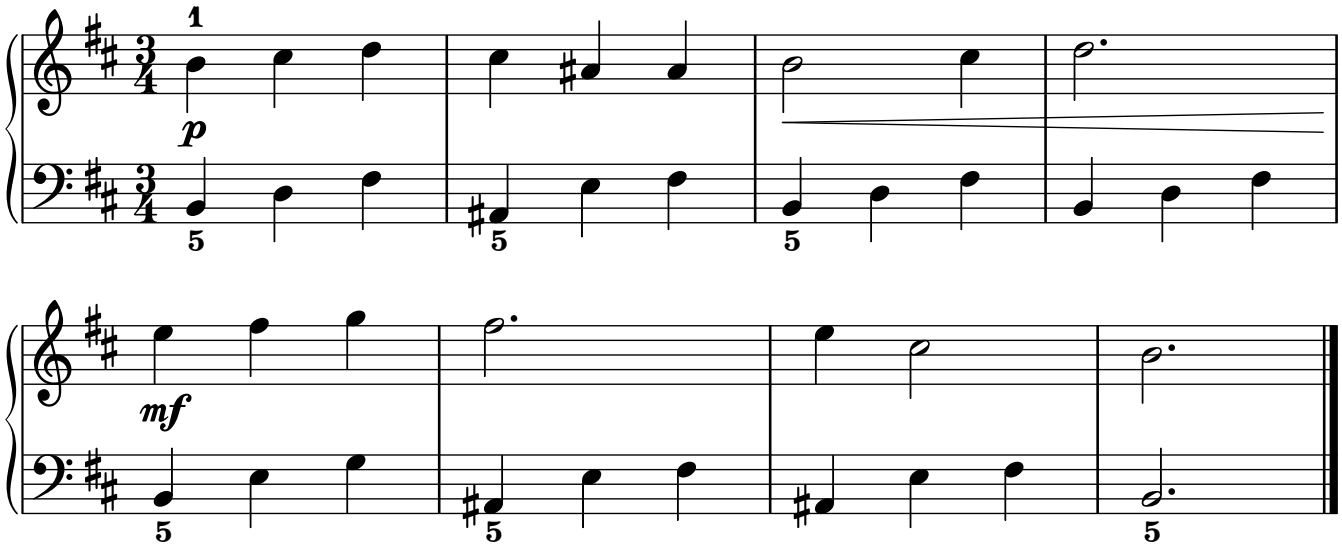


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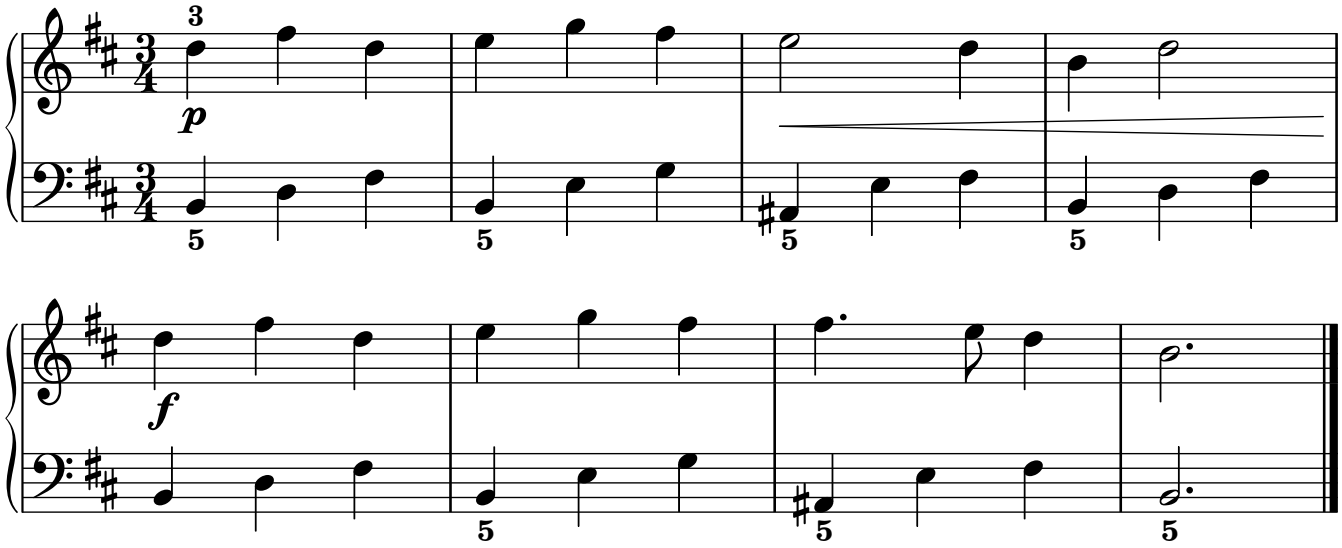


Part C: A B minor waltz ♩ = 72

A B minor waltz: watch for A-sharp in both hands.
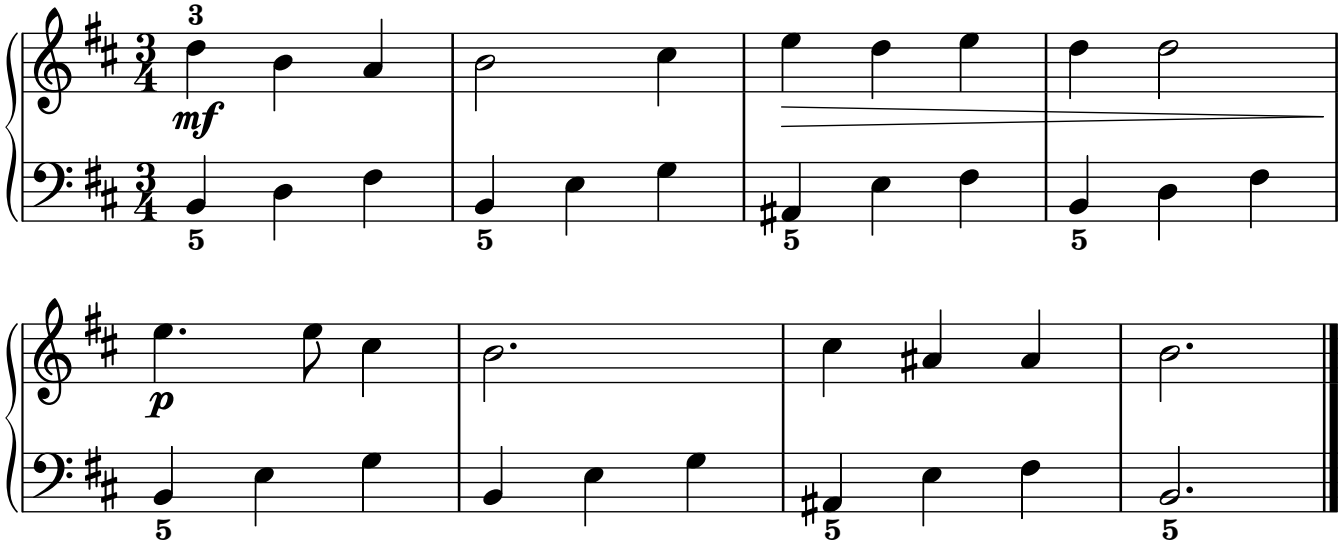
☐ **10.17**
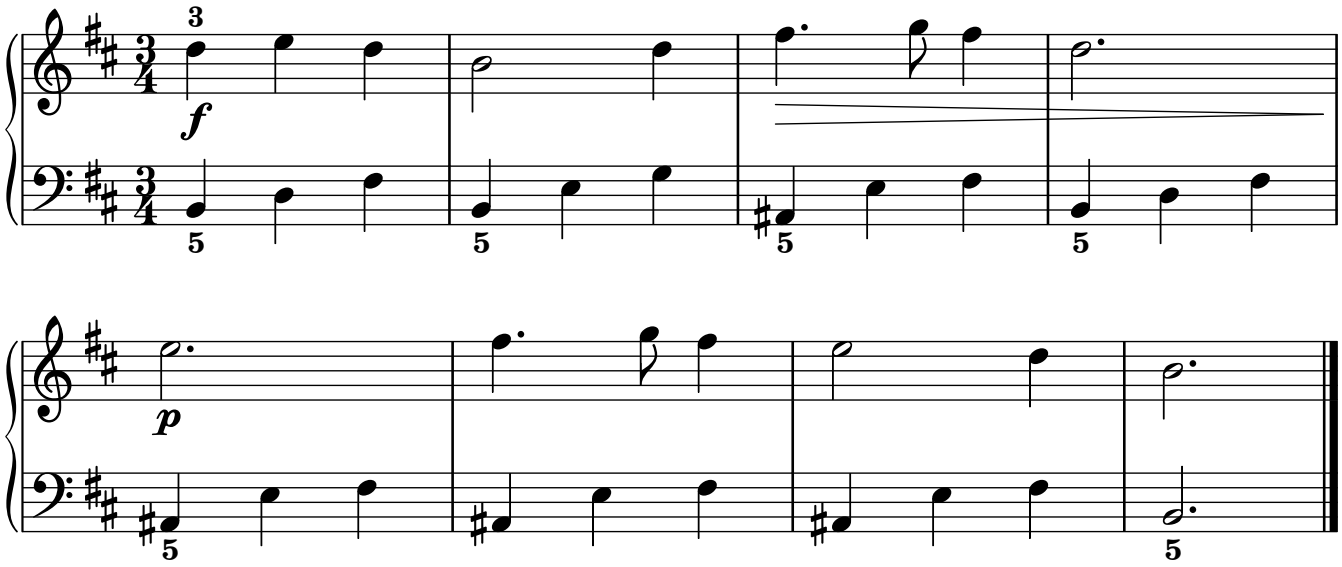


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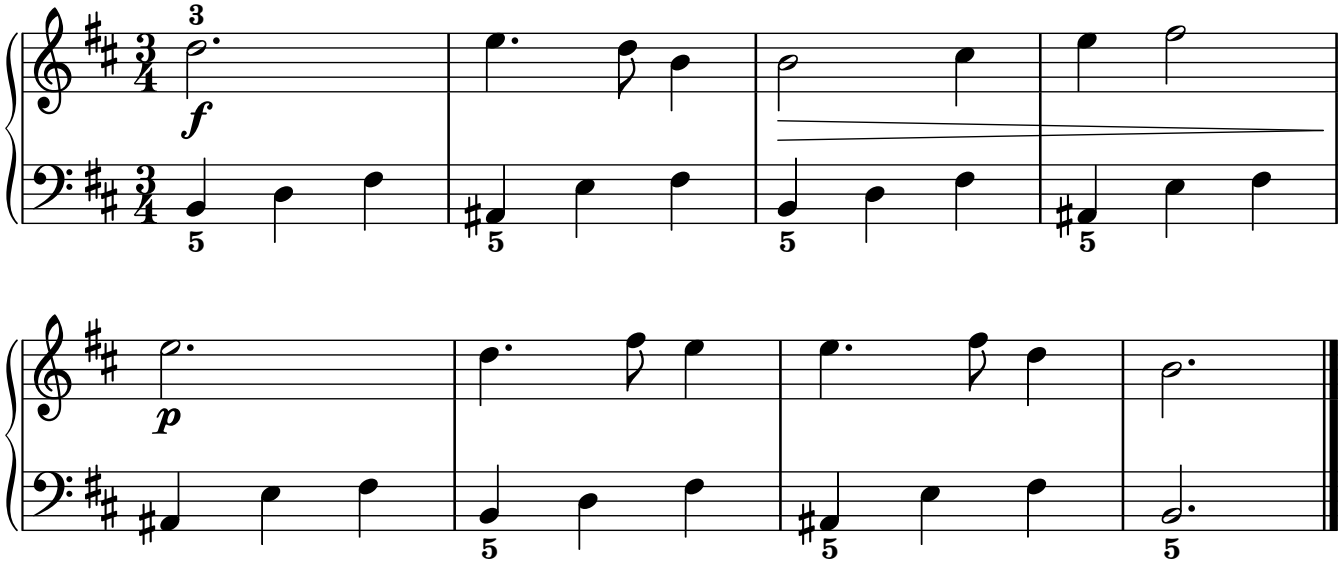


☐ **10.19**
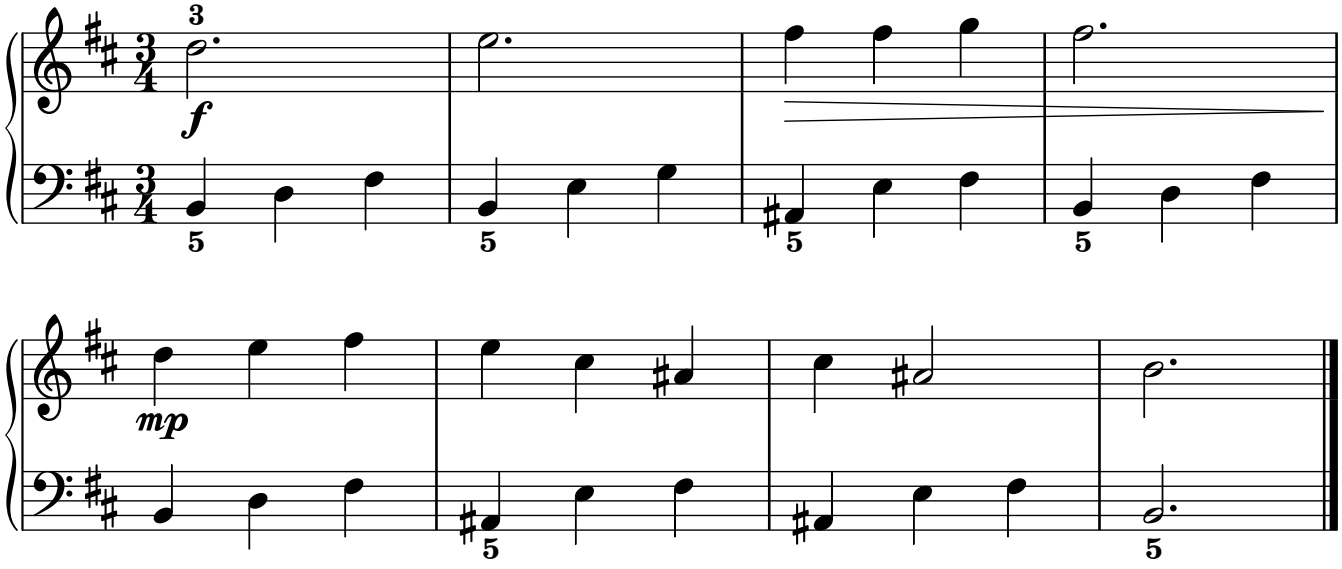


10.20



10.21



10.22
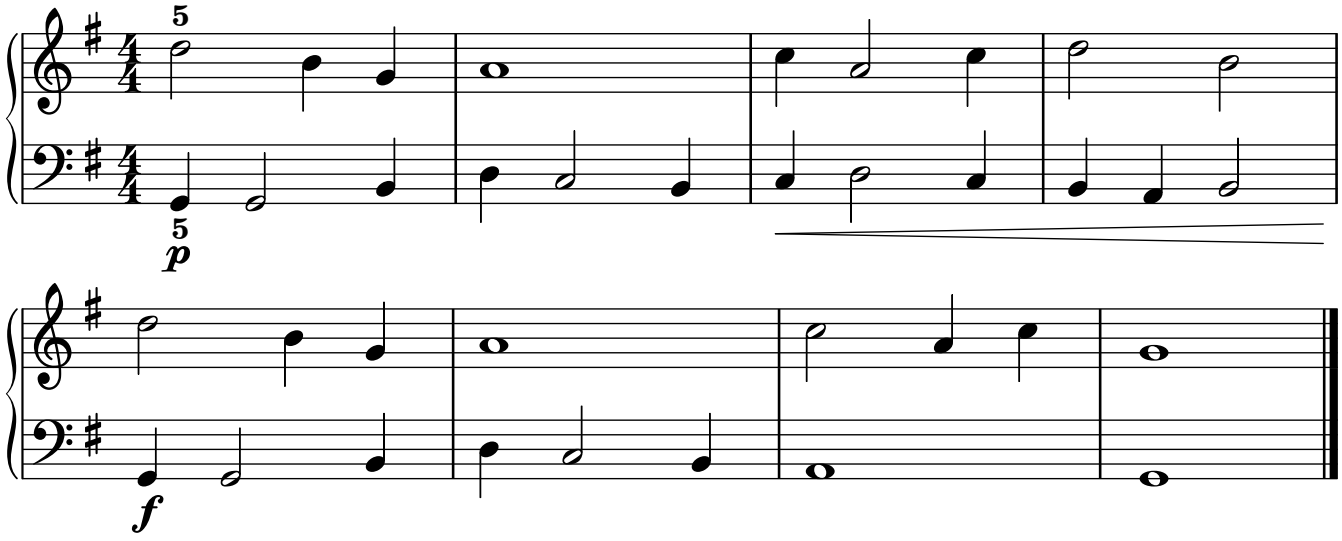


Part D: Two voices, the tune below
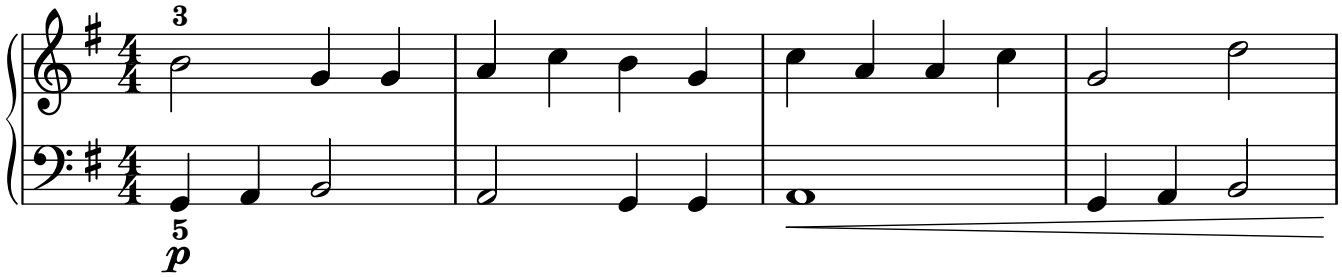
♩ = 60

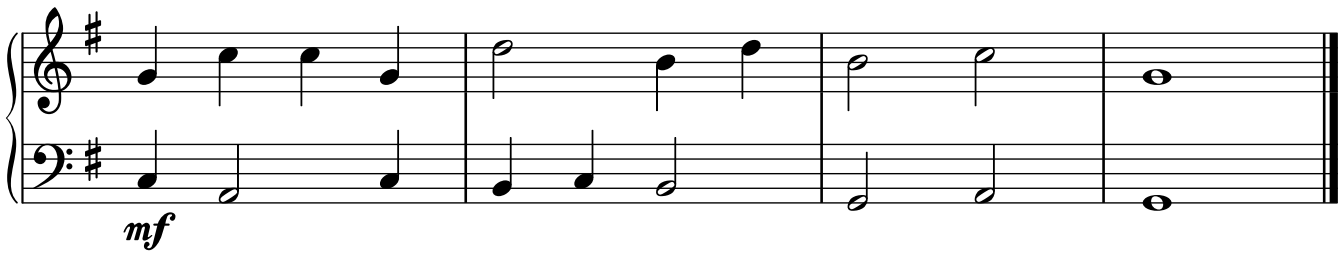
G major. The tune is in the left hand, and the right hand plays a second melody above it.

☐ **10.23**
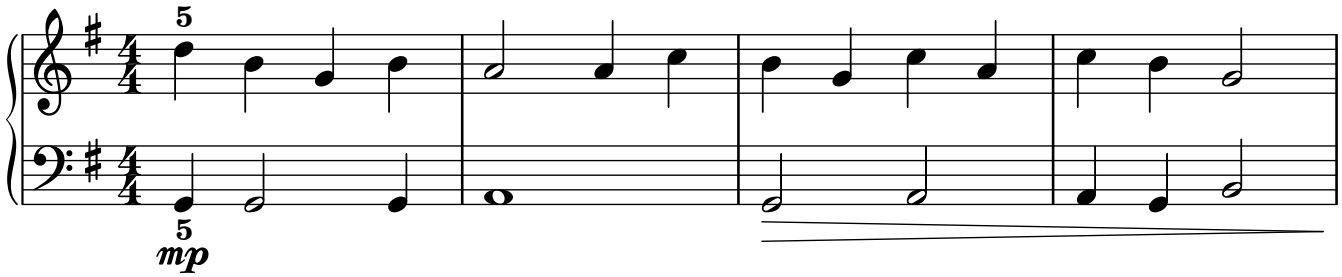


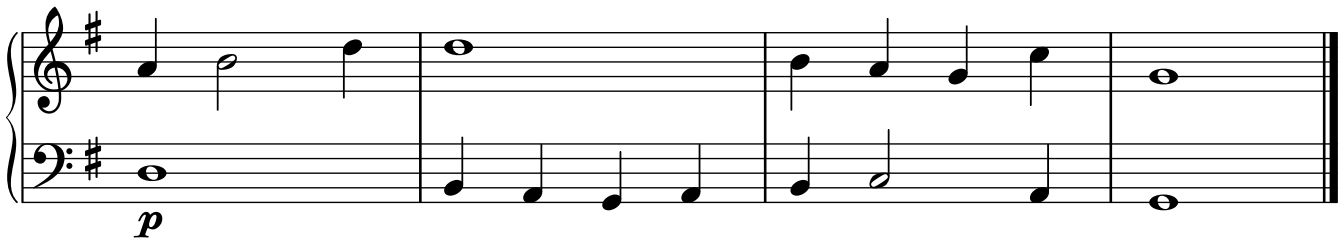
☐ **10.24**
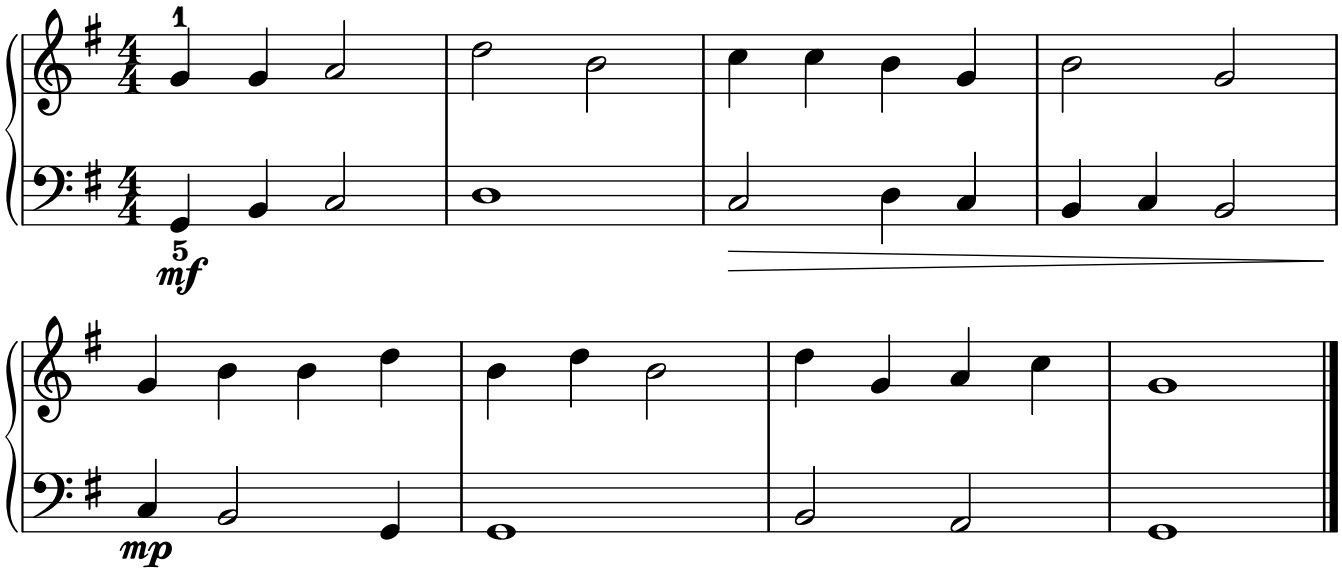




☐ **10.25**
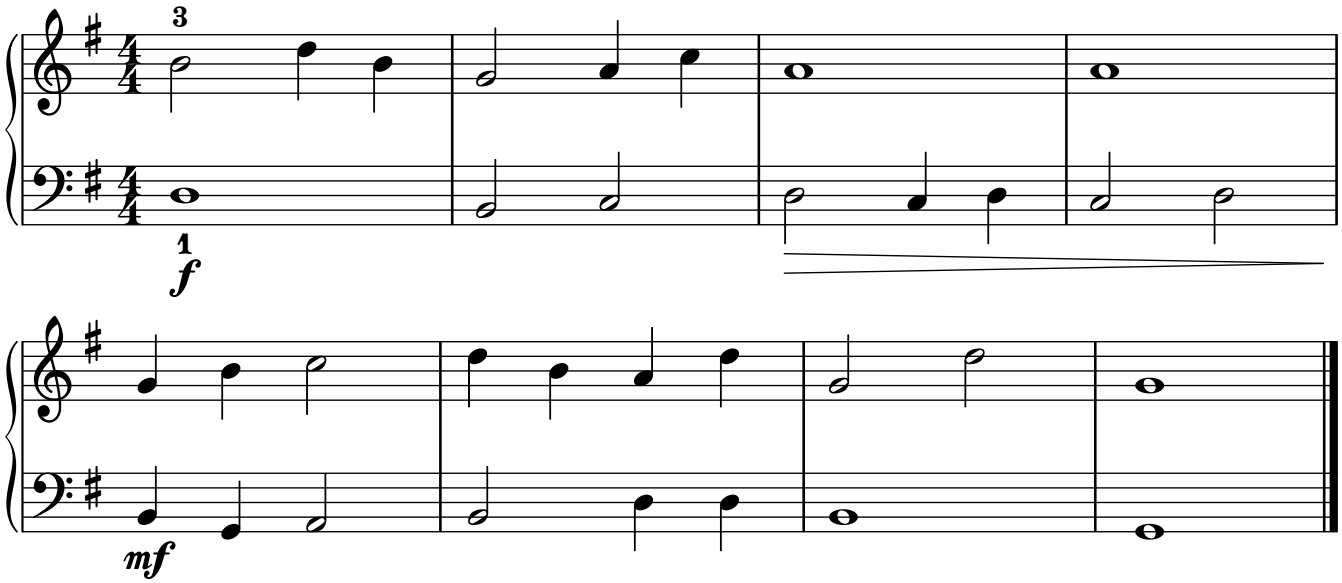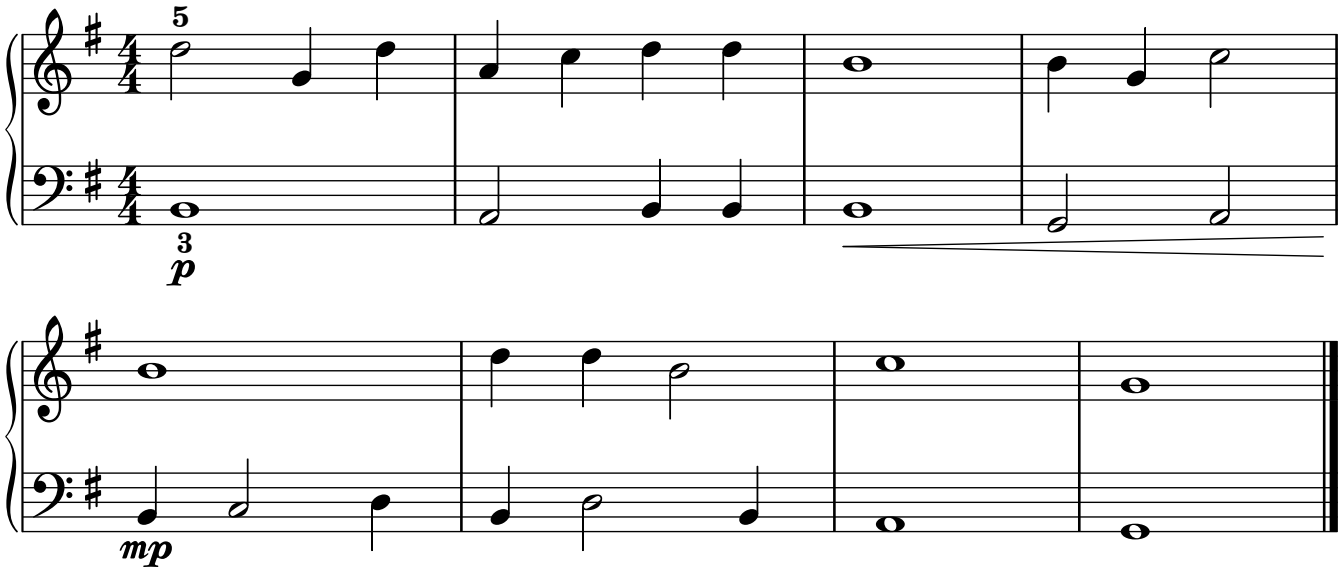




10.26



10.27
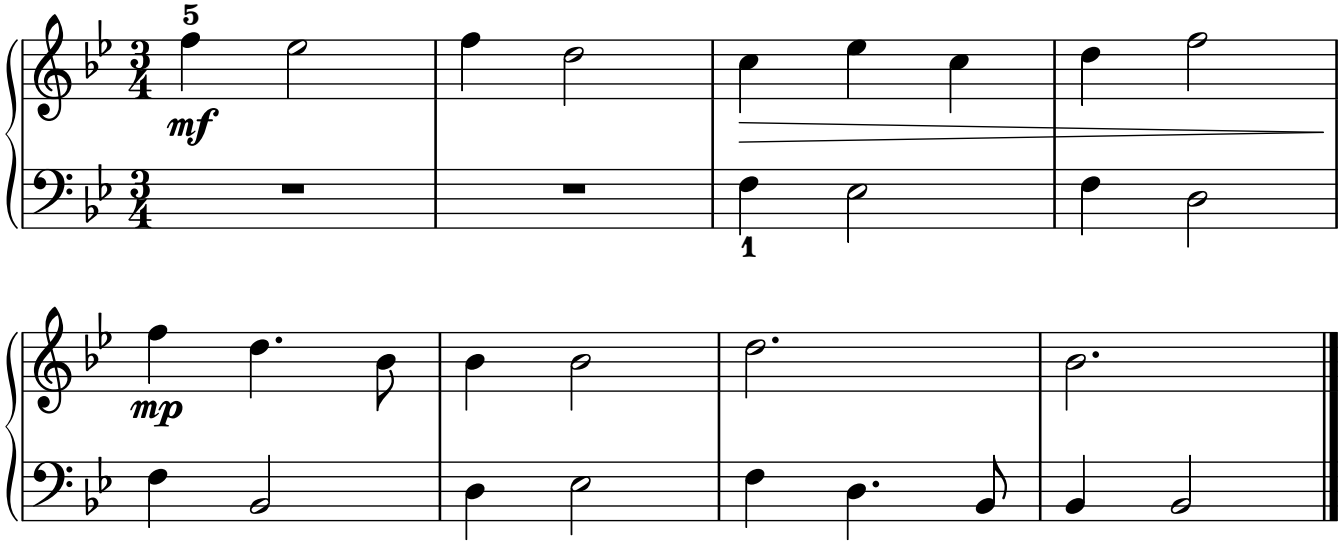


10.28
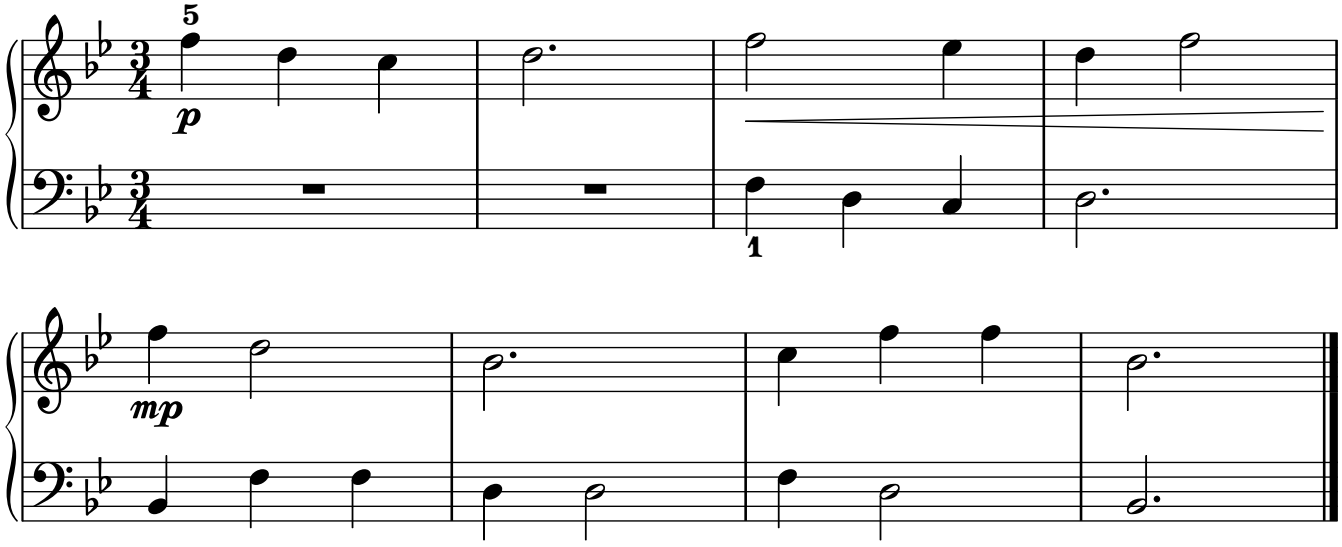


Part E: Imitation in B-flat major ♩ = 72

B-flat major imitation in 3/4.
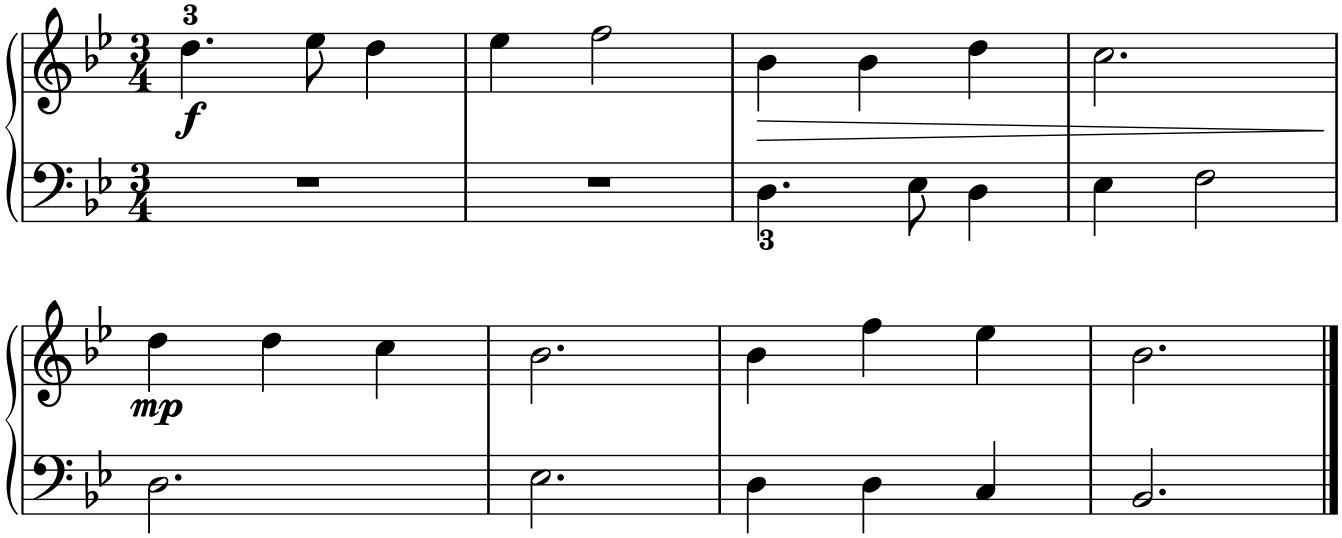
☐ **10.29**
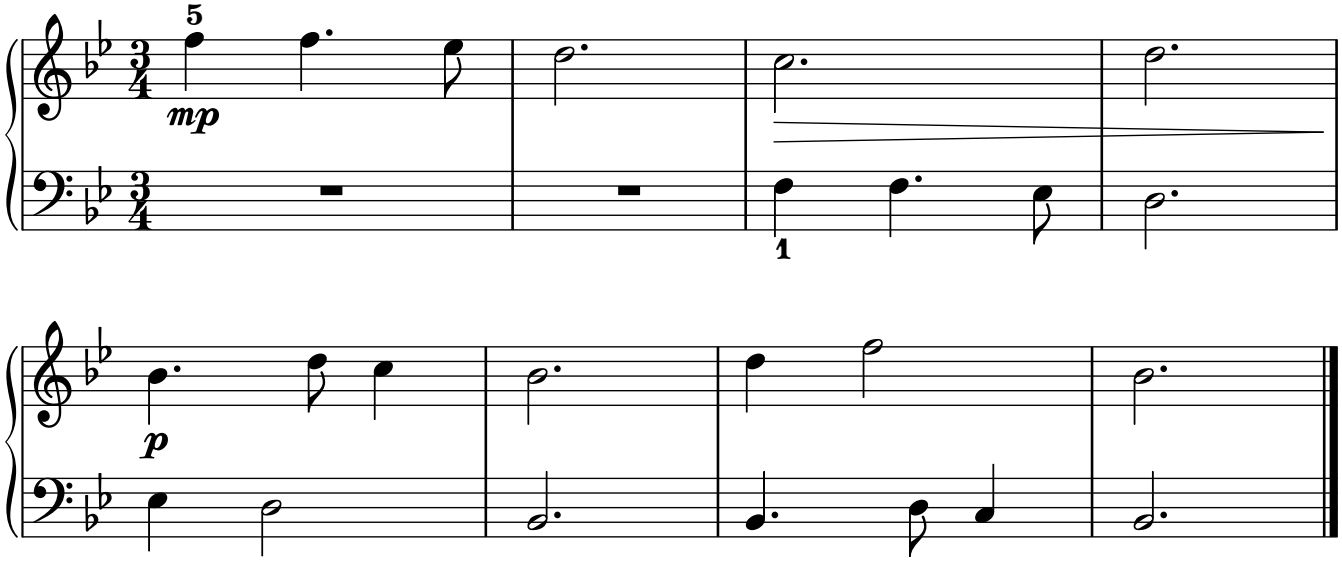


☐ **10.30**
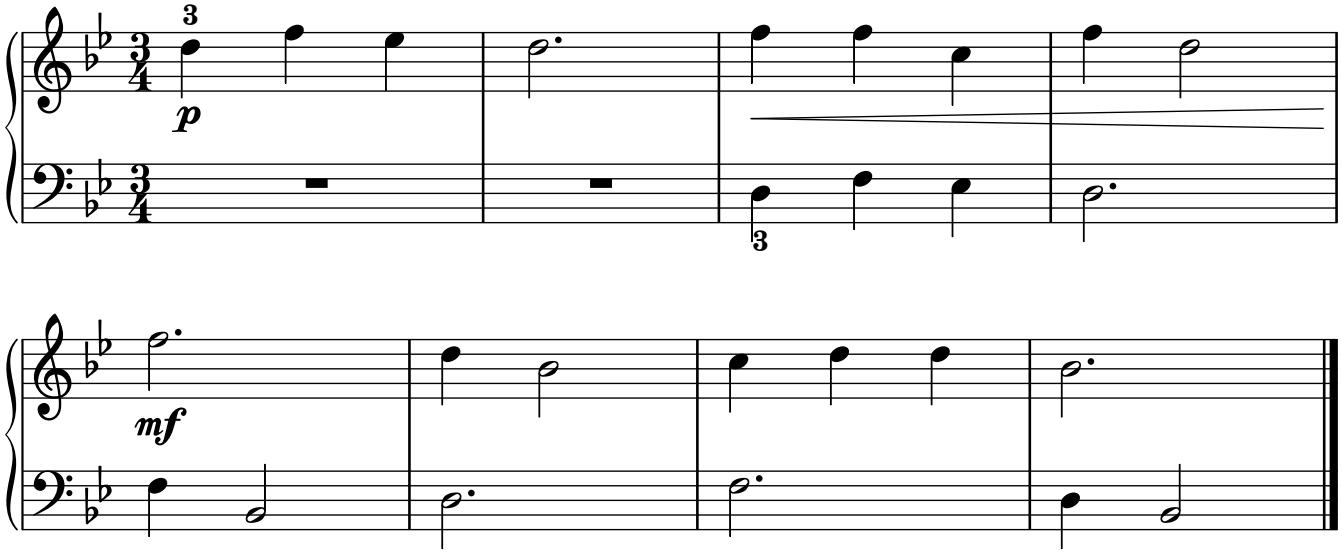


☐ **10.31**
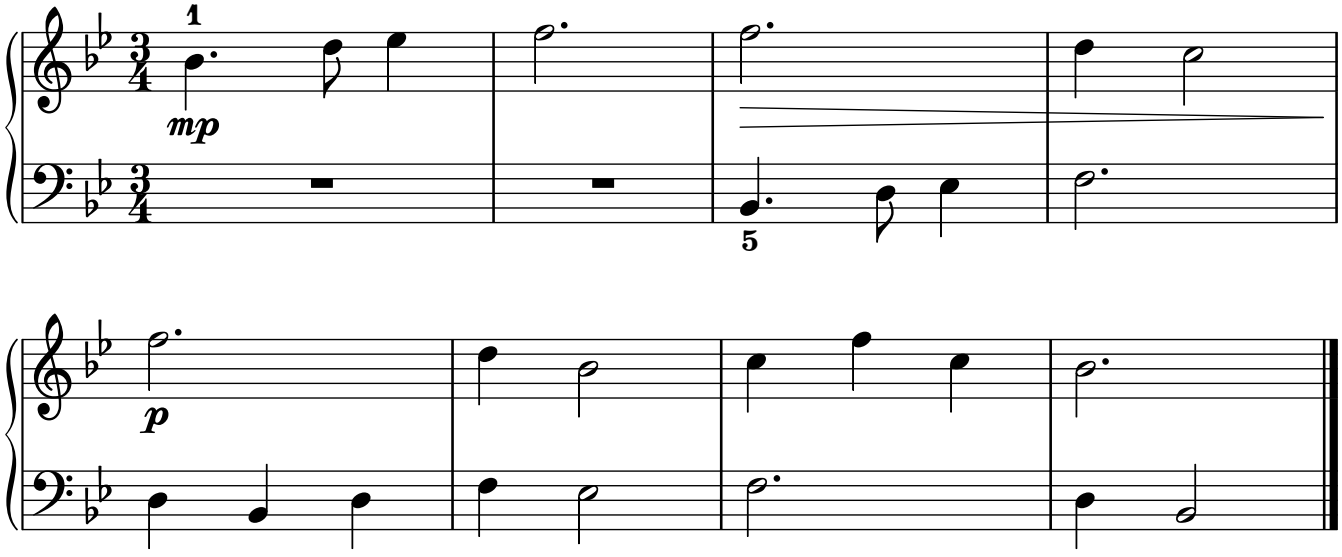


10.32



10.33



10.34
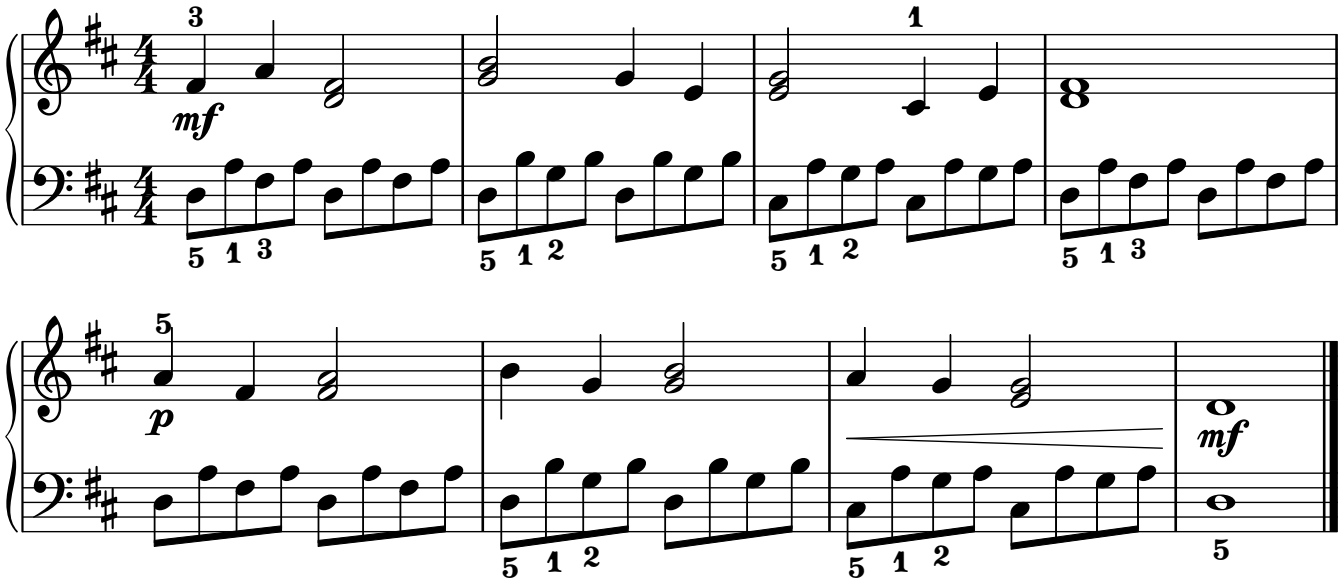


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Spring Rondo ♩ = 72

Original
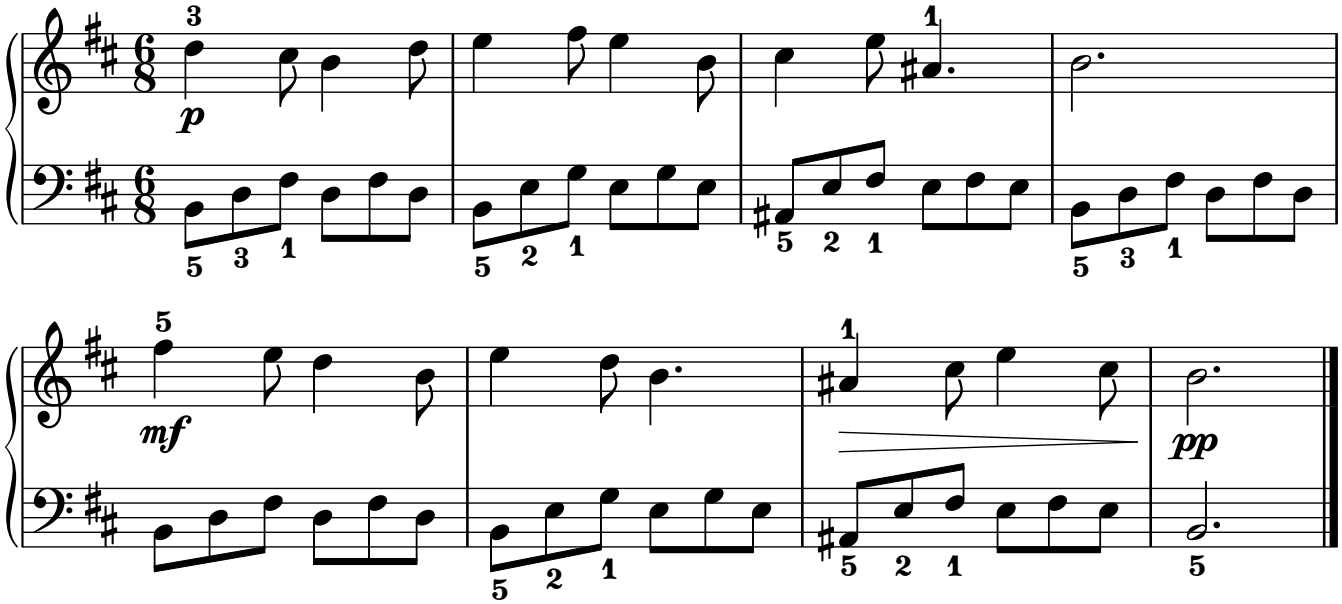
An Alberti bass in D major under a tune with thirds. In bar 3 the right-hand thumb stretches down to C-sharp, and in bar 6 finger 5 stretches up to B.



Night Song ♩. = 48

Original

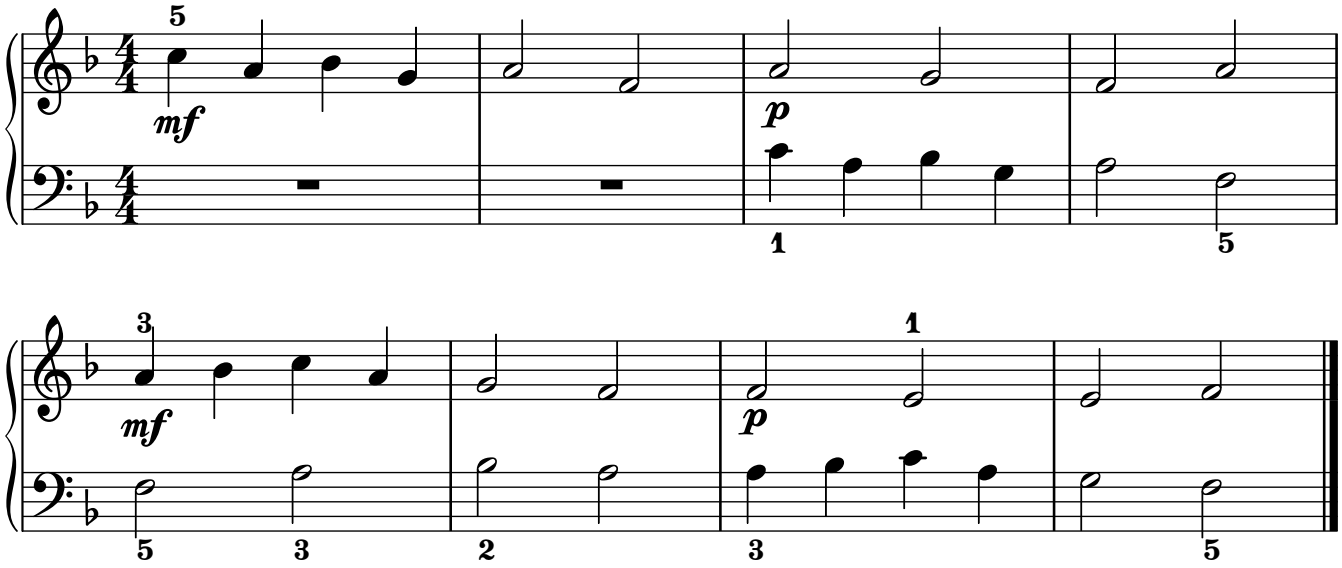
B minor in 6/8 over rolling eighths. A-sharp, the raised 7th, comes in bars 3 and 7 in both hands.



Little Canon in F ♩= 76

Original

Both hands in F position, as in Units 1 and 7. Two short tunes, each copied an octave lower by the left hand two bars later. In bars 5 and 6 the left hand plays a counter-melody under the second tune.



Checkpoint: ready for Volume 4?

- Play two new exercises from each part (A to E) at the speeds shown, naming the key and time before you start.
- Pass if you keep the beat with no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, you have finished Volume 3. If one skill keeps tripping you up, go back to its unit for a week.